Australian Business Conditions and Confidence, March

#businessconditions #confidence

By Luka Belobrajdic
Economist, Westpac

15:05 April 14 2026

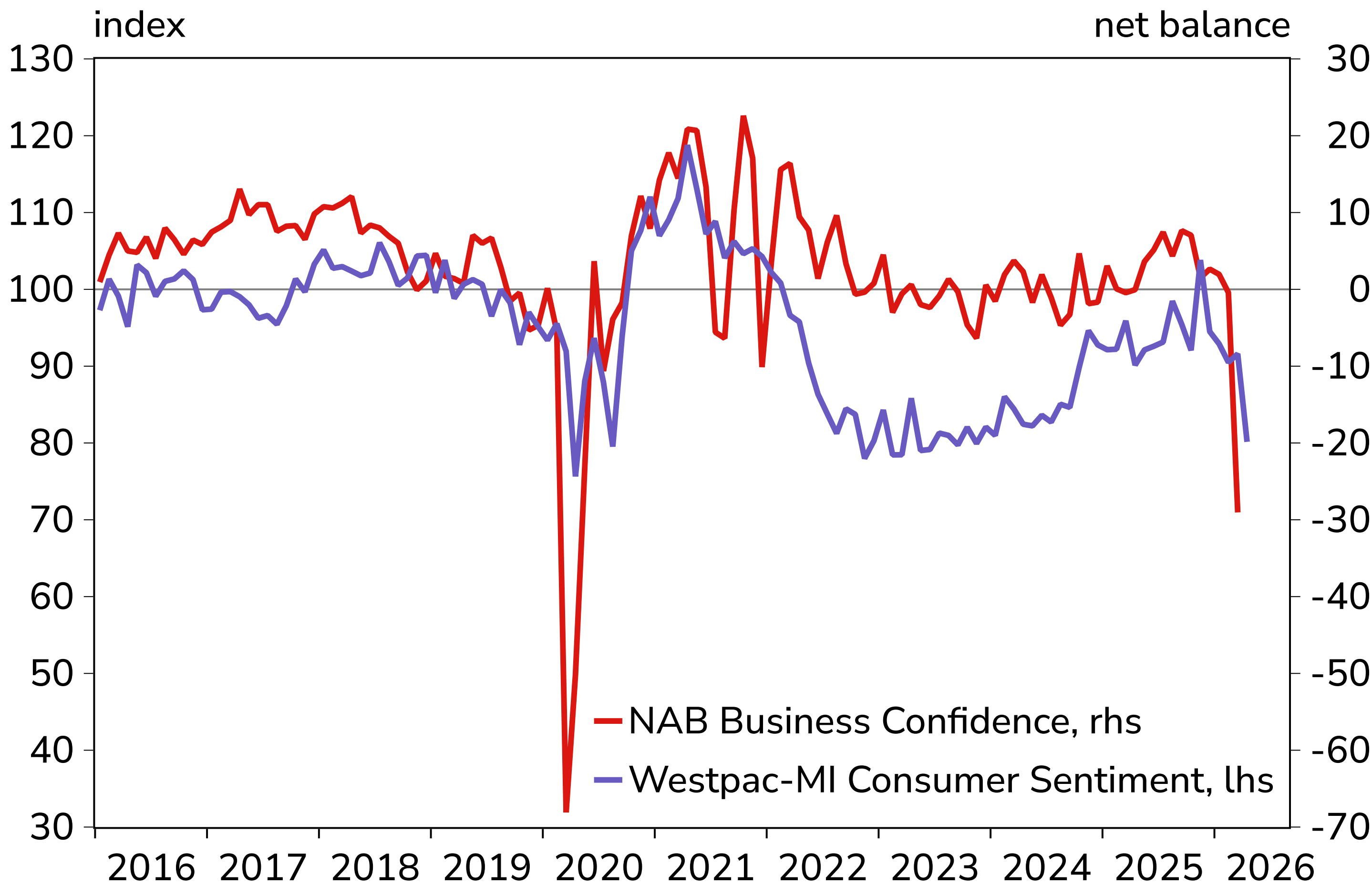
Share

Business confidence collapsed in response to the outbreak of the Middle East conflict, while current assessments of business conditions remain stable, for now. Confidence -29pts to -29 / Conditions unchanged at 6.

The March NAB Business Survey was in the field from 24 to 31 March. It provides the first complete read on business conditions and confidence since the outbreak of the Middle East conflict, the subsequent surge in fuel prices, and dual RBA rate hikes in February and March. Against this backdrop, business confidence collapsed a staggering –29pts from a neutral reading in February, representing the largest monthly decline since the onset of the pandemic in March 2020, and exceeds the fall recorded during the global financial crisis in October 2008. Confidence now sits 34pts below its long-run average. The timing and magnitude of the decline mirrors the sharp deterioration in consumer sentiment that was already evident in later responses to last month's survey. The –12.5% decline reported in April's Westpac-MI Consumer Sentiment survey, published earlier this morning, highlights just how sensitive sentiment is to the evolving policy and geopolitical backdrop.

Cost pressures intensified sharply in March. Purchase cost growth saw its largest monthly increase on record, with the quarterly growth pace more than doubling by 1.7ppt to 3.0%, placing it 1.9ppt above its long-run average. Final product price growth rose by a more modest, but still significant, 0.4ppt to 1.1%, suggesting firms are able to pass on some portion of the increase in fuel and oil-related input costs through prices. That said, the reported surge in costs was well in excess of prices, consistent with intensifying margin pressure and a weaker profitability reading in the month (–3pts to 1). Labour cost growth was unchanged at 1.5%.

Consumer vs Business Confidence

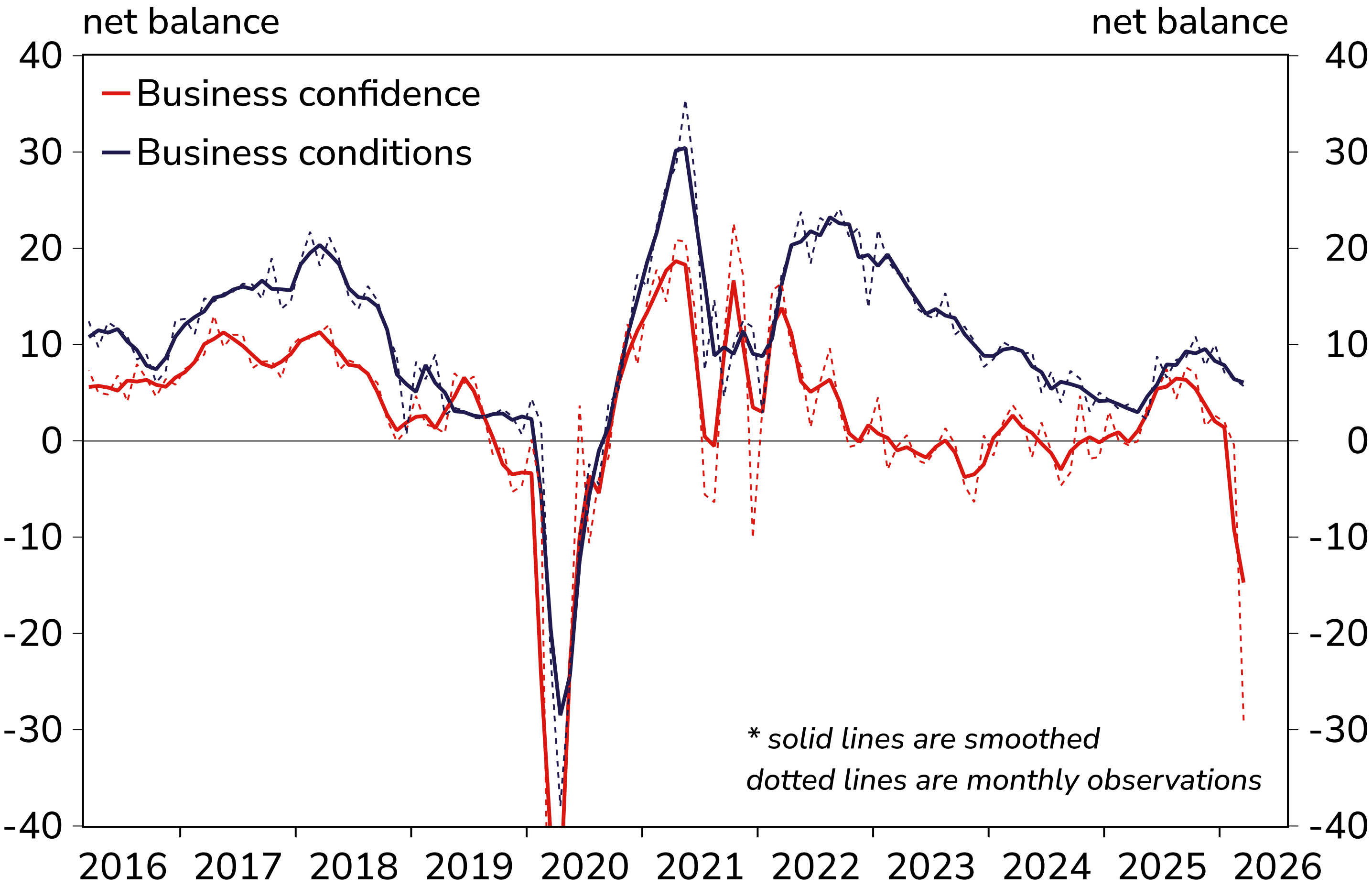


Source: NAB, Melbourne Institute of Applied Economic & Social Research, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Despite unambiguous signs of anxiety, business conditions remained broadly steady through the first quarter of 2026. The headline business conditions index was unchanged in March at 6, 1pt below its long-run average and following an earlier reading of 7 in January. This suggests firms entered this latest period of heightened uncertainty with a degree of resilience. However, on a three-month rolling average basis, the survey continues to point to a gradual easing in momentum as the elevated readings recorded late last year roll out of the calculation. The extent to which the collapse in confidence starts to bleed into current assessments of conditions will be a key dynamic to monitor over the coming months.

Outside of the aforementioned fall in profitability, the other major sub-components were unalarming. The employment sub-index rebounded in March, rising +3pts to 6, re-establishing a foothold above its long-run average. This largely reflects the lagged response of labour demand to earlier improvements in activity. The outlook for the labour market has certainly deteriorated in light of the Middle East shock, and signs of significantly weaker labour demand are likely to emerge later this year. Trading conditions dipped modestly, down 1pt to 11, consistent with early indications of softer consumer spending from the Westpac-DataX card tracker for March.

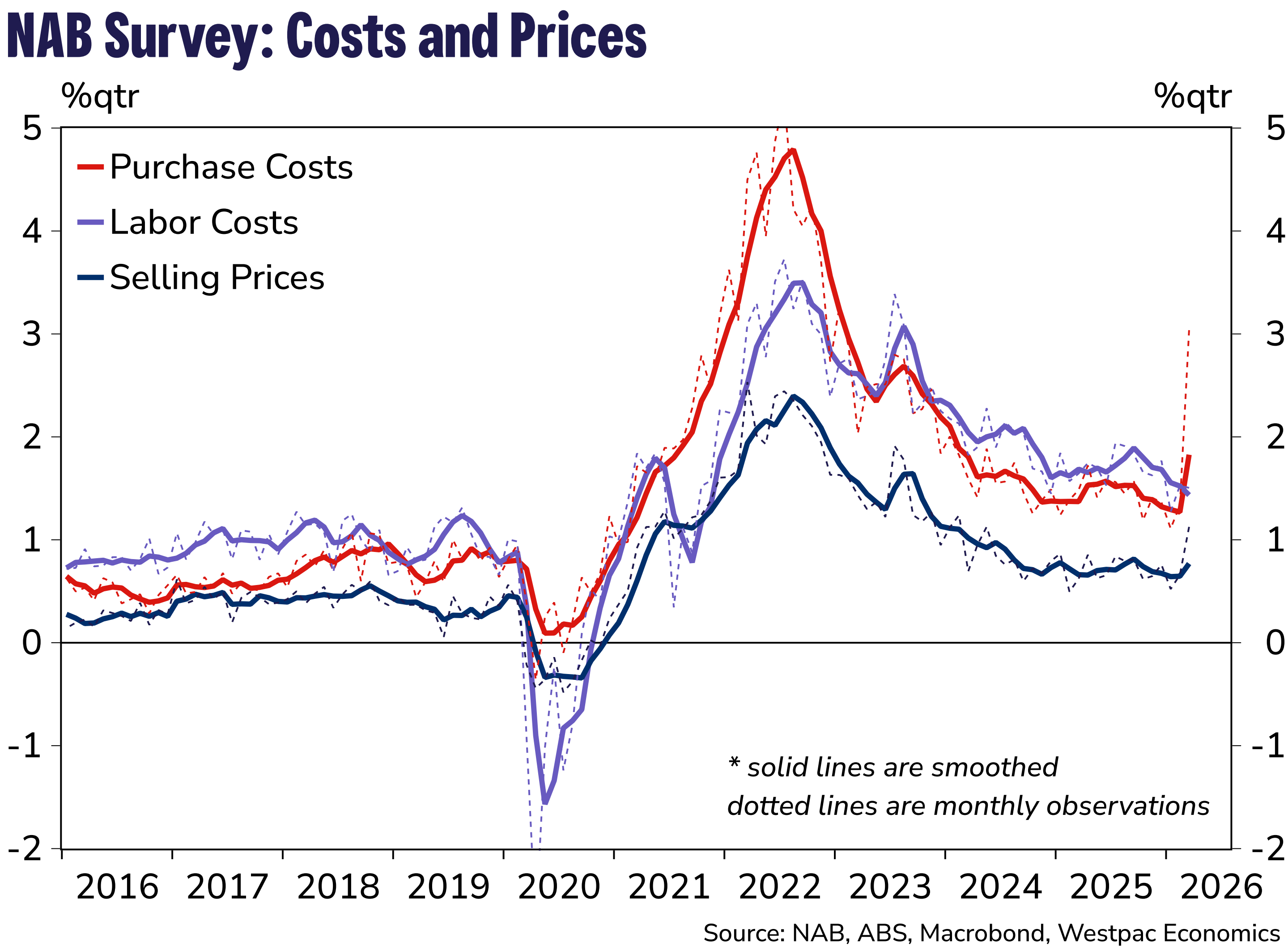
Business conditions and confidence



Source: NAB, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Capacity utilisation edged higher in March to 83.1%, though this increase does little to alter the broader picture, with utilisation broadly stable on a three-month average basis. Capital expenditure eased slightly following its elevated February outcome, declining –2pts to 10, but remains 4pts above its long-run average, indicating continued if cautious investment intentions.

Among other indicators, forward orders weakened, falling -7pts to -1 and recording its first below-average reading of 2026, consistent with the collapse in confidence. Inventories rose a further 2pts to 7, though this likely reflects softer trading conditions in March following the strong build-up in forward orders reported in the previous month.



Stay informed with Westpac IQ

Get the latest reports straight to your inbox.

Subscribe

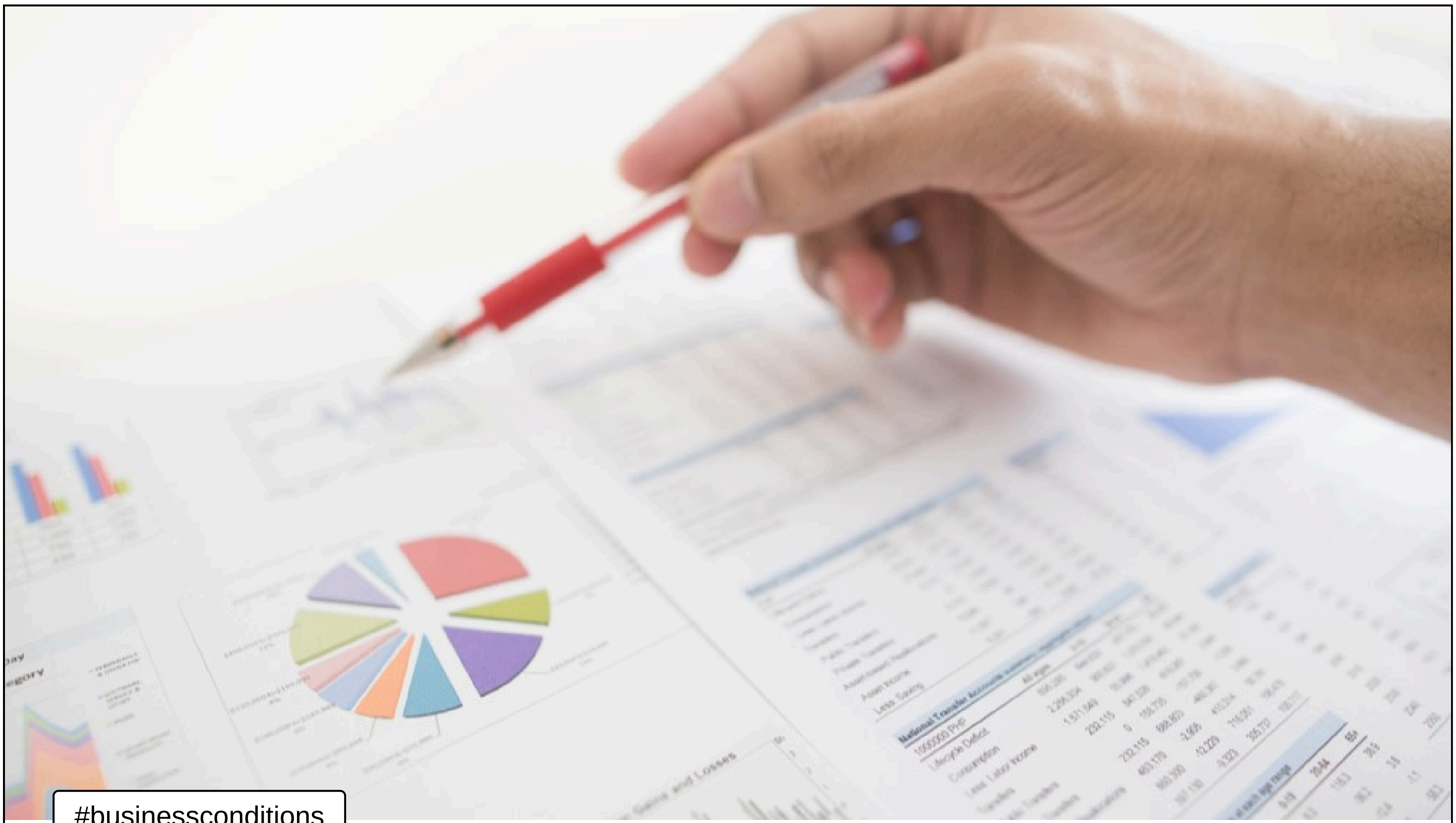
Related articles

#businessconditions

First Impressions: NZ business confidence, March 2026

March 31 2026 • 2 mins

By Michael Gordon



#businessconditions

Australian Business Conditions and Confidence, February

March 10 2026 • 5 mins

By Luka Belobrajdic

#businessconditions

First Impressions: NZ business confidence, February 2026

February 26 2026 • 2 mins

By Michael Gordon

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve #newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx #rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission (“CFTC”) as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (“FDIC”). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC (‘WCM’), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 (‘the Exchange Act’) and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority (‘FINRA’). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

“professional clients” as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for “retail clients”. Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area (“EEA”): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH (“WEG”) under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority (‘BaFin’) and subject to its regulation. WEG’s supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank (‘Deutsche Bundesbank’). WEG is registered with the commercial register (‘Handelsregister’) of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA’s Prudential Standard 222 ‘Association with Related Entities’, Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an ‘investment recommendation’ and/or ‘information recommending or suggesting an investment’, both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) (“MAR”). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

10 April 2026

MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

Key themes

There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with the US Iran ceasefire largely holding.

Sentiment received a boost and oil retraced some of its spike after Israel announced it will hold talks with Lebanon, increasing the likelihood of a broader Middle East ceasefire.

US equities extended their rally, while the late session rally in European equities was unable to fully retrace earlier losses.

US bond yields were slightly lower across the curve, potentially reflecting softer spending and labour market partials coming out of the US. The US dollar index also retreated, with risk currencies such as the Aussie outperforming.

Oil continued to rise earlier in the session but pulled back sharply after Israel announced discussions.

Data snapshot

FX Last 24 hrs	Current	Change
TWI	65.3	-0.5%
AUD/USD	0.7083	0.5%
AUD/JPY	112.60	0.8%
AUD/GBP	0.5272	0.2%
AUD/NZD	1.2092	-0.1%
AUD/EUR	0.6055	0.3%
AUD/CNH	4.8359	0.5%
AUD/SGD	0.9013	0.5%
AUD/HKD	5.5487	0.6%
AUD/CAD	0.9785	0.3%
EUR/USD	1.1698	0.3%
USD/JPY	158.98	0.2%
USD Index	98.80	-0.3%

AUS Interest Rate Swaps	Last	Change
30 day BBSY	4.11	0.00
90 day BBSY	4.37	0.00
180 day BBSY	4.83	0.00
1 year swap	4.57	-0.01
2 year swap	4.61	-0.03
3 year swap	4.59	-0.03
4 year swap	4.58	-0.02
5 year swap	4.61	-0.01
6 year swap	4.65	-0.01
7 year swap	4.70	-0.01
8 year swap	4.74	-0.01
9 year swap	4.79	-0.01
10 year swap	5.03	-0.02

Equities	Close	Change
S&P/ASX 200	8,973	0.2%
S&P 500	6,825	0.6%
Japan Nikkei	55,895	-0.7%
Hang Seng	25,752	-0.5%
Euro Stoxx 50	5,896	-0.3%
UK FTSE100	10,603	-0.1%
VIX Index	19.49	-7.4%

Commodities	Current	Change
CRB Index	368.55	0.6%
Gold	4766.89	1.0%
Copper	12682	-0.2%
Oil (WTI futures)	97.87	3.7%
Coal (coking)	229.00	-1.5%
Coal (thermal)	133.85	-0.6%
Iron Ore	103.30	-2.6%
ACCU	36.13	-4.3%

Government Bond Yields	Close	Change
Australia		
3 year bond	4.60	0.05
10 year bond	4.91	0.05
United States		
3-month T Bill	3.59	-0.02
2 year bond	3.77	-0.02
10 year bond	4.28	-0.02
Other (10 year yields)		
Germany	2.99	0.04
Japan	2.39	0.02
UK	4.75	0.04

Sydney Futures Exchange	Current	Change
10 yr bond	4.95	0.01
3 yr bond	4.60	-0.02
3 mth bill rate	4.32	0.14
SPI 200	8,995	-0.1%

Data as at 7:30am AEDT. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac Group
P: +61 468 571 786
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Financial Markets

- There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with reports suggesting Iran will allow tankers and cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz only with its military's consent. Sentiment received a late boost in the session after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu said he had agreed to negotiations with Lebanon.
- US equities extended their rally, more than retracing earlier market losses following the announcement that Israel will hold talks with Lebanon. Weaker-than-expected partial labour market and spending data from the US also helped push yields lower, supporting the rally. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average both closed around 0.6% higher, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq finished up 0.8%. The VIX declined almost 8% during the session, falling below 20pts.
- European equities ended Thursday lower, with the late-session rally unable to fully offset earlier losses. The Euro Stoxx 50 closed 0.3% lower, Germany's DAX was down 1.1%, potentially reflecting some softer than expected activity data coming out of Germany, and the FTSE 100 finished 0.1% in the red. Asian equities were also weaker, with Japan's Nikkei down 0.7% and the Hang Seng falling 0.5%. Locally, the S&P/ASX 200 edged 0.2% higher to 8,973. Futures are little changed, with the SPI 200 down 0.1%.
- Bond markets saw modest moves. In the US, Treasury yields eased, with the 2-year down 2bps to 3.77% and the 10-year also down 2bps to 4.28%, potentially reflecting the flow of US data. Interest rate futures now price no change through 2026. European yields were generally higher across the curve.
- Australian government bond yields were also little changed on futures, with the 3-year down 2bps to 4.60% and the 10-year up 1bp to 4.95%. OIS pricing suggests a terminal cash rate this year of around 4.7%, with the first full rate hike pencilled in for June and another by September.
- In FX markets, the USD weakened, with the DXY down 0.3% to 98.8. The Aussie outperformed, rising 0.5% to 0.7083 against the USD and strengthening broadly across most crosses. However, the TWI fell 0.5%, reflecting relative softness versus Asian currencies.
- Commodity markets were mixed. Oil prices ended higher, and at one-point WTI futures rose to almost US$105/bbl, before retracing much of the spike following the announcement of Israel-Lebanon discussions.

Today's key data and events

Time	Event	Exp	Prev
0:00	US Wholesale Inventories Feb Final	-0.1%	-0.5%
11:30	CN PPI Mar	0.4%	-0.9%
11:30	CN CPI Mar	1.1%	1.3%
22:30	US CPI Mar	0.9%	0.3%
0:00	US Factory Orders Feb	-0.2%	0.1%
0:00	US Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment Apr Prel.	51.5pts	53.3pts
0:00	US Durable Goods Orders Feb Final	-	-1.4%

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

- The price spike occurred amid reports that shipping traffic has yet to pick up through the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran stating that the strait would remain closed to most traffic until Israel ends its attacks on Hezbollah in Lebanon. WTI futures finished 3.7% higher at US$97.87/bbl. Gold rose 1.0% to US$4,766/oz, while the CRB index lifted 0.6%. Industrial metals were softer, with copper down 0.2%, while iron ore fell 2.6% to US$103.30/t.

International Data

US initial jobless claims edged up last week to 219k. This is slightly above the 2026 year-to-date average of 212k.

US personal income decreased 0.1%mth, which was the worst result since May last year. Personal spending rose by 0.5%mth in nominal terms. However, after accounting for higher inflation, real spending increased by only 0.1%mth. Following a flat outcome in January, this points to only minimal growth in consumer spending in Q1 to date.

The **US personal income and spending** data for February suggested that inflationary pressures were building even before the global energy price shock. The PCE deflator rose by 0.4%mth, the strongest monthly increase in twelve months. The annual pace was unchanged at 2.8%yr, while the three-month annualised pace increased to 3.5%.

The **US final Q4 national accounts** estimates confirmed that consumption grew by 0.5%qtr, or 1.9%qtr in annualised terms. It was one of the major contributors to the 0.5%qtr annualised increase in GDP that quarter, which was revised down from 0.7% previously.

After a notable increase in Q4 last year, **German industrial production** has reverted to a low-growth profile this year. The latest February data showed a 0.3%mth decline in output, well below market expectations for a 0.7%mth increase. Consumer durables fell 1.5%mth and were the main source of weakness, while capital and intermediate goods recorded modest gains. Taken together, the January–February point to a 0.5% decline in production in Q1. With energy prices having surged in March, near-term growth may be even weaker.

Local Data

There was no top-tier economic data released yesterday.

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

IQ
westpaciq.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given above are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The results ultimately achieved may differ substantially from these forecasts.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

10 April 2026

MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

Key themes

There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with the US Iran ceasefire largely holding.

Sentiment received a boost and oil retraced some of its spike after Israel announced it will hold talks with Lebanon, increasing the likelihood of a broader Middle East ceasefire.

US equities extended their rally, while the late session rally in European equities was unable to fully retrace earlier losses.

US bond yields were slightly lower across the curve, potentially reflecting softer spending and labour market partials coming out of the US. The US dollar index also retreated, with risk currencies such as the Aussie outperforming.

Oil continued to rise earlier in the session but pulled back sharply after Israel announced discussions.

Data snapshot

FX Last 24 hrs	Current	Change
TWI	65.3	-0.5%
AUD/USD	0.7083	0.5%
AUD/JPY	112.60	0.8%
AUD/GBP	0.5272	0.2%
AUD/NZD	1.2092	-0.1%
AUD/EUR	0.6055	0.3%
AUD/CNH	4.8359	0.5%
AUD/SGD	0.9013	0.5%
AUD/HKD	5.5487	0.6%
AUD/CAD	0.9785	0.3%
EUR/USD	1.1698	0.3%
USD/JPY	158.98	0.2%
USD Index	98.80	-0.3%

AUS Interest Rate Swaps	Last	Change
30 day BBSY	4.11	0.00
90 day BBSY	4.37	0.00
180 day BBSY	4.83	0.00
1 year swap	4.57	-0.01
2 year swap	4.61	-0.03
3 year swap	4.59	-0.03
4 year swap	4.58	-0.02
5 year swap	4.61	-0.01
6 year swap	4.65	-0.01
7 year swap	4.70	-0.01
8 year swap	4.74	-0.01
9 year swap	4.79	-0.01
10 year swap	5.03	-0.02

Equities	Close	Change
S&P/ASX 200	8,973	0.2%
S&P 500	6,825	0.6%
Japan Nikkei	55,895	-0.7%
Hang Seng	25,752	-0.5%
Euro Stoxx 50	5,896	-0.3%
UK FTSE100	10,603	-0.1%
VIX Index	19.49	-7.4%

Government Bond Yields	Close	Change
Australia		
3 year bond	4.60	0.05
10 year bond	4.91	0.05
United States		
3-month T Bill	3.59	-0.02
2 year bond	3.77	-0.02
10 year bond	4.28	-0.02
Other (10 year yields)		
Germany	2.99	0.04
Japan	2.39	0.02
UK	4.75	0.04

Commodities	Current	Change
CRB Index	368.55	0.6%
Gold	4766.89	1.0%
Copper	12682	-0.2%
Oil (WTI futures)	97.87	3.7%
Coal (coking)	229.00	-1.5%
Coal (thermal)	133.85	-0.6%
Iron Ore	103.30	-2.6%
ACCU	36.13	-4.3%

Sydney Futures Exchange	Current	Change
10 yr bond	4.95	0.01
3 yr bond	4.60	-0.02
3 mth bill rate	4.32	0.14
SPI 200	8,995	-0.1%

Data as at 7:30am AEDT. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac Group
P: +61 468 571 786
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Financial Markets

- There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with reports suggesting Iran will allow tankers and cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz only with its military's consent. Sentiment received a late boost in the session after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu said he had agreed to negotiations with Lebanon.
- US equities extended their rally, more than retracing earlier market losses following the announcement that Israel will hold talks with Lebanon. Weaker-than-expected partial labour market and spending data from the US also helped push yields lower, supporting the rally. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average both closed around 0.6% higher, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq finished up 0.8%. The VIX declined almost 8% during the session, falling below 20pts.
- European equities ended Thursday lower, with the late-session rally unable to fully offset earlier losses. The Euro Stoxx 50 closed 0.3% lower, Germany's DAX was down 1.1%, potentially reflecting some softer than expected activity data coming out of Germany, and the FTSE 100 finished 0.1% in the red. Asian equities were also weaker, with Japan's Nikkei down 0.7% and the Hang Seng falling 0.5%. Locally, the S&P/ASX 200 edged 0.2% higher to 8,973. Futures are little changed, with the SPI 200 down 0.1%.
- Bond markets saw modest moves. In the US, Treasury yields eased, with the 2-year down 2bps to 3.77% and the 10-year also down 2bps to 4.28%, potentially reflecting the flow of US data. Interest rate futures now price no change through 2026. European yields were generally higher across the curve.
- Australian government bond yields were also little changed on futures, with the 3-year down 2bps to 4.60% and the 10-year up 1bp to 4.95%. OIS pricing suggests a terminal cash rate this year of around 4.7%, with the first full rate hike pencilled in for June and another by September.
- In FX markets, the USD weakened, with the DXY down 0.3% to 98.8. The Aussie outperformed, rising 0.5% to 0.7083 against the USD and strengthening broadly across most crosses. However, the TWI fell 0.5%, reflecting relative softness versus Asian currencies.
- Commodity markets were mixed. Oil prices ended higher, and at one-point WTI futures rose to almost US$105/bbl, before retracing much of the spike following the announcement of Israel-Lebanon discussions.

Today's key data and events

Time	Event	Exp	Prev
0:00	US Wholesale Inventories Feb Final	-0.1%	-0.5%
11:30	CN PPI Mar	0.4%	-0.9%
11:30	CN CPI Mar	1.1%	1.3%
22:30	US CPI Mar	0.9%	0.3%
0:00	US Factory Orders Feb	-0.2%	0.1%
0:00	US Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment Apr Prel.	51.5pts	53.3pts
0:00	US Durable Goods Orders Feb Final	-	-1.4%

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

- The price spike occurred amid reports that shipping traffic has yet to pick up through the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran stating that the strait would remain closed to most traffic until Israel ends its attacks on Hezbollah in Lebanon. WTI futures finished 3.7% higher at US$97.87/bbl. Gold rose 1.0% to US$4,766/oz, while the CRB index lifted 0.6%. Industrial metals were softer, with copper down 0.2%, while iron ore fell 2.6% to US$103.30/t.

International Data

US initial jobless claims edged up last week to 219k. This is slightly above the 2026 year-to-date average of 212k.

US personal income decreased 0.1%mth, which was the worst result since May last year. Personal spending rose by 0.5%mth in nominal terms. However, after accounting for higher inflation, real spending increased by only 0.1%mth. Following a flat outcome in January, this points to only minimal growth in consumer spending in Q1 to date.

The **US personal income and spending** data for February suggested that inflationary pressures were building even before the global energy price shock. The PCE deflator rose by 0.4%mth, the strongest monthly increase in twelve months. The annual pace was unchanged at 2.8%yr, while the three-month annualised pace increased to 3.5%.

The **US final Q4 national accounts** estimates confirmed that consumption grew by 0.5%qtr, or 1.9%qtr in annualised terms. It was one of the major contributors to the 0.5%qtr annualised increase in GDP that quarter, which was revised down from 0.7% previously.

After a notable increase in Q4 last year, **German industrial production** has reverted to a low-growth profile this year. The latest February data showed a 0.3%mth decline in output, well below market expectations for a 0.7%mth increase. Consumer durables fell 1.5%mth and were the main source of weakness, while capital and intermediate goods recorded modest gains. Taken together, the January–February point to a 0.5% decline in production in Q1. With energy prices having surged in March, near-term growth may be even weaker.

Local Data

There was no top-tier economic data released yesterday.

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

IQ

westpaciq.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given above are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The results ultimately achieved may differ substantially from these forecasts.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

SORRY, WE CAN'T FIND THAT PAGE

The page you're looking for has been moved or taken off the site. Do you want to go our homepage or search?

If you continue to have difficulties – send us an email and we'll get back to you as soon as possible.

10 April 2026

MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

Key themes

There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with the US Iran ceasefire largely holding.

Sentiment received a boost and oil retraced some of its spike after Israel announced it will hold talks with Lebanon, increasing the likelihood of a broader Middle East ceasefire.

US equities extended their rally, while the late session rally in European equities was unable to fully retrace earlier losses.

US bond yields were slightly lower across the curve, potentially reflecting softer spending and labour market partials coming out of the US. The US dollar index also retreated, with risk currencies such as the Aussie outperforming.

Oil continued to rise earlier in the session but pulled back sharply after Israel announced discussions.

Data snapshot

FX Last 24 hrs	Current	Change
TWI	65.3	-0.5%
AUD/USD	0.7083	0.5%
AUD/JPY	112.60	0.8%
AUD/GBP	0.5272	0.2%
AUD/NZD	1.2092	-0.1%
AUD/EUR	0.6055	0.3%
AUD/CNH	4.8359	0.5%
AUD/SGD	0.9013	0.5%
AUD/HKD	5.5487	0.6%
AUD/CAD	0.9785	0.3%
EUR/USD	1.1698	0.3%
USD/JPY	158.98	0.2%
USD Index	98.80	-0.3%

AUS Interest Rate Swaps	Last	Change
30 day BBSY	4.11	0.00
90 day BBSY	4.37	0.00
180 day BBSY	4.83	0.00
1 year swap	4.57	-0.01
2 year swap	4.61	-0.03
3 year swap	4.59	-0.03
4 year swap	4.58	-0.02
5 year swap	4.61	-0.01
6 year swap	4.65	-0.01
7 year swap	4.70	-0.01
8 year swap	4.74	-0.01
9 year swap	4.79	-0.01
10 year swap	5.03	-0.02

Equities	Close	Change
S&P/ASX 200	8,973	0.2%
S&P 500	6,825	0.6%
Japan Nikkei	55,895	-0.7%
Hang Seng	25,752	-0.5%
Euro Stoxx 50	5,896	-0.3%
UK FTSE100	10,603	-0.1%
VIX Index	19.49	-7.4%

Government Bond Yields	Close	Change
Australia		
3 year bond	4.60	0.05
10 year bond	4.91	0.05
United States		
3-month T Bill	3.59	-0.02
2 year bond	3.77	-0.02
10 year bond	4.28	-0.02
Other (10 year yields)		
Germany	2.99	0.04
Japan	2.39	0.02
UK	4.75	0.04

Commodities	Current	Change
CRB Index	368.55	0.6%
Gold	4766.89	1.0%
Copper	12682	-0.2%
Oil (WTI futures)	97.87	3.7%
Coal (coking)	229.00	-1.5%
Coal (thermal)	133.85	-0.6%
Iron Ore	103.30	-2.6%
ACCU	36.13	-4.3%

Sydney Futures Exchange	Current	Change
10 yr bond	4.95	0.01
3 yr bond	4.60	-0.02
3 mth bill rate	4.32	0.14
SPI 200	8,995	-0.1%

Data as at 7:30am AEDT. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac Group
P: +61 468 571 786
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Financial Markets

- There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with reports suggesting Iran will allow tankers and cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz only with its military's consent. Sentiment received a late boost in the session after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu said he had agreed to negotiations with Lebanon.
- US equities extended their rally, more than retracing earlier market losses following the announcement that Israel will hold talks with Lebanon. Weaker-than-expected partial labour market and spending data from the US also helped push yields lower, supporting the rally. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average both closed around 0.6% higher, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq finished up 0.8%. The VIX declined almost 8% during the session, falling below 20pts.
- European equities ended Thursday lower, with the late-session rally unable to fully offset earlier losses. The Euro Stoxx 50 closed 0.3% lower, Germany's DAX was down 1.1%, potentially reflecting some softer than expected activity data coming out of Germany, and the FTSE 100 finished 0.1% in the red. Asian equities were also weaker, with Japan's Nikkei down 0.7% and the Hang Seng falling 0.5%. Locally, the S&P/ASX 200 edged 0.2% higher to 8,973. Futures are little changed, with the SPI 200 down 0.1%.
- Bond markets saw modest moves. In the US, Treasury yields eased, with the 2-year down 2bps to 3.77% and the 10-year also down 2bps to 4.28%, potentially reflecting the flow of US data. Interest rate futures now price no change through 2026. European yields were generally higher across the curve.
- Australian government bond yields were also little changed on futures, with the 3-year down 2bps to 4.60% and the 10-year up 1bp to 4.95%. OIS pricing suggests a terminal cash rate this year of around 4.7%, with the first full rate hike pencilled in for June and another by September.
- In FX markets, the USD weakened, with the DXY down 0.3% to 98.8. The Aussie outperformed, rising 0.5% to 0.7083 against the USD and strengthening broadly across most crosses. However, the TWI fell 0.5%, reflecting relative softness versus Asian currencies.
- Commodity markets were mixed. Oil prices ended higher, and at one-point WTI futures rose to almost US$105/bbl, before retracing much of the spike following the announcement of Israel-Lebanon discussions.

Today's key data and events

Time	Event	Exp	Prev
0:00	US Wholesale Inventories Feb Final	-0.1%	-0.5%
11:30	CN PPI Mar	0.4%	-0.9%
11:30	CN CPI Mar	1.1%	1.3%
22:30	US CPI Mar	0.9%	0.3%
0:00	US Factory Orders Feb	-0.2%	0.1%
0:00	US Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment Apr Prel.	51.5pts	53.3pts
0:00	US Durable Goods Orders Feb Final	-	-1.4%

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

- The price spike occurred amid reports that shipping traffic has yet to pick up through the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran stating that the strait would remain closed to most traffic until Israel ends its attacks on Hezbollah in Lebanon. WTI futures finished 3.7% higher at US$97.87/bbl. Gold rose 1.0% to US$4,766/oz, while the CRB index lifted 0.6%. Industrial metals were softer, with copper down 0.2%, while iron ore fell 2.6% to US$103.30/t.

International Data

US initial jobless claims edged up last week to 219k. This is slightly above the 2026 year-to-date average of 212k.

US personal income decreased 0.1%mth, which was the worst result since May last year. Personal spending rose by 0.5%mth in nominal terms. However, after accounting for higher inflation, real spending increased by only 0.1%mth. Following a flat outcome in January, this points to only minimal growth in consumer spending in Q1 to date.

The **US personal income and spending** data for February suggested that inflationary pressures were building even before the global energy price shock. The PCE deflator rose by 0.4%mth, the strongest monthly increase in twelve months. The annual pace was unchanged at 2.8%yr, while the three-month annualised pace increased to 3.5%.

The **US final Q4 national accounts** estimates confirmed that consumption grew by 0.5%qtr, or 1.9%qtr in annualised terms. It was one of the major contributors to the 0.5%qtr annualised increase in GDP that quarter, which was revised down from 0.7% previously.

After a notable increase in Q4 last year, **German industrial production** has reverted to a low-growth profile this year. The latest February data showed a 0.3%mth decline in output, well below market expectations for a 0.7%mth increase. Consumer durables fell 1.5%mth and were the main source of weakness, while capital and intermediate goods recorded modest gains. Taken together, the January–February point to a 0.5% decline in production in Q1. With energy prices having surged in March, near-term growth may be even weaker.

Local Data

There was no top-tier economic data released yesterday.

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Australia's Trade in Goods Account, February

#trade #australia

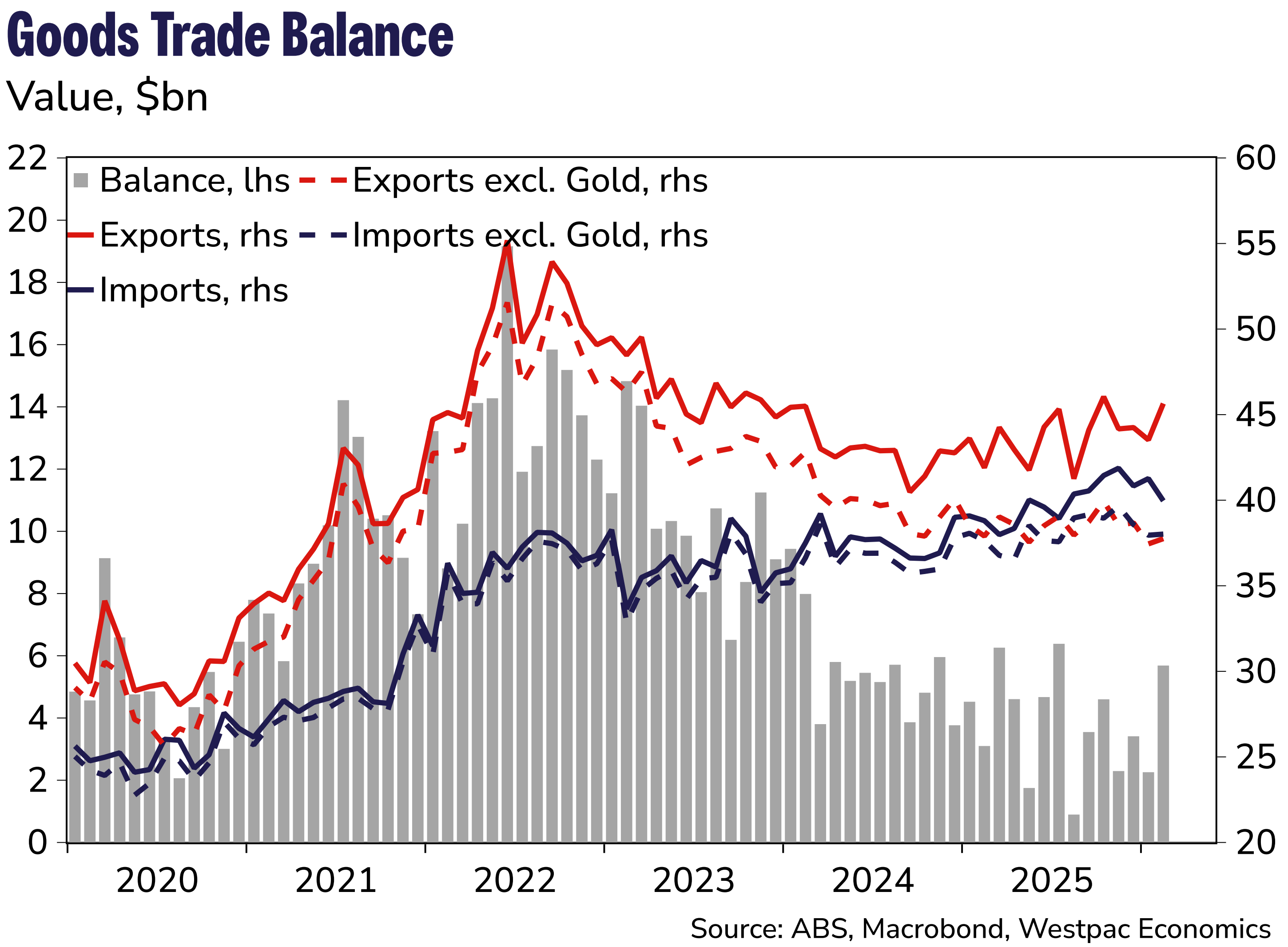
By Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist, Westpac

15:15 April 02 2026

Share

Sharp shifts in gold flows led to Australia's goods trade surplus widening in February. The impacts of the conflict in the Middle East, including on commodity prices, are likely to see volatility in monthly trade flows increase in March and beyond. Trade balance: $5.7bn. Export values: up 4.9%mth. Import values: down 3.9%mth.

After a period of more stability recently, monthly trade figures saw volatility return, with the headline goods trade surplus jumping from $2.3bn to $5.7bn, marking the highest level in seven months. Significant fluctuations in gold inflows and outflows were the primary driver. Excluding gold, the goods trade balance remained close to zero. Importantly, this data predates the outbreak of the conflict in the Middle East, suggesting greater volatility in trade flows is likely as these impacts flow through in coming months. The sharp appreciation of the AUD – in trade-weighted terms up more than 3% in February – had minimal impact on trade flows.



Exports

Export earnings surged nearly 5%mth. Gold exports reached a new record high and were almost entirely responsible for the increase. Most of this increase was likely driven by higher prices rather than volumes – this is consistent with our view that gold prices will deliver the federal budget a significant and underappreciated windfall (see here). Excluding gold, exports were up just 0.8%mth, remaining below last year’s peak following sharp declines in January and November.

Major commodity exports fell 3.7%mth, led by decreases in iron ore and LNG shipments. ABS data show that exports of both iron ore and LNG fell in both volume and price terms. Production and shipment disruptions caused by Tropical Cyclone Mitchell, which impacted the Pilbara coastline, were partly responsible for the soft outcome during the month. Coal exports, by contrast, were broadly unchanged.

Rural goods exports surprised on the upside, rising almost 14%mth – the steepest increase in over a year – offsetting the previous month’s decline. Meat exports jumped by more than a quarter, suggesting that January’s drop was likely a temporary retraction. We think that risks for meat exports remain skewed to the downside due to expected supply weakness, but such effects are likely to materialise more in the medium term.

By country, exports to major trading partners remained relatively stable. Hong Kong was an exception – exports there tripled due to a surge in gold shipments. Exports to the US showed little change, though larger shifts may occur in coming months, following the US Supreme Court’s decision to rule previous tariffs under the IEEPA act illegal and subsequent adjustments to US import tariffs.

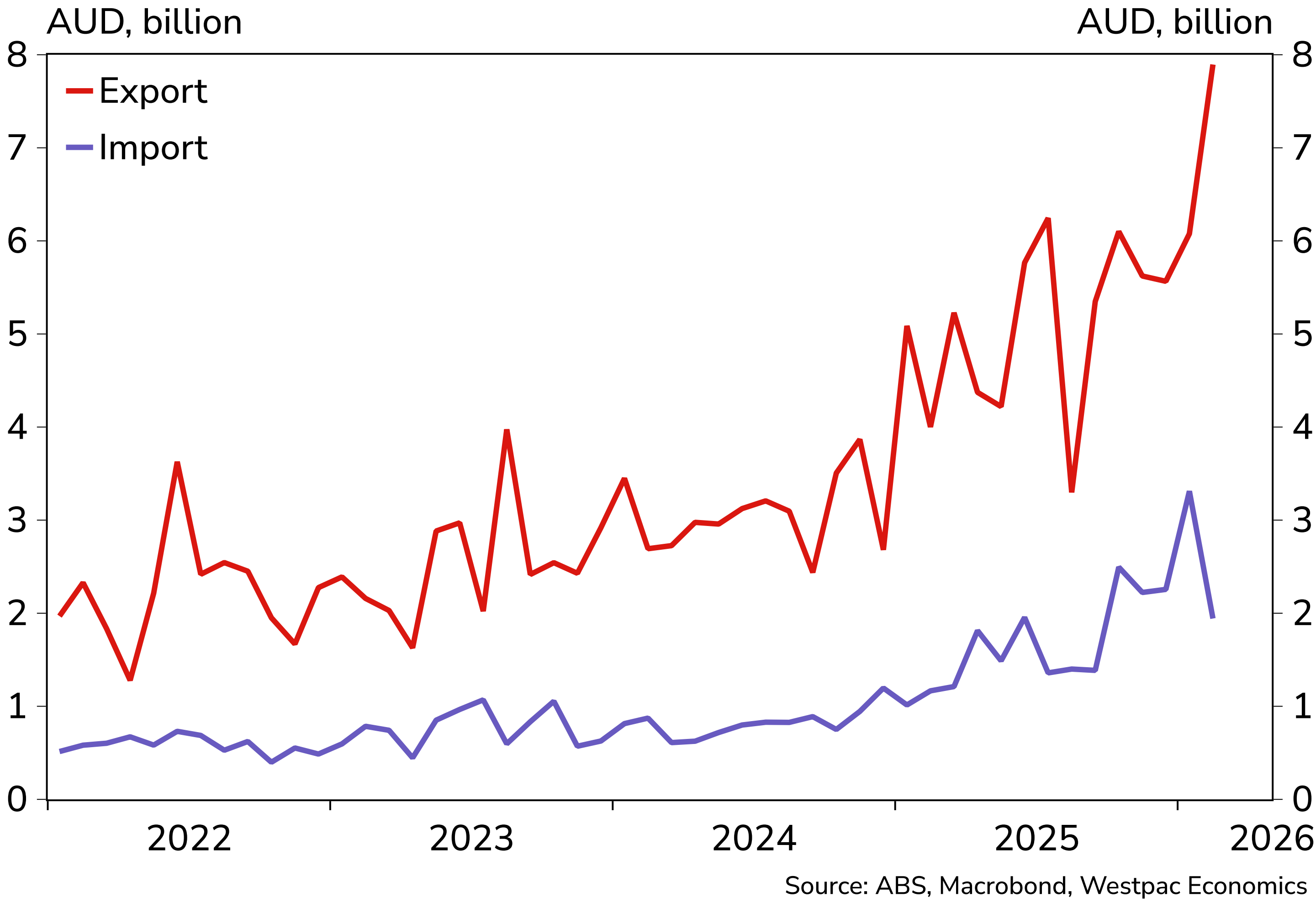
Imports

The import bill declined by 3.2%mth. Similar to exports, gold – which dropped over 40% – played a significant role. Excluding gold, imports were almost unchanged. Nonetheless, major import categories experienced considerable swings.

Consumption goods imports rose 3.4%mth, reversing a similar decline in January, with food and household electronics leading the way. Intermediate goods imports also strengthened notably, up 3.1%mth. Capital goods imports fell 8.1%mth – volatility seen in recent months for data processing equipment and aircraft imports was again the main driver.

Looking past the monthly volatility, imports for January–February were nearly 2% lower compared to Q4, with all three major components reporting declines. Price effects may have contributed, but following the significant jump in Q4, this suggests that domestic demand may have softened at the start of the year.

Gold trade flows (values)

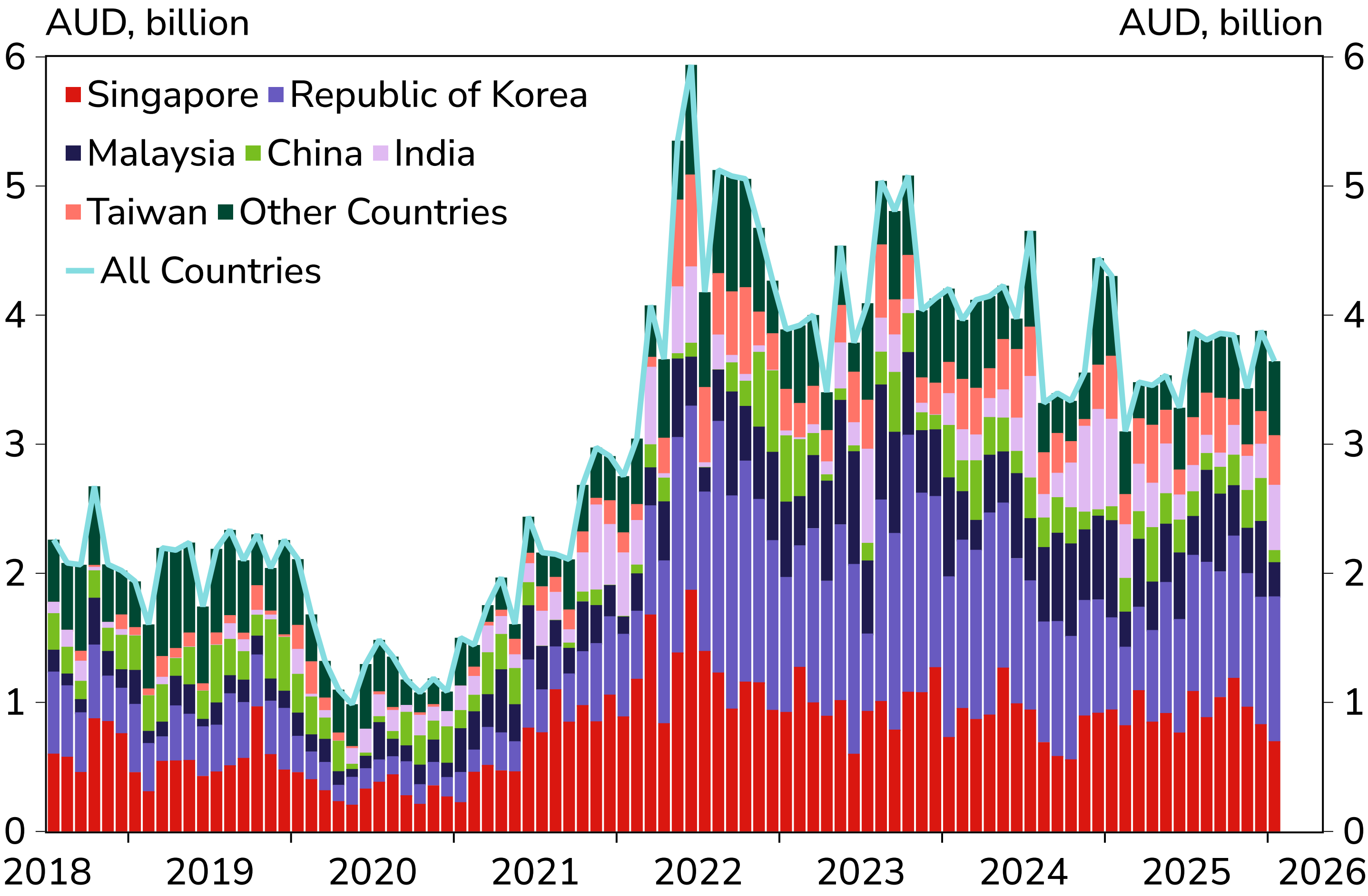


Trade in the coming months

Over the coming months, monthly trade data will likely be shaped by the ongoing conflict in the Middle East. Price effects are expected to dominate, with the LNG (Japan/Korea benchmark) 80% higher since the end of February, and coal and iron ore prices also up significantly.

Beyond price movements, we might also see impact to trade volumes. Australia's direct trade with Middle Eastern countries is small representing around $1bn in exports and around $0.5bn in imports per month. However, indirect impacts via supply chain disruptions could be substantial. For instance, most refined oil products in Australia are sourced from Asian countries, which in turn import crude oil from the Middle East. Oil accounts for roughly 11% of total goods imports, and a sharp drop could significantly affect the economy, especially if certain regions begin to experience fuel shortages.

Australia imports - refined petroleum (monthly values)



Source: DFAT, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Stay informed with Westpac IQ

Get the latest reports straight to your inbox.

Subscribe

Related articles

#trade

Australia’s Trade in Goods Account, January

March 05 2026 • 5 mins

By Mantas Vanagas

#trade

Talking about trade: more tariff uncertainty

February 27 2026 • 5 mins

By Elliot Clarke & Mantas Vanagas

#trade

Australia’s Trade in Goods Account, December

February 05 2026 • 5 mins

By Mantas Vanagas

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve #newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx

#rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission (“CFTC”) as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (“FDIC”). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC (‘WCM’), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 (‘the Exchange Act’) and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority (‘FINRA’). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

“professional clients” as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for “retail clients”. Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area (“EEA”): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH (“WEG”) under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority (‘BaFin’) and subject to its regulation. WEG’s supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank (‘Deutsche Bundesbank’). WEG is registered with the commercial register (‘Handelsregister’) of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA’s Prudential Standard 222 ‘Association with Related Entities’, Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an ‘investment recommendation’ and/or ‘information recommending or suggesting an investment’, both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) (“MAR”). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

10 April 2026

MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

Key themes

There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with the US Iran ceasefire largely holding.

Sentiment received a boost and oil retraced some of its spike after Israel announced it will hold talks with Lebanon, increasing the likelihood of a broader Middle East ceasefire.

US equities extended their rally, while the late session rally in European equities was unable to fully retrace earlier losses.

US bond yields were slightly lower across the curve, potentially reflecting softer spending and labour market partials coming out of the US. The US dollar index also retreated, with risk currencies such as the Aussie outperforming.

Oil continued to rise earlier in the session but pulled back sharply after Israel announced discussions.

Data snapshot

FX Last 24 hrs	Current	Change
TWI	65.3	-0.5%
AUD/USD	0.7083	0.5%
AUD/JPY	112.60	0.8%
AUD/GBP	0.5272	0.2%
AUD/NZD	1.2092	-0.1%
AUD/EUR	0.6055	0.3%
AUD/CNH	4.8359	0.5%
AUD/SGD	0.9013	0.5%
AUD/HKD	5.5487	0.6%
AUD/CAD	0.9785	0.3%
EUR/USD	1.1698	0.3%
USD/JPY	158.98	0.2%
USD Index	98.80	-0.3%

AUS Interest Rate Swaps	Last	Change
30 day BBSY	4.11	0.00
90 day BBSY	4.37	0.00
180 day BBSY	4.83	0.00
1 year swap	4.57	-0.01
2 year swap	4.61	-0.03
3 year swap	4.59	-0.03
4 year swap	4.58	-0.02
5 year swap	4.61	-0.01
6 year swap	4.65	-0.01
7 year swap	4.70	-0.01
8 year swap	4.74	-0.01
9 year swap	4.79	-0.01
10 year swap	5.03	-0.02

Equities	Close	Change
S&P/ASX 200	8,973	0.2%
S&P 500	6,825	0.6%
Japan Nikkei	55,895	-0.7%
Hang Seng	25,752	-0.5%
Euro Stoxx 50	5,896	-0.3%
UK FTSE100	10,603	-0.1%
VIX Index	19.49	-7.4%

Government Bond Yields	Close	Change
Australia		
3 year bond	4.60	0.05
10 year bond	4.91	0.05
United States		
3-month T Bill	3.59	-0.02
2 year bond	3.77	-0.02
10 year bond	4.28	-0.02
Other (10 year yields)		
Germany	2.99	0.04
Japan	2.39	0.02
UK	4.75	0.04

Commodities	Current	Change
CRB Index	368.55	0.6%
Gold	4766.89	1.0%
Copper	12682	-0.2%
Oil (WTI futures)	97.87	3.7%
Coal (coking)	229.00	-1.5%
Coal (thermal)	133.85	-0.6%
Iron Ore	103.30	-2.6%
ACCU	36.13	-4.3%

Sydney Futures Exchange	Current	Change
10 yr bond	4.95	0.01
3 yr bond	4.60	-0.02
3 mth bill rate	4.32	0.14
SPI 200	8,995	-0.1%

Data as at 7:30am AEDT. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac Group
P: +61 468 571 786
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Financial Markets

- There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with reports suggesting Iran will allow tankers and cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz only with its military's consent. Sentiment received a late boost in the session after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu said he had agreed to negotiations with Lebanon.
- US equities extended their rally, more than retracing earlier market losses following the announcement that Israel will hold talks with Lebanon. Weaker-than-expected partial labour market and spending data from the US also helped push yields lower, supporting the rally. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average both closed around 0.6% higher, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq finished up 0.8%. The VIX declined almost 8% during the session, falling below 20pts.
- European equities ended Thursday lower, with the late-session rally unable to fully offset earlier losses. The Euro Stoxx 50 closed 0.3% lower, Germany's DAX was down 1.1%, potentially reflecting some softer than expected activity data coming out of Germany, and the FTSE 100 finished 0.1% in the red. Asian equities were also weaker, with Japan's Nikkei down 0.7% and the Hang Seng falling 0.5%. Locally, the S&P/ASX 200 edged 0.2% higher to 8,973. Futures are little changed, with the SPI 200 down 0.1%.
- Bond markets saw modest moves. In the US, Treasury yields eased, with the 2-year down 2bps to 3.77% and the 10-year also down 2bps to 4.28%, potentially reflecting the flow of US data. Interest rate futures now price no change through 2026. European yields were generally higher across the curve.
- Australian government bond yields were also little changed on futures, with the 3-year down 2bps to 4.60% and the 10-year up 1bp to 4.95%. OIS pricing suggests a terminal cash rate this year of around 4.7%, with the first full rate hike pencilled in for June and another by September.
- In FX markets, the USD weakened, with the DXY down 0.3% to 98.8. The Aussie outperformed, rising 0.5% to 0.7083 against the USD and strengthening broadly across most crosses. However, the TWI fell 0.5%, reflecting relative softness versus Asian currencies.
- Commodity markets were mixed. Oil prices ended higher, and at one-point WTI futures rose to almost US$105/bbl, before retracing much of the spike following the announcement of Israel-Lebanon discussions.

Today's key data and events

Time	Event	Exp	Prev
0:00	US Wholesale Inventories Feb Final	-0.1%	-0.5%
11:30	CN PPI Mar	0.4%	-0.9%
11:30	CN CPI Mar	1.1%	1.3%
22:30	US CPI Mar	0.9%	0.3%
0:00	US Factory Orders Feb	-0.2%	0.1%
0:00	US Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment Apr Prel.	51.5pts	53.3pts
0:00	US Durable Goods Orders Feb Final	-	-1.4%

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

- The price spike occurred amid reports that shipping traffic has yet to pick up through the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran stating that the strait would remain closed to most traffic until Israel ends its attacks on Hezbollah in Lebanon. WTI futures finished 3.7% higher at US$97.87/bbl. Gold rose 1.0% to US$4,766/oz, while the CRB index lifted 0.6%. Industrial metals were softer, with copper down 0.2%, while iron ore fell 2.6% to US$103.30/t.

International Data

US initial jobless claims edged up last week to 219k. This is slightly above the 2026 year-to-date average of 212k.

US personal income decreased 0.1%mth, which was the worst result since May last year. Personal spending rose by 0.5%mth in nominal terms. However, after accounting for higher inflation, real spending increased by only 0.1%mth. Following a flat outcome in January, this points to only minimal growth in consumer spending in Q1 to date.

The **US personal income and spending** data for February suggested that inflationary pressures were building even before the global energy price shock. The PCE deflator rose by 0.4%mth, the strongest monthly increase in twelve months. The annual pace was unchanged at 2.8%yr, while the three-month annualised pace increased to 3.5%.

The **US final Q4 national accounts** estimates confirmed that consumption grew by 0.5%qtr, or 1.9%qtr in annualised terms. It was one of the major contributors to the 0.5%qtr annualised increase in GDP that quarter, which was revised down from 0.7% previously.

After a notable increase in Q4 last year, **German industrial production** has reverted to a low-growth profile this year. The latest February data showed a 0.3%mth decline in output, well below market expectations for a 0.7%mth increase. Consumer durables fell 1.5%mth and were the main source of weakness, while capital and intermediate goods recorded modest gains. Taken together, the January–February point to a 0.5% decline in production in Q1. With energy prices having surged in March, near-term growth may be even weaker.

Local Data

There was no top-tier economic data released yesterday.

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

1 April 2026

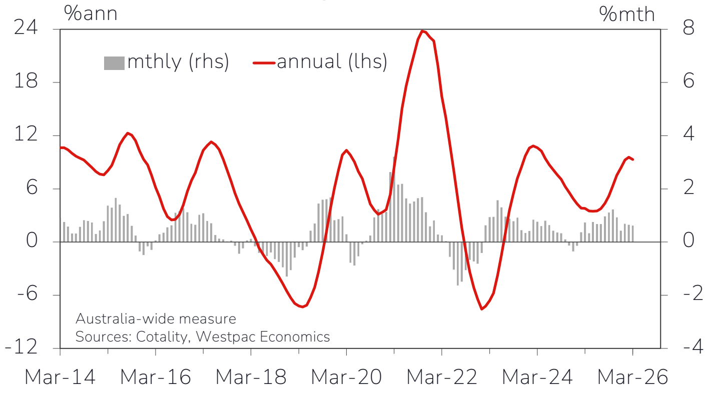
AUSTRALIAN DWELLING PRICES BULLETIN

Capital cities diverge further

Key points

- The Cotality home value index rose 0.6% in March, following gains of 0.5%mth in February, 0.6%mth in January and 0.4%mth in December. Annual growth was broadly steady at 9.3%yr.
- The March update confirms that the changed interest rate outlook has translated into moderation in price growth and a sharper pull-back in turnover.
- The slowdown remains concentrated in Sydney and Melbourne, where prices declined modestly in March and turnover has softened materially. In contrast, price growth continues to track a strong pace across the mid-sized capitals of Brisbane, Adelaide and Perth.
- With further interest rate increases expected over coming months, additional headwinds are likely, and the scope for renewed acceleration in price growth appears increasingly limited.

Australian dwelling prices



March Cotality home value index: +0.6%mth; +9.3%yr

Price growth holds, sales pull further back

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist

The Cotality home value index, covering the eight major capital cities, rose 0.6% in March, following gains of 0.5%mth in February, 0.6%mth in January and 0.4%mth in December. This follows a period of stronger growth of 0.9–1.2%mth across August to November last year. Annual growth was broadly steady in March, recording 9.3%yr.

The latest data continue to highlight a divergence across markets, with the changed policy rate outlook weighing most heavily on Sydney and Melbourne, where price growth has softened further. In contrast, price momentum remains firm across the other capital city's.

Note that, unless specified, figures in titles, tables and the commentary below are in non-seasonally adjusted terms, consistent with the 'headline' figures reported by Cotality. Figures shown in charts are in seasonally adjusted terms.

With March well clear of the typical seasonal softness seen over December and January, the latest read provides a clearer signal on underlying momentum. Prices rose 0.6%mth in non-seasonally adjusted terms, while the seasonally adjusted measure recorded a slightly softer 0.5%mth increase. The 3-month annualised pace held around 8.0% on a seasonally adjusted basis, down from a peak of around 14% in November.

Turnover fell sharply in March, with preliminary estimates pointing to a quarterly decline of around 9.1%, likely reflecting the impact of recent policy rate hikes on buyer sentiment. The decline was concentrated in Greater Sydney and Melbourne, although all capital cities recorded falls on a three-month basis. Annual growth in turnover has now slipped to -0.7%yr. Despite this weakness, sales continue to outpace new listings by a wide margin, indicating that supply conditions remain tight.

Auction clearance rates remained below long-run averages in Sydney and more materially below average in Melbourne. While both markets saw clearance rates touch recent lows during March, a modest recovery was evident toward the end of the month. Overall, the results remain consistent with a pronounced slowing in these markets. Note that clearance rates are only meaningful indicators for Sydney and Melbourne.

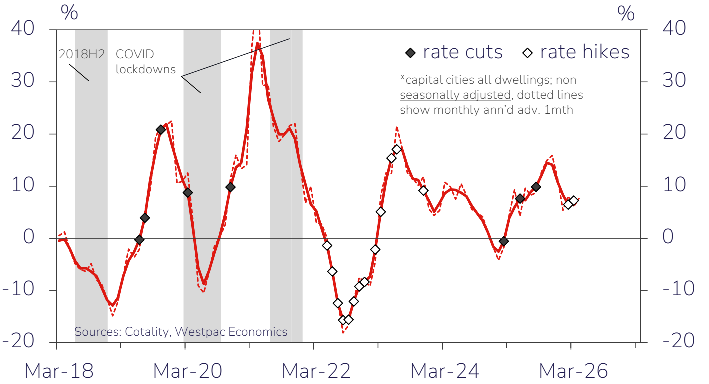
By dwelling type, the slowdown since late last year remains more pronounced for houses than units. In March, house prices rose 0.6%mth, compared with a 0.7%mth increase for units.

Cotality home value index: Mar 2026

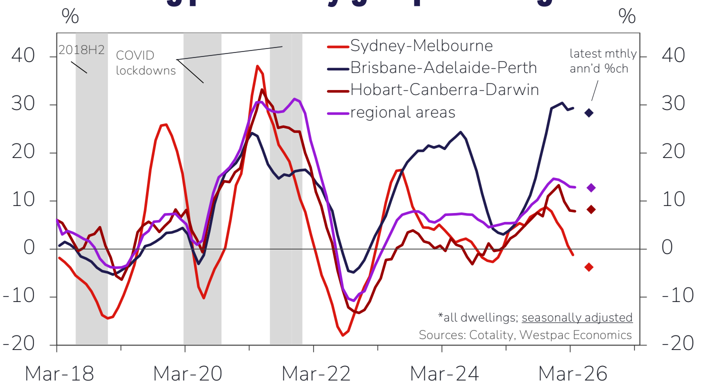
	%mth				%ann			
	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar	Dec	Jan	Feb	Mar
Australia*	**0.4**	**0.6**	**0.5**	**0.6**	**8.4**	**9.3**	**9.4**	**9.3**
seas. adjusted	0.8	0.9	0.5	0.5	8.4	9.2	9.4	9.4
– houses	0.5	0.7	0.4	0.6	9.4	10.4	10.4	10.2
– units	0.3	0.3	0.7	0.7	5.3	5.8	6.4	6.5
Major capital cities								
Sydney	-0.3	0.1	-0.2	-0.1	6.1	6.6	5.8	4.8
Melbourne	-0.3	-0.2	-0.2	-0.2	5.1	5.1	4.5	3.4
Brisbane	1.6	1.6	1.7	1.8	14.7	16.0	17.6	19.0
Adelaide	1.7	1.2	1.2	1.2	8.3	9.4	10.7	11.4
Perth	2.0	2.3	2.3	2.5	16.5	19.3	22.0	24.3
Turnover^	**3.2**	**-2.2**	**-6.0**	**-9.1**	**11.3**	**7.0**	**4.4**	**-0.7**

* combined capital cities
Sources: Cotality, Westpac Economics.
^ rolling 3mth total, %3mth and %ann ch, seasonally adjusted by Westpac.

Australian dwelling prices: 3mth ann'd



Dwelling prices: city groups and regional areas



The March price results by capital city were as follows:

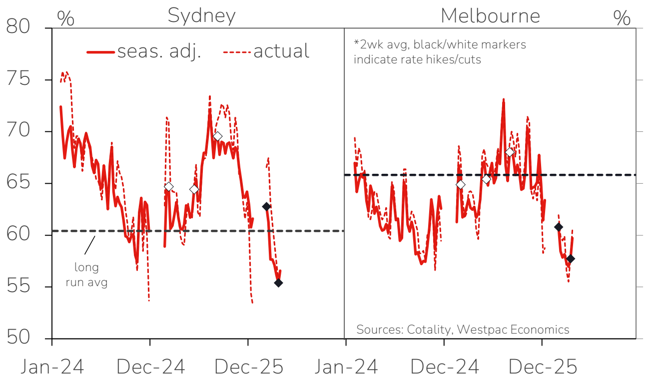
- **Sydney:** Prices declined a further 0.1%mth in non-seasonally adjusted terms. The fall was driven by a 0.3% decline in house prices, while unit prices rose 0.3%. Annual growth slowed to 4.8%yr, down from a recent peak of 6.6% in January.
- **Melbourne:** Prices recorded the worst result among the capitals, falling 0.2%mth, led by a 0.4% fall in house prices. Unit price growth of 0.3%mth was insufficient to offset this weakness. Annual growth remained the slowest of the major capitals at 3.4%yr.
- **Brisbane:** Price growth accelerated modestly, reaching 1.8%mth. Both houses and units contributed, increasing 1.7% and 2.0% respectively. Annual growth lifted to 19.0%yr, the strongest outcome since July 2022.
- **Adelaide:** Prices rose 1.2%mth, matching the pace of the previous two months. Annual growth edged higher to 11.4%yr.
- **Perth:** Prices continued to rise strongly, increasing 2.5%mth and 24.0%yr, the strongest performance of any capital city. Both houses and units recorded robust gains of 2.5%mth and 2.9%mth respectively.
- Outcomes across the smaller capitals were postive, albeit mixed. Price growth accelerated sharply in Darwin (+1.6%mth, +19.7%yr), they remained firm in Hobart (+0.8%mth, +7.8%yr), and Canberra (+0.4%mth, +6.1%yr).
- **Regional markets** continue to outperform their respective capital cities in NSW and Victoria, though they still lag the pace of growth seen in the mid-sized capitals. Annual growth ranges from 8.0%yr in regional Victoria, to 8.9%yr in regional NSW, and 14.7%yr in regional Queensland (which includes the Gold and Sunshine Coasts).

Overall, the March results confirm that national price growth remained elevated in March, driven by strong gains in Brisbane, Adelaide and Perth, while Sydney and Melbourne are providing a modest drag.

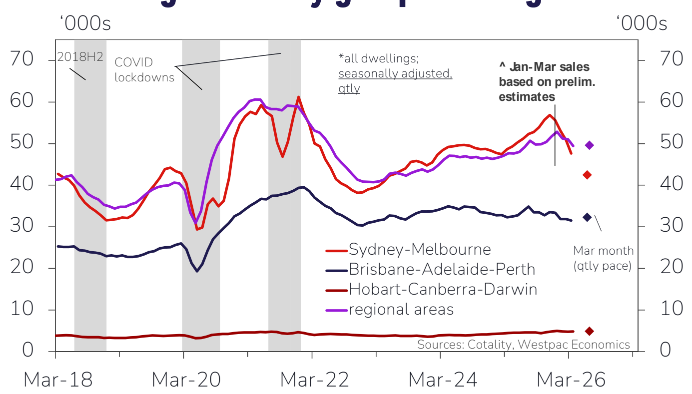
While turnover has fallen sharply following the recent dual RBA cash rate hikes, it remains early in the adjustment process. It often takes several months for the full effects of interest rate changes to flow through to housing market conditions.

Looking ahead, with further rate increases expected across May, June and August, and the economy facing a significant shock from an increase in global energy prices, additional headwinds in the Australian housing market with a further deacceleration in price growth are looking increasingly likely.

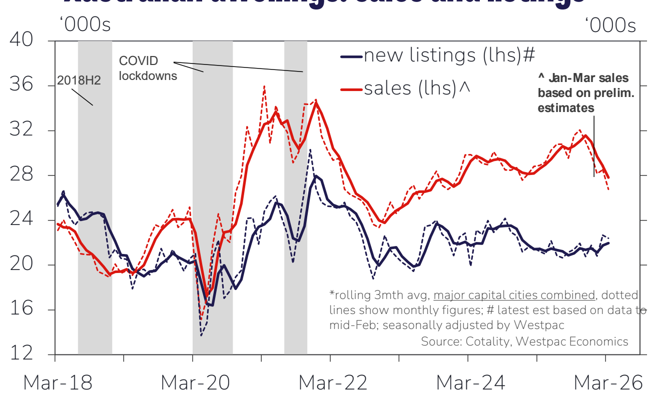
Auction clearance rates



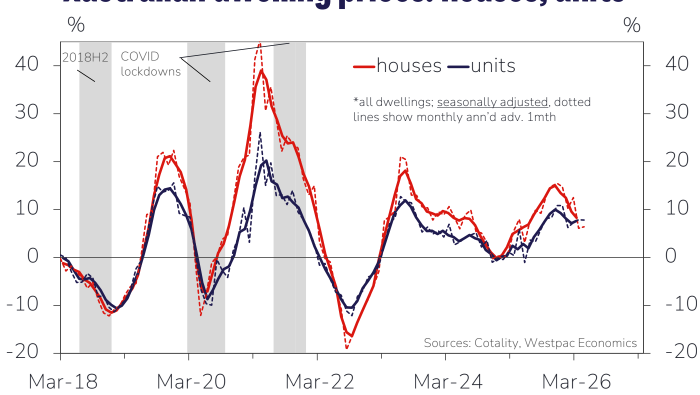
Dwelling sales: city groups and regional areas



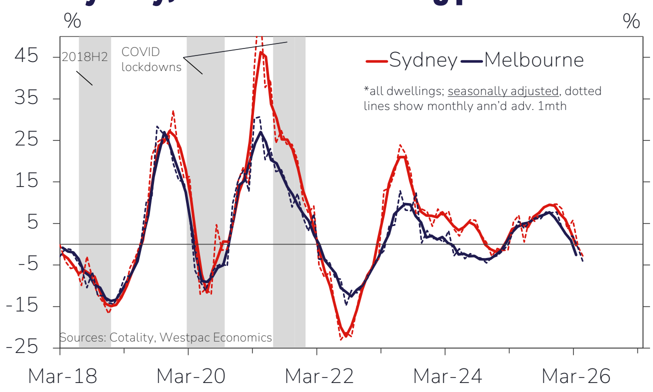
Australian dwellings: sales and listings



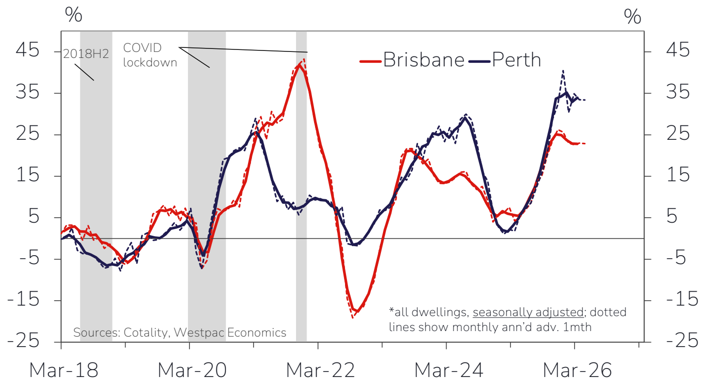
Australian dwelling prices: houses, units



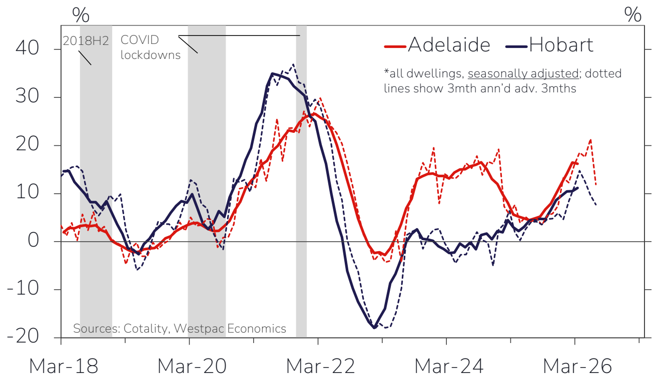
Sydney, Melbourne dwelling prices: 3mth ann'd



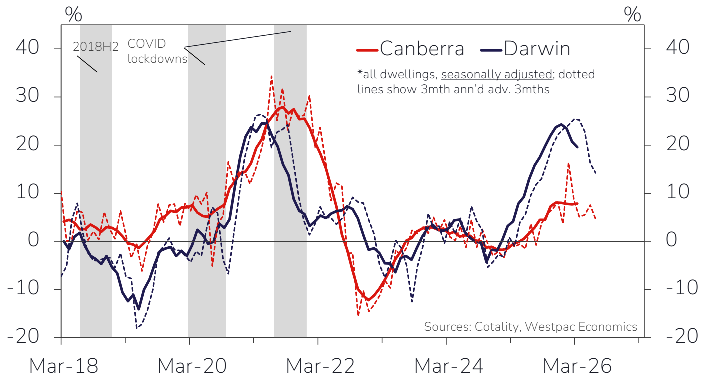
Brisbane, Perth dwelling prices: 3mth ann'd



Adelaide, Hobart dwelling prices: 6mth ann'd



Canberra, Darwin dwelling prices: 6mth ann'd



Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given above are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The results ultimately achieved may differ substantially from these forecasts.

Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106).

Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

10 April 2026

MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

Key themes

There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with the US Iran ceasefire largely holding.

Sentiment received a boost and oil retraced some of its spike after Israel announced it will hold talks with Lebanon, increasing the likelihood of a broader Middle East ceasefire.

US equities extended their rally, while the late session rally in European equities was unable to fully retrace earlier losses.

US bond yields were slightly lower across the curve, potentially reflecting softer spending and labour market partials coming out of the US. The US dollar index also retreated, with risk currencies such as the Aussie outperforming.

Oil continued to rise earlier in the session but pulled back sharply after Israel announced discussions.

Data snapshot

FX Last 24 hrs	Current	Change
TWI	65.3	-0.5%
AUD/USD	0.7083	0.5%
AUD/JPY	112.60	0.8%
AUD/GBP	0.5272	0.2%
AUD/NZD	1.2092	-0.1%
AUD/EUR	0.6055	0.3%
AUD/CNH	4.8359	0.5%
AUD/SGD	0.9013	0.5%
AUD/HKD	5.5487	0.6%
AUD/CAD	0.9785	0.3%
EUR/USD	1.1698	0.3%
USD/JPY	158.98	0.2%
USD Index	98.80	-0.3%

AUS Interest Rate Swaps	Last	Change
30 day BBSY	4.11	0.00
90 day BBSY	4.37	0.00
180 day BBSY	4.83	0.00
1 year swap	4.57	-0.01
2 year swap	4.61	-0.03
3 year swap	4.59	-0.03
4 year swap	4.58	-0.02
5 year swap	4.61	-0.01
6 year swap	4.65	-0.01
7 year swap	4.70	-0.01
8 year swap	4.74	-0.01
9 year swap	4.79	-0.01
10 year swap	5.03	-0.02

Equities	Close	Change
S&P/ASX 200	8,973	0.2%
S&P 500	6,825	0.6%
Japan Nikkei	55,895	-0.7%
Hang Seng	25,752	-0.5%
Euro Stoxx 50	5,896	-0.3%
UK FTSE100	10,603	-0.1%
VIX Index	19.49	-7.4%

Commodities	Current	Change
CRB Index	368.55	0.6%
Gold	4766.89	1.0%
Copper	12682	-0.2%
Oil (WTI futures)	97.87	3.7%
Coal (coking)	229.00	-1.5%
Coal (thermal)	133.85	-0.6%
Iron Ore	103.30	-2.6%
ACCU	36.13	-4.3%

Government Bond Yields	Close	Change
Australia		
3 year bond	4.60	0.05
10 year bond	4.91	0.05
United States		
3-month T Bill	3.59	-0.02
2 year bond	3.77	-0.02
10 year bond	4.28	-0.02
Other (10 year yields)		
Germany	2.99	0.04
Japan	2.39	0.02
UK	4.75	0.04

Sydney Futures Exchange	Current	Change
10 yr bond	4.95	0.01
3 yr bond	4.60	-0.02
3 mth bill rate	4.32	0.14
SPI 200	8,995	-0.1%

Data as at 7:30am AEDT. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac Group
P: +61 468 571 786
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Financial Markets

- There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with reports suggesting Iran will allow tankers and cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz only with its military's consent. Sentiment received a late boost in the session after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu said he had agreed to negotiations with Lebanon.
- US equities extended their rally, more than retracing earlier market losses following the announcement that Israel will hold talks with Lebanon. Weaker-than-expected partial labour market and spending data from the US also helped push yields lower, supporting the rally. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average both closed around 0.6% higher, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq finished up 0.8%. The VIX declined almost 8% during the session, falling below 20pts.
- European equities ended Thursday lower, with the late-session rally unable to fully offset earlier losses. The Euro Stoxx 50 closed 0.3% lower, Germany's DAX was down 1.1%, potentially reflecting some softer than expected activity data coming out of Germany, and the FTSE 100 finished 0.1% in the red. Asian equities were also weaker, with Japan's Nikkei down 0.7% and the Hang Seng falling 0.5%. Locally, the S&P/ASX 200 edged 0.2% higher to 8,973. Futures are little changed, with the SPI 200 down 0.1%.
- Bond markets saw modest moves. In the US, Treasury yields eased, with the 2-year down 2bps to 3.77% and the 10-year also down 2bps to 4.28%, potentially reflecting the flow of US data. Interest rate futures now price no change through 2026. European yields were generally higher across the curve.
- Australian government bond yields were also little changed on futures, with the 3-year down 2bps to 4.60% and the 10-year up 1bp to 4.95%. OIS pricing suggests a terminal cash rate this year of around 4.7%, with the first full rate hike pencilled in for June and another by September.
- In FX markets, the USD weakened, with the DXY down 0.3% to 98.8. The Aussie outperformed, rising 0.5% to 0.7083 against the USD and strengthening broadly across most crosses. However, the TWI fell 0.5%, reflecting relative softness versus Asian currencies.
- Commodity markets were mixed. Oil prices ended higher, and at one-point WTI futures rose to almost US$105/bbl, before retracing much of the spike following the announcement of Israel-Lebanon discussions.

Today's key data and events

Time	Event	Exp	Prev
0:00	US Wholesale Inventories Feb Final	-0.1%	-0.5%
11:30	CN PPI Mar	0.4%	-0.9%
11:30	CN CPI Mar	1.1%	1.3%
22:30	US CPI Mar	0.9%	0.3%
0:00	US Factory Orders Feb	-0.2%	0.1%
0:00	US Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment Apr Prel.	51.5pts	53.3pts
0:00	US Durable Goods Orders Feb Final	-	-1.4%

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

- The price spike occurred amid reports that shipping traffic has yet to pick up through the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran stating that the strait would remain closed to most traffic until Israel ends its attacks on Hezbollah in Lebanon. WTI futures finished 3.7% higher at US$97.87/bbl. Gold rose 1.0% to US$4,766/oz, while the CRB index lifted 0.6%. Industrial metals were softer, with copper down 0.2%, while iron ore fell 2.6% to US$103.30/t.

International Data

US initial jobless claims edged up last week to 219k. This is slightly above the 2026 year-to-date average of 212k.

US personal income decreased 0.1%mth, which was the worst result since May last year. Personal spending rose by 0.5%mth in nominal terms. However, after accounting for higher inflation, real spending increased by only 0.1%mth. Following a flat outcome in January, this points to only minimal growth in consumer spending in Q1 to date.

The **US personal income and spending** data for February suggested that inflationary pressures were building even before the global energy price shock. The PCE deflator rose by 0.4%mth, the strongest monthly increase in twelve months. The annual pace was unchanged at 2.8%yr, while the three-month annualised pace increased to 3.5%.

The **US final Q4 national accounts** estimates confirmed that consumption grew by 0.5%qtr, or 1.9%qtr in annualised terms. It was one of the major contributors to the 0.5%qtr annualised increase in GDP that quarter, which was revised down from 0.7% previously.

After a notable increase in Q4 last year, **German industrial production** has reverted to a low-growth profile this year. The latest February data showed a 0.3%mth decline in output, well below market expectations for a 0.7%mth increase. Consumer durables fell 1.5%mth and were the main source of weakness, while capital and intermediate goods recorded modest gains. Taken together, the January–February point to a 0.5% decline in production in Q1. With energy prices having surged in March, near-term growth may be even weaker.

Local Data

There was no top-tier economic data released yesterday.

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

IQ

westpaciq.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Still the lucky country: Conflict, Gold and Inflation to Lift the Budget

#federalbudget #australia #aud #inflation #fiscalpolicy #government

By Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac

10:27 March 31 2026

Share

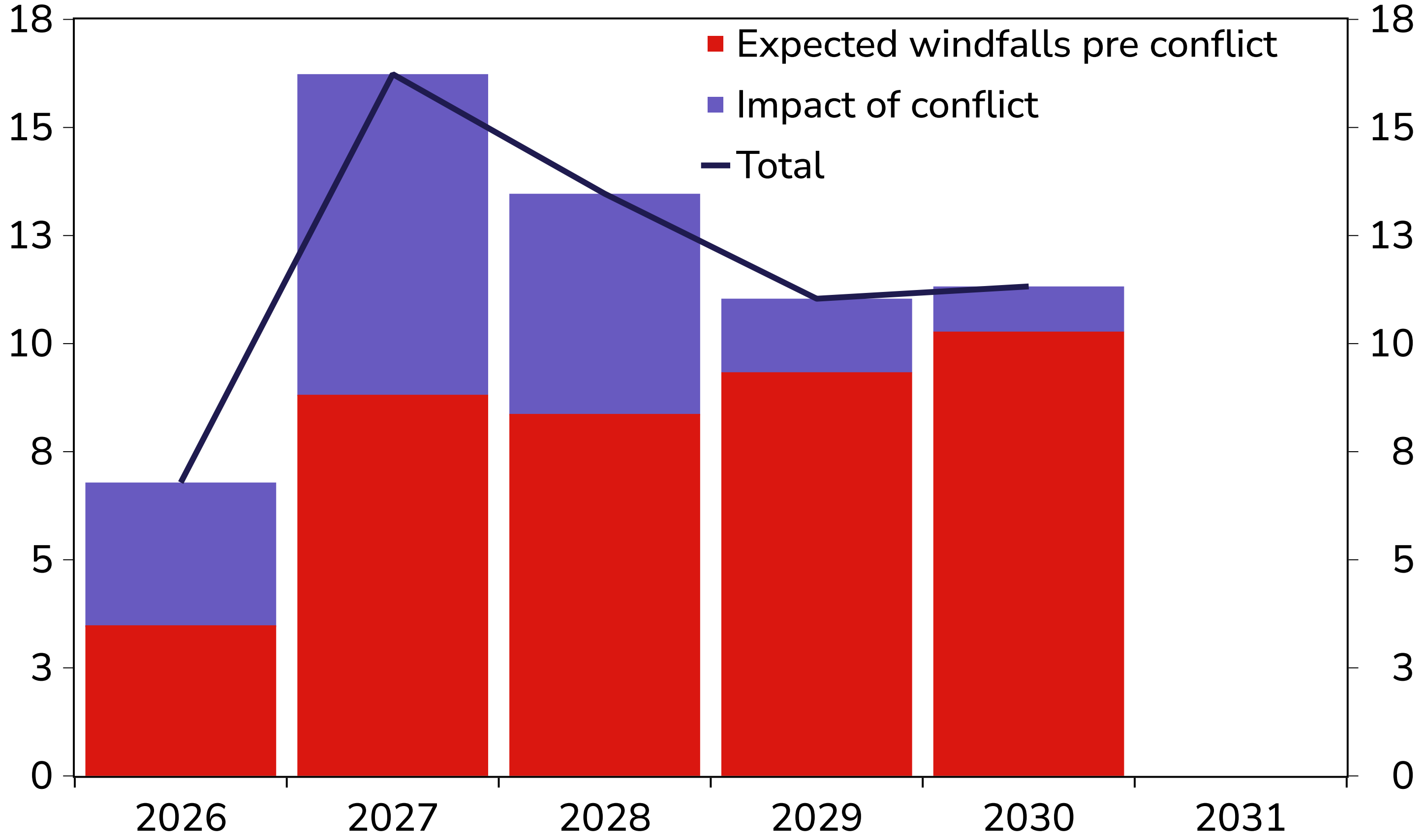
Stronger commodity prices and elevated inflation are boosting nominal incomes and tax collections, driving a net budget improvement.

- Higher-than-assumed commodity prices are expected to deliver the Federal budget a windfall of almost $60bn over the five years to FY30.

- Around $20bn of this uplift reflects the impact of the Middle East conflict, particularly via higher coal and LNG export prices. This more than offsets the $2.6bn cost of halving the fuel excise for three months.
- The run-up in gold prices since FY24 is estimated to add around $19bn to Treasury revenues over the next five years. This broadly aligns with Department of Industry forecasts showing gold export receipts rising by around $40bn in FY26 relative to FY24.
- Higher inflation and the cyclical upswing are boosting nominal incomes, consistent with the March monthly statements showing income and indirect tax revenue were around $7.0bn and $2.5bn ahead of MYEFO estimates, respectively. The inflationary impulse from the conflict is expected to provide further near-term support to revenues.
- We will provide a full update of revenue and expenses before the May Budget.

Expected company tax upgrades

Financial years, $bn



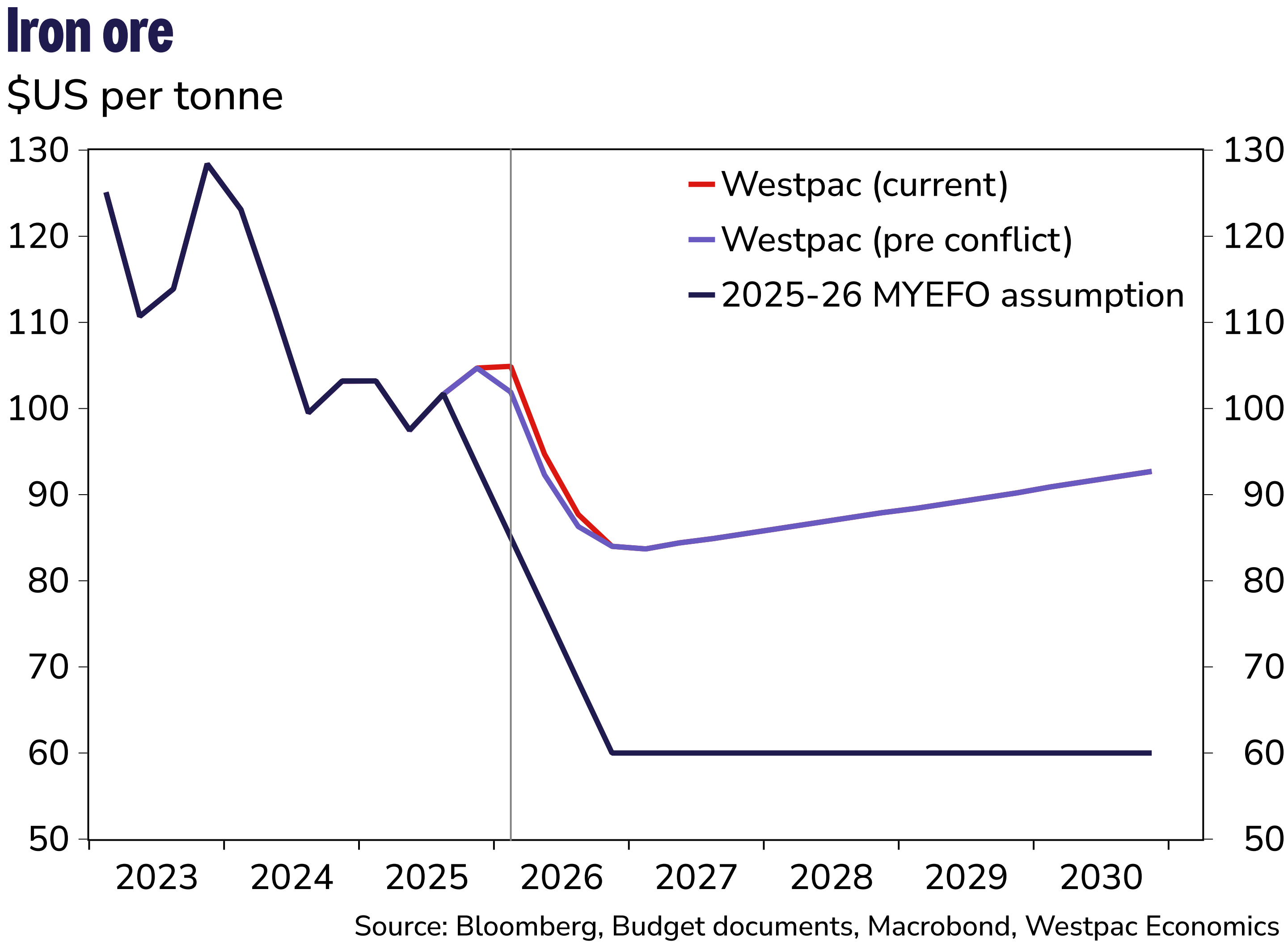
Source: Bloomberg, Budget documents, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

The Federal Treasurer has warned that the economic fallout from the Middle East conflict could be "just as serious" as the GFC, the COVID-19 pandemic and Russia's invasion of Ukraine. But there is a countervailing force: higher commodity prices and elevated inflation are lifting Treasury tax collections. Because the tax system operates in the nominal world, tax receipts can continue to rise even as real economic activity slows over the coming years, as we expect.

Using actual spot prices and Westpac commodity price forecasts, we estimate that **higher-than-assumed commodity prices will deliver the Federal budget a windfall of almost $60bn over the five years to FY30**.

Relaxing some of the conservatism in budget forecasts

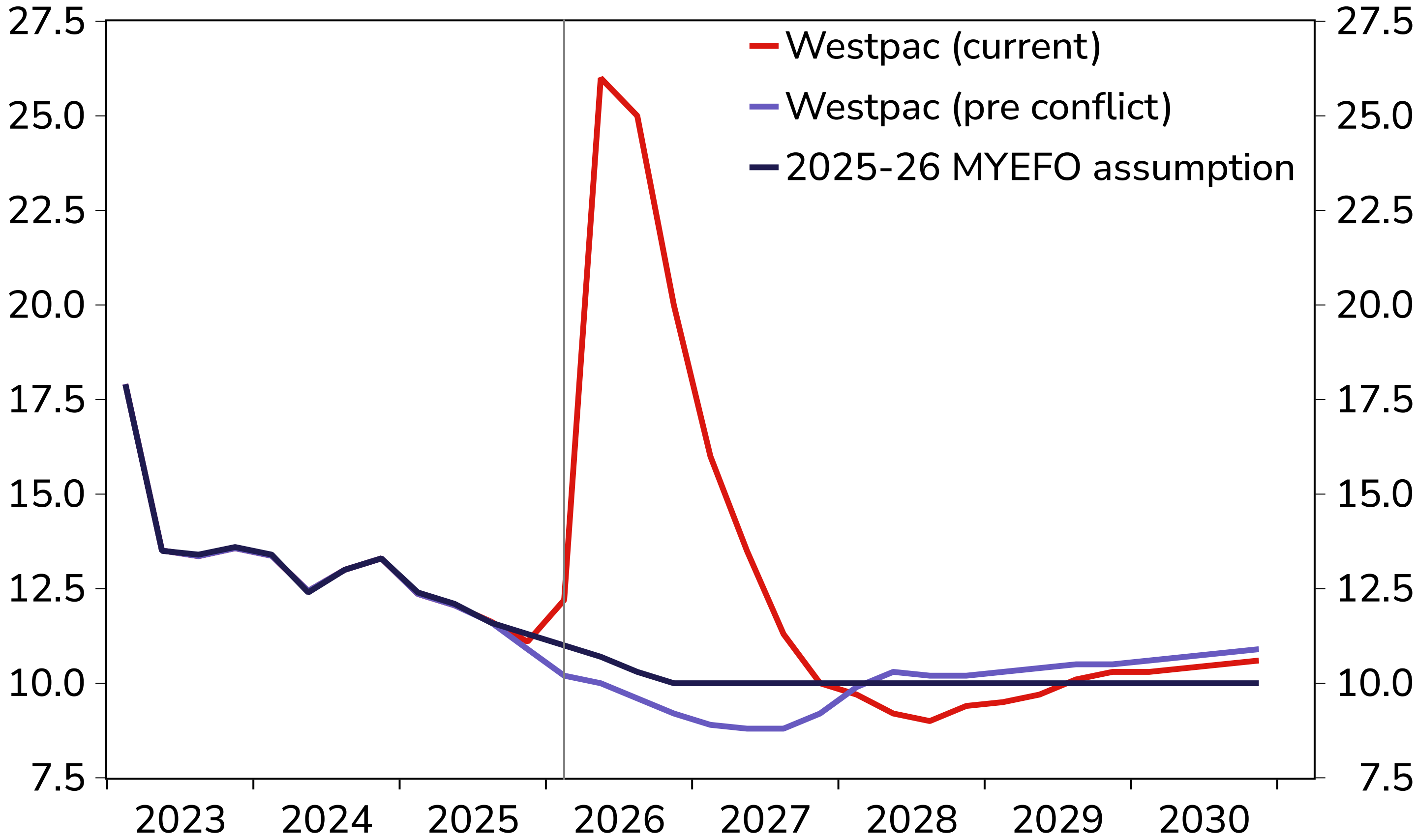
It is well known that Treasury's revenue forecasts remain highly conservative, anchored on commodity prices reverting to long-run assumptions. In practice, elevated prices had already proven more persistent before the conflict (see iron ore chart below), and the conflict itself has delivered a further lift.



The Middle East conflict also is pushing energy export prices higher, most notably for coal and LNG export prices. The longer the conflict persists, the greater the upside risk to commodity price forecasts. **At this stage, we estimate that around $20bn of the total budget windfall can be attributed directly to the Middle East conflict, with the gains front-loaded over the next few years. This additional revenue more than offsets the estimated $2.6bn fiscal cost of halving the fuel excise for three months, leaving a substantial net improvement in the budget position.**

LNG export prices

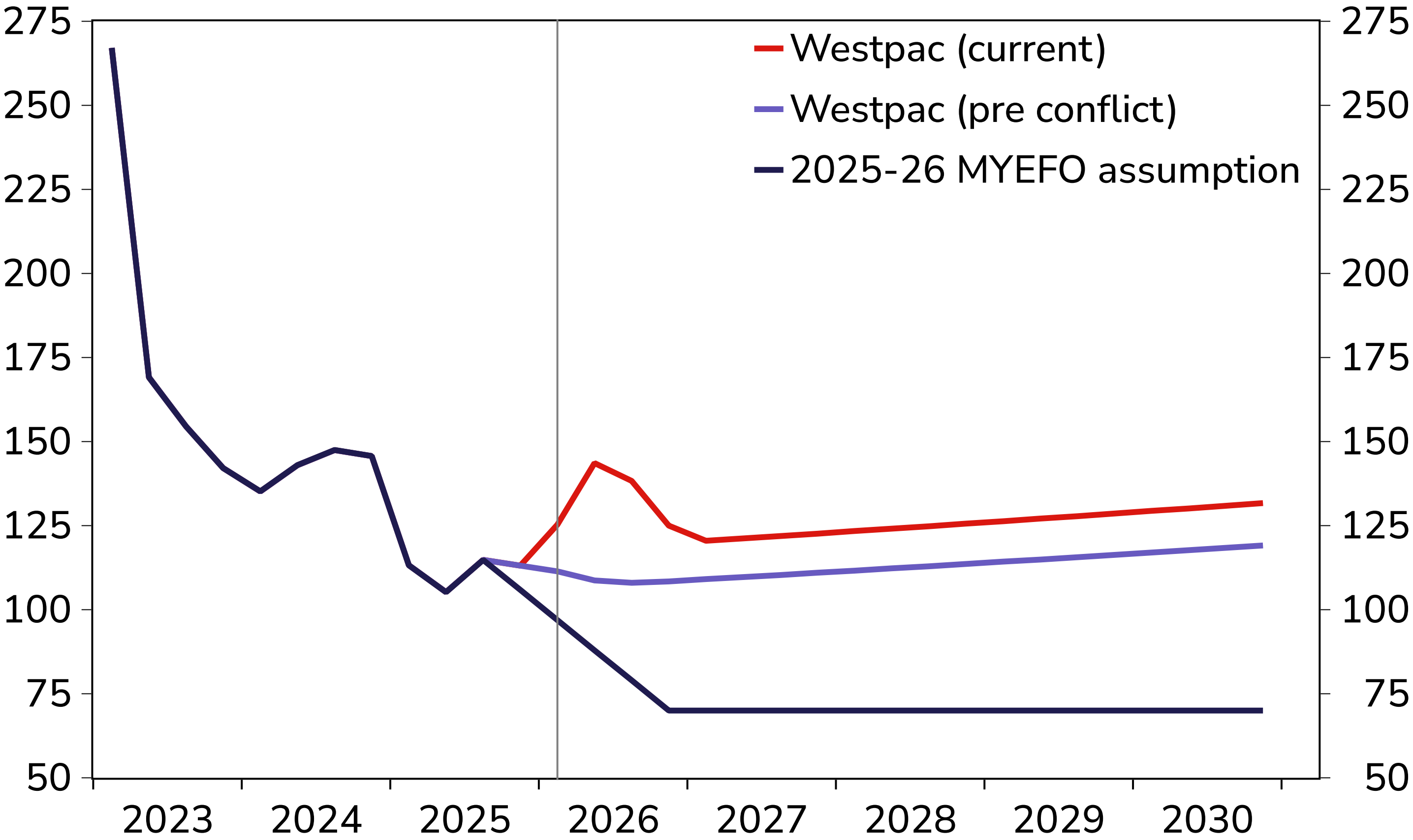
$US per mmBtu



Source: Bloomberg, Budget documents, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Thermal coal

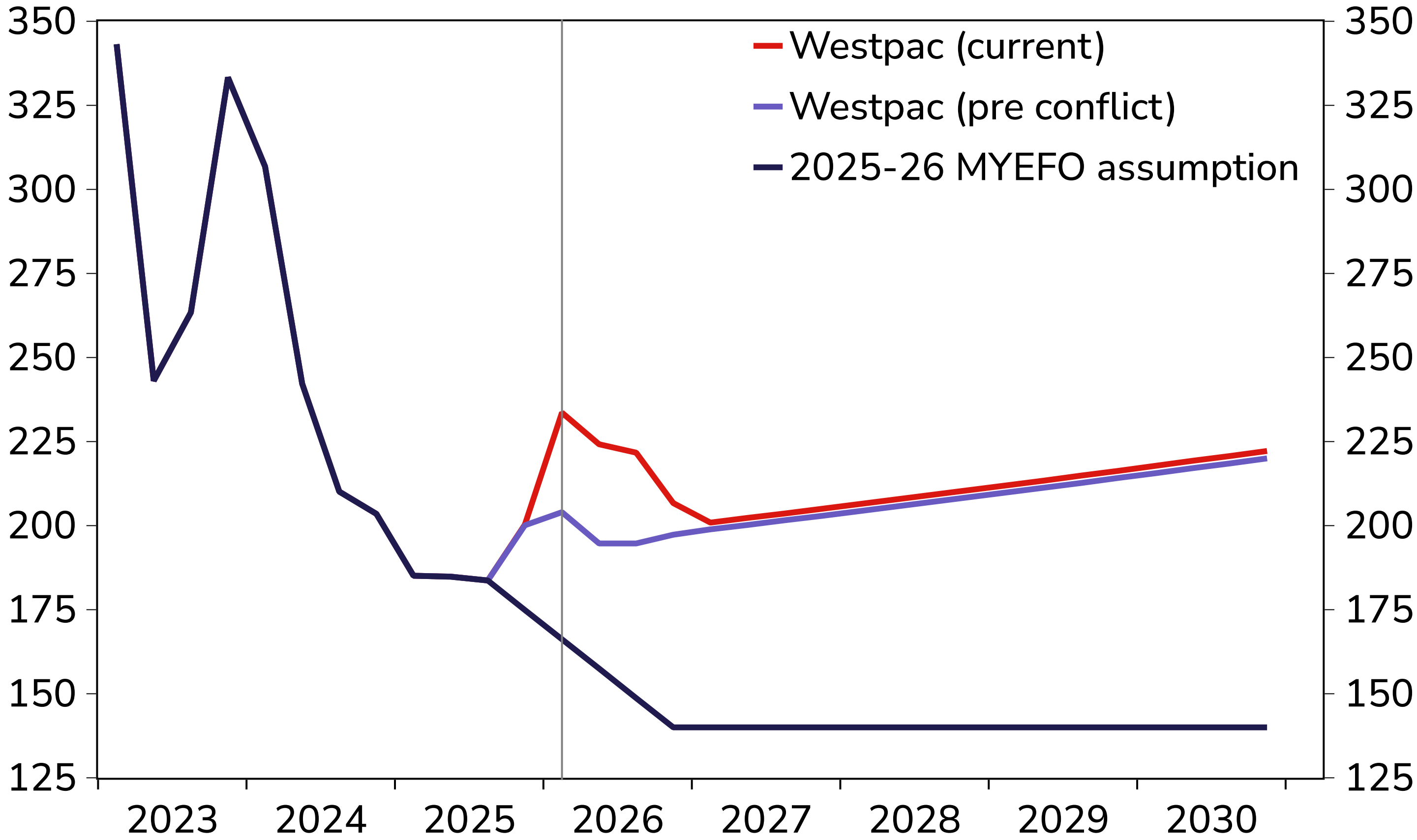
$US per tonne



Source: Bloomberg, Budget documents, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Metallurgical coal

$US per tonne

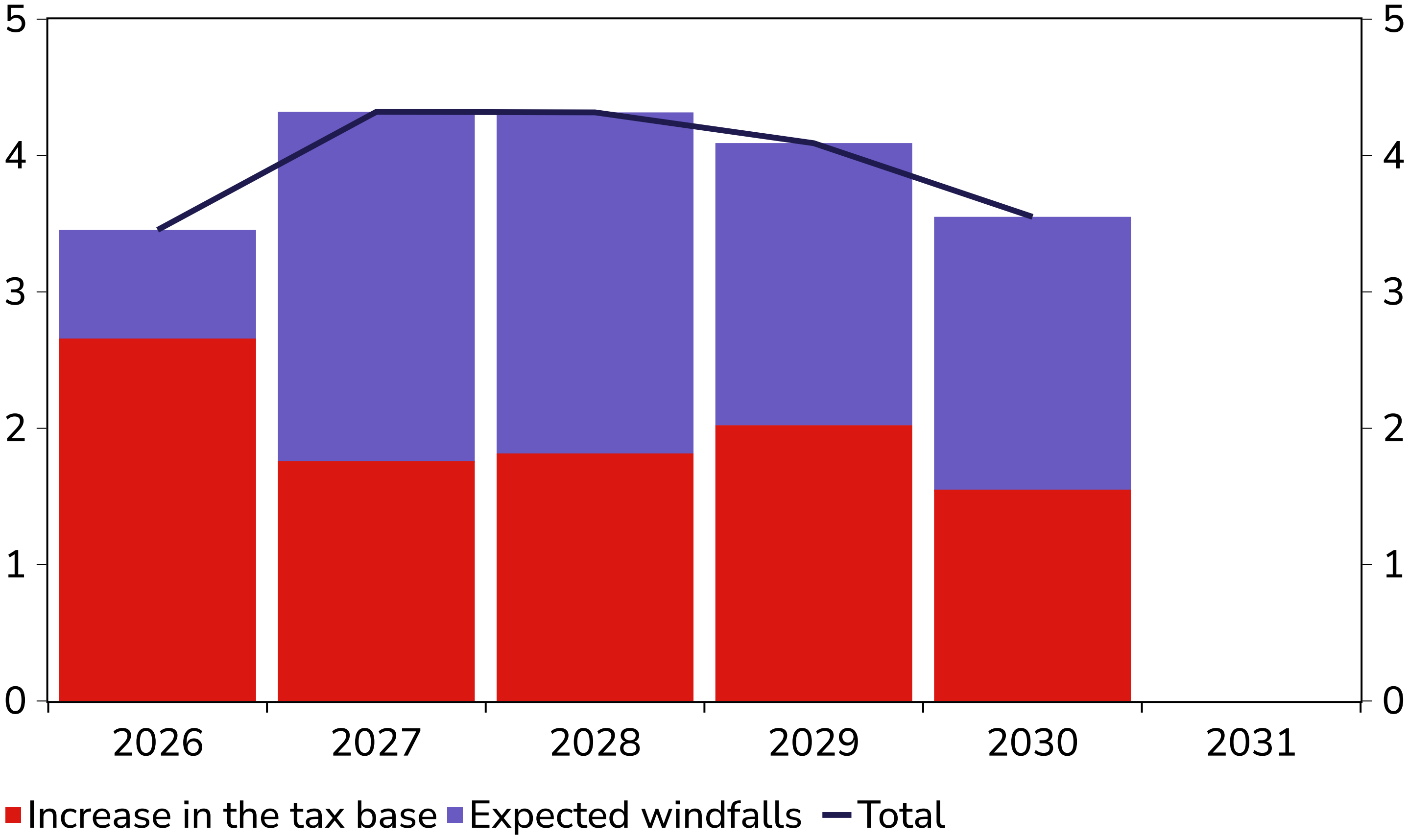


Source: Bloomberg, Budget documents, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Gold is also delivering an underappreciated windfall. Following the recent surge in prices, gold is expected to become Australia's second-largest export by value in FY26, overtaking LNG and coal. The run-up in gold prices since FY24 is estimated to add around $19bn to Treasury revenues over the next five years. Despite recent volatility, the gold spot price is currently around US$4,500 an ounce. That's almost double its level at the end of FY24. **We expect some of this revenue uplift to materialise as early as May 2026, when miners make large wash-up tax payments for the completed 2025 tax year.**

Expected tax upgrades due to gold prices

Financial years, $bn

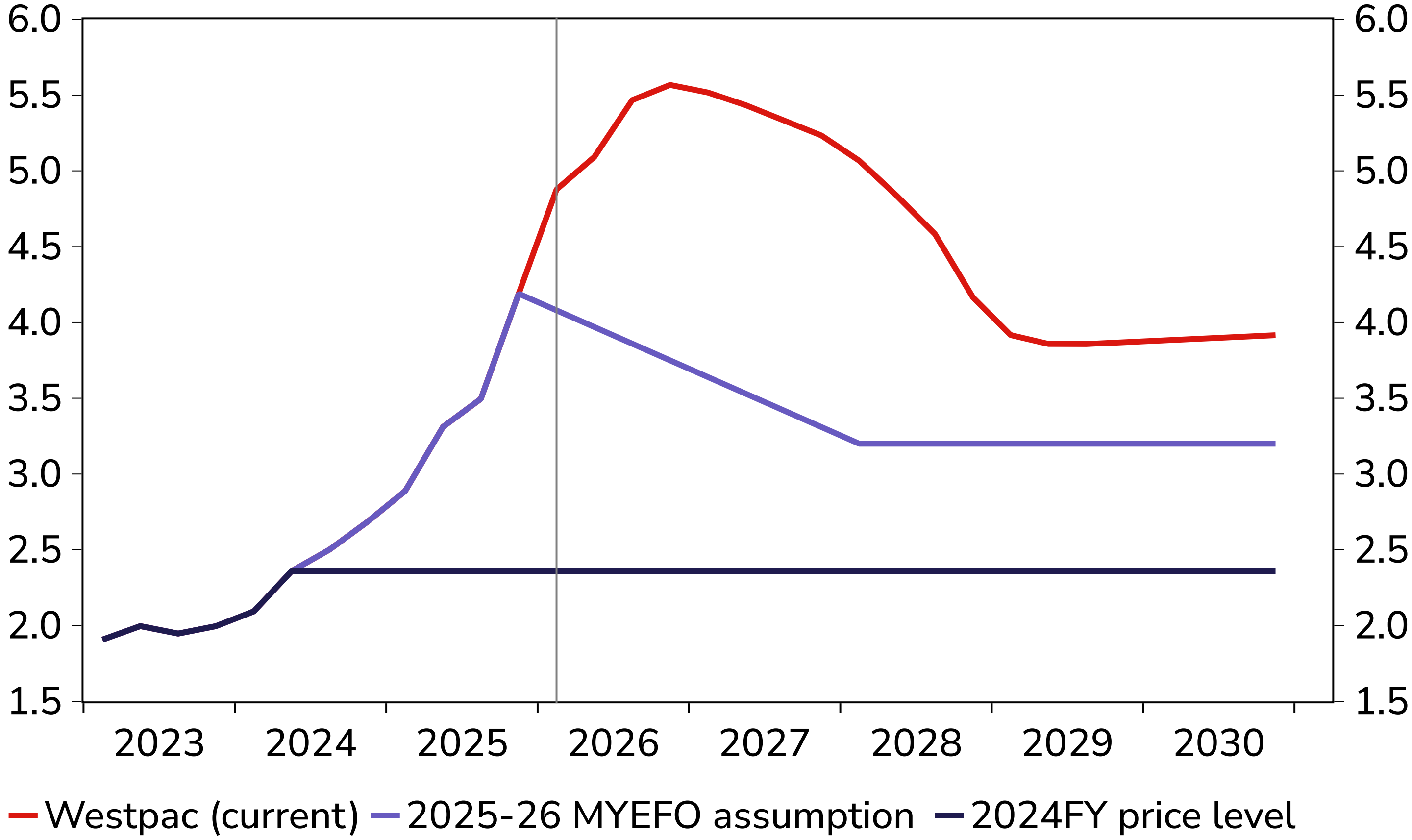


Source: Bloomberg, Budget documents, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

As Treasury marks commodity prices to market when updating its forecasts, we estimate that around half of this windfall has already been incorporated into the tax base and revenue forecasts. This is evident in the step-up from the FY2024 prices to those underpinning the 2026 MYEFO (see chart below). The remainder of the windfall is yet to be recognised and is expected to flow through in future budget updates, starting with the May 2026 Budget.

Gold price

Thousands, $US per ounce



Source: Bloomberg, Budget documents, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

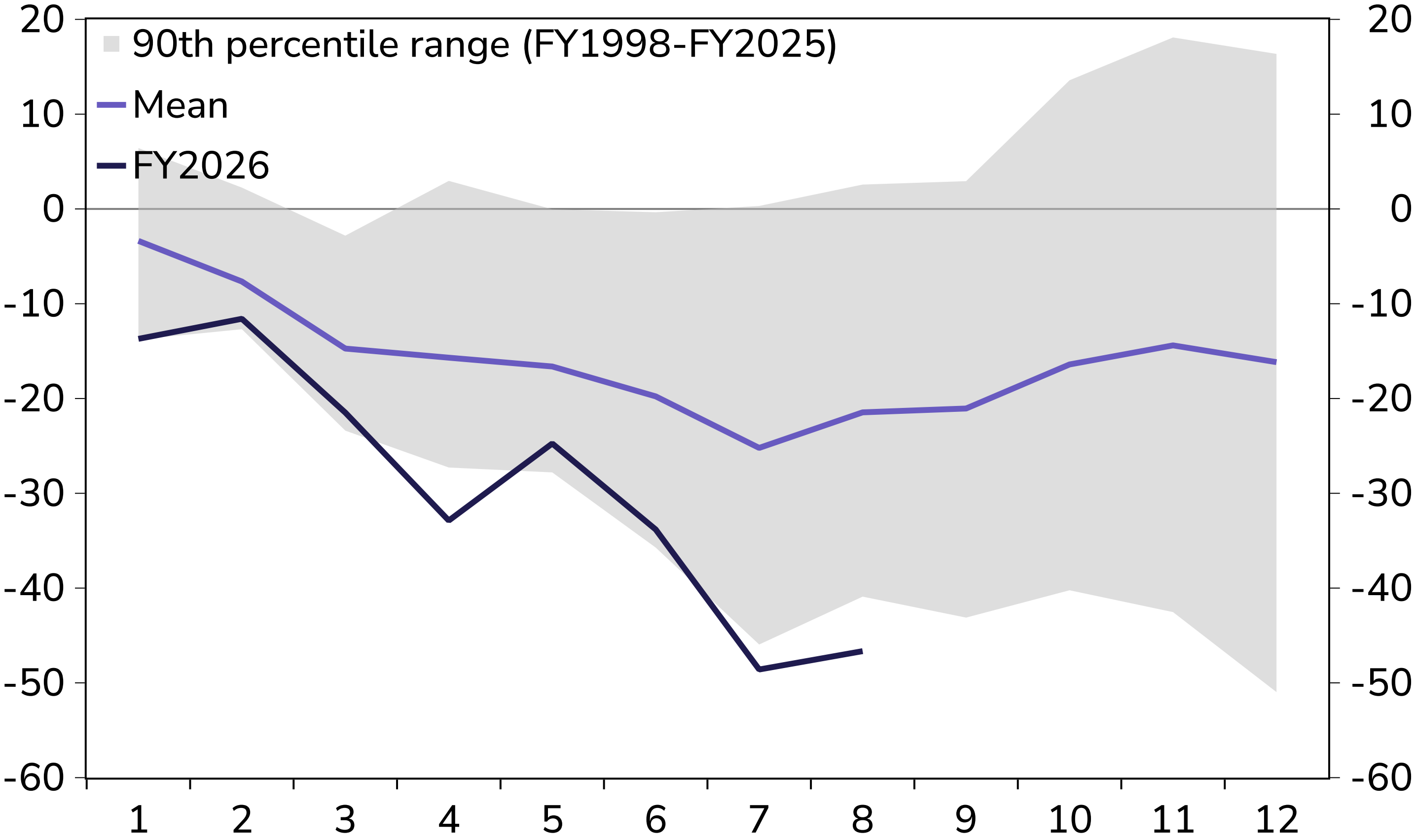
While the gold driven windfalls may seem modest in the context of the overall budget, this represents a genuinely unexpected positive surprise, one that is three times as large as the PRRT and almost as large as the fringe benefits tax base.

What about the other tax bases?

As we have previously noted, Australia's cyclical economic upswing coupled with elevated inflation are boosting nominal incomes and tax bases. This is consistent with the March monthly statements showing income and indirect tax revenue were around $7.0bn and $2.5bn ahead of MYEFO estimates, respectively. More broadly, the underlying balance was $8bn ahead of MYEFO estimates, just a few months after the MYEFO document was published. Despite this, the budget remains deeply in deficit, with the FY2026 year to date position worse than the 90th-percentile outcome recorded over the FY1998–FY2025 period.

Federal government receipts & payments

UCB, Rolling YTD aggregates, $bn



Source: Australian Department of Finance, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Bottom line

While there will be some offsetting pressures on the payments side of the budget, we expect the revenue uplift to dominate, resulting in a net improvement in the budget position. We will provide a full set of bottom-line estimates ahead of the Budget, incorporating revenue and payments variations, as well as expected policy changes.

Related articles

#federalbudget

NSW FY26 Mid-Year Budget Update Quick Response

December 19 2025 • 10mins

By Uma Choudhury

#federalbudget

FY26 Mid-Year Economic and Fiscal Outlook: Debt Statement highlights

December 17 2025 • 10mins

By Uma Choudhury

#federalbudget

2025-26 MYEFO: Cyclical upswing boosts Treasury coffers

December 17 2025 • 6 mins

By Pat Bustamante

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve #newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx #rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

"professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

10 April 2026

MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

Key themes

There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with the US Iran ceasefire largely holding.

Sentiment received a boost and oil retraced some of its spike after Israel announced it will hold talks with Lebanon, increasing the likelihood of a broader Middle East ceasefire.

US equities extended their rally, while the late session rally in European equities was unable to fully retrace earlier losses.

US bond yields were slightly lower across the curve, potentially reflecting softer spending and labour market partials coming out of the US. The US dollar index also retreated, with risk currencies such as the Aussie outperforming.

Oil continued to rise earlier in the session but pulled back sharply after Israel announced discussions.

Data snapshot

FX Last 24 hrs	Current	Change
TWI	65.3	-0.5%
AUD/USD	0.7083	0.5%
AUD/JPY	112.60	0.8%
AUD/GBP	0.5272	0.2%
AUD/NZD	1.2092	-0.1%
AUD/EUR	0.6055	0.3%
AUD/CNH	4.8359	0.5%
AUD/SGD	0.9013	0.5%
AUD/HKD	5.5487	0.6%
AUD/CAD	0.9785	0.3%
EUR/USD	1.1698	0.3%
USD/JPY	158.98	0.2%
USD Index	98.80	-0.3%

AUS Interest Rate Swaps	Last	Change
30 day BBSY	4.11	0.00
90 day BBSY	4.37	0.00
180 day BBSY	4.83	0.00
1 year swap	4.57	-0.01
2 year swap	4.61	-0.03
3 year swap	4.59	-0.03
4 year swap	4.58	-0.02
5 year swap	4.61	-0.01
6 year swap	4.65	-0.01
7 year swap	4.70	-0.01
8 year swap	4.74	-0.01
9 year swap	4.79	-0.01
10 year swap	5.03	-0.02

Equities	Close	Change
S&P/ASX 200	8,973	0.2%
S&P 500	6,825	0.6%
Japan Nikkei	55,895	-0.7%
Hang Seng	25,752	-0.5%
Euro Stoxx 50	5,896	-0.3%
UK FTSE100	10,603	-0.1%
VIX Index	19.49	-7.4%

Government Bond Yields	Close	Change
Australia		
3 year bond	4.60	0.05
10 year bond	4.91	0.05
United States		
3-month T Bill	3.59	-0.02
2 year bond	3.77	-0.02
10 year bond	4.28	-0.02
Other (10 year yields)		
Germany	2.99	0.04
Japan	2.39	0.02
UK	4.75	0.04

Commodities	Current	Change
CRB Index	368.55	0.6%
Gold	4766.89	1.0%
Copper	12682	-0.2%
Oil (WTI futures)	97.87	3.7%
Coal (coking)	229.00	-1.5%
Coal (thermal)	133.85	-0.6%
Iron Ore	103.30	-2.6%
ACCU	36.13	-4.3%

Sydney Futures Exchange	Current	Change
10 yr bond	4.95	0.01
3 yr bond	4.60	-0.02
3 mth bill rate	4.32	0.14
SPI 200	8,995	-0.1%

Data as at 7:30am AEDT. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac Group
P: +61 468 571 786
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Financial Markets

- There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with reports suggesting Iran will allow tankers and cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz only with its military's consent. Sentiment received a late boost in the session after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu said he had agreed to negotiations with Lebanon.
- US equities extended their rally, more than retracing earlier market losses following the announcement that Israel will hold talks with Lebanon. Weaker-than-expected partial labour market and spending data from the US also helped push yields lower, supporting the rally. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average both closed around 0.6% higher, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq finished up 0.8%. The VIX declined almost 8% during the session, falling below 20pts.
- European equities ended Thursday lower, with the late-session rally unable to fully offset earlier losses. The Euro Stoxx 50 closed 0.3% lower, Germany's DAX was down 1.1%, potentially reflecting some softer than expected activity data coming out of Germany, and the FTSE 100 finished 0.1% in the red. Asian equities were also weaker, with Japan's Nikkei down 0.7% and the Hang Seng falling 0.5%. Locally, the S&P/ASX 200 edged 0.2% higher to 8,973. Futures are little changed, with the SPI 200 down 0.1%.
- Bond markets saw modest moves. In the US, Treasury yields eased, with the 2-year down 2bps to 3.77% and the 10-year also down 2bps to 4.28%, potentially reflecting the flow of US data. Interest rate futures now price no change through 2026. European yields were generally higher across the curve.
- Australian government bond yields were also little changed on futures, with the 3-year down 2bps to 4.60% and the 10-year up 1bp to 4.95%. OIS pricing suggests a terminal cash rate this year of around 4.7%, with the first full rate hike pencilled in for June and another by September.
- In FX markets, the USD weakened, with the DXY down 0.3% to 98.8. The Aussie outperformed, rising 0.5% to 0.7083 against the USD and strengthening broadly across most crosses. However, the TWI fell 0.5%, reflecting relative softness versus Asian currencies.
- Commodity markets were mixed. Oil prices ended higher, and at one-point WTI futures rose to almost US$105/bbl, before retracing much of the spike following the announcement of Israel-Lebanon discussions.

Today's key data and events

Time	Event	Exp	Prev
0:00	US Wholesale Inventories Feb Final	-0.1%	-0.5%
11:30	CN PPI Mar	0.4%	-0.9%
11:30	CN CPI Mar	1.1%	1.3%
22:30	US CPI Mar	0.9%	0.3%
0:00	US Factory Orders Feb	-0.2%	0.1%
0:00	US Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment Apr Prel.	51.5pts	53.3pts
0:00	US Durable Goods Orders Feb Final	-	-1.4%

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

- The price spike occurred amid reports that shipping traffic has yet to pick up through the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran stating that the strait would remain closed to most traffic until Israel ends its attacks on Hezbollah in Lebanon. WTI futures finished 3.7% higher at US$97.87/bbl. Gold rose 1.0% to US$4,766/oz, while the CRB index lifted 0.6%. Industrial metals were softer, with copper down 0.2%, while iron ore fell 2.6% to US$103.30/t.

International Data

US initial jobless claims edged up last week to 219k. This is slightly above the 2026 year-to-date average of 212k.

US personal income decreased 0.1%mth, which was the worst result since May last year. Personal spending rose by 0.5%mth in nominal terms. However, after accounting for higher inflation, real spending increased by only 0.1%mth. Following a flat outcome in January, this points to only minimal growth in consumer spending in Q1 to date.

The **US personal income and spending** data for February suggested that inflationary pressures were building even before the global energy price shock. The PCE deflator rose by 0.4%mth, the strongest monthly increase in twelve months. The annual pace was unchanged at 2.8%yr, while the three-month annualised pace increased to 3.5%.

The **US final Q4 national accounts** estimates confirmed that consumption grew by 0.5%qtr, or 1.9%qtr in annualised terms. It was one of the major contributors to the 0.5%qtr annualised increase in GDP that quarter, which was revised down from 0.7% previously.

After a notable increase in Q4 last year, **German industrial production** has reverted to a low-growth profile this year. The latest February data showed a 0.3%mth decline in output, well below market expectations for a 0.7%mth increase. Consumer durables fell 1.5%mth and were the main source of weakness, while capital and intermediate goods recorded modest gains. Taken together, the January–February point to a 0.5% decline in production in Q1. With energy prices having surged in March, near-term growth may be even weaker.

Local Data

There was no top-tier economic data released yesterday.

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Cliff Notes: ceasefire optimism to be tested

#cliffnotes #rba #australia #inflation #us #fomc #ecb #aud #usd

By Elliot Clarke, Ryan Wells & Mantas Vanagas

10:47 April 10 2026

Share

Key insights from the week that was.

Ahead of the worst of the current conflict, the ABS' household spending indicator gained 0.3% in February, in line with January's result and the trend pace of the past two years. Services continued to drive growth overall, aided in particular by holiday-related spending. Goods spending only managed a 0.1% gain, however, remaining weak.

Our Westpac-DataX Card Tracker suggests spending growth is likely to moderate in coming months as higher energy prices and weaker sentiment are felt, though a lasting end to hostilities could ease concern and see households look through some of the cost shock already in train. Geopolitical considerations are challenging for market participants to digest, let alone households and small business. For these individuals, in the fulness of time, pricing responses and time delays up and down the supply chain could prove as, or more, significant than the energy market dynamics currently being witnessed. Risks for the Australian consumer are therefore likely to linger.

In New Zealand, the RBNZ maintained the stance of policy as expected. However, our New Zealand team took the commentary to be hawkish, with a particular focus on second-round inflation pressures. The RBNZ's short-term inflation forecast is now 4.2%yr at June 2026, in line with Westpac NZ Economics' 4.1%yr projection. As a result, Westpac's expected timing for the first hike for the coming cycle has been brought forward from December to September 2026, with the risk of a further acceleration if evidence of second-round inflation impacts accumulates.

Further afield, the data flow was concentrated in the US and mixed in tone. Over the Easter long weekend, nonfarm payrolls rebounded 178k in March, bringing the three-month average back up to 68k compared to an average monthly outcome of -8k in the second half of 2025 and 10k over the full year. The unemployment rate was also consistent with labour supply and demand being in balance in March, edging back down to 4.3%. Note though, this outcome was due to a further decline in the participation rate (now down 0.7ppts since April 2025) rather than an increase in household survey employment.

The weak outcomes for employment through late-2025 look to increasingly be affecting household demand – indeed, the downward revision to Q4 GDP to just 0.5% annualised was in part due to sub-par consumption growth (1.9% annualised).

Since the turn of the year, momentum looks to have slowed further, with real personal consumption expenditure up just 0.1% in February after a flat January. With business investment soft and susceptible to downside risks (core goods order growth in Q1-to-date is less than a third of the pace registered in Q4), US Q1 GDP growth looks likely to maintain a pace well below trend, closer to Q4's third estimate than the 1.3% annualised pace currently projected by the Atlanta Fed's GDPNow nowcast. This is before the sentiment and cost of living shock emanating from the Middle East is felt.

The above outcomes are unlikely to materially alter FOMC member's baseline view and overall risk assessment. While the latest meeting minutes indicate "a vast majority of participants" see "risks to the employment side of the mandate… [as] skewed to the downside", the labour market is considered to be in good health overall. Active risk assessment is therefore likely to focus more on price uncertainty, both with respect to the initial jump in energy prices and second-round effects which, over time, could build greater persistence into the core inflation pulse. This is not to say that the FOMC will vote on hiking interest rates anytime soon, in contrast to the RBA and RBNZ, but it likely means debate over a need to cut further will be deferred for the foreseeable future.

Stay informed with Westpac IQ

Get the latest reports straight to your inbox.

Subscribe

Related articles

#cliffnotes

Cliff Notes: mixed messages

April 02 2026 • 5 mins

By Elliot Clarke

#cliffnotes

Cliff Notes: a fork in the road

March 27 2026 • 5 mins

By Elliot Clarke & Ryan Wells

#cliffnotes

Cliff Notes: fear overwhelms

March 20 2026 • 5 mins

By Elliot Clarke, Ryan Wells & Mantas Vanagas

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve #newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx #rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation

Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

"professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Cliff Notes: mixed messages

#cliffnotes #rba #australia #inflation #us #fomc #ecb #aud #usd

By Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics, Westpac

09:28 April 02 2026

Share

Key insights from the week that was.

At the turn of the week, Chief Economist Luci Ellis and Westpac Economics highlighted how severe the inflationary impact is expected to be for Australia. Recognising the extreme uncertainty surrounding the conflict and the passage of time, we extended our baseline supply assumption from a one to two-month complete shutdown of the Strait of Hormuz followed by a protracted recovery in transit from 20%

of pre-conflict supply in May to normal supply at year end. Also, a consequence of elevated refining margins globally, annual Australian consumer inflation is now expected to peak around 6%yr in mid-Q2. While headline inflation will fall back to target over the following year, trimmed mean inflation is forecast to remain above 3.0%yr until end-2027 and only settle in the middle of the target range in late-2028, having peaked at 4.0%yr at end-2026.

With Australia already experiencing tight capacity and elevated domestic inflation pressures, attested to again by the RBA in the March Monetary Policy Board meeting minutes, the Middle East conflict warrants pre-emptive action by the RBA through three 25bp cash rate hikes in May, June and August 2026 to 4.85%. Policy is then seen on hold until 2028, when success with inflation should allow the cash rate to be reduced by 100bps steadily through the year. The consequence for GDP is likely to be a deceleration to just 1.0%yr in 2026, followed by a sub-par 1.6%yr gain in 2027, then an above-trend 2.8%yr recovery in 2028. The unemployment rate is forecast to rise to 5.0% at end-2026, and to take until end-2028 to return to its full employment level, circa 4.5%.

To the above forecasts, time matters a great deal. If, as has been mooted in recent days (and may be confirmed in a Presidential address later today), the Trump administration calls a quick end to the US' strikes against Iran, Australian GDP and the labour market may receive a reprieve. That said, heightened inflation will remain an acute risk while transit and supply-chain disruptions persist, and businesses may also take the opportunity to re-set margins. The balance between inflation and activity risks will therefore remain in focus for the RBA over the coming year. Ahead of the Federal Budget, the Government's financial position is also in flux, although current conditions look more likely to prove a positive than negative at this stage.

Local data out this week meanwhile focused on housing. Cotality home values increased a solid 0.6% in March. Although affordability saw a divergence in conditions city by city, with prices down a touch in Sydney and Melbourne as strong growth continued in Brisbane, Adelaide and Perth. Where conditions are weakest, reduced turnover is holding prices up. Dwelling approvals remained volatile in February, a 29.7% monthly gain lifting the annual growth rate to 14%yr. Australia clearly has need for significant, sustained additions to housing supply across our major cities, but affordability and the cost of construction are material risks which are likely to persist into the medium term.

Offshore, the list of data worthy of mention was short this week. University of Michigan consumer sentiment was, unsurprisingly, weak in March, 19% below the 5-year average and 37% under the full-history benchmark. The Conference Board's measure showed greater resilience but was still weak versus history. That said, ADP private payrolls continued to grow in March, and the retail sales control group recorded a solid gain of 0.5%mth. The ISM manufacturing index for March was also favourable, although the survey only caught the beginning of disruptions related to the Middle East conflict and the detail was also mixed, with production up, new orders down and employment contracting. China's official PMIs emphasised the nation's ability to weather uncertainty, with both the manufacturing and services indexes higher in March.

The key international data release for the week is still to come on Friday night. The US March employment report will be closely scrutinised after February's weak detail reset participants current understanding and expectations for the labour market. US policy makers have been more focused on inflation risks in recent weeks, but another poor employment result could see them reconsider this view. In contrast, a rebound in job creation will likely see market pricing for near-term policy decisions shift materially in favour of a hike, or two, as has been the case elsewhere across the developed world.

Stay informed with Westpac IQ

Get the latest reports straight to your inbox.

Subscribe

Related articles

#cliffnotes

Cliff Notes: ceasefire optimism to be tested

April 10 2026 • 5 mins

By Elliot Clarke, Ryan Wells & Mantas Vanagas

#cliffnotes

Cliff Notes: a fork in the road

March 27 2026 • 5 mins

By Elliot Clarke & Ryan Wells

#cliffnotes

Cliff Notes: fear overwhelms

March 20 2026 • 5 mins

By Elliot Clarke, Ryan Wells & Mantas Vanagas

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve #newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx #rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

“professional clients” as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for “retail clients”. Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area (“EEA”): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH (“WEG”) under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority (‘BaFin’) and subject to its regulation. WEG’s supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank (‘Deutsche Bundesbank’). WEG is registered with the commercial register (‘Handelsregister’) of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA’s Prudential Standard 222 ‘Association with Related Entities’, Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an ‘investment recommendation’ and/or ‘information recommending or suggesting an investment’, both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) (“MAR”). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

A materially bigger and more persistent shock

Westpac Economics

- **Longer Middle East disruption lifts peak prices for oil and gas, lengthens recovery. Infrastructure damage exacerbates the shock. Brent oil now expected to peak at an average $120/bbl in Q2 and Japanese LNG prices at $26mmbtu.**
- **Australian CPI inflation now expected to peak at 5.4%yr in June quarter, and even higher on the monthly series, despite the announced cut to fuel excise. Trimmed mean inflation peaks around 4% in 2026 H2. Food prices a particular concern through to 2028, but broader pass-through to non-energy prices also an issue.**
- **RBA now expected to hike rates three times (May, June, August), revised up from one more (in May) previously. Peak cash rate now 4.85%, above previous peak.**
- **Supply shock and tight monetary policy drag on demand, especially consumption and other interest-sensitive sectors. GDP growth forecast to trough at 1%yr in 2027; unemployment rate peaks at 5% end-2026.**

Energy situation

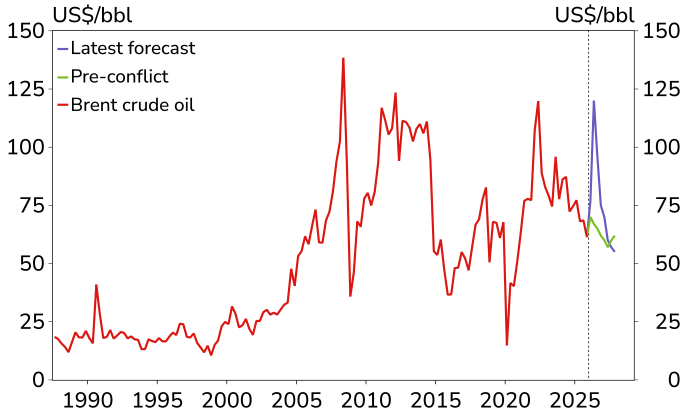
As previously highlighted, the key risk to our previous central case view (released on [March 17](#)) was that the Middle East conflict would prove to be more prolonged than assumed. With the conflict now entering its fifth week, it has become increasingly clear that the US/Israel–Iran confrontation is likely to result in a longer-lasting disruption to energy production in the Middle East and shipping through the Strait of Hormuz. We have therefore revised our baseline assumptions.

Specifically, we now assume the Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed until the end of April, a total of eight weeks, and takes longer to reopen fully. This compares with our earlier assumption of a one-month disruption followed by a relatively rapid normalisation.

The slower recovery reflects several factors. Recent shipping traffic through the Strait has been limited to countries Iran deems friendly to it. Insurance premiums are expected to remain elevated given the risk of further attacks by regional factions. Shipping companies will also require time to re-establish vessel rotations and contractual delivery arrangements across energy and upstream industrial inputs.

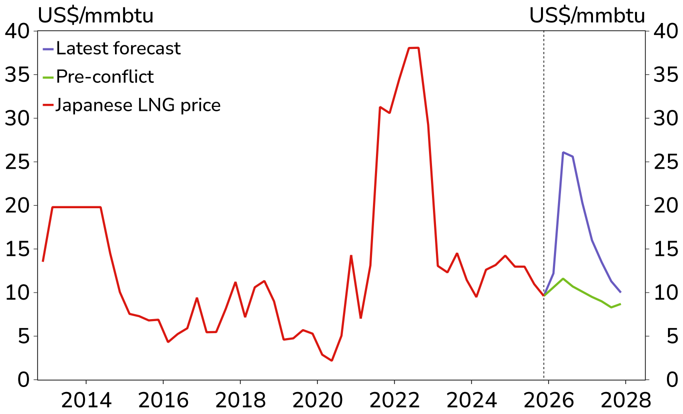
As a result, we now assume traffic through the Strait reaches only around 20% of normal levels in May. Traffic is expected to continue to improve thereafter, although capacity is not expected to return to normal levels until end 2026.

Oil price scenarios



Source: EIA, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Japanese LNG price comparison



Source: EIA, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

The extension of the conflict and slower normalisation will lead to more 'shut-ins' (temporary stops in production due to storage capacity limits) among smaller Gulf producers. Coupled with some oil infrastructure damage, we now project this to see a shortfall in global oil production of around 6mb/d on average in Q2. This assumes Saudi Arabia and the UAE continue to divert exports via operational pipelines to partially bypass the Strait, with an available capacity at around 1.6–5.5 mbpd, alongside the release of IEA emergency stockpiles.

Risks around this path remain clearly skewed to the downside, particularly if there is more damage to port and energy infrastructure and/or shipping via the Red Sea is also impacted now that Yemen's Houthi rebels have entered the conflict.

This would represent a sharp escalation, but it could also see a faster resolution as it would bring more Gulf state countries into the fray against Iran.

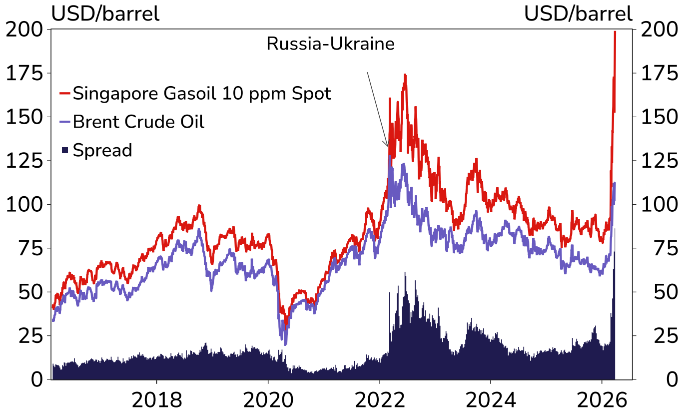
Overall, the changes to our baseline assumptions imply a materially bigger and more persistent energy price shock than previously assumed.

Consequently, we now expect Brent crude oil prices to average around US$120/bbl in Q2, compared with US$90 previously. Prices are expected to remain elevated for longer, reflecting both ongoing physical disruptions and a sustained risk premium linked to security and insurance costs. Under our revised base case, oil prices ease only to around US$75/bbl in Q4, still US$13 above our pre conflict baseline, and do not converge back to pre conflict levels of around US$60/bbl until Q2 2027.

The impact on gas markets is even larger than for crude oil. LNG exports from the Middle East, particularly Qatar, have no viable alternative route that bypasses the Strait, leaving supply highly exposed to an extended disruption. Moreover, Qatar's Ras Laffan LNG plant has suffered extensive damage halting production, with reports that it will potentially take up to five years to fully repair. As a result, Japanese LNG prices have surged above US$20mmbtu in recent weeks and are currently trading US$10 above pre-conflict levels. We forecast further increases as supply tightens to a quarterly average price of around US$26mmbtu over the next few quarters. Prices are projected to remain elevated even after oil markets begin to stabilise.

We have also made greater allowance for wider refinery margins than our previous forecasts. Disruptions to crude supply, combined with tight refined product inventories in Asia, have driven a sharp widening in the spread between Brent crude and Singapore Gas10, the key benchmark for Australian petrol and diesel prices. The spread has recently surged to around US$70/bbl, exceeding levels seen following Russia's invasion of Ukraine. Given the importance of refined product availability and logistics, we expect margins to remain elevated even as the conflict eases, materially amplifying the pass through from higher crude prices to domestic fuel costs.

Brent Crude oil vs Singapore Gasoil 10



Source: CME Group, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

More acute pressures on supply chains

Given the prolonged closure, we now also assume supply chain pressures are more acute and persistent. Container freight rates have risen by 20% since the start of the conflict, reflecting longer shipping routes, higher fuel costs, insurance surcharges and booking constraints. While freight rates are still lower than the peaks in 2025 and significantly below the extraordinary peaks of 2021–22, Iran is reportedly extracting additional charges from non-hostile vessels negotiating passage through the Strait, further increasing transit costs even where shipping through the Strait is allowed.

The Middle East is also a key upstream supplier of industrial inputs, including fertilisers, chemicals, polymers and metals. Around 33% of global fertiliser trade, particularly urea and ammonia, transits the Strait. Disruptions are already pushing up prices for these inputs, with Egyptian urea prices, a global indicator for fertiliser prices, particularly nitrogen fertilisers, reaching its highest level in more than three years. That said, at around US$475/t, it is still significantly below its record of $1050 following Russia's invasion of Ukraine.

Globally, manufacturing PMIs show a sharp re-acceleration in input cost growth, with energy, freight and intermediate goods cited as key drivers, alongside some lengthening in supplier delivery times. In Australia, the PMI manufacturing input price measure has risen to its highest level since August 2023.

However, while supply chain pressures are rising and are expected to remain elevated beyond the end of the conflict, they are expected to remain materially below the peak levels experienced in 2021–22. The port congestion, post-COVID reopening surge in demand and broad-based shortages that were features in this episode remain absent. The appreciation of the Australian dollar, both against the US dollar and on a trade weighted basis, will also provide a partial offset to imported cost pressures, reducing the local currency impact of higher global input prices. In contrast, the AUD/USD cross fell by 9% around during the 2022 episode, amplifying the rise in import costs.

Accordingly, while price pressures are rising, particularly for energy-intensive inputs such as fertilisers and aluminium, the impact on producer prices and the flow through to headline and core inflation is expected to be smaller than during the 2022 cost of living crisis.

Inflation impact

Both the Oxford Economics model and our bottom-up forecasts imply that higher energy, freight and upstream input costs are expected to lift headline inflation materially over 2026. The direct impact comes firstly through fuel and transport-related components before it broadens as higher distribution and input costs are passed on to a wider range of consumer prices.

Reacting to this, the Australian Government announced that from April 1, the fuel excise tax will be cut in half, reducing the pump price of petrol and diesel by 26¢/litre. We are now expecting headline CPI to peak at 5.4%yr in Q2 2026, up from 4.1% previously, with monthly inflation likely to be even higher breaking through 6%yr around April or May.

Fuel inflation is expected to contribute 1.1ppt to the headline figure by the June quarter with national weekly average petrol and diesel prices projected to peak at around $2.65/litre and $3.25/litre in early April – they would have both been much higher through April and into May were it not for the cut in the fuel excise. The excise only applies to fuels used on Australian roads and is not applied to fuel sold for farming, mining, other industrial purposes, including aviation and shipping.

Higher energy, freight and fertiliser costs are expected to flow through to agricultural prices and food prices with a lag. The pass-through is unlikely to be uniform across products; more energy-intensive production will see greater pass-through, along with products where production elsewhere in the world is constrained. At first glance, winter crops such as wheat would appear to come under pressures, but for now strong global supply balances will keep these prices contained and the risks of large price increases sit more in 2027. At this stage we have food price inflation of more than 4%yr by end 2026 and into the first half of 2028.

We have allowed for larger spillovers into services prices and wages than previously, based on early firm announcements as well as the higher profile for fuel prices. Higher fuel costs are feeding directly into transport prices, including airfares, with Qantas already announcing a 5% price increases in response to higher jet fuel costs. More broadly, higher transport and input costs will mechanically lift prices for items such as eating out and even new home construction, adding to core inflation pressures even as weaker real disposable income growth signals some limited scope for costs to be fully passed on.

We expect the Trimmed mean inflation to peak at around 4.0%yr by end 2026 and remain above 3%yr in 2027. That said, a key risk is that memories of the last global supply shock mean businesses react pre-emptively to increases in prices, something we are already hearing anecdotally. This time around, businesses could also be readier to pass on any actual cost increases to consumers. Indeed, there have already been calls from some Australian businesses to implement a fuel surcharge including the Australian Restaurant and Cafe Association proposing a 5% charge. Again, we see these spillovers as likely to be smaller than in 2022, when demand was recovering strongly, policy was expansionary and a wider range of supply chains were disrupted. They will, however, contribute to a slower normalisation in underlying inflation.

RBA response

We have changed our forecast for the RBA cash rate, adding in two more hikes, in June and August, on top of the increase we were already forecasting for May. The cash rate is now expected to peak at 4.85%, significantly above the previous peak of 4.35%. With trimmed mean inflation sitting around 4% in the second half of this year and only slowly declining thereafter, the Monetary Policy Board (MPB) will want policy to be clearly restrictive to keep inflation expectations anchored. It will be dismayed at the recent examples of rapid pass-through of energy costs to other prices, and

Despite the weaker economic outlook and potential undershoot of the inflation target implied by these revised forecasts, we think the RBA will be slow to reverse this policy tightening and risks getting behind the curve in coming years. We push out the date for rate cuts and pencil in four rate cuts, one per quarter in February, May, August and November 2028. We have low conviction about the exact timing.

The main rationales for the slower reversal are that Australia already had relatively limited spare capacity at the point the conflict broke out, and that pre-emptive pass-through by firms could keep underlying inflation high into 2027. We also note that the RBA is likely to have something of a “once bitten, twice shy” approach even as inflation declines towards the 2–3% target range. Inflation kicked up shortly after it cut rates last year, and the MPB would want to avoid a repeat of the backtracking that induced.

GDP impact

The combination of a deeper energy shock globally and higher path for inflation and interest rates locally points to a more pronounced and prolonged slowdown in the Australian economy than we forecast in mid-March. The combination will place particularly intense strains on the household sector. We now expect real consumption growth to slow to just 1.2%yr in 2026, implying a renewed period of decline in per capita terms.

Higher borrowing and input costs will also weigh on other interest-sensitive parts of the economy, particularly dwelling construction and business investment in construction-related industries, including new commercial buildings.

Taken together, these forces are expected to see real GDP growth slow to just 1% in 2027 and remain subdued at 1.6% in 2027. With population growth running at 1.6%yr, activity is set to contract in per capita terms in 2026, holding flat in 2027. Beyond that, anticipated rate cuts in 2028 should mean that monetary policy no longer prevents a recovery in growth. With energy supply assumed to have recovered by then, demand growth can rebound to 2.8% over 2028, though there will still be considerable spare capacity at that point.

Australia’s labour market is also expected to experience a more pronounced and extended weakening. The combination of slower employment growth and a slightly higher participation rate sees the unemployment rate rise from 4.3% currently to a peak of 5% by year end, holding near these levels through 2027. That additional slack will, in turn, accentuate the moderation in inflation expected to come through as energy price related pressures subside in 2028.

Economic & financial forecasts

Interest rate forecasts

Australia	Latest (30 Mar)	Jun–26	Sep–26	Dec–26	Mar–27	Jun–27	Sep–27	Dec–27	Mar–28	Jun–28
Cash	4.10	4.60	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.60	4.35
90 Day BBSW	4.32	4.80	4.90	4.90	4.95	4.95	4.95	4.80	4.55	4.30
3 Year Swap	4.70	4.80	4.75	4.70	4.65	4.60	4.50	4.40	4.30	4.20
3 Year Bond	4.72	4.80	4.75	4.70	4.65	4.60	4.50	4.40	4.30	4.20
10 Year Bond	5.08	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.00	4.95	4.90	4.90
10 Year Spread to US (bps)	68	65	65	60	55	50	40	30	20	15
United States										
Fed Funds	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625
US 10 Year Bond	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.45	4.50	4.55	4.60	4.65	4.70	4.75

Exchange rate forecasts

	Latest (30 Mar)	Jun–26	Sep–26	Dec–26	Mar–27	Jun–27	Sep–27	Dec–27	Mar–28	Jun–28
AUD/USD	0.6861	0.72	0.72	0.73	0.73	0.74	0.74	0.74	0.73	0.73
NZD/USD	0.5739	0.59	0.61	0.62	0.64	0.66	0.67	0.67	0.67	0.665
USD/JPY	159.72	156	155	154	152	150	148	146	144	142
EUR/USD	1.1506	1.17	1.18	1.19	1.20	1.21	1.22	1.22	1.22	1.22
GBP/USD	1.3254	1.35	1.36	1.37	1.38	1.39	1.40	1.41	1.41	1.41
USD/CNY	6.9103	6.85	6.80	6.70	6.60	6.50	6.45	6.40	6.35	6.35
AUD/NZD	1.1958	1.22	1.18	1.18	1.14	1.12	1.11	1.10	1.10	1.10

Australian economic forecasts

	2025		2026				2027		Calendar years			
% Change	**Q3**	**Q4**	**Q1f**	**Q2f**	**Q3f**	**Q4f**	**Q1f**	**Q2f**	**2025**	**2026f**	**2027f**	**2028f**
GDP %qtr	0.5	0.8	0.5	0.2	0.1	0.2	0.3	0.4	–	–	–	–
%yr end	2.1	2.6	2.6	1.9	1.6	1.0	0.9	1.1	2.6	1.0	1.6	2.8
Unemployment rate %	4.3	4.3	4.2	4.3	4.6	4.9	5.0	4.9	4.3	4.9	4.9	4.5
Wages (WPI) %qtr	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.7	0.8	–	–	–	–
%yr end	3.3	3.4	3.3	3.2	3.2	3.2	3.2	3.2	3.4	3.2	3.0	3.4
CPI Headline %qtr	1.3	0.6	1.5	1.9	0.9	0.3	0.5	0.6	–	–	–	–
%yr end	3.2	3.6	4.2	5.4	5.0	4.6	3.6	2.3	3.6	4.6	2.4	2.4
CPI Trimmed Mean %qtr	1.0	0.9	0.9	1.0	1.0	0.9	0.8	0.7	–	–	–	–
%yr end	3.0	3.4	3.5	3.9	4.0	4.0	3.8	3.5	3.4	4.0	3.0	2.5

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

IQ

westpaciq.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

10 April 2026

MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

Key themes

There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with the US Iran ceasefire largely holding.

Sentiment received a boost and oil retraced some of its spike after Israel announced it will hold talks with Lebanon, increasing the likelihood of a broader Middle East ceasefire.

US equities extended their rally, while the late session rally in European equities was unable to fully retrace earlier losses.

US bond yields were slightly lower across the curve, potentially reflecting softer spending and labour market partials coming out of the US. The US dollar index also retreated, with risk currencies such as the Aussie outperforming.

Oil continued to rise earlier in the session but pulled back sharply after Israel announced discussions.

Data snapshot

FX Last 24 hrs	Current	Change
TWI	65.3	-0.5%
AUD/USD	0.7083	0.5%
AUD/JPY	112.60	0.8%
AUD/GBP	0.5272	0.2%
AUD/NZD	1.2092	-0.1%
AUD/EUR	0.6055	0.3%
AUD/CNH	4.8359	0.5%
AUD/SGD	0.9013	0.5%
AUD/HKD	5.5487	0.6%
AUD/CAD	0.9785	0.3%
EUR/USD	1.1698	0.3%
USD/JPY	158.98	0.2%
USD Index	98.80	-0.3%

Equities	Close	Change
S&P/ASX 200	8,973	0.2%
S&P 500	6,825	0.6%
Japan Nikkei	55,895	-0.7%
Hang Seng	25,752	-0.5%
Euro Stoxx 50	5,896	-0.3%
UK FTSE100	10,603	-0.1%
VIX Index	19.49	-7.4%

Commodities	Current	Change
CRB Index	368.55	0.6%
Gold	4766.89	1.0%
Copper	12682	-0.2%
Oil (WTI futures)	97.87	3.7%
Coal (coking)	229.00	-1.5%
Coal (thermal)	133.85	-0.6%
Iron Ore	103.30	-2.6%
ACCU	36.13	-4.3%

AUS Interest Rate Swaps	Last	Change
30 day BBSY	4.11	0.00
90 day BBSY	4.37	0.00
180 day BBSY	4.83	0.00
1 year swap	4.57	-0.01
2 year swap	4.61	-0.03
3 year swap	4.59	-0.03
4 year swap	4.58	-0.02
5 year swap	4.61	-0.01
6 year swap	4.65	-0.01
7 year swap	4.70	-0.01
8 year swap	4.74	-0.01
9 year swap	4.79	-0.01
10 year swap	5.03	-0.02

Government Bond Yields	Close	Change
Australia		
3 year bond	4.60	0.05
10 year bond	4.91	0.05
United States		
3-month T Bill	3.59	-0.02
2 year bond	3.77	-0.02
10 year bond	4.28	-0.02
Other (10 year yields)		
Germany	2.99	0.04
Japan	2.39	0.02
UK	4.75	0.04

Sydney Futures Exchange	Current	Change
10 yr bond	4.95	0.01
3 yr bond	4.60	-0.02
3 mth bill rate	4.32	0.14
SPI 200	8,995	-0.1%

Data as at 7:30am AEDT. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac Group
P: +61 468 571 786
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Financial Markets

- There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with reports suggesting Iran will allow tankers and cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz only with its military's consent. Sentiment received a late boost in the session after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu said he had agreed to negotiations with Lebanon.
- US equities extended their rally, more than retracing earlier market losses following the announcement that Israel will hold talks with Lebanon. Weaker-than-expected partial labour market and spending data from the US also helped push yields lower, supporting the rally. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average both closed around 0.6% higher, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq finished up 0.8%. The VIX declined almost 8% during the session, falling below 20pts.
- European equities ended Thursday lower, with the late-session rally unable to fully offset earlier losses. The Euro Stoxx 50 closed 0.3% lower, Germany's DAX was down 1.1%, potentially reflecting some softer than expected activity data coming out of Germany, and the FTSE 100 finished 0.1% in the red. Asian equities were also weaker, with Japan's Nikkei down 0.7% and the Hang Seng falling 0.5%. Locally, the S&P/ASX 200 edged 0.2% higher to 8,973. Futures are little changed, with the SPI 200 down 0.1%.
- Bond markets saw modest moves. In the US, Treasury yields eased, with the 2-year down 2bps to 3.77% and the 10-year also down 2bps to 4.28%, potentially reflecting the flow of US data. Interest rate futures now price no change through 2026. European yields were generally higher across the curve.
- Australian government bond yields were also little changed on futures, with the 3-year down 2bps to 4.60% and the 10-year up 1bp to 4.95%. OIS pricing suggests a terminal cash rate this year of around 4.7%, with the first full rate hike pencilled in for June and another by September.
- In FX markets, the USD weakened, with the DXY down 0.3% to 98.8. The Aussie outperformed, rising 0.5% to 0.7083 against the USD and strengthening broadly across most crosses. However, the TWI fell 0.5%, reflecting relative softness versus Asian currencies.
- Commodity markets were mixed. Oil prices ended higher, and at one-point WTI futures rose to almost US$105/bbl, before retracing much of the spike following the announcement of Israel-Lebanon discussions.

Today's key data and events

Time	Event	Exp	Prev
0:00	US Wholesale Inventories Feb Final	-0.1%	-0.5%
11:30	CN PPI Mar	0.4%	-0.9%
11:30	CN CPI Mar	1.1%	1.3%
22:30	US CPI Mar	0.9%	0.3%
0:00	US Factory Orders Feb	-0.2%	0.1%
0:00	US Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment Apr Prel.	51.5pts	53.3pts
0:00	US Durable Goods Orders Feb Final	-	-1.4%

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

- The price spike occurred amid reports that shipping traffic has yet to pick up through the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran stating that the strait would remain closed to most traffic until Israel ends its attacks on Hezbollah in Lebanon. WTI futures finished 3.7% higher at US$97.87/bbl. Gold rose 1.0% to US$4,766/oz, while the CRB index lifted 0.6%. Industrial metals were softer, with copper down 0.2%, while iron ore fell 2.6% to US$103.30/t.

International Data

US initial jobless claims edged up last week to 219k. This is slightly above the 2026 year-to-date average of 212k.

US personal income decreased 0.1%mth, which was the worst result since May last year. Personal spending rose by 0.5%mth in nominal terms. However, after accounting for higher inflation, real spending increased by only 0.1%mth. Following a flat outcome in January, this points to only minimal growth in consumer spending in Q1 to date.

The **US personal income and spending** data for February suggested that inflationary pressures were building even before the global energy price shock. The PCE deflator rose by 0.4%mth, the strongest monthly increase in twelve months. The annual pace was unchanged at 2.8%yr, while the three-month annualised pace increased to 3.5%.

The **US final Q4 national accounts** estimates confirmed that consumption grew by 0.5%qtr, or 1.9%qtr in annualised terms. It was one of the major contributors to the 0.5%qtr annualised increase in GDP that quarter, which was revised down from 0.7% previously.

After a notable increase in Q4 last year, **German industrial production** has reverted to a low-growth profile this year. The latest February data showed a 0.3%mth decline in output, well below market expectations for a 0.7%mth increase. Consumer durables fell 1.5%mth and were the main source of weakness, while capital and intermediate goods recorded modest gains. Taken together, the January–February point to a 0.5% decline in production in Q1. With energy prices having surged in March, near-term growth may be even weaker.

Local Data

There was no top-tier economic data released yesterday.

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

10 April 2026

MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

Key themes

There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with the US Iran ceasefire largely holding.

Sentiment received a boost and oil retraced some of its spike after Israel announced it will hold talks with Lebanon, increasing the likelihood of a broader Middle East ceasefire.

US equities extended their rally, while the late session rally in European equities was unable to fully retrace earlier losses.

US bond yields were slightly lower across the curve, potentially reflecting softer spending and labour market partials coming out of the US. The US dollar index also retreated, with risk currencies such as the Aussie outperforming.

Oil continued to rise earlier in the session but pulled back sharply after Israel announced discussions.

Data snapshot

FX Last 24 hrs	Current	Change
TWI	65.3	-0.5%
AUD/USD	0.7083	0.5%
AUD/JPY	112.60	0.8%
AUD/GBP	0.5272	0.2%
AUD/NZD	1.2092	-0.1%
AUD/EUR	0.6055	0.3%
AUD/CNH	4.8359	0.5%
AUD/SGD	0.9013	0.5%
AUD/HKD	5.5487	0.6%
AUD/CAD	0.9785	0.3%
EUR/USD	1.1698	0.3%
USD/JPY	158.98	0.2%
USD Index	98.80	-0.3%

AUS Interest Rate Swaps	Last	Change
30 day BBSY	4.11	0.00
90 day BBSY	4.37	0.00
180 day BBSY	4.83	0.00
1 year swap	4.57	-0.01
2 year swap	4.61	-0.03
3 year swap	4.59	-0.03
4 year swap	4.58	-0.02
5 year swap	4.61	-0.01
6 year swap	4.65	-0.01
7 year swap	4.70	-0.01
8 year swap	4.74	-0.01
9 year swap	4.79	-0.01
10 year swap	5.03	-0.02

Equities	Close	Change
S&P/ASX 200	8,973	0.2%
S&P 500	6,825	0.6%
Japan Nikkei	55,895	-0.7%
Hang Seng	25,752	-0.5%
Euro Stoxx 50	5,896	-0.3%
UK FTSE100	10,603	-0.1%
VIX Index	19.49	-7.4%

Government Bond Yields	Close	Change
Australia		
3 year bond	4.60	0.05
10 year bond	4.91	0.05
United States		
3-month T Bill	3.59	-0.02
2 year bond	3.77	-0.02
10 year bond	4.28	-0.02
Other (10 year yields)		
Germany	2.99	0.04
Japan	2.39	0.02
UK	4.75	0.04

Commodities	Current	Change
CRB Index	368.55	0.6%
Gold	4766.89	1.0%
Copper	12682	-0.2%
Oil (WTI futures)	97.87	3.7%
Coal (coking)	229.00	-1.5%
Coal (thermal)	133.85	-0.6%
Iron Ore	103.30	-2.6%
ACCU	36.13	-4.3%

Sydney Futures Exchange	Current	Change
10 yr bond	4.95	0.01
3 yr bond	4.60	-0.02
3 mth bill rate	4.32	0.14
SPI 200	8,995	-0.1%

Data as at 7:30am AEDT. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac Group
P: +61 468 571 786
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Financial Markets

- There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with reports suggesting Iran will allow tankers and cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz only with its military's consent. Sentiment received a late boost in the session after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu said he had agreed to negotiations with Lebanon.
- US equities extended their rally, more than retracing earlier market losses following the announcement that Israel will hold talks with Lebanon. Weaker-than-expected partial labour market and spending data from the US also helped push yields lower, supporting the rally. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average both closed around 0.6% higher, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq finished up 0.8%. The VIX declined almost 8% during the session, falling below 20pts.
- European equities ended Thursday lower, with the late-session rally unable to fully offset earlier losses. The Euro Stoxx 50 closed 0.3% lower, Germany's DAX was down 1.1%, potentially reflecting some softer than expected activity data coming out of Germany, and the FTSE 100 finished 0.1% in the red. Asian equities were also weaker, with Japan's Nikkei down 0.7% and the Hang Seng falling 0.5%. Locally, the S&P/ASX 200 edged 0.2% higher to 8,973. Futures are little changed, with the SPI 200 down 0.1%.
- Bond markets saw modest moves. In the US, Treasury yields eased, with the 2-year down 2bps to 3.77% and the 10-year also down 2bps to 4.28%, potentially reflecting the flow of US data. Interest rate futures now price no change through 2026. European yields were generally higher across the curve.
- Australian government bond yields were also little changed on futures, with the 3-year down 2bps to 4.60% and the 10-year up 1bp to 4.95%. OIS pricing suggests a terminal cash rate this year of around 4.7%, with the first full rate hike pencilled in for June and another by September.
- In FX markets, the USD weakened, with the DXY down 0.3% to 98.8. The Aussie outperformed, rising 0.5% to 0.7083 against the USD and strengthening broadly across most crosses. However, the TWI fell 0.5%, reflecting relative softness versus Asian currencies.
- Commodity markets were mixed. Oil prices ended higher, and at one-point WTI futures rose to almost US$105/bbl, before retracing much of the spike following the announcement of Israel-Lebanon discussions.

Today's key data and events

Time	Event	Exp	Prev
0:00	US Wholesale Inventories Feb Final	-0.1%	-0.5%
11:30	CN PPI Mar	0.4%	-0.9%
11:30	CN CPI Mar	1.1%	1.3%
22:30	US CPI Mar	0.9%	0.3%
0:00	US Factory Orders Feb	-0.2%	0.1%
0:00	US Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment Apr Prel.	51.5pts	53.3pts
0:00	US Durable Goods Orders Feb Final	-	-1.4%

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

- The price spike occurred amid reports that shipping traffic has yet to pick up through the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran stating that the strait would remain closed to most traffic until Israel ends its attacks on Hezbollah in Lebanon. WTI futures finished 3.7% higher at US$97.87/bbl. Gold rose 1.0% to US$4,766/oz, while the CRB index lifted 0.6%. Industrial metals were softer, with copper down 0.2%, while iron ore fell 2.6% to US$103.30/t.

International Data

US initial jobless claims edged up last week to 219k. This is slightly above the 2026 year-to-date average of 212k.

US personal income decreased 0.1%mth, which was the worst result since May last year. Personal spending rose by 0.5%mth in nominal terms. However, after accounting for higher inflation, real spending increased by only 0.1%mth. Following a flat outcome in January, this points to only minimal growth in consumer spending in Q1 to date.

The **US personal income and spending** data for February suggested that inflationary pressures were building even before the global energy price shock. The PCE deflator rose by 0.4%mth, the strongest monthly increase in twelve months. The annual pace was unchanged at 2.8%yr, while the three-month annualised pace increased to 3.5%.

The **US final Q4 national accounts** estimates confirmed that consumption grew by 0.5%qtr, or 1.9%qtr in annualised terms. It was one of the major contributors to the 0.5%qtr annualised increase in GDP that quarter, which was revised down from 0.7% previously.

After a notable increase in Q4 last year, **German industrial production** has reverted to a low-growth profile this year. The latest February data showed a 0.3%mth decline in output, well below market expectations for a 0.7%mth increase. Consumer durables fell 1.5%mth and were the main source of weakness, while capital and intermediate goods recorded modest gains. Taken together, the January–February point to a 0.5% decline in production in Q1. With energy prices having surged in March, near-term growth may be even weaker.

Local Data

There was no top-tier economic data released yesterday.

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

10 April 2026

MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

Key themes

There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with the US Iran ceasefire largely holding.

Sentiment received a boost and oil retraced some of its spike after Israel announced it will hold talks with Lebanon, increasing the likelihood of a broader Middle East ceasefire.

US equities extended their rally, while the late session rally in European equities was unable to fully retrace earlier losses.

US bond yields were slightly lower across the curve, potentially reflecting softer spending and labour market partials coming out of the US. The US dollar index also retreated, with risk currencies such as the Aussie outperforming.

Oil continued to rise earlier in the session but pulled back sharply after Israel announced discussions.

Data snapshot

FX Last 24 hrs	Current	Change
TWI	65.3	-0.5%
AUD/USD	0.7083	0.5%
AUD/JPY	112.60	0.8%
AUD/GBP	0.5272	0.2%
AUD/NZD	1.2092	-0.1%
AUD/EUR	0.6055	0.3%
AUD/CNH	4.8359	0.5%
AUD/SGD	0.9013	0.5%
AUD/HKD	5.5487	0.6%
AUD/CAD	0.9785	0.3%
EUR/USD	1.1698	0.3%
USD/JPY	158.98	0.2%
USD Index	98.80	-0.3%

Equities	Close	Change
S&P/ASX 200	8,973	0.2%
S&P 500	6,825	0.6%
Japan Nikkei	55,895	-0.7%
Hang Seng	25,752	-0.5%
Euro Stoxx 50	5,896	-0.3%
UK FTSE100	10,603	-0.1%
VIX Index	19.49	-7.4%

Commodities	Current	Change
CRB Index	368.55	0.6%
Gold	4766.89	1.0%
Copper	12682	-0.2%
Oil (WTI futures)	97.87	3.7%
Coal (coking)	229.00	-1.5%
Coal (thermal)	133.85	-0.6%
Iron Ore	103.30	-2.6%
ACCU	36.13	-4.3%

AUS Interest Rate Swaps	Last	Change
30 day BBSY	4.11	0.00
90 day BBSY	4.37	0.00
180 day BBSY	4.83	0.00
1 year swap	4.57	-0.01
2 year swap	4.61	-0.03
3 year swap	4.59	-0.03
4 year swap	4.58	-0.02
5 year swap	4.61	-0.01
6 year swap	4.65	-0.01
7 year swap	4.70	-0.01
8 year swap	4.74	-0.01
9 year swap	4.79	-0.01
10 year swap	5.03	-0.02

Government Bond Yields	Close	Change
Australia		
3 year bond	4.60	0.05
10 year bond	4.91	0.05
United States		
3-month T Bill	3.59	-0.02
2 year bond	3.77	-0.02
10 year bond	4.28	-0.02
Other (10 year yields)		
Germany	2.99	0.04
Japan	2.39	0.02
UK	4.75	0.04

Sydney Futures Exchange	Current	Change
10 yr bond	4.95	0.01
3 yr bond	4.60	-0.02
3 mth bill rate	4.32	0.14
SPI 200	8,995	-0.1%

Data as at 7:30am AEDT. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac Group
P: +61 468 571 786
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Financial Markets

- There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with reports suggesting Iran will allow tankers and cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz only with its military's consent. Sentiment received a late boost in the session after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu said he had agreed to negotiations with Lebanon.
- US equities extended their rally, more than retracing earlier market losses following the announcement that Israel will hold talks with Lebanon. Weaker-than-expected partial labour market and spending data from the US also helped push yields lower, supporting the rally. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average both closed around 0.6% higher, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq finished up 0.8%. The VIX declined almost 8% during the session, falling below 20pts.
- European equities ended Thursday lower, with the late-session rally unable to fully offset earlier losses. The Euro Stoxx 50 closed 0.3% lower, Germany's DAX was down 1.1%, potentially reflecting some softer than expected activity data coming out of Germany, and the FTSE 100 finished 0.1% in the red. Asian equities were also weaker, with Japan's Nikkei down 0.7% and the Hang Seng falling 0.5%. Locally, the S&P/ASX 200 edged 0.2% higher to 8,973. Futures are little changed, with the SPI 200 down 0.1%.
- Bond markets saw modest moves. In the US, Treasury yields eased, with the 2-year down 2bps to 3.77% and the 10-year also down 2bps to 4.28%, potentially reflecting the flow of US data. Interest rate futures now price no change through 2026. European yields were generally higher across the curve.
- Australian government bond yields were also little changed on futures, with the 3-year down 2bps to 4.60% and the 10-year up 1bp to 4.95%. OIS pricing suggests a terminal cash rate this year of around 4.7%, with the first full rate hike pencilled in for June and another by September.
- In FX markets, the USD weakened, with the DXY down 0.3% to 98.8. The Aussie outperformed, rising 0.5% to 0.7083 against the USD and strengthening broadly across most crosses. However, the TWI fell 0.5%, reflecting relative softness versus Asian currencies.
- Commodity markets were mixed. Oil prices ended higher, and at one-point WTI futures rose to almost US$105/bbl, before retracing much of the spike following the announcement of Israel-Lebanon discussions.

Today's key data and events

Time	Event	Exp	Prev
0:00	US Wholesale Inventories Feb Final	-0.1%	-0.5%
11:30	CN PPI Mar	0.4%	-0.9%
11:30	CN CPI Mar	1.1%	1.3%
22:30	US CPI Mar	0.9%	0.3%
0:00	US Factory Orders Feb	-0.2%	0.1%
0:00	US Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment Apr Prel.	51.5pts	53.3pts
0:00	US Durable Goods Orders Feb Final	-	-1.4%

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

- The price spike occurred amid reports that shipping traffic has yet to pick up through the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran stating that the strait would remain closed to most traffic until Israel ends its attacks on Hezbollah in Lebanon. WTI futures finished 3.7% higher at US$97.87/bbl. Gold rose 1.0% to US$4,766/oz, while the CRB index lifted 0.6%. Industrial metals were softer, with copper down 0.2%, while iron ore fell 2.6% to US$103.30/t.

International Data

US initial jobless claims edged up last week to 219k. This is slightly above the 2026 year-to-date average of 212k.

US personal income decreased 0.1%mth, which was the worst result since May last year. Personal spending rose by 0.5%mth in nominal terms. However, after accounting for higher inflation, real spending increased by only 0.1%mth. Following a flat outcome in January, this points to only minimal growth in consumer spending in Q1 to date.

The **US personal income and spending** data for February suggested that inflationary pressures were building even before the global energy price shock. The PCE deflator rose by 0.4%mth, the strongest monthly increase in twelve months. The annual pace was unchanged at 2.8%yr, while the three-month annualised pace increased to 3.5%.

The **US final Q4 national accounts** estimates confirmed that consumption grew by 0.5%qtr, or 1.9%qtr in annualised terms. It was one of the major contributors to the 0.5%qtr annualised increase in GDP that quarter, which was revised down from 0.7% previously.

After a notable increase in Q4 last year, **German industrial production** has reverted to a low-growth profile this year. The latest February data showed a 0.3%mth decline in output, well below market expectations for a 0.7%mth increase. Consumer durables fell 1.5%mth and were the main source of weakness, while capital and intermediate goods recorded modest gains. Taken together, the January–February point to a 0.5% decline in production in Q1. With energy prices having surged in March, near-term growth may be even weaker.

Local Data

There was no top-tier economic data released yesterday.

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

On hoping you'll be wrong

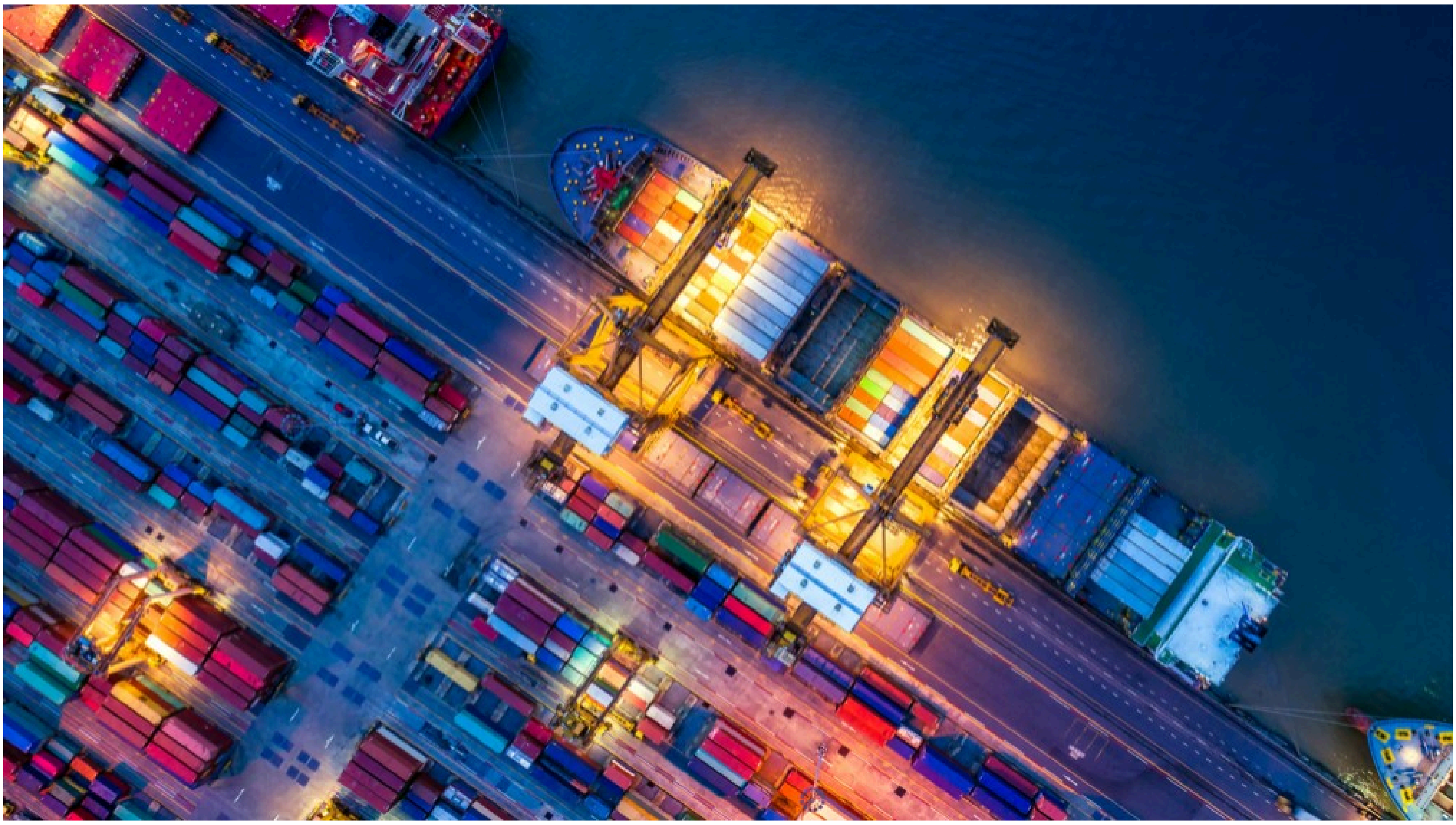
#australia #luciellis #fx #interestrates #rba


By Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group, Westpac

08:25 April 10 2026

Share

Forecasts are an assessment of the most likely outcome, not the preferred one. The ceasefire announcement was welcome, but whether it holds is highly uncertain.



- The economy does not care about your feelings, so forecasts must reflect what you think is the most likely outcome, not necessarily what you wish would happen. This distinction is especially salient now. The outright fall in global fuel supply has different implications than other recent supply shocks, and the outlook for Australia and the world is rough.

- The ceasefire announced this week was obviously welcome, but the question is whether the Strait of Hormuz opens properly. The first 24 hours after the announcement were not promising. But if it does, that would be a better outcome than the baseline forecast update we released last week. We would be happy if our baseline forecast was wrong for this reason.
- The key issue for Australia, and for the domestic interest rate outlook, is how much of the energy price shock is already being passed through to prices of other goods and services. The RBA will be watching for this kind of behaviour, including through its liaison program, and will see it as a further leg up in underlying inflation from a rate that was already higher than desired.

The thing about forecasting is that your preferences do not matter. A baseline scenario is simply what you think is most likely. It is not necessarily what you wish would happen. And of course things could play out differently. It is the role of scenario and risk-sensitivity analysis to articulate these other possible future states of the world.

The disconnect between what you hope will happen and what you think will actually happen is especially salient now. The near-term outlook for Australia is tough: higher inflation, with consumers again squeezed by some combination of higher interest rates, lower income growth and higher unemployment. Things are even worse for many other countries. Australia has been able to leverage its LNG exports to ensure we have – so far – not been left short of other fuels. Many lower-income countries do not have this advantage and have been facing the prospect of shortages and rationing; some of our neighbours in the Pacific are particularly hard-hit.

The economic shock from the Gulf conflict centres on global oil and gas supply. It is different from COVID, when the disruptions were all the way down supply chains. It also differs from the energy shock following Russia's invasion of Ukraine, where the Russian oil and gas supply did not disappear, it just needed time to be redistributed to non-European nations willing to buy it despite the sanctions; the peak decline in its oil output was estimated to be around 3 million barrels per day, but the disruption faded quickly. This time around, the oil and gas are not getting out of the Persian Gulf. Some production has been redirected through Saudi pipelines to other ports, but not all of it. Current estimates are that the net reduction of global production has been 8–9 million barrels per day for oil and one-fifth of pre-war global supply for gas. And at the same time, Russia's output capacity has been reduced by successful Ukrainian attacks on Russian oil infrastructure; news reports suggest this has cut global output by a further 0.7–1 million barrels per day.

The effect on prices from such a cut to capacity was always going to be severe.

News this week that a two-week ceasefire had been agreed was obviously welcome. Assuming it holds well enough to reopen the Strait of Hormuz properly – a big if given the attacks in the 24 hours following its announcement – it would be a better outcome than the baseline update we released last week, and one of the "risks on both sides" we contemplated when we released it. A lasting ceasefire and faster opening up of the Strait would put energy prices on a trajectory between the one we contemplated in last week's baseline, and the one underpinning the forecasts in the March *Market*

Outlook. A return to pre-war prices is unlikely in the short term, though, given the damage to oil and gas infrastructure in the Gulf states and in Russia.

Even if the ceasefire holds well enough that the Strait stays open, a key watchpoint is whether ships enter the Gulf during the next two weeks, not just whether those previously stuck there leave. If ships do not enter, the next wave of production will not be able to be shipped. Supply will sag again a few weeks later and prices will rebound, especially for refined product.

If the ceasefire does not hold, the reprieve on fuel supply will be brief. Trust between the parties is low and Iranian control of the Strait – even jointly with Oman – is an unstable equilibrium that is unacceptable to much of the rest of the world. Even if the ceasefire gets back on track after its rocky start, flare-ups later in the year cannot be ruled out.

The real question for Australia, and for the domestic interest rate outlook, is how much of the energy price shock is already being passed through to prices of other goods and services. On this there is less cause for optimism. While ‘temporary fuel levies’ are easier to unwind as fuel prices decline, for many products, list prices have been lifted significantly and a reversal seems less likely. Building materials are a particular issue, with the cost of building a detached home increasing as much as 10%, on our preliminary estimates. The lift in pricing has been widespread across industries and in some cases quite large relative to overall inflation trends. The RBA will be watching for this kind of behaviour, including through its liaison program, and will see it as a further leg up in underlying inflation from a rate that was already higher than desired.

Our next forecast round, scheduled for release next week, will contemplate both the case where traffic through the Strait remains disrupted and one where the ceasefire holds.
If the ceasefire does hold, downside risks to growth diminish and inflation risks ease. Because of the downstream pass-through to other prices we are already seeing, though, the inflation risks do not disappear and the RBA is still likely to raise the cash rate further. Still, it would be a better outcome than our current published baseline. This would be one of the instances where we would be quite happy to be wrong.

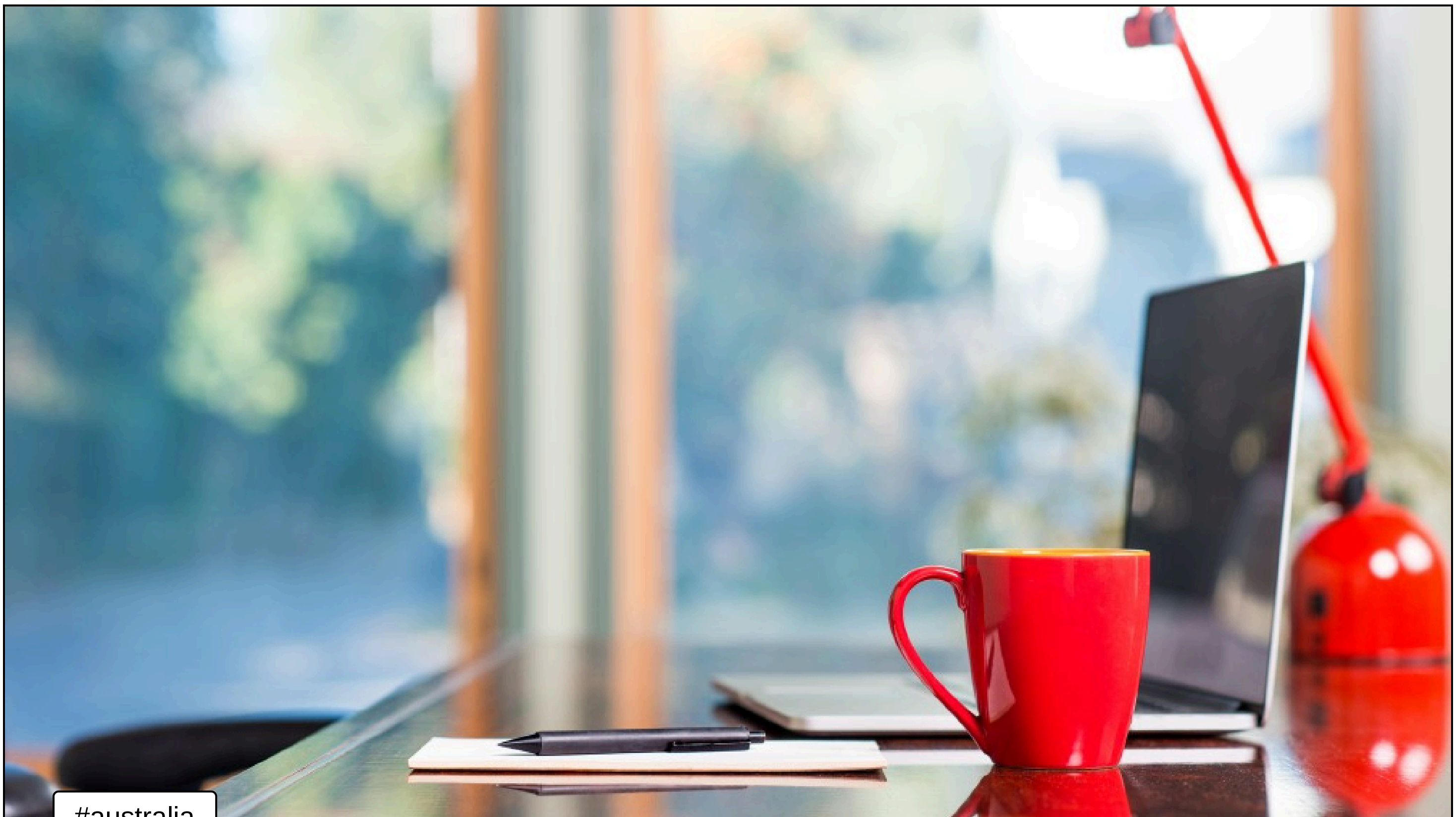
Related articles

#australia

Australia and NZ Weekly 13 April 2026

April 13 2026 • 10 mins

By Luci Ellis, Matthew Hassan, Elliot Clarke & 10 more



#australia

Australia and NZ Weekly 13 April 2026

April 10 2026 • 10 mins

By Luci Ellis, Matthew Hassan, Elliot Clarke & 10 more

#australia

Australia and NZ Weekly 6 April 2026

April 07 2026 • 10 mins

By Luci Ellis, Matthew Hassan, Elliot Clarke & 10 more

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve #newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx

#rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

"professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Once bitten, twice shy. Why inflation is being pumped up

#inflation #labour #employment #australia #aud

By Justin Smirk
Senior Economist, Westpac

16:26 April 09 2026

Share

A short video from Justin Smirk on economic forecasting uncertainties amid a geopolitical conflict focusing on scenarios involving closures of the Strait of Hormuz and their impact on energy prices and inflation.

This video dives into recent developments such as a ceasefire and the reopening of the Strait, and their implications for inflation and monetary policy in Australia. The Westpac Economics Team has built up a series of conflict scenarios and baseline forecasts including a baseline before conflict, a one-month closure of the Strait of Hormuz with minimal damage, and a two-month closure with some damage and slow recovery. Our current forecasts are based on the two-month closure scenario but predate the recent two-week ceasefire and the claimed reopening of the Strait. The ceasefire, if it holds, represents a positive risk with potentially faster reopening and lower energy prices than previously anticipated.

- **Inflation impact and fuel prices**: Crude oil prices to average around US$120 per barrel in the June quarter, with Brent trading under US$100 per barrel currently. Refining margins are expected to normalize slowly, and despite reductions in Australian fuel excise, unleaded petrol prices are projected to peak at $2.46 per litre in late May, with a 26¢ increase when excise returns to normal. This results in a 1.5% CPI increase in the March quarter, a 4.2% annual pace with a further 1.9% CPI rise in the June quarter for a 5.4% annual rate.
- **Core inflation and price pass-through**: Firms are passing fuel cost increases to other prices more rapidly than in the past, often via fuel surcharges or direct price hikes, raising concerns for RBA to the magnitude of pass-through to core inflation measures. Consequently, core inflation estimates have been raised, with the quarterly Trimmed Mean expected to rise 0.9% in March, 1% in June and September, then easing a touch to 0.9% in December. Core inflation is projected to accelerate from 3.4% annual pace in December to 4.0% by September and remain at that level through to year-end and will be staying near the top of the RBA's target band at around 3% by end 2027.
- **Monetary policy outlook and uncertainties**: Monthly CPI is expected to show more volatility than quarterly figures, with auto fuel prices surging 35% in March, pushing monthly CPI annual pace to around 6% in May or June. Monthly core inflation is projected to peak around 4% in the second half of the year. The RBA is expected to respond with 25 basis point rate hikes in May, June, and August. However, outcomes depend on whether the ceasefire holds, energy prices fall faster, and pass-through is less than expected, or conversely, if conflict reignites, supply disruptions persist, and inflation pressures intensify.

Related articles

#inflation

Hormuz hit CPI & core inflation: the magnitude of the shock has significant implications

April 10 2026 • 5 mins

By Justin Smirk

#inflation

February CPI – Core inflation is less than expected

March 25 2026 • 5 mins

By Justin Smirk

#inflation

February CPI: preview and analysis

March 24 2026 • 5 mins

By Justin Smirk

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve #newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx #rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission (“CFTC”) as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (“FDIC”). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC (‘WCM’), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 (‘the Exchange Act’) and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority (‘FINRA’). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

“professional clients” as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for “retail clients”. Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area (“EEA”): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH (“WEG”) under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority (‘BaFin’) and subject to its regulation. WEG’s supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank (‘Deutsche Bundesbank’). WEG is registered with the commercial register (‘Handelsregister’) of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA’s Prudential Standard 222 ‘Association with Related Entities’, Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an ‘investment recommendation’ and/or ‘information recommending or suggesting an investment’, both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) (“MAR”). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

10 April 2026

MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

Key themes

There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with the US Iran ceasefire largely holding.

Sentiment received a boost and oil retraced some of its spike after Israel announced it will hold talks with Lebanon, increasing the likelihood of a broader Middle East ceasefire.

US equities extended their rally, while the late session rally in European equities was unable to fully retrace earlier losses.

US bond yields were slightly lower across the curve, potentially reflecting softer spending and labour market partials coming out of the US. The US dollar index also retreated, with risk currencies such as the Aussie outperforming.

Oil continued to rise earlier in the session but pulled back sharply after Israel announced discussions.

Data snapshot

FX Last 24 hrs	Current	Change
TWI	65.3	-0.5%
AUD/USD	0.7083	0.5%
AUD/JPY	112.60	0.8%
AUD/GBP	0.5272	0.2%
AUD/NZD	1.2092	-0.1%
AUD/EUR	0.6055	0.3%
AUD/CNH	4.8359	0.5%
AUD/SGD	0.9013	0.5%
AUD/HKD	5.5487	0.6%
AUD/CAD	0.9785	0.3%
EUR/USD	1.1698	0.3%
USD/JPY	158.98	0.2%
USD Index	98.80	-0.3%

AUS Interest Rate Swaps	Last	Change
30 day BBSY	4.11	0.00
90 day BBSY	4.37	0.00
180 day BBSY	4.83	0.00
1 year swap	4.57	-0.01
2 year swap	4.61	-0.03
3 year swap	4.59	-0.03
4 year swap	4.58	-0.02
5 year swap	4.61	-0.01
6 year swap	4.65	-0.01
7 year swap	4.70	-0.01
8 year swap	4.74	-0.01
9 year swap	4.79	-0.01
10 year swap	5.03	-0.02

Equities	Close	Change
S&P/ASX 200	8,973	0.2%
S&P 500	6,825	0.6%
Japan Nikkei	55,895	-0.7%
Hang Seng	25,752	-0.5%
Euro Stoxx 50	5,896	-0.3%
UK FTSE100	10,603	-0.1%
VIX Index	19.49	-7.4%

Commodities	Current	Change
CRB Index	368.55	0.6%
Gold	4766.89	1.0%
Copper	12682	-0.2%
Oil (WTI futures)	97.87	3.7%
Coal (coking)	229.00	-1.5%
Coal (thermal)	133.85	-0.6%
Iron Ore	103.30	-2.6%
ACCU	36.13	-4.3%

Government Bond Yields	Close	Change
Australia		
3 year bond	4.60	0.05
10 year bond	4.91	0.05
United States		
3-month T Bill	3.59	-0.02
2 year bond	3.77	-0.02
10 year bond	4.28	-0.02
Other (10 year yields)		
Germany	2.99	0.04
Japan	2.39	0.02
UK	4.75	0.04

Sydney Futures Exchange	Current	Change
10 yr bond	4.95	0.01
3 yr bond	4.60	-0.02
3 mth bill rate	4.32	0.14
SPI 200	8,995	-0.1%

Data as at 7:30am AEDT. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac Group
P: +61 468 571 786
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Financial Markets

- There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with reports suggesting Iran will allow tankers and cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz only with its military's consent. Sentiment received a late boost in the session after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu said he had agreed to negotiations with Lebanon.
- US equities extended their rally, more than retracing earlier market losses following the announcement that Israel will hold talks with Lebanon. Weaker-than-expected partial labour market and spending data from the US also helped push yields lower, supporting the rally. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average both closed around 0.6% higher, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq finished up 0.8%. The VIX declined almost 8% during the session, falling below 20pts.
- European equities ended Thursday lower, with the late-session rally unable to fully offset earlier losses. The Euro Stoxx 50 closed 0.3% lower, Germany's DAX was down 1.1%, potentially reflecting some softer than expected activity data coming out of Germany, and the FTSE 100 finished 0.1% in the red. Asian equities were also weaker, with Japan's Nikkei down 0.7% and the Hang Seng falling 0.5%. Locally, the S&P/ASX 200 edged 0.2% higher to 8,973. Futures are little changed, with the SPI 200 down 0.1%.
- Bond markets saw modest moves. In the US, Treasury yields eased, with the 2-year down 2bps to 3.77% and the 10-year also down 2bps to 4.28%, potentially reflecting the flow of US data. Interest rate futures now price no change through 2026. European yields were generally higher across the curve.
- Australian government bond yields were also little changed on futures, with the 3-year down 2bps to 4.60% and the 10-year up 1bp to 4.95%. OIS pricing suggests a terminal cash rate this year of around 4.7%, with the first full rate hike pencilled in for June and another by September.
- In FX markets, the USD weakened, with the DXY down 0.3% to 98.8. The Aussie outperformed, rising 0.5% to 0.7083 against the USD and strengthening broadly across most crosses. However, the TWI fell 0.5%, reflecting relative softness versus Asian currencies.
- Commodity markets were mixed. Oil prices ended higher, and at one-point WTI futures rose to almost US$105/bbl, before retracing much of the spike following the announcement of Israel-Lebanon discussions.

Today's key data and events

Time	Event	Exp	Prev
0:00	US Wholesale Inventories Feb Final	-0.1%	-0.5%
11:30	CN PPI Mar	0.4%	-0.9%
11:30	CN CPI Mar	1.1%	1.3%
22:30	US CPI Mar	0.9%	0.3%
0:00	US Factory Orders Feb	-0.2%	0.1%
0:00	US Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment Apr Prel.	51.5pts	53.3pts
0:00	US Durable Goods Orders Feb Final	-	-1.4%

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

- The price spike occurred amid reports that shipping traffic has yet to pick up through the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran stating that the strait would remain closed to most traffic until Israel ends its attacks on Hezbollah in Lebanon. WTI futures finished 3.7% higher at US$97.87/bbl. Gold rose 1.0% to US$4,766/oz, while the CRB index lifted 0.6%. Industrial metals were softer, with copper down 0.2%, while iron ore fell 2.6% to US$103.30/t.

International Data

US initial jobless claims edged up last week to 219k. This is slightly above the 2026 year-to-date average of 212k.

US personal income decreased 0.1%mth, which was the worst result since May last year. Personal spending rose by 0.5%mth in nominal terms. However, after accounting for higher inflation, real spending increased by only 0.1%mth. Following a flat outcome in January, this points to only minimal growth in consumer spending in Q1 to date.

The **US personal income and spending** data for February suggested that inflationary pressures were building even before the global energy price shock. The PCE deflator rose by 0.4%mth, the strongest monthly increase in twelve months. The annual pace was unchanged at 2.8%yr, while the three-month annualised pace increased to 3.5%.

The **US final Q4 national accounts** estimates confirmed that consumption grew by 0.5%qtr, or 1.9%qtr in annualised terms. It was one of the major contributors to the 0.5%qtr annualised increase in GDP that quarter, which was revised down from 0.7% previously.

After a notable increase in Q4 last year, **German industrial production** has reverted to a low-growth profile this year. The latest February data showed a 0.3%mth decline in output, well below market expectations for a 0.7%mth increase. Consumer durables fell 1.5%mth and were the main source of weakness, while capital and intermediate goods recorded modest gains. Taken together, the January–February point to a 0.5% decline in production in Q1. With energy prices having surged in March, near-term growth may be even weaker.

Local Data

There was no top-tier economic data released yesterday.

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

DISCLAIMER

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Q1 Job Vacancies: modest increase

#labour #labour #employment


By Luka Belobrajdic
Economist, Westpac

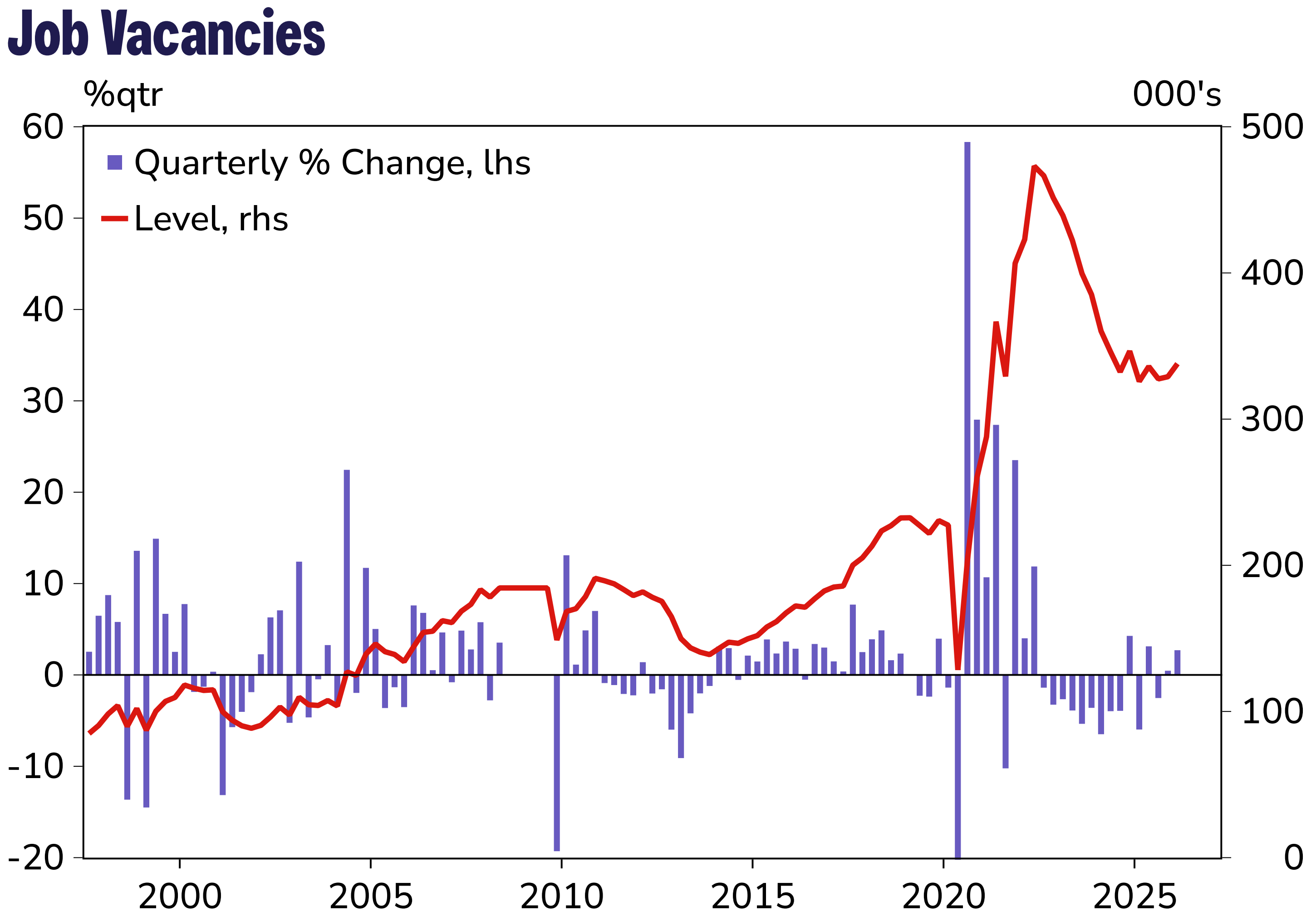
15:31 April 02 2026

Share

The level of job vacancies rose between November and February, up 8.9k (2.7%) to 338k, remaining at levels comparable to the past year.

The number of job vacancies increased by 8.9k (2.7%) between November and February, slightly below our expectation. Of note, however, the Q4 2025 outcome was revised higher to 329k (327k previously). Today's result was broadly consistent with the recent strengthening evident in monthly partials from other job vacancy and advertisement data. While the broad trends across these sources remain aligned, quarterly outcomes can differ given the varied nature and coverage of the underlying data.

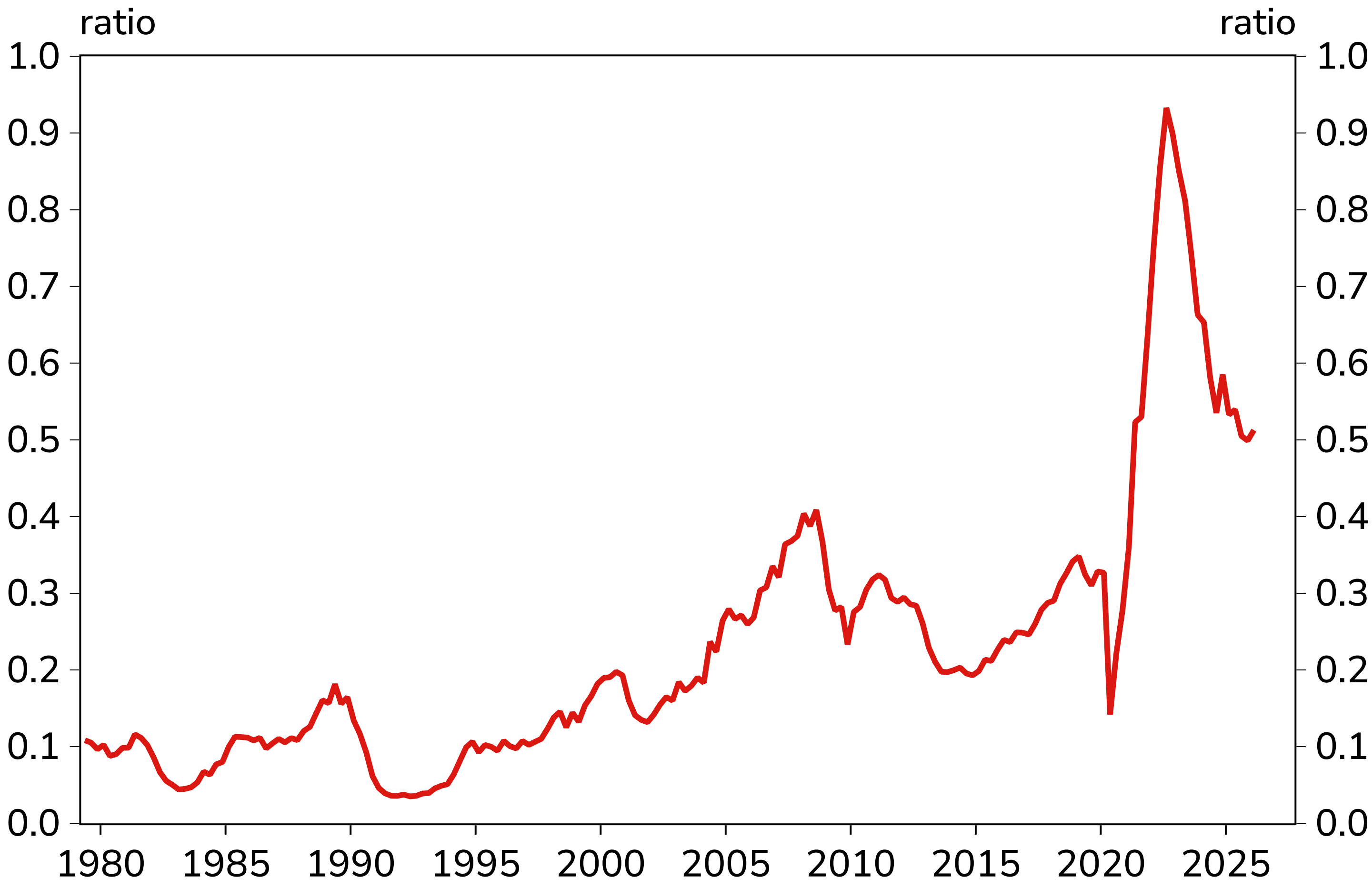
Over 2022 to 2024, the stock of job vacancies were falling at a rapid pace from its peak as labour supply came back online after the pandemic. Over 2025, job vacancies were broadly steady: 326k in Q1, lifting to 336k in Q2, before returning to 327k in Q3 and recording modest growth to 329k in Q4. Today's outcome is the strongest since Q4 2024, though still well within the recent range, and leaves vacancies around 40% above pre-pandemic- levels.



Source: ABS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

In response to the unexpected moderation in unemployment over the December-January months, the vacancy-to-unemployment ratio - a key metric that provides a better perspective on the degree of 'slack' in the labour market - has edged higher. The ratio rose to 0.51 in February 2026, from 0.50 in November 2025. Importantly, it remains below its level in the same period last year (0.53), reinforcing the view that the labour market continues to gradually soften. This is still higher than the 0.20-0.35 range that prevailed prior to the pandemic, although this was a period characterised by a greater degree of labour market slack and below-target inflation.

Vacancy-to-Unemployment Ratio

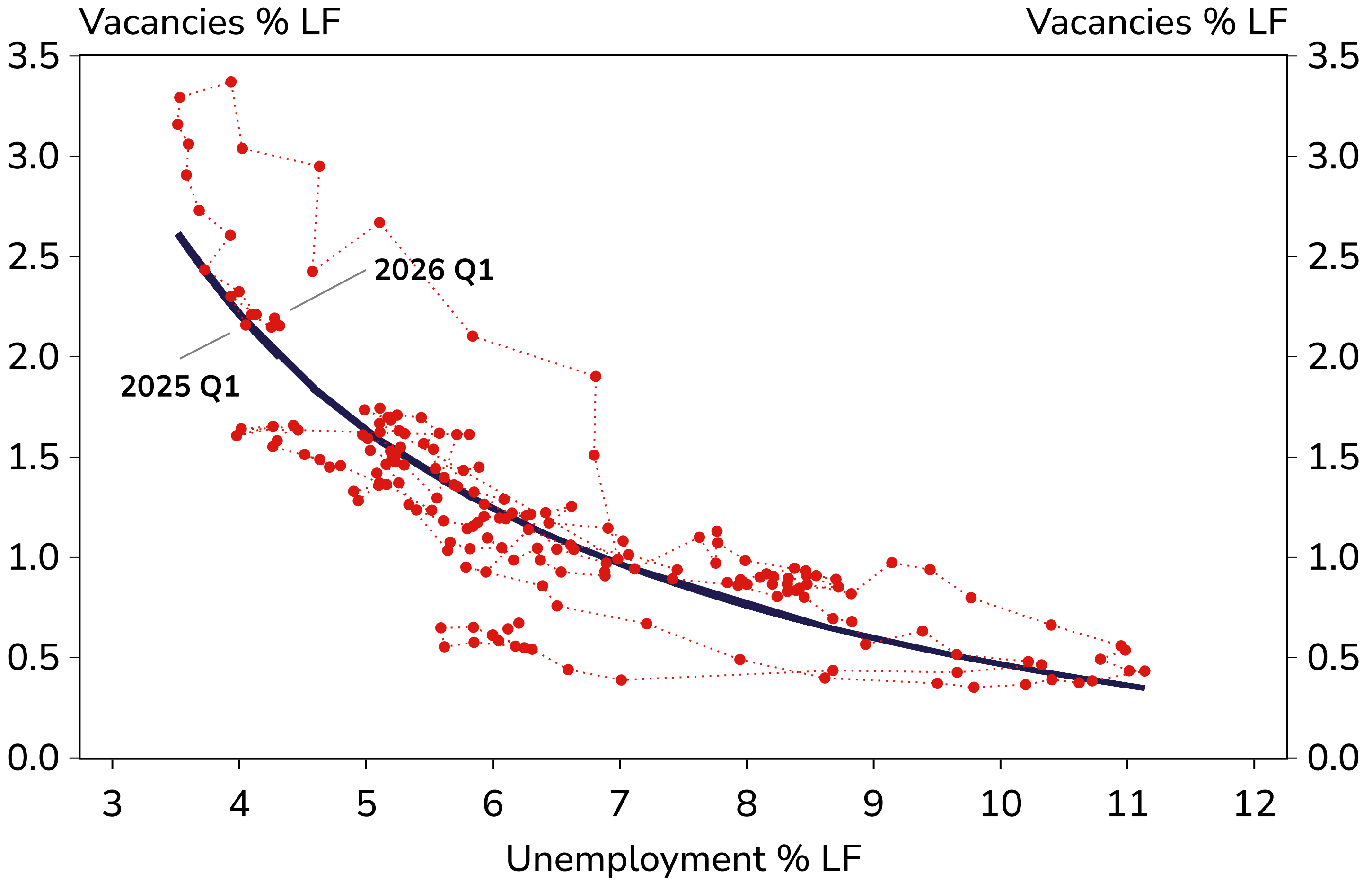


Source: ABS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

To place the current vacancy-to-unemployment dynamics in context, the Beveridge curve provides a useful reference point by mapping the typical relationship between the vacancy rate (vacancies as a proportion of the labour force) and the unemployment rate over time. Over 2022 to 2024, the labour market was sliding down the 'steep part' of the Beveridge curve, where large falls in vacancies (due to strong jobs growth) came without much of a lift in the unemployment rate.

In the latest quarter, the vacancy rate recorded a mild increase, as the rise in vacancies more than offset ongoing growth in the labour force. At the same time, a brief easing in the unemployment rate at the start of the year saw the labour market operating more-or-less around the Beveridge curve. This suggests that the relationship between vacancies and unemployment continues to behave broadly as expected.

Beveridge Curve



Source: ABS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

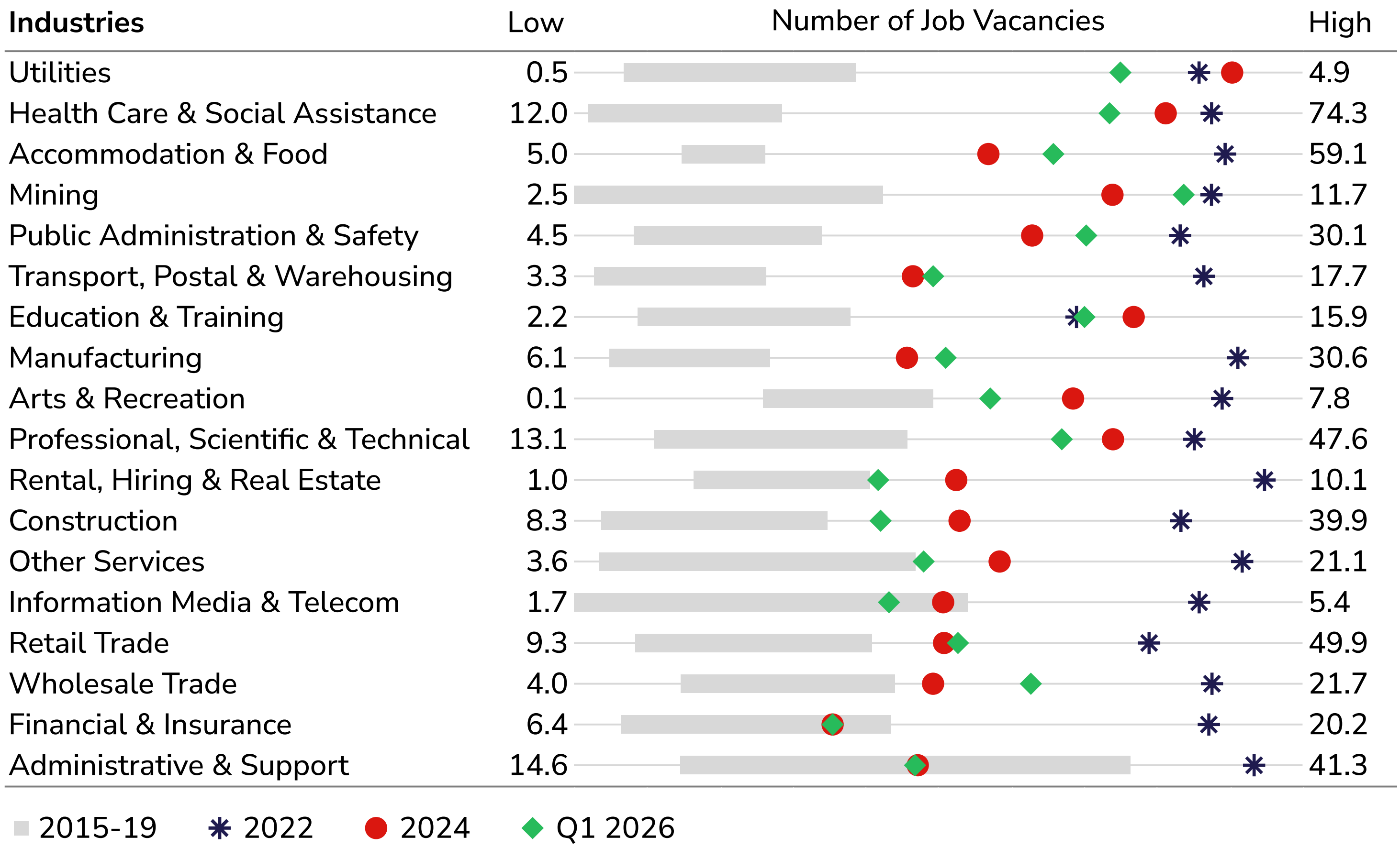
The start of 2026 saw a divergence in vacancy growth across sectors. Vacancies in the private sector (around 88% of the total) rose by 9.2k (3.2%) in Q1, while public sector vacancies (12% of the total) edged lower, falling by 0.2k (–0.5%).

All statistics mentioned below are not seasonally adjusted and hence may not add up to the seasonally adjusted statistics referenced above.

At the industry level, outcomes across private sector dominated industries were mixed. Construction recorded the largest increase in both level and percentage terms, with vacancies rising by 3.5k (19%). Retail trade vacancies increased by 2.9k (10%), consistent with firmer consumer conditions ahead of the escalation in Middle East conflict. Professional, scientific and technical services also posted solid gains, with vacancies up by 2.6k (7.7%). In contrast, administrative and support services was the weakest performing private sector industry, with vacancies declining by 1.6k (–5.6%).

The softness in public sector vacancies was broad based across industries with a significant public sector presence. Vacancies in public administration and safety declined by 0.7k (–3.0%), while health care and social assistance recorded the largest fall of any industry, down 1.8k (–3.0%). This aligns with our earlier observation that jobs growth in the 'care economy' has pulled back significantly after a monumental hiring effort over recent years.

Job Vacancies by Industry



Source: ABS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Stay informed with Westpac IQ

Get the latest reports straight to your inbox.

Subscribe

Related articles

#labour

Q4 Labour Account: jobs growth moving past its trough

March 06 2026 • 5 mins

By Ryan Wells

#labour

NZ labour market chartpack, December quarter 2025

February 04 2026 • 8 mins

By Michael Gordon

#labour

First Impressions: NZ labour market statistics, December quarter 2025

February 04 2026 • 3 mins

By Michael Gordon

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve #newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx #rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission (“CFTC”) as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (“FDIC”). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC (‘WCM’), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 (‘the Exchange Act’) and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority (‘FINRA’). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

"professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

1 April 2026

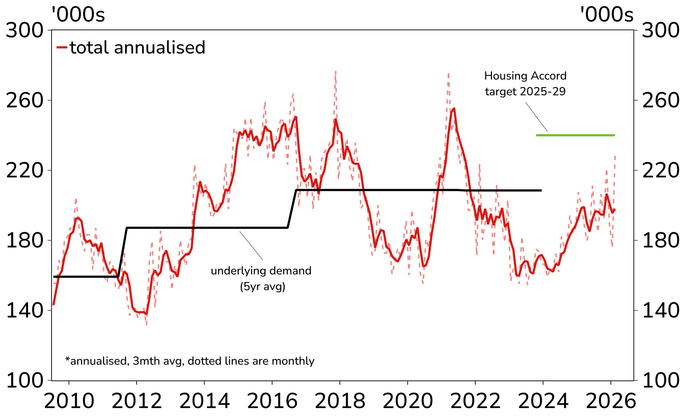
AUSTRALIAN DWELLING APPROVALS BULLETIN

Units take approvals higher

Key points

- Total dwelling approvals rebounded sharply in February, rising 29.7%mth. The annual pace lifted to 14.0%yr, marking the first positive read following the December–January low period.
- As in recent months, private unit approvals drove the headline outcome, surging 101%mth, with strength spanning both high-rise and low-mid-rise segments. Private detached house approvals were broadly flat, though underlying momentum remains positive on a smoothed basis.
- State-level outcomes remain uneven, with strength concentrated in Qld, NSW and WA, while Vic and SA lag.
- Looking ahead, further expected RBA cash rate rises throughout 2026, alongside likely softer dwelling price growth are likely to temper the near-term recovery.

Dwelling approvals



Source: ABS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Total dwelling approvals 29.7%mth, 14.0%yr

High-rise and low-mid-rise both support

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist

Total dwelling approvals rebounded sharply in February, rising 29.7%mth, following two consecutive monthly declines over the December–January period. The result was well above both our and the market's expectations, lifting the annual pace to 14.0%yr.

Note that most figures in the charts and table are presented on a rolling-three month basis to smooth out monthly volatility.

Private unit approvals once again drove headline volatility, doubling in February after declines of 25%mth in January and 30%mth in December. The segment accounted for just under 47% of private approvals in the month, the highest share since December 2022. Strength was evident across both 'high-rise' and 'low-mid-rise' segments. High-rise approvals were the standout, rising 198%mth, the strongest monthly outcome since September 2009, while low-mid-rise approvals increased 73%mth. On a rolling three-month basis, high-rise approvals are now up 6.2%, while earlier weakness continues to weigh on the low-mid-rise segment, which remains 1.5% lower over the same period.

Private detached house approvals were little changed in February, recording a modest 0.2%mth gain. January approvals were revised higher to 1.7%mth (+0.6ppt), reinforcing the recent improvement in underlying momentum. On a rolling three-month basis, house approvals rose 3.3%qtr, slightly below the revised 3.6%qtr pace recorded in January, but still indicative of a gradual upswing.

A clear divergence across states persisted. On a rolling three-month basis, approvals were strongest in Qld (26.3%yr), NSW (24.0%yr) and WA (20.7%yr). In Qld and NSW, annual growth is driven primarily by unit approvals, while in WA the bulk of the increase reflects strength in detached housing. In contrast, dwelling approvals growth remained comparatively weak in Vic (2.5%yr), while SA recorded a contraction (–6.0%yr).

In value terms, new residential approvals rose sharply on a rolling three-month basis (+35.9%), more than offsetting a modest decline in renovation activity (–1.2%). The value of non-residential approvals fell 4.4%, led by weakness in transport-related buildings. Overall, the total value of building approvals increased 14.4%mth in February.

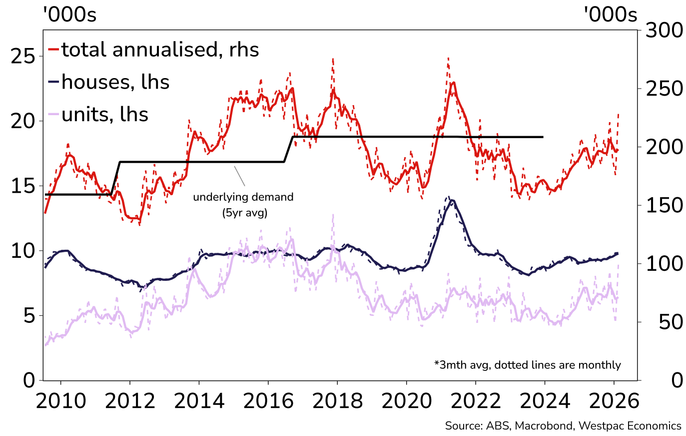
Looking ahead, further expected RBA cash rate increases across May, June and August, alongside softer dwelling price growth, are likely to temper the near-term recovery in dwelling approvals. While detached housing momentum has improved, volatility in unit approvals and broader affordability constraints suggest the recovery is likely to remain uneven.

Building approvals – February 2026

		3mth %chg*		%yr	
3mth avg	latest	Jan	Feb	Jan	Feb
Private houses	9,781	3.6	3.3	6.7	7.3
Private units	6,423	-4.0	-12.8	-4.8	-10.0
Public dwellings	293	4.6	-23.9	-16.2	7.3
Total dwellings	16,497	0.5	-4.2	1.4	-0.1
Total dwellings, mthly*	19,022	-7.2	29.7	-15.2	14.0
Renovations, $bn	1.281	6.4	5.6	7.8	9.3
Non–res., $bn	7.725	1.2	7.9	15.5	28.5

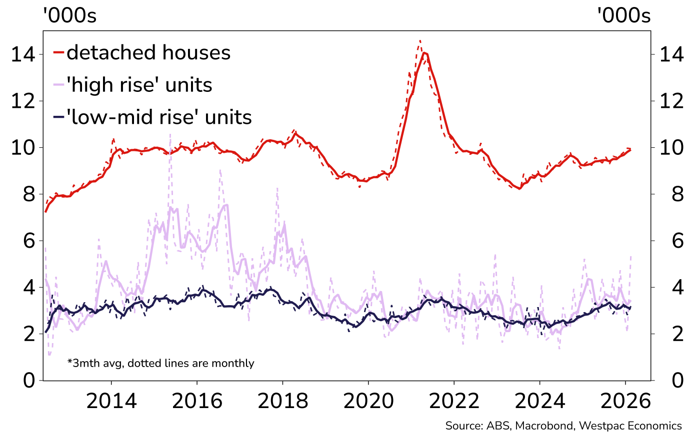
*figures for 'total dwellings mthly' are monthly and mthly%ch, all others are rolling 3mth avg and 3mth%ch; ^all sectors, Westpac estimates
Sources: ABS, Westpac Economics

Dwelling approvals: major segment



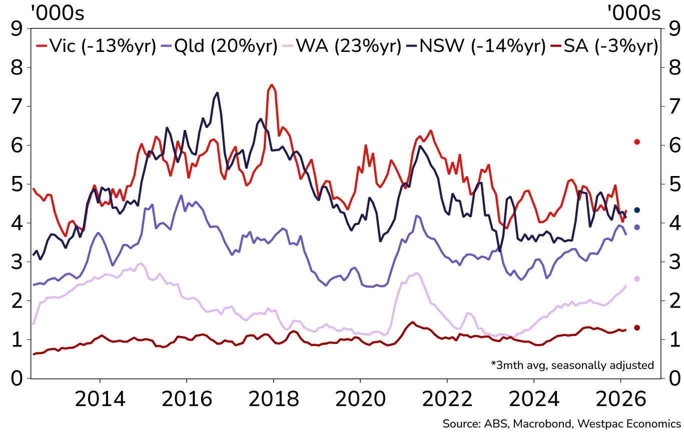
Source: ABS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Dwelling approvals: detailed segment

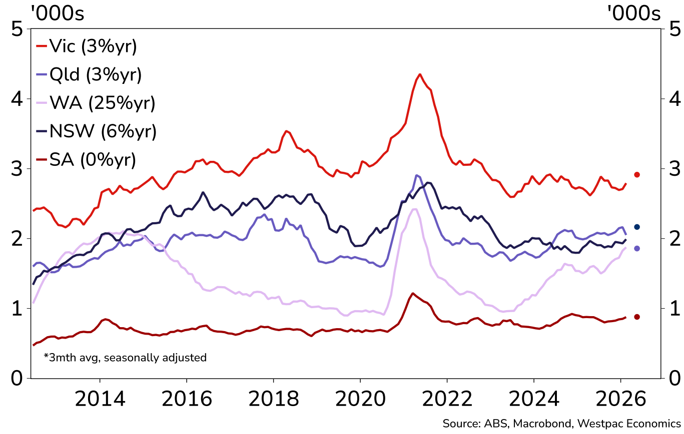


Source: ABS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

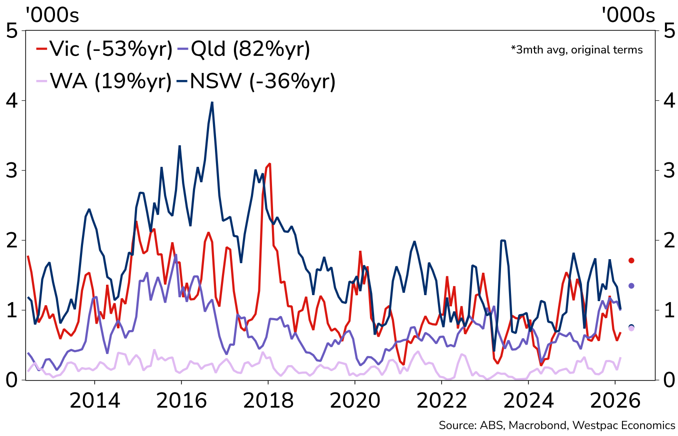
Total dwelling approvals: by state



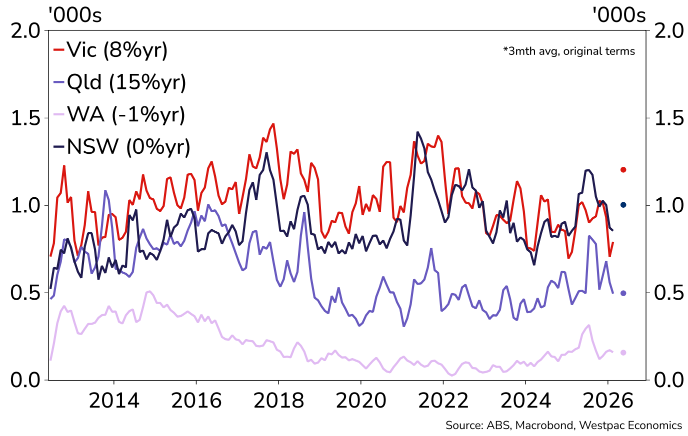
Detached house approvals: by state



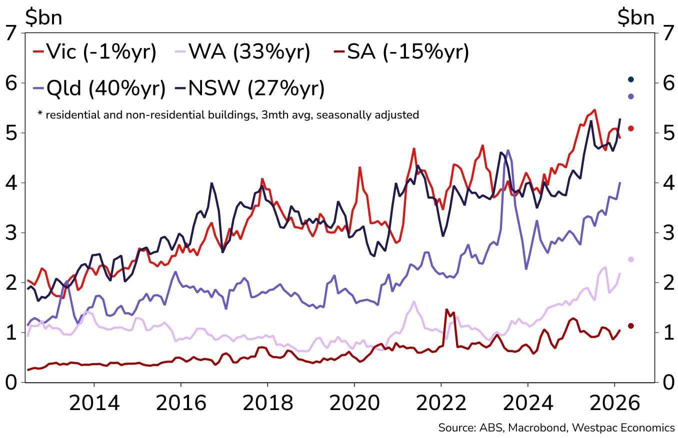
'High rise' approvals: by state



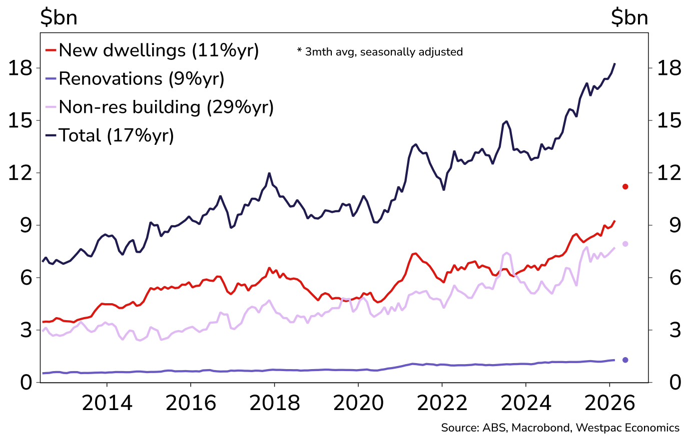
'Low-mid rise' approvals: by state



Total building approvals: by state



Total building approvals: by segment



Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg ©

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

10 April 2026

MORNING REPORT

Today's economic developments and market movements.

Key themes

There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with the US Iran ceasefire largely holding.

Sentiment received a boost and oil retraced some of its spike after Israel announced it will hold talks with Lebanon, increasing the likelihood of a broader Middle East ceasefire.

US equities extended their rally, while the late session rally in European equities was unable to fully retrace earlier losses.

US bond yields were slightly lower across the curve, potentially reflecting softer spending and labour market partials coming out of the US. The US dollar index also retreated, with risk currencies such as the Aussie outperforming.

Oil continued to rise earlier in the session but pulled back sharply after Israel announced discussions.

Data snapshot

FX Last 24 hrs	Current	Change
TWI	65.3	-0.5%
AUD/USD	0.7083	0.5%
AUD/JPY	112.60	0.8%
AUD/GBP	0.5272	0.2%
AUD/NZD	1.2092	-0.1%
AUD/EUR	0.6055	0.3%
AUD/CNH	4.8359	0.5%
AUD/SGD	0.9013	0.5%
AUD/HKD	5.5487	0.6%
AUD/CAD	0.9785	0.3%
EUR/USD	1.1698	0.3%
USD/JPY	158.98	0.2%
USD Index	98.80	-0.3%

AUS Interest Rate Swaps	Last	Change
30 day BBSY	4.11	0.00
90 day BBSY	4.37	0.00
180 day BBSY	4.83	0.00
1 year swap	4.57	-0.01
2 year swap	4.61	-0.03
3 year swap	4.59	-0.03
4 year swap	4.58	-0.02
5 year swap	4.61	-0.01
6 year swap	4.65	-0.01
7 year swap	4.70	-0.01
8 year swap	4.74	-0.01
9 year swap	4.79	-0.01
10 year swap	5.03	-0.02

Equities	Close	Change
S&P/ASX 200	8,973	0.2%
S&P 500	6,825	0.6%
Japan Nikkei	55,895	-0.7%
Hang Seng	25,752	-0.5%
Euro Stoxx 50	5,896	-0.3%
UK FTSE100	10,603	-0.1%
VIX Index	19.49	-7.4%

Government Bond Yields	Close	Change
Australia		
3 year bond	4.60	0.05
10 year bond	4.91	0.05
United States		
3-month T Bill	3.59	-0.02
2 year bond	3.77	-0.02
10 year bond	4.28	-0.02
Other (10 year yields)		
Germany	2.99	0.04
Japan	2.39	0.02
UK	4.75	0.04

Commodities	Current	Change
CRB Index	368.55	0.6%
Gold	4766.89	1.0%
Copper	12682	-0.2%
Oil (WTI futures)	97.87	3.7%
Coal (coking)	229.00	-1.5%
Coal (thermal)	133.85	-0.6%
Iron Ore	103.30	-2.6%
ACCU	36.13	-4.3%

Sydney Futures Exchange	Current	Change
10 yr bond	4.95	0.01
3 yr bond	4.60	-0.02
3 mth bill rate	4.32	0.14
SPI 200	8,995	-0.1%

Data as at 7:30am AEDT. Change is from the previous trading day (excluding the SFE, which is the change during the night session). Source: Bloomberg.

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist, Westpac Group
P: +61 468 571 786
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Financial Markets

- There was a slight risk on tone overnight as the US and Iran prepared for peace talks in Pakistan, with reports suggesting Iran will allow tankers and cargo ships to pass through the Strait of Hormuz only with its military's consent. Sentiment received a late boost in the session after Israeli Prime Minister Netanyahu said he had agreed to negotiations with Lebanon.
- US equities extended their rally, more than retracing earlier market losses following the announcement that Israel will hold talks with Lebanon. Weaker-than-expected partial labour market and spending data from the US also helped push yields lower, supporting the rally. The S&P 500 and Dow Jones Industrial Average both closed around 0.6% higher, while the tech-heavy Nasdaq finished up 0.8%. The VIX declined almost 8% during the session, falling below 20pts.
- European equities ended Thursday lower, with the late-session rally unable to fully offset earlier losses. The Euro Stoxx 50 closed 0.3% lower, Germany's DAX was down 1.1%, potentially reflecting some softer than expected activity data coming out of Germany, and the FTSE 100 finished 0.1% in the red. Asian equities were also weaker, with Japan's Nikkei down 0.7% and the Hang Seng falling 0.5%. Locally, the S&P/ASX 200 edged 0.2% higher to 8,973. Futures are little changed, with the SPI 200 down 0.1%.
- Bond markets saw modest moves. In the US, Treasury yields eased, with the 2-year down 2bps to 3.77% and the 10-year also down 2bps to 4.28%, potentially reflecting the flow of US data. Interest rate futures now price no change through 2026. European yields were generally higher across the curve.
- Australian government bond yields were also little changed on futures, with the 3-year down 2bps to 4.60% and the 10-year up 1bp to 4.95%. OIS pricing suggests a terminal cash rate this year of around 4.7%, with the first full rate hike pencilled in for June and another by September.
- In FX markets, the USD weakened, with the DXY down 0.3% to 98.8. The Aussie outperformed, rising 0.5% to 0.7083 against the USD and strengthening broadly across most crosses. However, the TWI fell 0.5%, reflecting relative softness versus Asian currencies.
- Commodity markets were mixed. Oil prices ended higher, and at one-point WTI futures rose to almost US$105/bbl, before retracing much of the spike following the announcement of Israel-Lebanon discussions.

Today's key data and events

Time	Event	Exp	Prev
0:00	US Wholesale Inventories Feb Final	-0.1%	-0.5%
11:30	CN PPI Mar	0.4%	-0.9%
11:30	CN CPI Mar	1.1%	1.3%
22:30	US CPI Mar	0.9%	0.3%
0:00	US Factory Orders Feb	-0.2%	0.1%
0:00	US Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment Apr Prel.	51.5pts	53.3pts
0:00	US Durable Goods Orders Feb Final	-	-1.4%

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are our forecasts and for other countries they are consensus forecasts.

- The price spike occurred amid reports that shipping traffic has yet to pick up through the Strait of Hormuz, with Iran stating that the strait would remain closed to most traffic until Israel ends its attacks on Hezbollah in Lebanon. WTI futures finished 3.7% higher at US$97.87/bbl. Gold rose 1.0% to US$4,766/oz, while the CRB index lifted 0.6%. Industrial metals were softer, with copper down 0.2%, while iron ore fell 2.6% to US$103.30/t.

International Data

US initial jobless claims edged up last week to 219k. This is slightly above the 2026 year-to-date average of 212k.

US personal income decreased 0.1%mth, which was the worst result since May last year. Personal spending rose by 0.5%mth in nominal terms. However, after accounting for higher inflation, real spending increased by only 0.1%mth. Following a flat outcome in January, this points to only minimal growth in consumer spending in Q1 to date.

The **US personal income and spending** data for February suggested that inflationary pressures were building even before the global energy price shock. The PCE deflator rose by 0.4%mth, the strongest monthly increase in twelve months. The annual pace was unchanged at 2.8%yr, while the three-month annualised pace increased to 3.5%.

The **US final Q4 national accounts** estimates confirmed that consumption grew by 0.5%qtr, or 1.9%qtr in annualised terms. It was one of the major contributors to the 0.5%qtr annualised increase in GDP that quarter, which was revised down from 0.7% previously.

After a notable increase in Q4 last year, **German industrial production** has reverted to a low-growth profile this year. The latest February data showed a 0.3%mth decline in output, well below market expectations for a 0.7%mth increase. Consumer durables fell 1.5%mth and were the main source of weakness, while capital and intermediate goods recorded modest gains. Taken together, the January–February point to a 0.5% decline in production in Q1. With energy prices having surged in March, near-term growth may be even weaker.

Local Data

There was no top-tier economic data released yesterday.

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

IQ
westpaciq.com.au

DISCLAIMER

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given above are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The results ultimately achieved may differ substantially from these forecasts.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Weekly Economic Commentary 13 April 2026

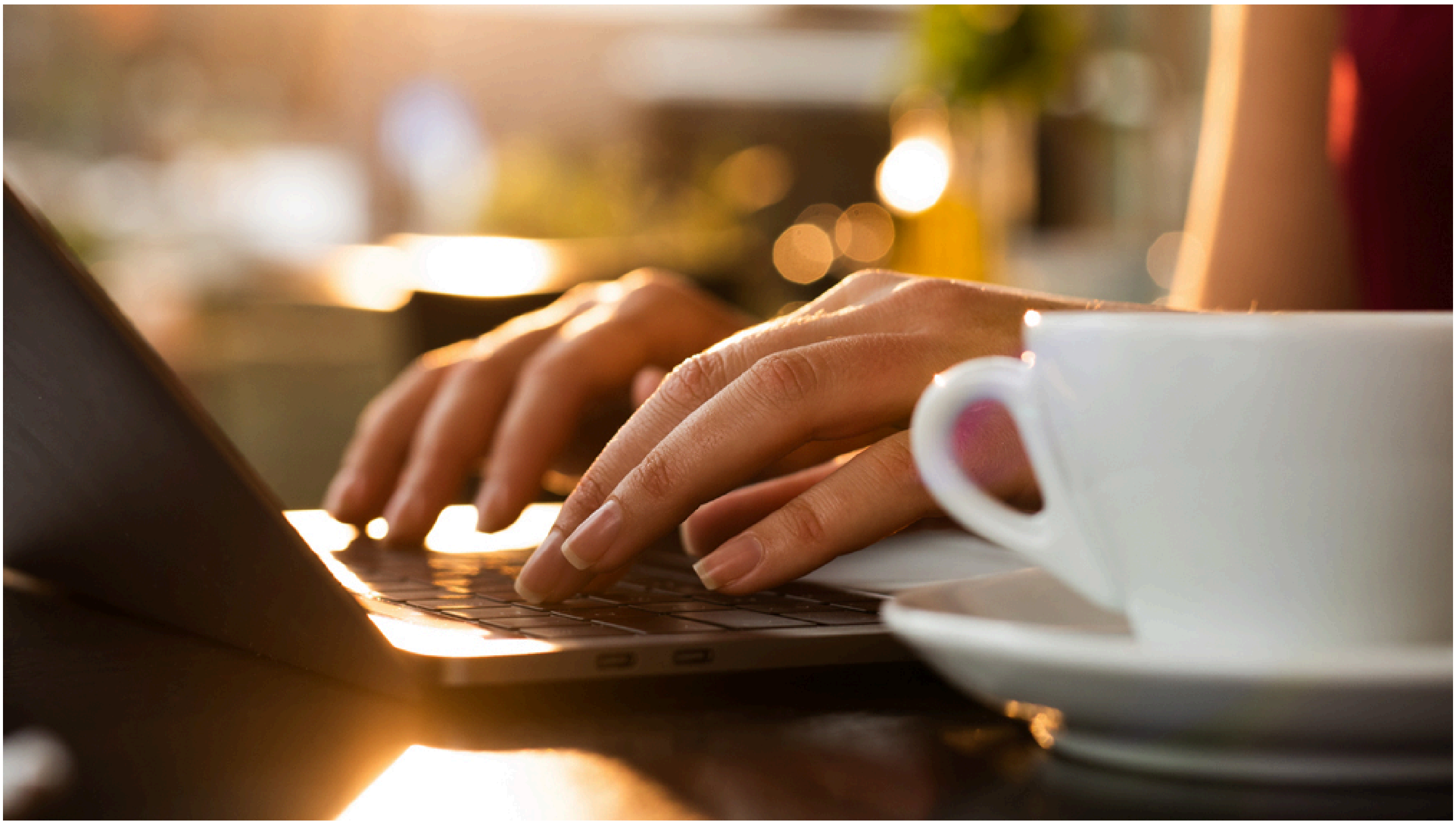
#newzealand

By Westpac New Zealand Economics

08:12 April 13 2026

Share

Analysis and forecasts of the economy and markets, along with previews of data for the week ahead.



Read full report here (PDF 722KB)

A hawkish RBNZ is prepared to act decisively

Views on the likely duration and the severity of the war waxed and waned over the week as markets wavered between the prospect of an end to a civilisation (as mooted by President Trump) and the alternative of world peace in our time. The reality remains cloudy and the prospects of a long bumpy road ahead remain the base case. The RBNZ channelled these themes of uncertainty and the prospect of potentially longer-lived inflationary impacts, by delivering a hawkish hold. We brought forward our view of when the OCR will begin to normalise and have further fine-tuned how the overall tightening cycle may evolve.

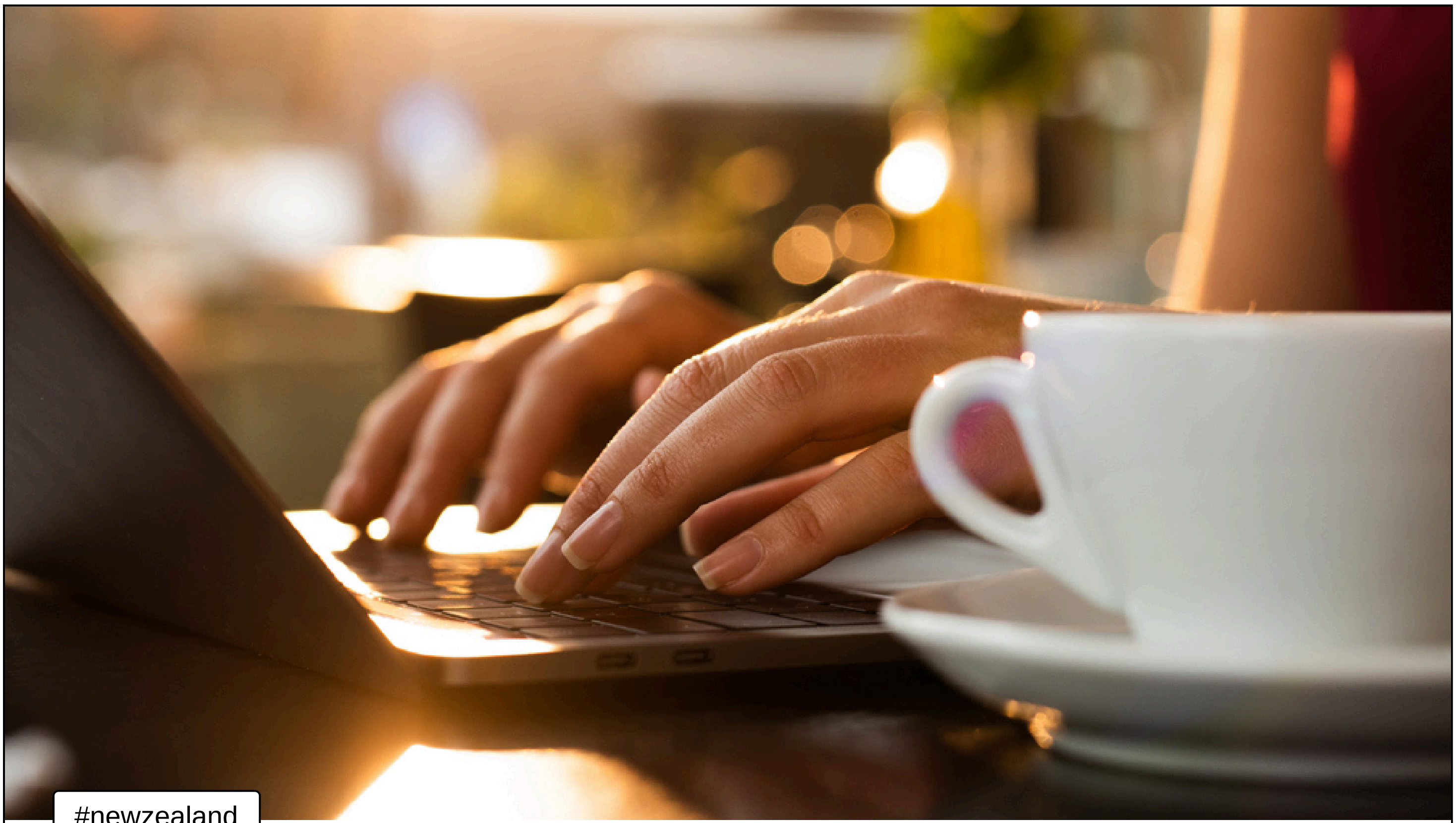
Related articles

#newzealand

NZ Weekly Economic Insight 10 April 2026

April 10 2026 • 2 mins

By Kelly Eckhold



#newzealand

Weekly Economic Commentary 7 April 2026

April 07 2026 • 10 mins

By Westpac New Zealand Economics

#newzealand

NZ Weekly Economic Insight 2 April 2026

April 02 2026 • 2 mins

By Kelly Eckhold

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve #newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx #rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission (“CFTC”) as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (“FDIC”). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC (‘WCM’), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 (‘the Exchange Act’) and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority (‘FINRA’). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

"professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Australia and NZ Weekly 13 April 2026

#australia #newzealand #forecasts #europe #uk #us

By Luci Ellis, Matthew Hassan, Elliot Clarke, Justin Smirk, Ryan Wells, Illiana Jain, Kelly Eckhold, Satish Ranchhod, Darren Gibbs, Michael Gordon, Mantas Vanagas, Neha Sharma & Luka Belobrajdic

08:00 April 13 2026

Share

Monday re-issue edition: analysis and forecasts for this week's key releases.

Read the full report **'Australia and NZ Weekly' (PDF 801KB)**

In this week's edition:

Economic Insight: On hoping you'll be wrong.

The Week That Was: Ceasefire optimism to be tested.

Focus on New Zealand: A hawkish RBNZ is prepared to act decisively.

For the week ahead:

Australia: Unemployment rate, employment change, Westpac-MI consumer sentiment, Westpac-Now.

New Zealand: Retail card spending, selected price indices, REINZ house sales and prices, net migration.

Japan: Industrial production.

China: GDP, fixed asset investment, industrial production, retail sales.

Euro area: HICP inflation, trade balance, industrial production.

UK: Monthly GDP.

United States: PPI, Federal Reserve's Biege Book, industrial production, existing home sales.

Click on above link for full report

Related articles

#australia

Australia and NZ Weekly 13 April 2026

April 10 2026 • 10 mins

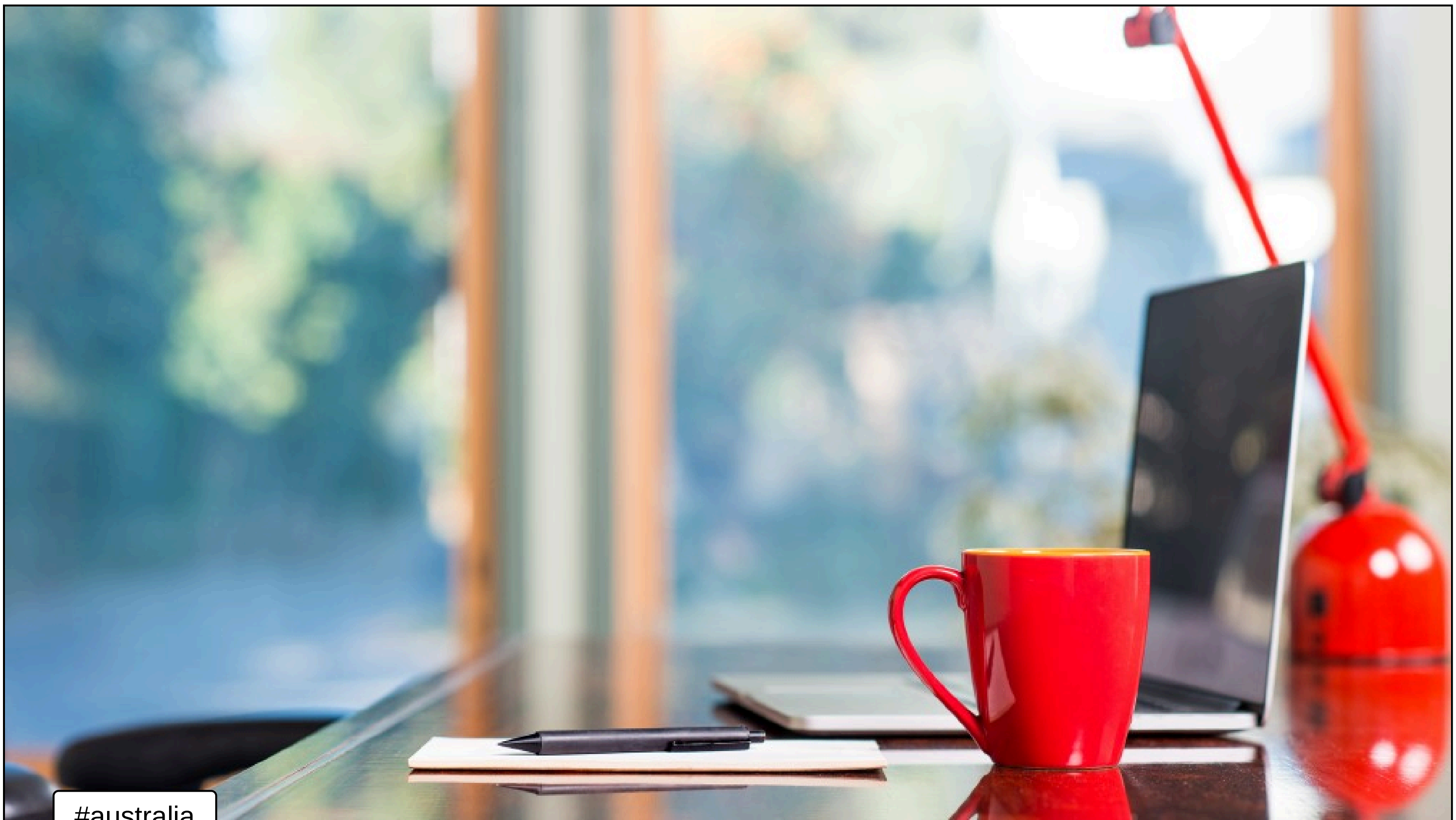
By Luci Ellis, Matthew Hassan, Elliot Clarke & 10 more

#australia

On hoping you'll be wrong

April 10 2026 • 8 mins

By Luci Ellis



#australia

Australia and NZ Weekly 6 April 2026

April 07 2026 • 10 mins

By Luci Ellis, Matthew Hassan, Elliot Clarke & 10 more

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve

#newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx

#rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac’s London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the “Order”)); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as “relevant persons”). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for “eligible counterparties” and

“professional clients” as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for “retail clients”. Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area (“EEA”): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH (“WEG”) under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority (‘BaFin’) and subject to its regulation. WEG’s supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank (‘Deutsche Bundesbank’). WEG is registered with the commercial register (‘Handelsregister’) of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA’s Prudential Standard 222 ‘Association with Related Entities’, Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an ‘investment recommendation’ and/or ‘information recommending or suggesting an investment’, both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) (“MAR”). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Australia and NZ Weekly 13 April 2026

#australia #newzealand #forecasts #europe #uk #us

By Luci Ellis, Matthew Hassan, Elliot Clarke, Justin Smirk, Ryan Wells, Illiana Jain, Kelly Eckhold, Satish Ranchhod, Darren Gibbs, Michael Gordon, Mantas Vanagas, Neha Sharma & Luka Belobrajdic

08:00 April 13 2026

Share

Monday re-issue edition: analysis and forecasts for this week's key releases.

Read the full report **'Australia and NZ Weekly' (PDF 801KB)**

In this week's edition:

Economic Insight: On hoping you'll be wrong.

The Week That Was: Ceasefire optimism to be tested.

Focus on New Zealand: A hawkish RBNZ is prepared to act decisively.

For the week ahead:

Australia: Unemployment rate, employment change, Westpac-MI consumer sentiment, Westpac-Now.

New Zealand: Retail card spending, selected price indices, REINZ house sales and prices, net migration.

Japan: Industrial production.

China: GDP, fixed asset investment, industrial production, retail sales.

Euro area: HICP inflation, trade balance, industrial production.

UK: Monthly GDP.

United States: PPI, Federal Reserve's Biege Book, industrial production, existing home sales.

Click on above link for full report

Stay informed with Westpac IQ

Get the latest reports straight to your inbox.

Subscribe

Related articles

#australia

Australia and NZ Weekly 13 April 2026

April 10 2026 • 10 mins

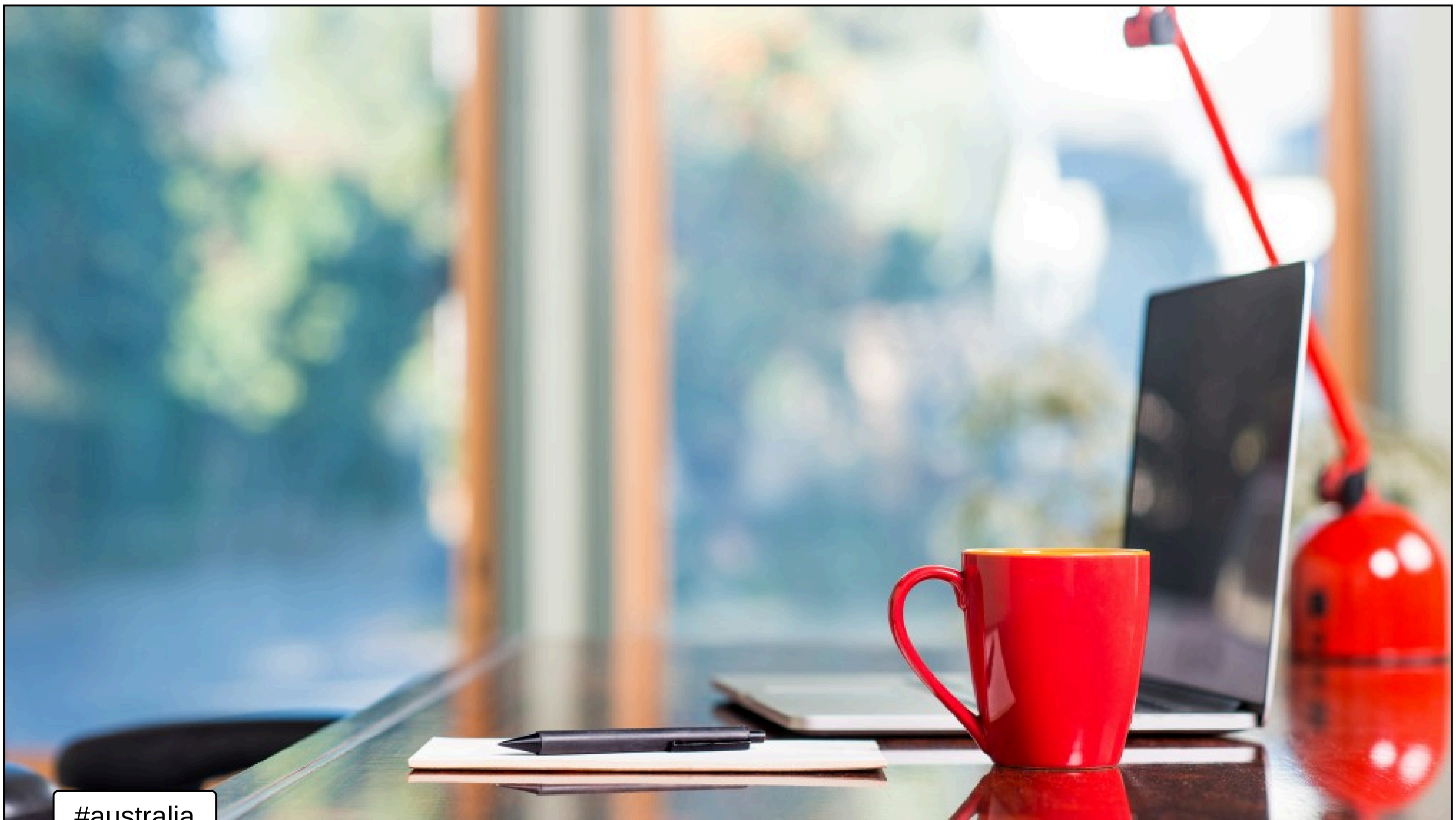
By Luci Ellis, Matthew Hassan, Elliot Clarke & 10 more

#australia

On hoping you'll be wrong

April 10 2026 • 8 mins

By Luci Ellis



#australia

Australia and NZ Weekly 6 April 2026

April 07 2026 • 10 mins

By Luci Ellis, Matthew Hassan, Elliot Clarke & 10 more

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve #newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx

#rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission (“CFTC”) as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (“FDIC”). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC (‘WCM’), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 (‘the Exchange Act’) and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority (‘FINRA’). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

“professional clients” as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for “retail clients”. Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area (“EEA”): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH (“WEG”) under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority (‘BaFin’) and subject to its regulation. WEG’s supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank (‘Deutsche Bundesbank’). WEG is registered with the commercial register (‘Handelsregister’) of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA’s Prudential Standard 222 ‘Association with Related Entities’, Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an ‘investment recommendation’ and/or ‘information recommending or suggesting an investment’, both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) (“MAR”). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

ECONOMIC BULLETIN

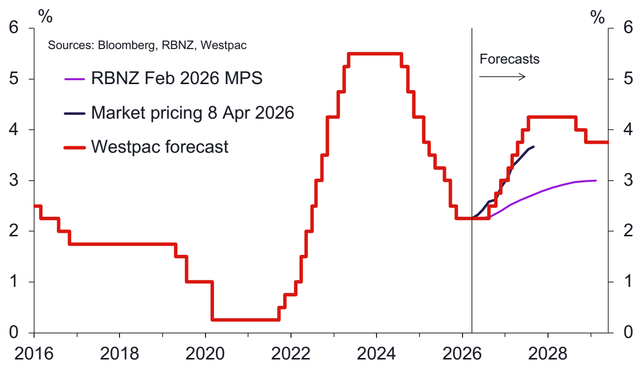
RBNZ April 2026 Monetary Policy Review and change of call.

8 Apr 2026 | **Kelly Eckhold**, Chief Economist | +64 9 348 9382 | +64 21 786 758 | kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

RBNZ to tighten in September

- **As widely expected, the RBNZ retained the OCR at 2.25%. There was no vote, with the decision reached by consensus.**
- **The commentary was hawkish as concerns of rising second-round inflation pressures were quite prominent.**
- **The MPC debated the options of an earlier vs later beginning to interest rate normalisation. Interest rate cuts were not discussed.**
- **An earlier start was described as May or July. A hike was discussed as an option today, but the Governor said that the MPC was not close to hiking at this meeting.**
- **The RBNZ's short-term inflation forecast is now 4.2%y/y in June 2026 – higher than before, but close to our 4.1% forecast.**
- **We have pulled forward our forecast for the first OCR hike from the RBNZ to September (previously December).**
- **The balance of risks is towards an earlier start to hikes than September, should evidence of second-round inflation impacts accumulate.**

Official Cash Rate forecasts



OCR retained at 2.25% but coupled with a hawkish outlook.

The RBNZ kept the OCR unchanged at 2.25% as expected. There was no vote, with the decision reached by consensus. However, the Bank's commentary adopted a more hawkish tone than expected. There was no discussion of needing to cut the OCR despite acknowledging that, at least in the short term, there would be greater excess capacity than previously thought. Rather, the debate was between:

- a *"a pre-emptive response to medium-term inflation pressures could guard against the risk of inflation expectations becoming unanchored"*; or
- a gradual increase in the OCR towards *"more neutral levels"* to reduce the risk of *"reacting to higher near-term inflation and accentuating weakness in the real economy and labour market"*.

In the press conference the Governor noted that the MPC discussed the possibility of raising the OCR at this meeting, but there had been *"no strong advocate"* for doing so.

We interpret the more gradual path as being something akin to the late 2026 lift-off date that we have been forecasting, and that the RBNZ largely had in mind at the February meeting. A pre-emptive response likely implies something faster that begins by September but could come sooner than that, should evidence of second-round inflation impacts begin to accumulate. Indeed, the Governor indicated that the pre-emptive approach could have been a tightening in May or July. More dovish members were uncomfortable with the risks of that.

Key evidence that the RBNZ seeks seems to be in the form of anecdotal evidence on pricing and wage setting behaviour combined with higher frequency evidence on price setting, costs and inflation expectations coming from monthly surveys. We think it likely that at least some evidence along these lines will accumulate given the broad-based cost shock that the economy is facing. As a result, an earlier than December beginning to the tightening cycle looks much more likely now.

Hence, we are bringing forward our existing 25bp per meeting tightening profile to begin in September. The OCR will thus end 2026 at 3% and reach the previously expected 4.25% peak earlier, in September 2027. Easing is forecast to begin a year later in September 2028 with the neutral OCR reestablished in December 2028.

An earlier start than September should not be ruled out. And given it's likely easier to explain the tightening profile in a Monetary Policy Statement meeting then the bias is likely for an earlier move to come in May versus July. The key question is: will sufficient evidence of second-round inflation impacts have accumulated by then? We think that's still an open question at this point.

Key quotes from the press release and Record of Meeting were:

> *"The Monetary Policy Committee is focused on ensuring that inflation returns to the 2-percent target midpoint over the medium term. This requires core inflation and wage growth to remain contained and medium- and long-term inflation expectations to remain around 2 percent. If these conditions are not met, decisive and timely increases in the OCR would be required."*

> *"The outlook for medium-term inflation pressures depends on the size and persistence of the inflationary impulse stemming from higher oil prices and the extent to which it is offset by weaker demand in the economy."*

> *"If the increase in near-term inflation is largely temporary, the Committee envisages gradually moving the OCR to more neutral levels as activity recovers and near-term inflationary pressures dissipate. However, any signs of significant second-round inflationary effects or increases in medium-term inflation expectations would require decisive and timely increases in the OCR to re-anchor inflation expectations."*

> *"On the timing of any increase in the OCR, members discussed that a pre-emptive response to medium-term inflation pressures could guard against the risk of inflation expectations becoming unanchored and reduce the extent of second round price increases."*

> *"Conversely, the Committee noted the risk of reacting to higher near-term inflation and accentuating weakness in the real economy and labour market. Members noted that this could cause unnecessary volatility in output and employment if the conflict was resolved in the near term or if the economic outlook weakens by more than currently expected."*

The RBNZ's initial thoughts on the near-term outlook.

The RBNZ provided updated inflation forecasts for the next two quarters. This is a change from their usual practice of not releasing updates to their forecasts at interim reviews and reflects that recent geopolitical developments have in the RBNZ's words *"materially altered the outlook and the balance of risks for inflation and economic growth"*.

The RBNZ now expects inflation of 3% in the March quarter (previously 2.8%), rising to 4.2% in the June quarter (previously 2.7%). Those updated figures are close to our own forecasts. The RBNZ did not provide forecasts further ahead.

The RBNZ has noted that higher energy costs will push up other prices in the economy. However, longer term impacts on wage and price setting (aka. 'second round impacts') are expected to be constrained by weak demand at this stage. This is a key area of uncertainty and one where the RBNZ will be watching closely for signs that longer-term inflation pressures are increasing. Indeed, the RBNZ went on to note that *"any signs of significant second-round inflationary effects or increases in medium-term inflation expectations would require decisive and timely increases in the OCR to re-anchor inflation expectations. The Committee is vigilant to these risks."*

While the RBNZ did not provide forecasts for other variables, they noted that the conflict and related increases in both operating costs and economic uncertainty will result in weaker activity in the near term. That's very much in line with our own thoughts.

Things to watch ahead of the next meeting.

The RBNZ's next policy review is on 27 May, when it will also publish a full Monetary Policy Statement (MPS) with refreshed forecasts (and probably some alternative scenarios too considering the current level of uncertainty). How the RBNZ's stance evolves between now and then will depend on the path the Middle East conflict takes; what early indicators and anecdote suggest about the impact of the conflict on activity and inflation, both in New Zealand and abroad; and any developments in financial markets as a result of the conflict or other vulnerabilities triggered by the conflict.

As far as domestic economic indicators are concerned, we think the following are key ones to watch.

- **Q1 CPI** (21 April) and **April Selected Prices** (15 May): These pricing indicators will reveal the initial first-round direct and indirect impacts of the recent surge in fuel prices. They will provide some insight as to how high headline inflation might peak, but not about how long it will remain at elevated levels.
- **Q1 QSBO** (21 April) and **April/May ANZ Business Outlook** (30 April/27 May): Unfortunately, the data-rich QSBO survey was initially in the field very early in the conflict (it is unclear whether a breakdown of early and late responses will be released). Therefore, the ANZ surveys may provide a more up-to-date account of how businesses are responding to the conflict.
- **March/April PMI and PSI surveys** (mid-April/mid-May): These may provide some early insight regarding the likelihood of a contraction in GDP in Q2.
- **Q1 labour market surveys** (6 May): Employment and hours worked data from the HLFS and QES surveys will cast light on what momentum the economy had going into the conflict, while the LCI will cast light on underlying inflation pressures.
- **Budget 2026** (28 May): While the formal unveiling of the Budget comes the day after the release of the MPS, ahead of the Budget the RBNZ's MPC will receive a high-level briefing from the Treasury on what to expect at the macro level. Pre-Budget speeches and policy announcements may reveal more in the public sphere.

In addition to the above, we will be monitoring a range of other high-frequency indicators, such as monthly data on filled jobs, consumer spending, building consents, housing market activity and prices, job ads and consumer confidence. We will also be paying close attention to developments in prices for New Zealand's key export commodities. The RBNZ looks to also be focused on anecdotal evidence of business pricing and wage setting behaviour – although that will be harder to track.

Contact

Westpac Economics Team | **westpac.co.nz/economics** | economics@westpac.co.nz

Connect with us

Kelly Eckhold, Chief Economist | +64 9 348 9382 | +64 21 786 758 | kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod, Senior Economist | +64 9 336 5668 | +64 21 710 852 | satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs, Senior Economist | +64 9 367 3368 | +64 21 794 292 | darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon, Senior Economist | +64 9 336 5670 | +64 21 749 506 | michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark, Industry Economist | +64 9 336 5656 | +64 21 713 704 | paul.clark@westpac.co.nz

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given in this document are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from these forecasts.

Disclaimer

Things you should know.

We respect your privacy: You can view the **New Zealand Privacy Policy** here, or the Australian **Group Privacy Statement** here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer.

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access **Westpac's Financial Services Guide** here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at **www.westpac.co.nz**.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from **www.westpac.com.fj** © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from **www.westpac.com.pg** © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the **general disclosure** which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Westpac Banking Corporation.

Week beginning 6 April 2026

AUSTRALIA & NEW ZEALAND WEEKLY

Analysis and forecasts for this week's key releases.

In this week's edition:

Economic Insight: Revised RBA rates view: two extra hikes, 4.85% peak, later reversal.

The Week That Was: Mixed messages.

Focus on New Zealand: Not hawkish. Not dovish. Balanced.

Forecast Update: we pencil in three more rate hikes this year and have posted our full baseline forecasts.

For the week ahead:

Australia: Household spending indicator, MI inflation gauge.

New Zealand: RBNZ Policy decision, manufactruing PMI.

Japan: Household spending.

China: CPI, PPI.

Euro area: PPI, retail sales, Sentix investor confidence.

United States: CPI, GDP, personal income, personal spending, PCE deflator, factory orders, consumer credit.

Global: Easter Monday, S&P Global Services PMIs.

Information contained in this report current as at 2 April 2026.

Revised RBA rates view: two extra hikes, 4.85% peak, later reversal

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist, Westpac Group

We have revised our view of the outlook for RBA policy, adding two further hikes to the near-term profile and pushing out the eventual reversal. We now expect 25bp rate hikes at the 16 June and 11 August decisions, in addition to the 25bp hike we already expected at the May meeting. The peak for the cash rate is now expected to be 4.85%.

This shift reflects the longer disruption to and slower recovery in fuel supply assumed in the revised baseline forecasts we first published on Friday afternoon, with the Strait of Hormuz essentially closed for eight weeks and traffic recovering only slowly after that. It also reflects the surprisingly rapid pass-through of higher fuel and other oil-derived product prices into other prices in Australia. We believe the RBA will respond to this pricing behaviour by tightening monetary policy by more than would have been needed absent that pass-through.

The halving of fuel excise, announced by national cabinet today, reduces the near-term outlook for headline CPI inflation, but a peak of 5.4%yr in June quarter remains likely. The announcement also does not affect prices of other oil-related products, including aviation fuel and various plastics, or any price increases from damage to gas and other production facilities in non-combatant Gulf states. Much of the second-round pass-through of prices is therefore likely to remain in place, and we continue to expect trimmed mean inflation to peak around 4%yr later this year.

The higher cash rate profile will weigh on Australia's economic outlook. Growth will be slower, especially consumption, and the labour market will be softer. We expect unemployment to peak around 5%, somewhat higher than the 4.7% peak we flagged last week. Headline inflation will dip below 2½% by mid 2027 and will remain in the lower half of the 2–3% target range through to 2028. Trimmed mean inflation will take a little longer to decline, but will be back in the target range in 2028.

A companion note, also to be released this afternoon, fleshes out the rest of the forecasts. The revisions incorporate the assumed longer closure of the Strait of Hormuz and other supply disruptions in the Middle East flagged last week. In addition, we have updated for the new profile for the cash rate, the changes to fuel excise and some other recent events.

Despite the weaker economic outlook and potential undershoot of the inflation target implied by these revised forecasts, we think the RBA will be slow to reverse this policy tightening and risks getting behind the curve in coming years. We push out the date for rate cuts and pencil in four rate cuts, one per quarter in February, May, August and November 2028. We have low conviction about the exact timing.

The RBA will have already been spooked by the way inflation kicked up late last year after it took back some of its earlier rate hikes (though the usual lags of policy imply that the cuts were not the cause of that increase in inflation). We therefore suspect that the unwind of the current policy tightening will involve something of a "one bitten, twice shy" mentality. Second-round pass-through to other prices and costs will only increase the RBA's reluctance to unwind the current policy tightening.

"we continue to expect trimmed mean inflation to peak around 4%yr later this year."

We also believe the RBA's evolving intellectual framework will militate against an early reversal of these hikes. A supply shock such as the one the world is now facing should ordinarily be looked through to the extent possible, so long as longer-term inflation expectations remain anchored. Because it believes Australia is starting from a position of little spare capacity, though, the RBA sees the supply shocks as a potential reason to have both a restrictive stance of policy and to revise up its view of what constitutes restrictive policy.

The RBA has insisted that it retains its earlier strategy of holding onto as much of the post-pandemic employment gains as possible, subject to meeting the inflation target. While inflation was actually in the 2–3% target range for part of last year, underlying inflation did not get all the way back to the 2½% target midpoint before lifting again. This is clearly being interpreted in some quarters as inflation having been above target continuously. The Monetary Policy Board will therefore want to demonstrate its commitment to returning inflation back to target expeditiously and its willingness to do what it sees as necessary to achieve this.

As noted last week, there are risks on both sides of our revised baseline view. Iran is already letting some ships through the Strait, and it is possible that fuel supply recovers faster than we are currently assuming. It is also possible that a consensus forms domestically to resist second-round inflation, especially where the flow-on of higher costs to downstream prices could be construed as excessive. On the more inflationary side, it is possible that the war drags on longer, or domestic pass-through is stronger than we currently expect.

Forecast changes

- **RBA now expected to hike rates three times (May, June, August), revised up from one more (in May) previously. Peak cash rate now 4.85%, above previous peak.**
- **Longer Middle East disruption lifts peak prices for oil and gas, lengthens recovery. Infrastructure damage exacerbates the shock. Brent oil now expected to peak at an average $120/bbl in Q2 and Japanese LNG prices at $26mmbtu.**
- **Australian CPI inflation now expected to peak at 5.4%yr in June quarter, and even higher on the monthly series, despite the announced cut to fuel excise. Trimmed mean inflation peaks around 4% in 2026 H2. Food prices a particular concern through to 2028, but broader pass-through to non energy prices also an issue.**
- **Supply shock and tight monetary policy drag on demand, especially consumption and other interest-sensitive sectors. GDP growth forecast to trough at 1%yr in 2026, and remain subdued at 1.6%yr in 2027; unemployment rate peaks at 5% end-2026.**

Cliff Notes: mixed messages

Elliot Clarke, Head of International Economics

At the turn of the week, Chief Economist Luci Ellis and Westpac Economics highlighted how severe the inflationary impact is expected to be for Australia. Recognising the extreme uncertainty surrounding the conflict and the passage of time, we extended our baseline supply assumption from a one to two-month complete shutdown of the Strait of Hormuz followed by a protracted recovery in transit from 20% of pre-conflict supply in May to normal supply at year end. Also, a consequence of elevated refining margins globally, annual Australian consumer inflation is now expected to peak around 6%yr in mid-Q2. While headline inflation will fall back to target over the following year, trimmed mean inflation is forecast to remain above 3.0%yr until end-2027 and only settle in the middle of the target range in late-2028, having peaked at 4.0%yr at end-2026.

With Australia already experiencing tight capacity and elevated domestic inflation pressures, attested to again by the RBA in the March Monetary Policy Board meeting minutes, the Middle East conflict warrants pre-emptive action by the RBA through three 25bp cash rate hikes in May, June and August 2026 to 4.85%. Policy is then seen on hold until 2028, when success with inflation should allow the cash rate to be reduced by 100bps steadily through the year. The consequence for GDP is likely to be a deceleration to just 1.0%yr in 2026, followed by a sub-par 1.6%yr gain in 2027, then an above-trend 2.8%yr recovery in 2028. The unemployment rate is forecast to rise to 5.0% at end-2026, and to take until end-2028 to return to its full employment level, circa 4.5%.

To the above forecasts, time matters a great deal. If, as has been mooted in recent days (and may be confirmed in a Presidential address later today), the Trump administration calls a quick end to the US' strikes against Iran, Australian GDP and the labour market may receive a reprieve. That said, heightened inflation will remain an acute risk while transit and supply-chain disruptions persist, and businesses may also take the opportunity to re-set margins. The balance between inflation and activity risks will therefore remain in focus for the RBA over the coming year. Ahead of the Federal Budget, the Government's financial position is also in flux, although current conditions look more likely to prove a positive than negative at this stage.

Local data out this week meanwhile focused on housing. Cotality home values increased a solid 0.6% in March. Although affordability saw a divergence in conditions city by city, with prices down a touch in Sydney and Melbourne as strong growth continued in Brisbane, Adelaide and Perth. Where conditions are weakest, reduced turnover is holding prices up. Dwelling approvals remained volatile in February, a 29.7% monthly gain lifting the annual growth rate to 14%yr. Australia clearly has need for significant, sustained additions to housing supply across our major cities, but affordability and the cost of construction are material risks which are likely to persist into the medium term.

"heightened inflation will remain an acute risk while transit and supply-chain disruptions persist"

Offshore, the list of data worthy of mention was short this week. University of Michigan consumer sentiment was, unsurprisingly, weak in March, 19% below the 5-year average and 37% under the full-history benchmark. The Conference Board's measure showed greater resilience but was still weak versus history. That said, ADP private payrolls continued to grow in March, and the retail sales control group recorded a solid gain of 0.5%mth. The ISM manufacturing index for March was also favourable, although the survey only caught the beginning of disruptions related to the Middle East conflict and the detail was also mixed, with production up, new orders down and employment contracting. China's official PMIs emphasised the nation's ability to weather uncertainty, with both the manufacturing and services indexes higher in March.

The key international data release for the week is still to come on Friday night. The US March employment report will be closely scrutinised after February's weak detail reset participants current understanding and expectations for the labour market. US policy makers have been more focused on inflation risks in recent weeks, but another poor employment result could see them reconsider this view. In contrast, a rebound in job creation will likely see market pricing for near-term policy decisions shift materially in favour of a hike, or two, as has been the case elsewhere across the developed world.

Not hawkish. Not dovish. Balanced.

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist

The RBNZ meets next week for its April Monetary Policy Review (Wednesday 8 April, NZ 2pm). As discussed in our preview, in the absence of major developments in the Middle East over the coming days, the RBNZ is set to leave the Official Cash Rate (OCR) at 2.25%. However, rather than the immediate OCR decision, the key focus will be on how the RBNZ is balancing the significant challenges stemming from the conflict in the Middle East and what that implies for the longer-term policy outlook.

Since the RBNZ last met in February, the risks around the economic outlook have changed significantly. Economic growth in the final quarter of last year has already come in below the RBNZ's forecast. More significantly, disruptions stemming from the war in the Middle East mean that growth over 2026 is now also likely to fall well short of the RBNZ's previous forecast. We expect the economy to grow just 1.9% in the year to December, well below the February MPS forecast for growth of 2.8%. We also expect a higher track for the unemployment rate.

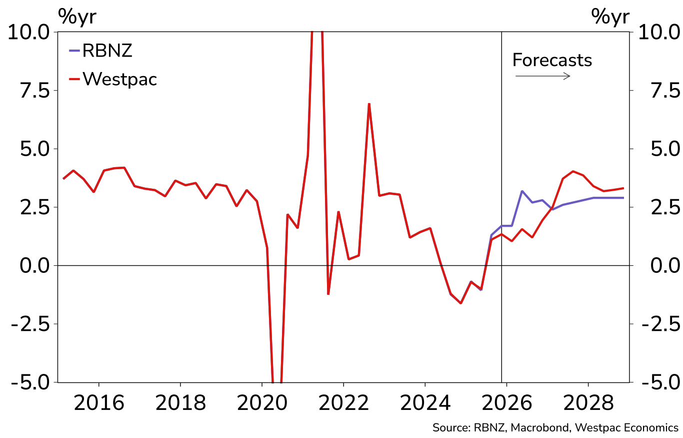
At the same time, inflation is set to run much hotter than the RBNZ had expected over 2026. We're forecasting that inflation will peak around 4.1% around the middle of this year before softening a little to 3.8% by year's end – well above the RBNZ's previous year-end forecast for 2.4%. Our stronger inflation outlook is mainly due to the direct impact of higher oil prices (i.e., higher prices for petrol and diesel). However, even if global oil prices were to drop back now, inflation is still set to linger above the RBNZ's forecast over the remainder of this year, as disruptions to supply chains and other related increases in costs of production will take time to dissipate.

RBNZ Governor Breman has already outlined how she is thinking about those challenges in a recent speech. That speech described an orthodox (and sensible) approach to monetary policy in the face of a supply shock, of which the current oil price is a typical example. The Governor noted that the RBNZ would not react to the immediate fuel-related lift in inflation. The RBNZ can't offset a rise in oil prices that has already occurred with higher interest rates now, but doing so would compound the downward pressure on growth. Furthermore, with interest rates taking around 12 to 18 months to have their maximum impact, hiking rates now would potentially result in an even deeper fall in inflation at the same time as the eventual falls in oil prices will naturally pull it lower.

Instead, the focus for the RBNZ will be the longer-term outlook for inflation. And this is where things start to get murky. The key issue for the RBNZ is whether the current sharp rise in prices will have lingering effects, resulting in higher inflation even when oil prices eventually ease. That could occur if businesses come to expect continued large increases in operating costs and raise their prices accordingly. There's also the risk that we see demands for higher-than-normal cost-of-living increases as workers try to recoup the current loss of spending power. Both of those risks are very plausible given that we've recently been through an extended period of high inflation and related pressure on businesses' operating costs. And if those risks do materialise, the current uplift in inflation could end up being much more protracted.

It will take some time before we know whether those longer-term inflation risks (sometimes referred to as 'second round' impacts of an oil price shock) are manifesting. The starting point for the economy is important on this front and provides some cause for optimism. Soft activity in recent years has left the New Zealand economy with a high level of spare capacity, including a higher-than-average unemployment rate. That will limit the ability to push through larger increases in output prices or wages (though that does also imply related pressure on margins and households' purchasing power).

GDP growth forecasts



Source: RBNZ, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

We are already seeing reports of businesses raising their prices due to the direct impact of increases in fuel prices on their operating costs (e.g., higher airfares and fuel surcharges within the land transport industry). Perhaps of more concern for the RBNZ, the latest ANZ Business Outlook Survey (which was conducted following the outbreak of the war) showed a sharp rise in inflation expectations, along with increases in the number of businesses who said they are planning to increase their prices. That said, given the outlook for inflation, it would be surprising if surveyed inflation expectations did not rise in the near-term. Some comfort might be taken from firms' expectations for wage growth. These remained muted in the survey, suggesting that firms are not expecting current cost increases to feed a wage-price spiral.

The RBNZ's discussion of how its balancing the impact on growth and near-term inflation will be crucial for how markets react next week. Markets have been very focused on the rise in inflation pressures and related hawkish comments from other central banks. That's seen financial markets also pulling forward expectations for rate hikes here: at the time of writing, market pricing was consistent with an 60% chance of an OCR hike in July, and just over two hikes are priced in before the end of the year.

In its communications on 8 April, the RBNZ will balance a desire to avoid a further tightening of financial conditions with the desire to not sound complacent about the medium-term inflation risks that come with an energy price shock. Reinforcement of the approach communicated in Governor Breman's speech guidance should continue to lean against the market's current pricing for earlier rate hikes, especially as liquidity issues in the domestic market continue to ease. We continue to forecast just one 25bp hike this year, but also that significant tightening will occur in 2027 once the activity implications of the energy shock begin to dissipate.

The RBNZ's guidance about what to expect at future meetings will also likely echo the Governor's speech. In crafting this guidance, the MPC will aim to reassure markets that it will not overreact to the shock, which could cause markets to further tighten financial conditions. At the same time, the RBNZ will need to ensure it sounds credible to households and businesses about its willingness to tighten policy if inflation expectations and pricing behaviour evolve in a manner inconsistent with achieving the inflation target over the medium-term. While monetary policy should look through a temporary spike in energy prices, the MPC will need to be vigilant – and be seen to be vigilant – against the risk that inflation becomes persistent.

As we discuss in our latest Hawks, doves, and kiwis note, there are clearly risks on both sides for the OCR. Governor Breman's recent speech did draw on feedback from other MPC members, but there could still be a range of views among the Committee. Furthermore, this is a fast-changing situation. And with inflation pressures continuing to build over the past few days, even more dovish or balanced members of the MPC could start to change their assessments of risks. With that in mind, the Record of Meeting accompanying next week's interest rate review will be monitored closely to see where the members of the Committee see the risk. Key areas where the views of the Committee could diverge include the likely duration of the conflict, the impact on the economy, the likelihood of second-round effects driving persistent inflation over the medium-term, and the appropriate course for monetary policy over time. Such discussions might provide some insight into how the consensus view of the MPC might evolve as more is learnt about the evolution of the conflict and its economic impacts.

As part of her efforts to improve central bank transparency, Governor Breman has introduced a full press conference at interim reviews, and this will be the first review under that new framework. Historically, the RBNZ has not released updated forecasts at review meetings, and instead released them at the more complete quarterly updates. However, given the large changes in the economic landscape in recent weeks, the RBNZ is likely to discuss the risks around their previous forecasts. And we wouldn't rule out the chance that they could release some initial forecasts of key variables, like GDP, inflation, and the OCR.

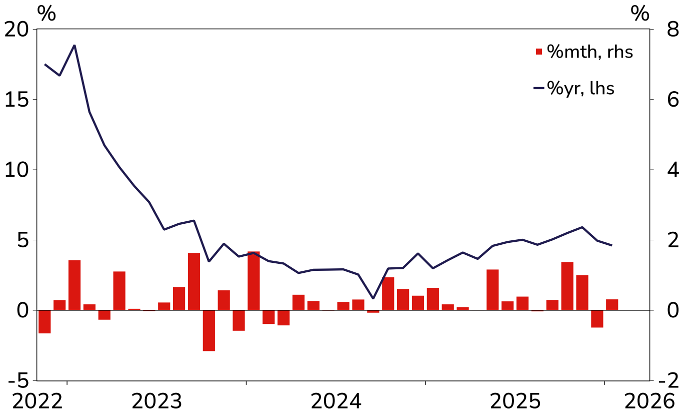
AUS: Feb Household Spending Indicator (%mth)

Apr 7, Last: 0.3, Westpac f/c: –0.2
Mkt f/c: 0.2, Range: –0.2 to 0.4

The Household Spending Indicator rose 0.3%mth in January, in line with its average monthly pace over the past two years. Annual growth eased back to 4.6%yr, having averaged just over 5%yr through the second half of 2025.

The detail from our **Westpac-DataX Card Tracker** suggests the ABS spending indicator will show a dip for the February month. Our forecast 0.2% decline in the month would take annual growth to 4.2%yr. With population growth tracking at 1.6%yr, the 2.6%yr pace in per capita terms this points to a slight decline in real, inflation-adjusted terms. Of course, all of this pre-dates the Middle East conflict and associated fuel price surge. Our card tracker shows this has already seen significant disruptions to activity in March (see here).

Monthly household spending indicator



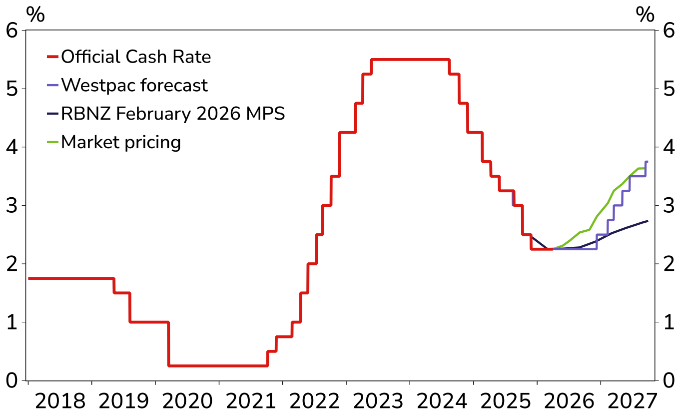
Source: ABS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

NZ: RBNZ Monetary Policy Review

Apr 8, Official Cash Rate – last: 2.25%, Westpac: 2.25%, Market: 2.25%

We expect the RBNZ to hold the OCR at 2.25% at its 8 April review. We expect the RBNZ to emphasise that it will not react to the first-round impact of higher energy prices on near-term inflation, but that it will respond should there be evidence of second round effects that might create persistent inflation. The Bank is not scheduled to present revised economic projections at this meeting. However, it is possible that the RBNZ will provide some guidance of the likely magnitude of the upward revision to near-term inflation and downward revision to GDP.

RBNZ Official Cash Rate



Source: RBNZ, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

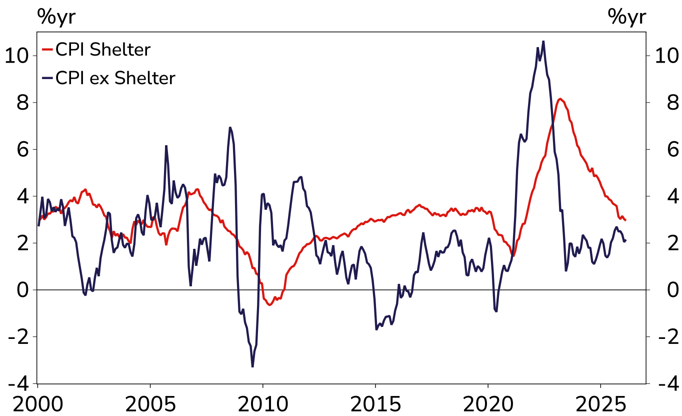
US: Mar CPI

Apr 10, %m/m, Last: 0.3%

February saw a 0.3% increase in headline consumer prices as both food and energy contributed to the aggregate impulse. The gain for core prices was measured at 0.2%, although that means underlying inflation continues to run meaningfully above the FOMC's 2.0% target on both an annual and annualised basis.

March is likely to see a material step up in headline inflation as the Middle East conflict shocks energy prices higher. Firms may also take the opportunity to push through additional increases to strengthen margins. All the while, capacity pressures continue to hold up price growth for services, and the weaker dollar and tariff costs support core goods pricing. Inflation risks will remain a lasting concern for the FOMC.

Domestic pressures persist; energy to jolt



Source: BLS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

What to watch

	For	Data/Event	Unit	Last	Market f/c	Westpac f/c	Risk/Comment
Mon 06							
US	Mar	ISM Services PMI	index	56.1	54.9	–	Confidence shock could arrest the upturn in services activity.
World		Easter Monday	–	–	–	–	Markets closed.
Tue 07							
Aus	Mar	MI Inflation Gauge	%ann	3.6	–	–	Will kick materially higher given the fuel price shock.
	Mar	ANZ–Indeed Job Ads	%mth	3.2	–	–	Labour demand is stabilising, but outlook is cloudy.
	Feb	Household Spending Indicator	%mth	0.3	0.2	–0.2	Card activity suggests momentum is pulling back in early-26.
NZ	Mar	ANZ Commodity Prices	%mth	4.2	–	–	Overall index up due to dairy prices, others mixed.
Jpn	Feb	Household Spending	%mth	–1.0	–1.3	–	Households on fragile footing, even before Middle East.
Eur	Apr	Sentix Investor Confidence	index	–3.1	–5.2	–	Global inflation and growth risks do not bode well for confidence.
US	Feb	Durable Goods Orders	%mth	0.0	–	–	Businesses may delay investment plans amid uncertainty.
	Mar	NY Fed 1-Yr Inflation Expectations	%ann	3.0	–	–	Surge in fuel prices will have a salient impact on expectations.
	Feb	Consumer Credit	$bn	8.1	–	–	On a firmer trend compared to this time last year.
		Fedspeak	–	–	–	–	Goolsbee.
World	Mar	S&P Global Services PMI	–	–	–	–	Final estimates for Eurozone and UK.
Wed 08							
NZ		RBNZ Policy Decision	%	2.25	2.25	2.25	Key focus will be the discussion of longer term risks.
Eur	Feb	PPI	%ann	–2.2	–	–	Producer price deflation may reverse over coming months.
	Feb	Retail Sales	%mth	–0.1	0.2	–	Choppy over recent months, but annual growth is lifting.
US		FOMC Meeting Minutes	–	–	–	–	Deliberations around conflict risks will be a key focus.
Thu 09							
US	Feb	Personal Income	%mth	0.4	–	–	Income growth continues to outpace inflation, allowing ...
	Feb	Personal Spending	%mth	0.4	–	–	... real consumption to maintain stable growth, but the war ...
	Feb	PCE Deflator	%mth	0.3	–	–	... poses a material risk to both these trends near-term.
		Initial Jobless Claims	000s	–	–	–	Still at a low level versus history.
	Q4	GDP	%ann'd	0.7	–	–	Final estimate closely watched given downward revisions.
Fri 10							
NZ	Mar	Manufacturing PMI	index	55	–	–	Watching for signs of easing as global pressures mount.
Chn	Mar	CPI	%ann	1.3	1.1	–	Temporary boost from Lunar New Year spend will abate ...
	Mar	PPI	%ann	–0.9	0.6	–	... overcapacity and subdued demand back in spotlight.
US	Mar	CPI	%mth	0.3	–	–	Authorities will be focused on second-round effects.
	Feb	Factory Orders	%mth	0.1	–	–	Conflict may put some investment plans on the back burner.
	Apr	Uni. Of Michigan Sentiment	index	53.3	–	–	Flailing sentiment puts consumer spending at risk.

Economic & financial forecasts

Interest rate forecasts

Australia	Latest (2 Apr)	Jun–26	Sep–26	Dec–26	Mar–27	Jun–27	Sep–27	Dec–27	Mar–28	Jun–28
Cash	4.10	4.60	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.60	4.35
90 Day BBSW	4.30	4.80	4.90	4.90	4.95	4.95	4.95	4.80	4.55	4.30
3 Year Swap	4.71	4.80	4.75	4.70	4.65	4.60	4.50	4.40	4.30	4.20
3 Year Bond	4.72	4.80	4.75	4.70	4.65	4.60	4.50	4.40	4.30	4.20
10 Year Bond	5.03	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.00	4.95	4.90	4.90
10 Year Spread to US (bps)	66	65	65	60	55	50	40	30	20	15
United States										
Fed Funds	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625
US 10 Year Bond	4.38	4.40	4.40	4.45	4.50	4.55	4.60	4.65	4.70	4.75
New Zealand										
Cash	2.25	2.25	2.25	2.50	3.00	3.50	3.75	4.00	4.25	4.25
90 Day Bill	2.51	2.45	2.50	2.90	3.40	3.75	4.00	4.25	4.45	4.45
2 Year Swap	3.43	3.60	3.85	4.10	4.30	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.35	4.30
10 Year Bond	4.72	4.80	4.95	4.95	5.05	5.10	5.10	5.10	5.10	5.10
10 Year Spread to US (bps)	34	50	60	55	60	60	55	50	45	40

Exchange rate forecasts

	Latest (2 Apr)	Jun–26	Sep–26	Dec–26	Mar–27	Jun–27	Sep–27	Dec–27	Mar–28	Jun–28
AUD/USD	0.6878	0.72	0.72	0.73	0.73	0.74	0.74	0.74	0.73	0.73
NZD/USD	0.5701	0.59	0.61	0.62	0.64	0.66	0.67	0.67	0.67	0.665
USD/JPY	159.35	156	155	154	152	150	148	146	144	142
EUR/USD	1.1536	1.17	1.18	1.19	1.20	1.21	1.22	1.22	1.22	1.22
GBP/USD	1.3236	1.35	1.36	1.37	1.38	1.39	1.40	1.41	1.41	1.41
USD/CNY	6.9099	6.85	6.80	6.70	6.60	6.50	6.45	6.40	6.35	6.35
AUD/NZD	1.2047	1.22	1.18	1.18	1.14	1.12	1.11	1.10	1.10	1.10

Australian economic forecasts

	2025		2026				2027		Calendar years			
% Change	**Q3**	**Q4**	**Q1f**	**Q2f**	**Q3f**	**Q4f**	**Q1f**	**Q2f**	**2025**	**2026f**	**2027f**	**2028f**
GDP %qtr	0.5	0.8	0.5	0.2	0.1	0.2	0.3	0.4	–	–	–	–
%yr end	2.1	2.6	2.6	1.9	1.6	1.0	0.9	1.1	2.6	1.0	1.6	2.8
Unemployment rate %	4.3	4.3	4.2	4.3	4.6	4.9	5.0	4.9	4.3	4.9	4.9	4.5
Wages (WPI) %qtr	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.7	0.8	–	–	–	–
%yr end	3.3	3.4	3.3	3.2	3.2	3.2	3.2	3.2	3.4	3.2	3.1	3.3
CPI Headline %qtr	1.3	0.6	1.5	1.9	0.9	0.3	0.5	0.6	–	–	–	–
%yr end	3.2	3.6	4.2	5.4	5.0	4.6	3.6	2.3	3.6	4.6	2.4	2.3
CPI Trimmed Mean %qtr	1.0	0.9	0.9	1.0	1.0	0.9	0.8	0.7	–	–	–	–
%yr end	3.0	3.4	3.5	3.9	4.0	4.0	3.8	3.5	3.4	4.0	3.0	2.4

New Zealand economic forecasts

	2025		2026				2027		Calendar years			
% Change	**Q3**	**Q4**	**Q1f**	**Q2f**	**Q3f**	**Q4f**	**Q1f**	**Q2f**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026f**	**2027f**
GDP %qtr	0.9	0.2	0.8	-0.4	0.5	1.0	1.4	0.8	–	–	–	–
Annual avg change	-0.6	0.2	0.6	1.2	1.3	1.5	1.9	2.4	-0.3	0.2	1.5	3.5
Unemployment rate %	5.3	5.4	5.4	5.6	5.6	5.4	5.1	4.9	5.1	5.4	5.4	4.6
CPI %qtr	1.0	0.6	0.8	1.6	1.0	0.4	0.3	0.1	–	–	–	–
Annual change	3.0	3.1	2.9	4.1	4.0	3.8	3.3	1.7	2.2	3.1	3.8	1.7

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

IQ

westpaciq.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author’s knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac’s Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac (“WNZL”). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

April

PNG ECONOMIC UPDATE

Monthly update on the PNG economy

CONTENTS

westpaciq.com.au

The PNG Economic Update report is produced by Westpac Economics (Australia and Fiji) with support from Westpac PNG.

Editor: Justin Smirk, Shamal Chand
Internet: www.westpac.com.au
Email: economics@westpac.com.au

This issue was finalised on 14 Apr

Non-resources keeps the economy running

A resilient outlook amid global uncertainty

Papua New Guinea entered 2026 with a comparatively resilient macro position despite heightened global volatility driven by Middle East conflict, energy market disruption and rising geopolitical fragmentation. Real GDP growth in 2025 was estimated at 5.3% by the Bank of Papua New Guinea (Westpac estimate 5.5%) and is expected to moderate in 2026 as activity normalises, with official and institutional forecasts clustering around 3–4%. Inflation remained contained at around 4%yr in the December quarter, supported by GST exemptions and easing non-fuel price pressures, although rising global fuel prices increased upside risks into mid-2026 and through the second half of the year.

Underlying economic momentum improved through February and March, supported by firm commodity prices, easing foreign exchange constraints and improving business sentiment, despite delays in major resource project decisions.

Resource Projects

Papua LNG, valued at around US$14 billion, remains in the Final Investment Decision window, although the time line has slipped beyond earlier expectations for early 2026. Developers are reported to be seeking an additional US$3 billion in concessions amid cost escalation, while the Government has maintained a target of 55% total state benefit under existing fiscal laws. A more optimistic outlook around the P'nyang gas project provides some confidence in the resources sector.

Macroeconomic tone strengthens

The World Bank, ADB and IMF alongside Westpac Pacific all upgraded PNG's outlook relative to earlier expectations, citing stronger mineral output, supportive gold and copper prices and improving macro-financial stability.

The World Bank's Public Finance Review noted that resource revenues averaged only 1.9% of GDP between 2013 and 2024, despite a doubling in production, while estimating that PNG requires additional public investment of around 4.5% of GDP annually in health, education and social protection to meet development goals.

Business confidence lifts

Business sentiment improved sharply. Results from the 2026 PNG CEO100 Survey showed:

- 72% of CEOs expect higher profits in 2026,
- Over 50% plan substantial increases in capital investment, and
- Foreign exchange availability fell from the top business constraint to 12th place.

Utilities reliability and infrastructure quality were among the few impediments reported to have worsened, underscoring capacity stress despite improving demand conditions.

Foreign exchange liquidity normalising

Foreign exchange conditions improved significantly. The Bank of PNG reported a reduction in the backlog of FX orders from around K1.8 billion to roughly K200 million, with outstanding orders now met on a daily or weekly basis, compared with a multi-month delay previously. Weekly FX auctions averaged around US$30 million, with oversubscription signalling still-strong demand but improved allocation efficiency.

The Kina depreciation continues. BPNG reaffirmed its crawling-peg approach, with further gradual depreciation expected through 2026 in the absence of major project inflows. Westpac projects a trough of USD 0.2150 by end-2026, before stabilisation as LNG-related capital inflows begin in 2027.

FATF grey listing

Papua New Guinea was formally placed on the FATF grey list in February 2026 following assessments identifying effectiveness gaps in AML/CTF supervision. The Government has committed to an 18-point action plan, including six legislative amendments, with a National Risk Assessment due by September 2026.

Authorities allocated K10 million to strengthen AML/CTF systems, while the US Treasury and other partners confirmed technical cooperation to accelerate removal. Commercial banks reported increased compliance costs and scrutiny but no systemic disruption to trade finance or domestic liquidity.

Key themes

Cyclone and humanitarian crisis

Severe Tropical Cyclone Maila dominated April, causing widespread destruction across Bougainville and parts of the New Guinea Islands. Fatalities were confirmed, over 100,000 people were affected, and major damage occurred to housing, roads, power and coastal communities. Emergency responses were mobilised, with Australia providing humanitarian assistance.

Fuel price shock

Fuel prices surged due to Middle East conflict–driven global oil disruptions. The government introduced a K1 billion stabilisation package, directed the ICCC to freeze prices at March levels, and warned suppliers against increases. Despite this, transport operators and businesses reported rising operating costs and ongoing logistics strain. Authorities highlighted exposure through transport, electricity generation and household living costs, reinforcing macro downside risks for the second half of 2026.

Law and order, elections and government reset

Law and order dominated the policy agenda. Parliament passed the Vagrancy Act 2025/26 with an 80–1 vote, granting courts powers to issue exclusion orders and reinforcing urban security ahead of major events including NRL matches from 2028 and APEC 2033. The Government allocated early funding for 2027 election preparations, with election costs projected to exceed K1 billion. Firearms amnesty and forced recovery operations are scheduled to run until August 2026.

Public-sector reform and delivery

Under the Reset@50 agenda, all departments were directed to submit Delivery & Outcomes Reports by 31 March 2026, tied to the MTDP IV. The Prime Minister ordered reviews of underperforming SOEs following repeated blackouts, water failures and infrastructure delays. A public-service census was initiated to address payroll integrity ahead of a 3% public-sector base salary increase implemented under the 2026 Budget. Prime Ministers (Amendment) Bill 2026 looking into improving Government efficiency was tabled in the Parliament recently.

Energy security and domestic fuel vulnerability

Treasury warned PNG would feel the full effect of Middle East energy disruptions by early April, with domestic fuel prices already rising in March. The Government invoked emergency powers under the Essential Services Act and signalled willingness to intervene via subsidies or structural market changes if global prices spike further. Five new energy regulations were launched in March to modernise electricity licensing, off-grid systems and appliance standards.

Infrastructure stress

Severe weather events caused repeated transport disruption. Floods destroyed the Aumea Bridge, landslides cut the Madang–Lae–Highlands Highway, and wet-season damage isolated multiple districts. While Connect PNG allocations exceed K1.7 billion for works in 2026, parliamentary inquiries revealed deficiencies in trust-fund compliance and project governance, amplifying execution risk.

Digitalisation prospects

PNG accelerated digital infrastructure reforms. LEO satellite permits, including Starlink testing, expanded broadband access. Digital national ID (SevisPass) progressed as a mandatory KYC tool, while financial sector innovation continued through digital superannuation platforms, green finance pilots and capital-market reforms aimed at reducing PNGX concentration risk.

Rising strategic relevance

PNG's geopolitical profile strengthened through deeper engagement with the US, Australia, Japan and the EU, spanning security cooperation, critical minerals, digital infrastructure and governance reform. PNG's selection as APEC 2033 host reinforced its long-term strategic positioning, raising both opportunity and accountability expectations.

Labour markets, migration and human capital constraints

Skills mismatches are becoming more binding as non-resource growth of about 4% lifts labour demand, while public-sector capacity came under scrutiny through a national workforce census targeting payroll integrity and performance ahead of July 2026 pay adjustments. Migration frictions increased after PNG was added to the US visa bond list, requiring a US$15,000 bond from April.

Interest Rates

- The Bank of Papua New Guinea maintained a neutral monetary policy stance at its March 2026 meeting, keeping the Kina Facility Rate at 5.0% and the Cash Reserve Requirement at 9.0%. Headline inflation remained contained at around 4%, with core inflation trending lower, supported by GST exemptions and easing non-fuel price pressures.
- The MPC reaffirmed the exchange rate as the key nominal anchor, continuing the crawl-like adjustment of the kina to address remaining foreign-exchange imbalances. FX backlog has reduced sharply, from around K1.8 billion at its peak to roughly K200 million, according to the Bank of Papua New Guinea. Outstanding import and dividend orders are now being met daily or weekly, rather than over several months previously.
- The Bank flagged upside inflation risks from global fuel prices and ongoing Middle Eastern crisis, while judging current policy settings as appropriate to balance price stability and growth amid heightened global uncertainty.
- Fixed Rate Full Allotment 7–day C–Bill remains pegged to the KFR at 5.00%
- March 2026 saw a rebound in the 365–day Treasury bill yield, 5.56% in 20th February 2026 to 5.63% by 20th March 2026.
- March 2026 saw yield increases as market participants had bid the rates higher.
- The last Government Bond Auction was held on the 17th March 2026. Auctions were undertaken in the 3–15 year buckets - were comfortably oversubscribed.
- Total bids reached K280.5 million, exceeding the offer by K80.5 million (40%), with successful allotments totaling K200.45 million across five maturities.
- Demand was strongest in the 5-year, 7-year and 10-year tenors, reflecting investor preference for medium- to long-dated paper.
- Weighted average yields rose steadily along the curve:
    - 3-year: 6.48%
    - 5-year: 6.80%
    - 7-year: 6.95%
    - 10-year: 7.14%
    - 15-year: 7.48%

Foreign Exchange

- The gradual, crawling peg depreciation of the PGK continues, with February and March 2026 seeing PGKUSD fall from 0.2337 to 0.2317 on the 26th March 2026.
- Total FX Market turnover increased by PGK474.7m to PGK 6.1bn in February 2026, from PGK 5.625bn in January 2026 reflecting more FX liquidity in the PNG Market.
- There is still no guidance on the target rate of the depreciation or on where BPNG views the rate aligned to fundamentals.
- PGK/AUD remained rangebound throughout February to March 15th 2026. Breaking previous highs, AUD/USD peaked at 0.7151 during the month of February to March 15th 2026.
- The PGK/AUD dropped significantly, reflecting a high of 0.3249 and a low of 0.3127.
- PGK/AUD had a range of 122 basis points reflecting a volatile AUD/USD exchange rate. This reflects a weakening US Dollar amid global tension and market uncertainty.
- Weekly FX auctions continue, typically around US$30 million per auction, with consistent oversubscription. This indicates strong demand, but improved allocation efficiency compared with 2023–24.

Government Bond Auction

Series	Amount on offer	Bid recieved	Successful bids	Successful yields	Weighted average rate	Coupon Rate	Overall Auction
	K'million	K'million	K'million				
Issue ID 2026/5256 (3 Years)	30.00	33.35	23.45	5.75% - 6.57%	6.48%	5.75%	3.45
Issue ID 2026/5257 (5 Years)	40.00	65.00	55.00	6.58% – 6.89%	6.80%	6.00%	25.00
Issue ID 2026/5258 (7 Years)	50.00	68.00	68.00	6.25% - 7.11%	6.95%	6.25%	18.00
Issue ID 2026/5259 (10 Years)	50.00	72.00	42.00	7.05% - 7.23%	7.14%	6.50%	22.00
Issue ID 2026/5260 (15 Years)	30.00	42.00	12.00	7.46% - 7.55%	7.48%	6.75%	12.00
TOTAL	200.000	280.450	200.450				80.450

Auction Number:17-MAR-26 /GOB/ Government Bond; Settlement Date: 20-MAR-26; Amount on Offer: K200.000 million

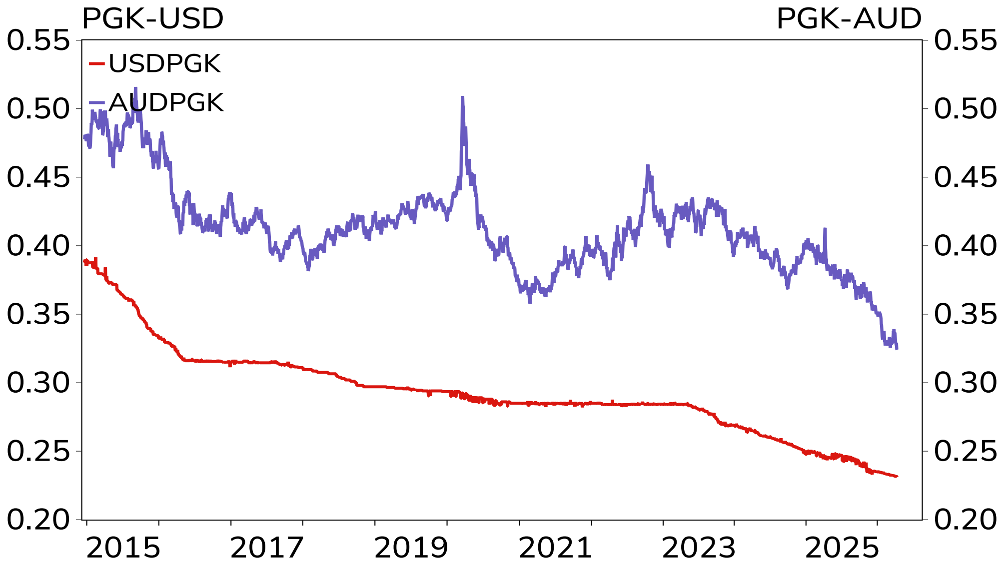
Government Treasury Auctions

Terms	Issue ID 2025	Issue ID 2025	Issue ID 2025/4516	Issue ID 2025/4517	Issue ID 2025/4518	Total
	63	91	182	273	364	
Weighted Average Yield	0.000	0.00%	5.41%	5.58%	5.59%	
Amount on offer Kina Million	0.000	0.000	10.000	60.000	217.000	K287.000
Bids Received Kina Million	0.00	0.000	37.530	177.100	493.780	K708.410
Successful Bids Kina Million	0.00	0.000	20.530	50.000	312.780	K383.310
Overall Auction OVER- SUBSCRIBED	0.00	0.000	27.530	117.100	276.780	K421.410

Auction Number: 08-APR-26 / GOI/ Government Treasury Bill; Settlement Date: 10-APR-26; Amount on Offer: K287 million

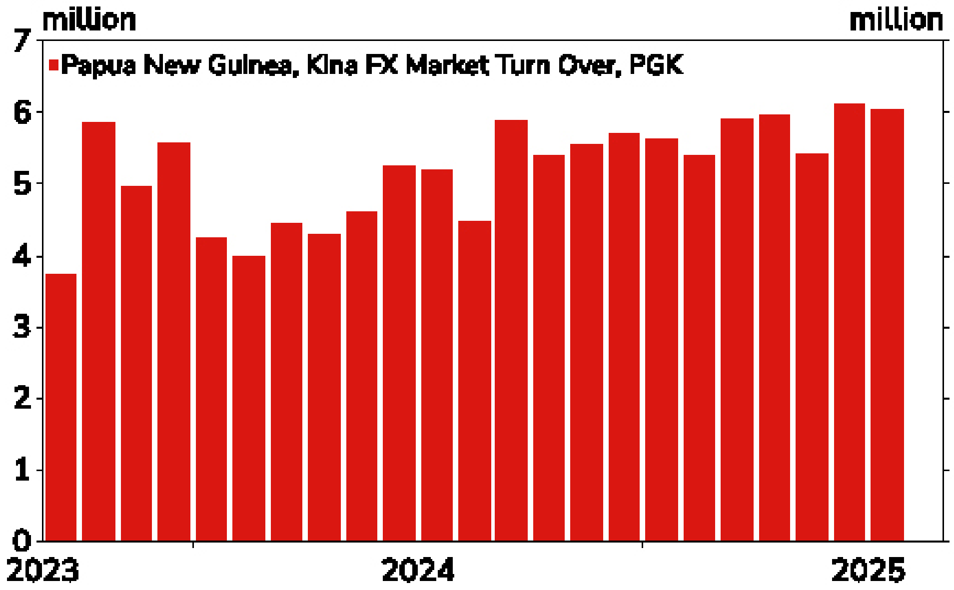
Gradual kina depreciation continues

Kina Foreign Exchange Rate



Source: , Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Foreign Exchange Market Turnover



Source: Bank PNG, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

"PNG/AUD weakened through December to find some stabilty through March as AUD softened."

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given above are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The results ultimately achieved may differ substantially from these forecasts.

PNG and Middle Eastern Conflict

The escalation of the Middle Eastern conflict since late February 2026 triggered a severe global energy shock. While PNG is a major LNG exporter, the domestic economy remains highly exposed to global fuel price volatility due to its continued reliance on imported refined petroleum products, limited domestic fuel storage capacity and weak, short term shock absorption buffers.

Westpac assumes that the Strait of Hormuz remains closed until the end of April, a total of eight weeks, and takes longer to reopen fully. This compares with our earlier assumption of a one-month disruption followed by a relatively rapid normalisation.

The slower recovery reflects limited shipping traffic through the Strait, insurance premiums remain elevated given the risk of further attacks by regional factions while shipping companies require time to re-establish vessel rotations and contractual arrangements.

We now assume traffic through the Strait reaches only 20% of normal levels in May. Traffic is expected to continue to improve thereafter, although capacity is not expected to return to normal until end 2026.

A longer Middle East disruption lifts peak prices for oil and gas, lengthens recovery. Infrastructure damage exacerbates the shock. Brent oil is expected to peak at an average of US$120/bbl in Q2 and Japanese LNG prices at US$26mmbtu.

A prolonged three month disruption would see oil average closer to US$130/bbl, LNG remain above US$20/mmbtu, and global growth reduced by about 0.5 percentage points.

Despite being a net exporter of energy, PNG imports most of its refined fuels, mainly from Singapore, which relies heavily on Middle Eastern crude. Refined petroleum imports totalled about US$886 million in 2024, equivalent to roughly 16% of total merchandise imports.

Westpac's baseline implies significant spillovers. A 10% increase in fuel prices would add roughly US$90 million to annual import costs, widening the trade deficit and intensifying foreign exchange pressures.

PNG's fuel insecurity magnifies these risks. The Napa Napa refinery, with a capacity of around 32,000bbl/day, has been largely non operational due to cost, margin and operational constraints, leaving PNG reliant on imported fuels. Inventories are thin, covering around just 2–3 weeks of demand. In early March, some regions reported 2–5 days of cover forcing emergency imports and state of emergency style measures prioritising fuel for essential services. PNG is among the most fuel vulnerable economies in the Pacific.

Headline inflation was 4.1% in Q4 but under the baseline scenario, higher fuel, freight and electricity costs will push inflation higher from April 2026, even if global prices ease later in the year. Transport intensive sectors such as food distribution, construction, manufacturing and mining will bear the brunt.

For mining, particularly open pit gold and copper mines, rising diesel costs are partially offset by gains in robust commodity prices. While gold may have surged through US$5,00/oz, it has since eased with operators flagging margin pressure from fuel driven cost inflation.

In 2025 PNG growth was a robust 5.5% supported by LNG, mining and agriculture. For 2026, growth is set to moderate to 4.6% as higher energy costs, global uncertainty and delayed investment decisions weigh on activity. Large projects remain sensitive to elevated construction costs and tighter global financial conditions. Further delays weaken medium term growth prospects and foreign exchange inflows.

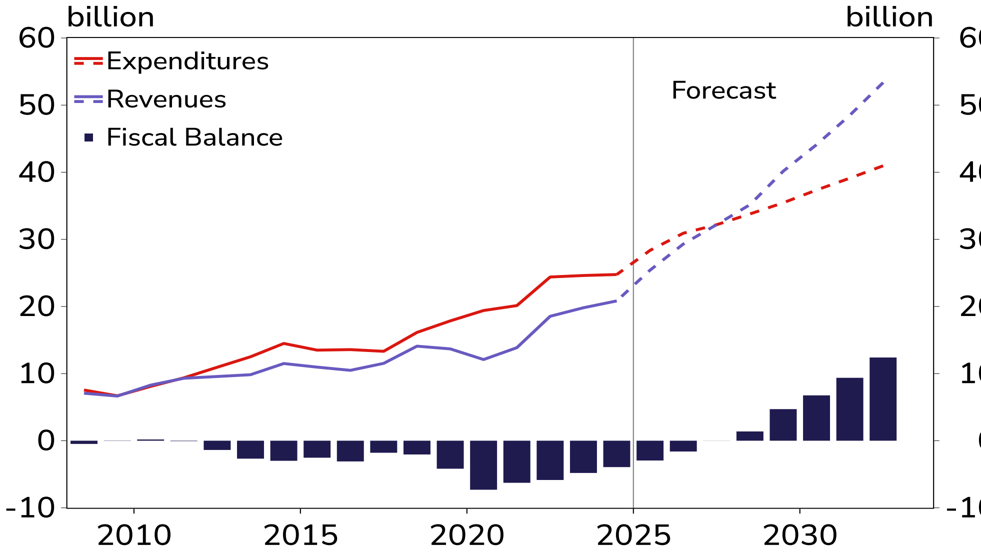
The K30.9 billion 2026 Budget targets a near balance but is exposed to downside risks. Resource revenues averaged only about 1.9% of GDP between 2013 and 2024, limiting their value as shock absorbers. The World Bank's estimate that PNG requires an additional 4.5% of GDP annually in social and human capital spending underscores the limited scope to absorb external shocks.

While three new fuel storage projects are planned, including a US funded 264ml facility near Port Moresby, they are unlikely to be operational until around 2030. PNG remains reliant on emergency shipments and ad-hoc policy responses, leaving the economy highly exposed even under our current scenario.

Fiscal Consolidation Path Intact

- The 2026 Papua New Guinea National Budget, themed "Security with Growth", puts forward a record expenditure number and aims to further consolidate fiscal repair plan while heavily directing funding towards key economic and social sectors. The total expenditure for fiscal year 2026 is projected at K30.9 billion with the estimated revenues at K29.3 billion.
- The central focus of the budget remains the continuation of the 13-Year Budget Repair Plan, with the government aiming to achieve a small budget surplus by 2027. PNG Government claims it is 88% of the way down the path toward achieving the surplus.
- The budget deficit is projected to fall substantially to just 1.1% of GDP in 2026, down sharply from 8.9% in 2020, demonstrating significant progress toward fiscal recovery. Revenues are projected to increase by 15.3%, outstripping the estimated 9.0% growth in expenditure, aligning with responsible budget repair efforts. Total domestic revenues are expected to reach 18.8% of GDP.
- Due to strong fiscal discipline, debt growth is slower than economic growth, leading the debt to GDP ratio to fall from estimated 48.4% in 2025 to the projected 45.5% in 2026 fiscal year.
- To mitigate temporary fiscal imbalances and reinforce the consolidation drive, PNG Government is also amending the Papua New Guinea Fiscal Responsibility Act 2006 to reduce the interim debt ceiling from 55% down to 52.5% of GDP for a period of five years.
- The National Budget also introduces Bill that details mechanisms allowing the Minister for Treasury to direct the reallocation of unspent funds or funds from the "Contingency Fund" to cover shortfalls in other activities.
- In order improve cash flow management, the budget proposed amendments to the Central Banking Act which details mechanism for the Bank of PNG to provide Treasury and Finance with weekly data on the closing balances of all Government accounts.
- The Budget further tries to strengthen tax administration by establishing at the Internal Revenue Commission the formal IRC Board that will be responsible to oversee revenue performance, strategic directions and budget approvals.

Budget Surplus target from 2027



Source: Bank of Papua New Guinea, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

"...PNG Government targets budget surplus from 2027...debt ceiling lowered to 52.5% from 55%..."

Key sectoral allocation

The 2026 National Budget, themed "Security with Growth", allocates K30.3 billion in total expenditure, with K19.4 billion (64.1%) for operational costs and K10.9 billion (35.9%) for capital investment. The budget prioritizes education, health, law and justice, infrastructure, and provincial development.

Education Sector – K4,935.2 million (16.3%)

Education receives the largest share, reflecting the Government's commitment to universal access and quality learning. Operational spending of K4,325.7m includes K2,532.1m for teacher salaries, K904.5m for Tuition Fee Subsidy, and K103.9m for TESAS scholarships. Capital investment of K609.5m supports higher education programs, TVET, and infrastructure upgrades.

Provinces – K4,720.9 million (15.6%)

Funding for subnational service delivery through District Support Improvement Program (DSIP) and Provincial Support Improvement Program (PSIP). Includes K1,854m for GoPNG capital projects.

Administration – K4,609.5 million (15.2%)

Covers revenue collection agencies (IRC, Customs), governance reforms, and flagship programs like District Infrastructure Program (K480m) and Kina-for-Kina Project (K400m). Capital allocation of K3,011.1m supports digital governance and infrastructure.

Health Sector – K3,204.9 million (10.6%)

Operational allocation of K2,346.8m funds medical supplies (K264.6m), public health commodities (K84.9m), and Provincial Health Authorities. Capital allocation of K858.1m supports hospital development, cancer treatment facilities, and the new Medical University.

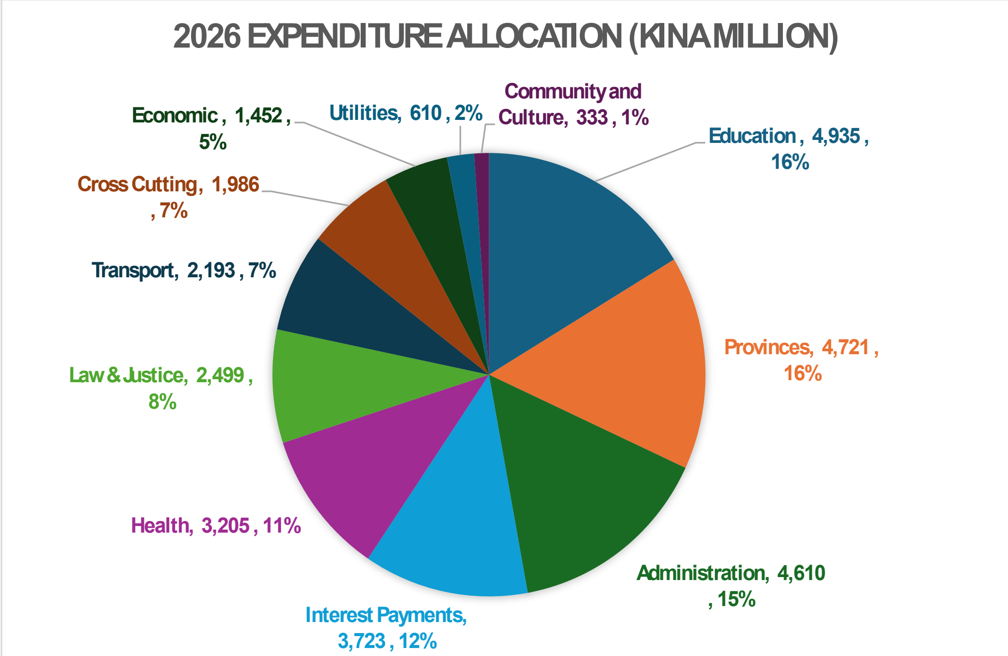
Law & Justice – K2,498.6 million (8.3%)

Increased funding for police recruitment, judicial reforms, and correctional services. Capital allocation of K468m targets infrastructure upgrades for courts, prisons, and security facilities.

Transport – K2,193.1 million (7.2%)

Focused on Connect PNG infrastructure projects, including roads, bridges, and aviation facilities. Includes K1,191m GoPNG funding and K842m from grants and loans.

Other sectors include Economic (K1,452.1m), Utilities (K609.5m), Community & Culture (K332.9m), and Cross-Cutting programs (K1,985.5m) for rentals, utilities, and arrears clearance.



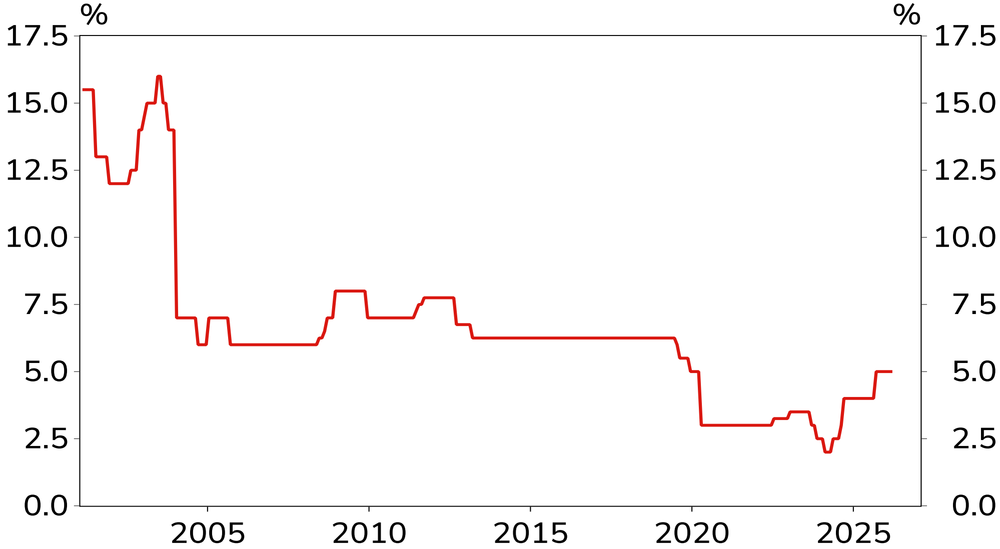
"...education receives the highest budget allocation at K5 billion"

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given above are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The results ultimately achieved may differ substantially from these forecasts.

March BPNG rate unchanged

- The Bank of Papua New Guinea's Monetary Policy Committee at its March 2026 meeting decided to maintain a broadly neutral policy stance, keeping the Kina Facility Rate at 5.0% and the Cash Reserve Requirement at 9.0%. The Committee judged current settings as appropriate to support non-mineral sector activity while preserving macroeconomic stability amid ongoing foreign exchange constraints and global uncertainty.
- Global growth remains resilient and inflation pressures have eased, but escalation of the Middle East conflict has heightened risks through higher energy prices, shipping costs and imported inflation. Domestically, growth remains moderate, supported by mineral output with the Porgera mine operating close to full capacity, while non-mineral sector growth remains subdued. GDP growth is expected to moderate to around 3.0% in 2026.
- The Committee noted that GST relief is temporary and cautioned that further Kina depreciation could lift inflation pressures through 2026.
- The exchange rate remains the primary nominal anchor for monetary policy given weak interest rate transmission and high import dependence. The MPC reaffirmed continuation of the crawl-like exchange rate arrangement, noting that despite recent adjustments, the Kina remains overvalued relative to its estimated equilibrium, with a continued backlog of foreign exchange orders. Further gradual adjustment is considered necessary to restore market clearing, reduce intervention reliance and progress toward full convertibility, while safeguarding reserves.
- All members supported maintaining central bank liquidity operations, including continued issuance of 7-day and 28-day central bank bills, FX auctions, and repo and reverse repo margins at 2.0 percentage points around the policy rate.
- Voting decisions showed one dissent. Four members voted to maintain the KFR at 5.0% and CRR at 9.0%. Professor David Kavanamur dissented, voting for a rate cut to 3.0%, a reduction in the CRR to 8.0% and a slower pace of exchange rate depreciation, citing low core inflation, fiscal consolidation's deflationary impact and delayed supply-side responses. Mr Dairi Vele supported holding rates but argued that further Kina depreciation should be paused, emphasising improved balance of payments prospects and increased FX interventions.

Kina Facility Rate



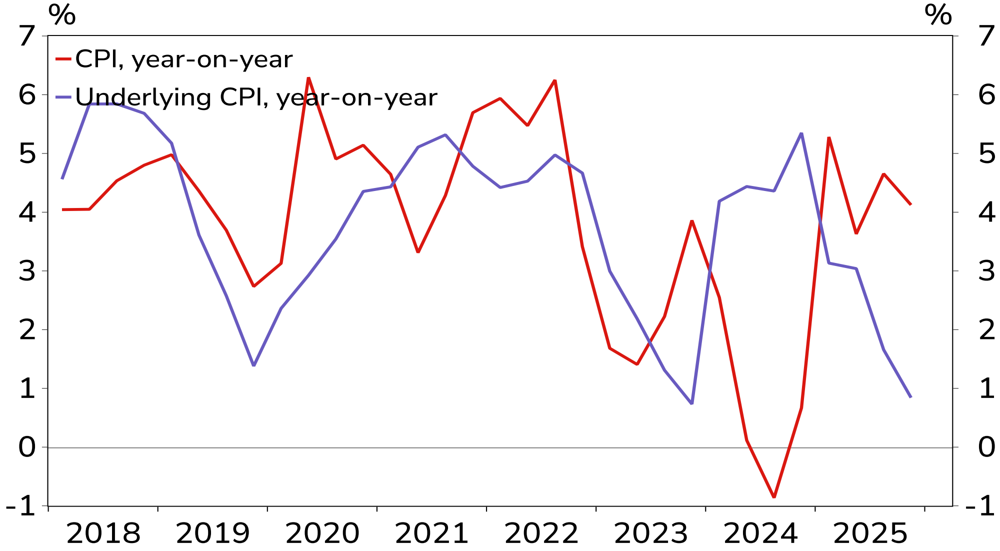
Source: Bank of Papua New Guinea, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

"...The Committee also discussed medium-term reforms, including a potential shift to a trade-weighted currency basket"

2025 inflation update

- PNG's headline CPI rose 4.1%yr in the December 2025 quarter, easing from 4.7%yr in the September quarter, driven by a 0.7%yr increase in Food & Non-Alcoholic Beverages, a still elevated 21.8%yr rise in Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco & Betel Nut, and a 2.2%yr increase in Transport.
- Apart from these main drivers, consumer prices rose across all other broad items in the December quarter.
  - Clothing & Footwear +1.6%yr
  - Health +3.3%yr
  - Restaurant & Hotels +2.6%yr
  - Education +1.7%yr
  - Communication +0.7%yr
  - Housing +2.3%yr
- Underlying inflation eased sharply to 0.8%yr in December 2025, down from 1.7%yr in September. Underlying inflation is now noticeably below.
- Headline inflation excluding seasonal items rose 0.8%yr in December 2025, while excluding seasonal items and customs excise rose 1.0%yr, and excluding seasonal, customs excise and price controlled items rose 0.7%yr.
- Betel nut prices remain the largest single source of volatility. Although moderating from their September spike, betel nut prices still rose 29.0%yr and 21.9%qrt in Q4 and continue to heavily influence headline inflation.
- Food & Non-Alcoholic Beverages increased 0.7%yr, though the category fell modestly –0.27% in the quarter, helping moderate the broader inflation impulse. As in Q3, food sub-components remained mixed with several staples continued to ease while some dairy and fresh produce lines recorded small increases.
- Transport rose 0.6%qtr in Q4. Fuel items remained higher (diesel, petrol and lubricants all modestly up), and motor vehicle increased slightly. Airfares also edged higher, consistent with ongoing domestic aviation disruptions. With aircraft grounding and capacity constraints persisting at Jacksons Airport and other key routes, pressure on airfares and freight costs remains a near-term inflation risk for transport and perishable food supply chains.

Core inflation falls to 2-year low at 2025-end



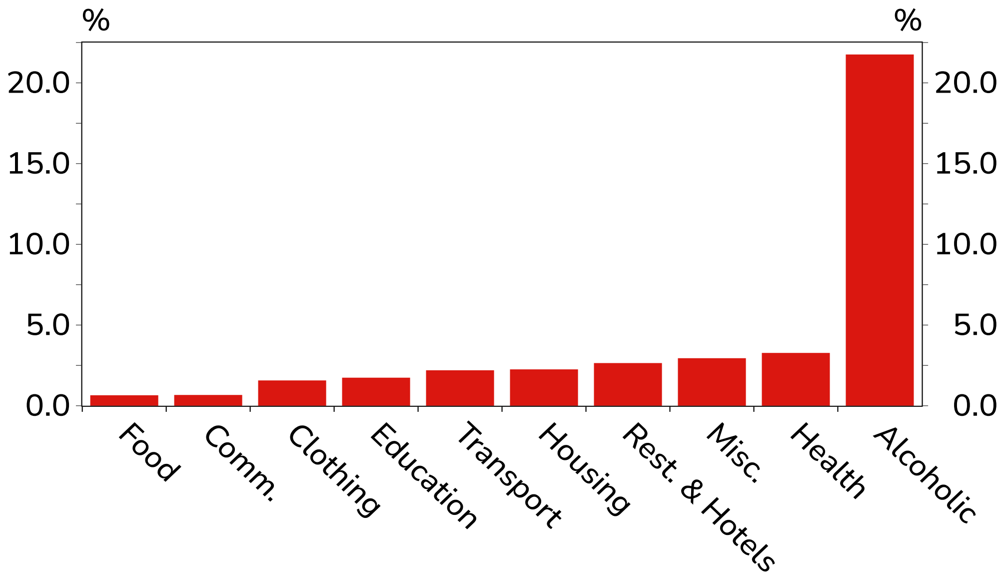
Source: NSO, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

"...Betel Nut a key driver for surge in headline inflation as underlying inflation register lower"

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given above are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The results ultimately achieved may differ substantially from these forecasts.

Highlands and Islands inflation up

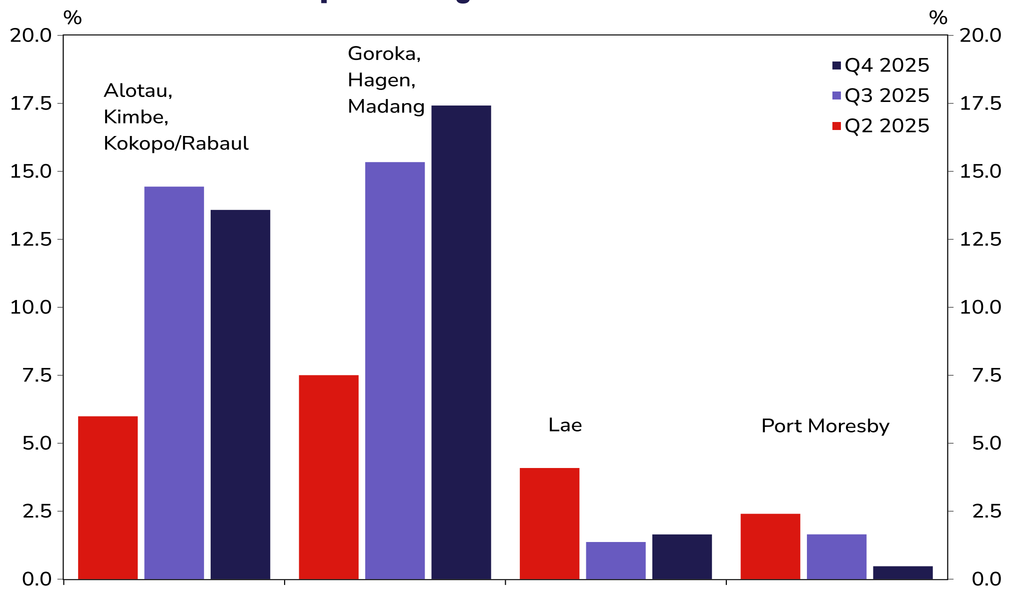
PNG's inflation categories in Q4 2025



Source: NSO, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

"... Betel nut prices remain the largest single source of volatility, pushing up the Alcoholic, Beverages and Narcotics component"

Headline inflation in respective regions



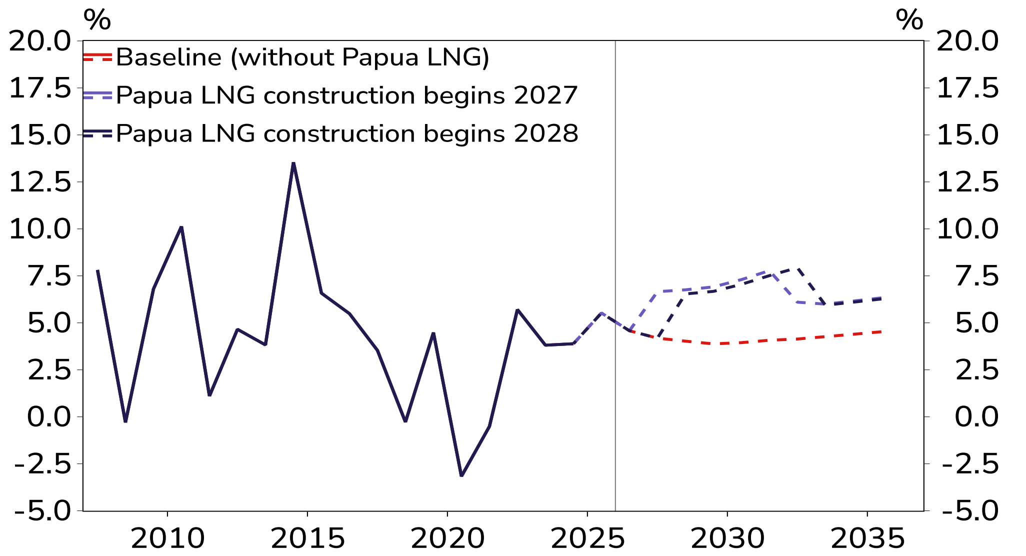
Source: NSO, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

"...double digit inflation in Alotau, Kimbe, Kikipo/Rabaul, Goroka, Hagen and Madang"

PNG's growth holds despite project delays

- Papua New Guinea's moved through last year with a sense of cautious steadiness rather than any dramatic turning point As such, we upgraded our 2025 growth estimate to 5.5% from our earlier 4.7%, with strong performance in mining, industries and services sectors.
- PNG's medium-term outlook is characterised by a stable baseline growth profile, with the prospect of a significant uplift once the Papua LNG project enters construction and production. However, repeated delays to the Final Investment Decision, initially expected in 2018 and now anticipated in the second half of 2026, continue to complicate near-term forecasts.
- Under our baseline scenario, assuming no Papua LNG FID within the forecast horizon, real GDP growth remains solid but moderates gradually. We forecast growth of 4.6% in 2026, easing to 4.2% in 2027 and 4.0% in 2028, before stabilising around 3.9–4.1% in the longer term. Sectoral dynamics are steady: primary sector growth slows as agriculture plateaus and mining stabilises near 1.4–1.6%, industry expands by 4.2–4.6%, with services the strongest driver, lifting from 5.6% in 2026 to around 6.5% by 2035. This trajectory assumes continued normalisation following earlier shocks and no major new projects altering aggregate growth.
- Papua LNG is modelled as a two-phase overlay on this baseline. The construction phase assumes US$14 billion in capital expenditure spread evenly over five years, equivalent to an effective ~10% demand uplift relative to PNG's 2024 nominal GDP. Construction generates a substantial growth surge, lifting real GDP growth by +2.5 to +3.4 percentage points, with growth peaking at around 7.3% during peak construction years.
- The production phase, assumed to commence around 2032, delivers a smaller but persistent uplift. With output of 5.6 Mtpa and estimated revenues of US$2.7 billion per year, mining growth lifts by around +6–7 percentage points, raising economy-wide growth by +1.6 to +2.0 percentage points on a sustained basis.

PNG Growth Outlook

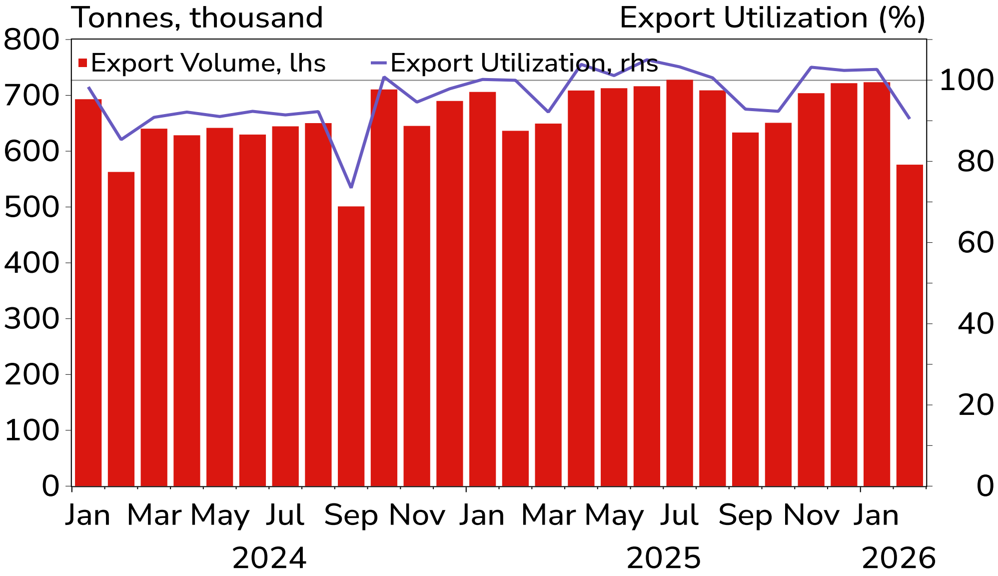


Source: NSO, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

"Even allowing for further delays, Papua LNG remains the single most consequential driver of PNG's growth outlook over the coming decade."

PNG LNG export to rise

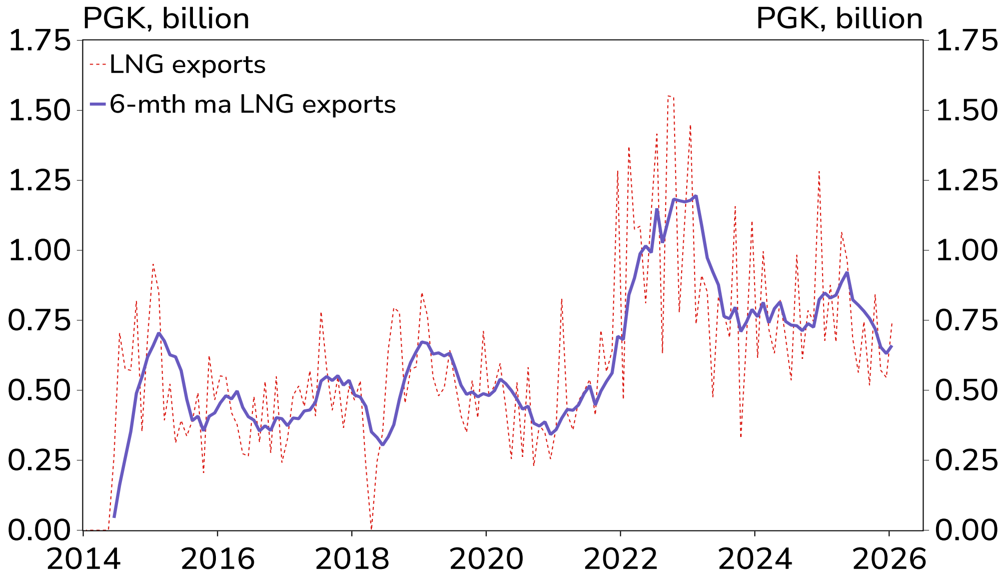
PNG LNG Export



Source: Bloomberg, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

"...PNG LNG export utilization at 114% in March 2026, as output ramps up amidst Middle Eastern Crisis"

PNG's LNG export to Japan



Source: MOF, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

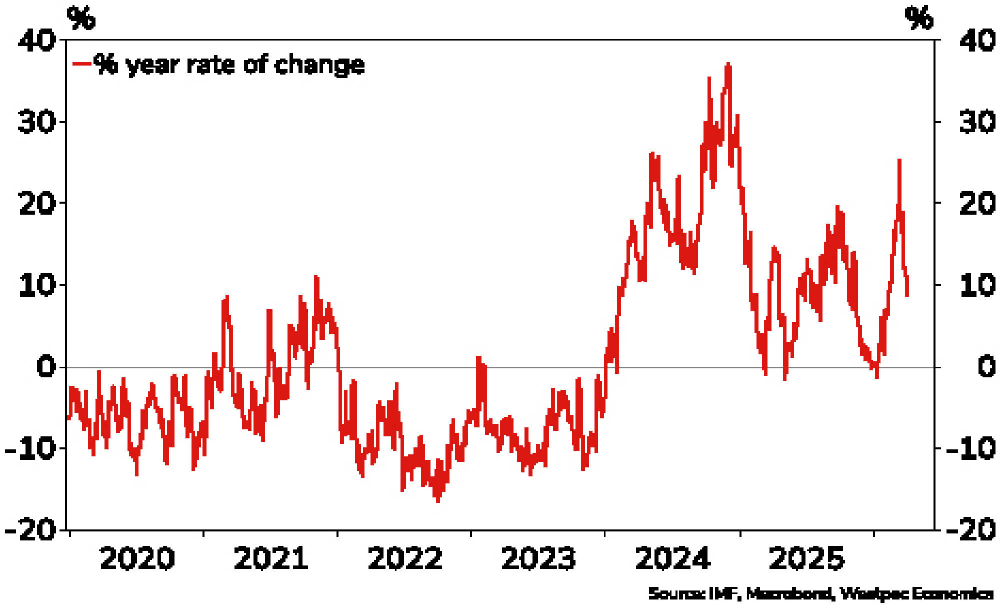
"...LNG exports to Japan rose 9% in January 2026 with more uplift in revenue expected"

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given above are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The results ultimately achieved may differ substantially from these forecasts.

Signs of strength in import activity

- Westpac has developed a proprietary index tracking import activity at PNG ports, known as the PNG Ports Imports Indicator.
- While the data can be volatile and subject to revision as updates are received, when used judiciously, it provides a timely signal of import momentum and, by extension, domestic economic activity.
- The latest update from the Indicator suggests the strength in import activity has strengthed through early 2026 up to mid March since when we have seen a moderation which could be related to shipping disruptions associated with the conflict in the Middle East.
- Annual growth in the Port Imports Indicator peaked at 2% around mid July before easing back to just under 10% in September. As we moved through 2026 the annual pace pick up again peaking at around 25%yr in mid March before easing back to just under 10%yr in early April.
- We are always cautious about drawing firm conclusions from a single indicator such as this. Nevertheless, the consistent gains throughout 2025 and into 2026 until the recent Middle East crisis pointed to a positive underlying momentum in the PNG economy.
- **Why do we track imports?** The PNG domestic economy continues to grow at just under 5%, a sound pace but less than what is needed to lift more out of poverty.
- The anticipated Final Investment Decisions (FID) for several large resource projects will provide a significant boost. While these projects can deliver multi-decade benefits, they do not drive permanent positive change on their own. Additional measures are required to ensure inclusive and sustained growth. These include:
  - Improving domestic physical infrastructure.
  - Building human capital through better health, education, and training.
  - Reforming State Owned Enterprises to enhance service delivery.
  - Strengthening government services.

PNG Imports Indicator



"...strength in imports continued as 2026 started..."

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given above are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The results ultimately achieved may differ substantially from these forecasts.

Cocoa at its lowest since early 2023

Cocoa

Cocoa prices have been under pressure as markets focus on improving supply conditions and frequent rain in West Africa supporting pod development and rising stockpiles, with ICE-monitored certified stocks lifting to around a 7.5-month high (2.34m bags) by late March.

Demand has also softened with Barry Callebaut, a Swiss-based global cocoa and chocolate company reported a 22% decline in cocoa division sales volumes (quarter to Nov 30), while grindings fell 8.3% y/y in Europe in Q4, with weaker outcomes also reported in Asia. This indicates that consumers have become quite resist to high chocolate prices.

Cocoa remains economically important, particularly in Bougainville, which reported K750m in cocoa revenue and assumed full control over its cocoa export system. Supply resilience efforts are also emerging, including the launch of a cocoa seed bank in Madang.

Softer cocoa prices are a downside risk for rural incomes and export receipts.

Coffee

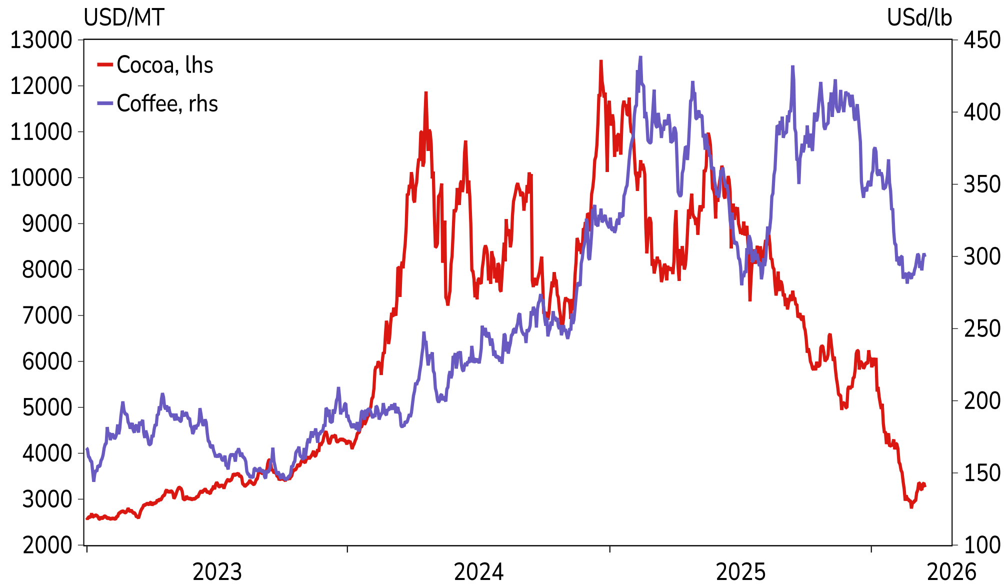
Global coffee prices have been choppy but recently firmer due to near-term supply tightness in Brazil and logistics risk, even as the medium-term supply outlook looks more comfortable.

Brazil's Cooxupé expects exports to fall 10% in 2026 to around 4.4m bags (from 4.9m in 2025) because the smaller 2025 harvest is constraining export availability early in 2026, while some growers are holding back sales.

Offsetting this, expectations of a large Brazil crop and rising inventories have been a recurring bearish force, and Vietnam's export performance is also adding to supply availability. Demand risks remain tied to higher delivered costs from shipping, fuel and insurance when global logistics are disrupted.

PNG recorded a record 1.5 million coffee bags exported in 2025 (highest since the 1980s), improving rural cashflow and FX inflows

Cocoa and Coffee



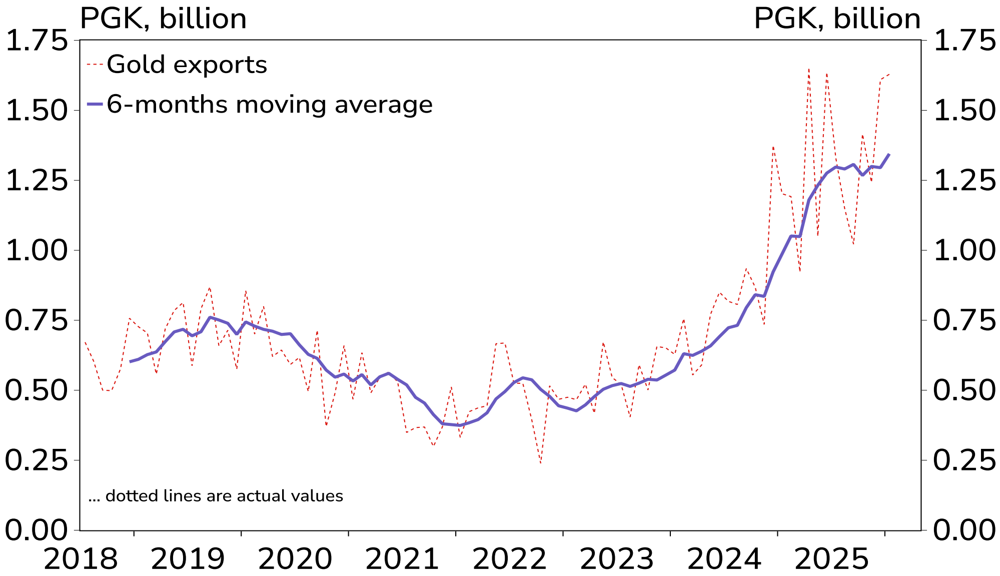
Source: Bloomberg, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

"...subdued global prices threatens PNG's cocoa sector which thrived in 2024-25 period..."

Gold export rally supports PNG economy

- Gold production momentum strengthened across several key operations. K92 Mining's Kainantu mine continues to stand out as a top-tier performer. The company reported 174,134 ounces of gold-equivalent production in 2025, exceeding guidance, and issued 2026 guidance of up to 225,000 ounces as the Stage 3 expansion ramps up. Over calendar 2025, K92 contributed approximately K423 million in corporate taxes, alongside significant royalties, levies and local procurement, cementing its importance to both fiscal and FX inflows.
- At Porgera, New Porgera Limited exceeded expectations in 2025, producing 376,057 ounces of gold and paying K985.8 million in taxes, while declaring around US$400 million (≈K1.7 billion) in dividends, with 51% accruing to PNG interests. Porgera is on track to move back toward Tier-1 status, with production capacity expected to rise further by 2027.
- Elsewhere, Simberi (St Barbara) reported a return to profitability, supported by expanded resources of nearly 7.9 million ounces, while Adyton Resources and Great Pacific Gold reported encouraging exploration outcomes, pointing to a strengthening pipeline of future output.
- Gold export values to Australia surged into early 2026. In January 2026, PNG's gold exports to Australia totaled approximately PGK 1.63 billion, up from PGK 1.61 billion in December 2025 and significantly higher than the PGK 0.63–0.94 billion range seen through much of early 2024.
- Over 2025, monthly gold exports to Australia were consistently above PGK 1.0 billion, peaking near PGK 1.65 billion, reflecting higher prices rather than large volume swings.
- This export strength has materially supported foreign exchange liquidity, helping reduce the FX backlog from around K1.8 billion to near K200 million, according to Bank of PNG assessments. Gold receipts have also cushioned the kina under the crawling-peg regime and partially offset higher fuel import costs.

Gold exports to Australia K1.6bn in January



Source: DFAT, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

"...the rally in 2025 is largely attributed to elevated global gold prices driven by economic uncertainty and inflationary pressures ..."

Gold consolidation before retesting $5,000

- Gold has been under pressure over recent weeks as markets focused on the inflationary implications of higher oil prices and the prospect that central banks may need to keep policy tighter for longer.
  A rapid rise in US real yields alongside renewed USD strength weighed on bullion, prompting a notable retracement from the all-time high reached in late January.

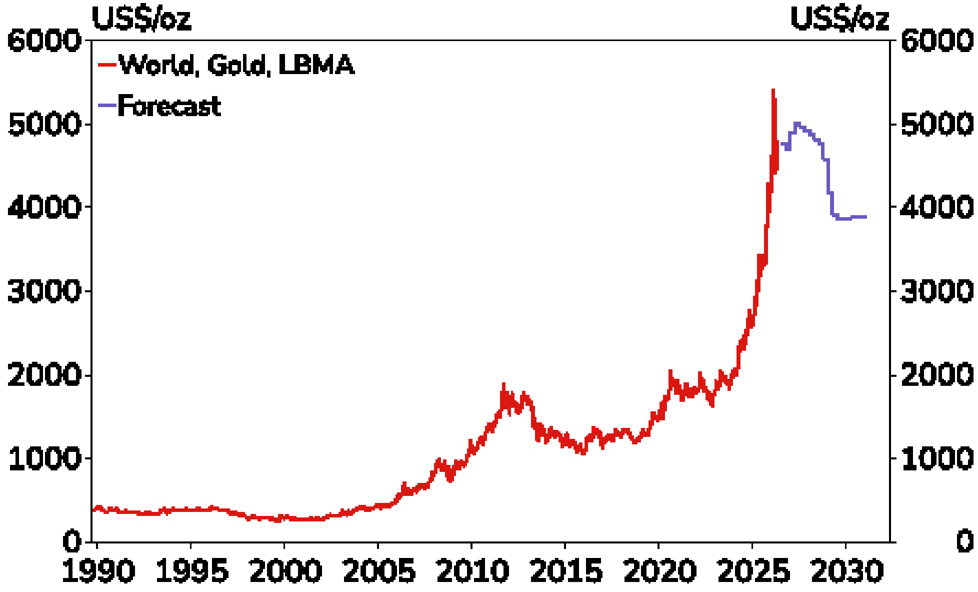
- Consolidation to persist over coming weeks, but recent pullbacks may been seen as opportunities to re-engage. Gold has already corrected and speculative positioning has been flushed out. We are looking for a period of range-trading in which volatility subsiding should allow a base to form. This environment is likely to encourage longer-term investors to rebuild positions.

- Geopolitical risks tend to have an uneven and often short-lived impact on gold with near-term safe-haven rallies typically fading as markets adjust. More durable support for gold usually comes via second-round effects: shifts in the growth–inflation mix, policy responses and a strengthening of strategic demand as investors look to diversify. If geopolitical disruptions persist and energy prices remain elevated, the combination of higher inflation and weaker growth, with the associated risk of renewed fiscal and monetary stimulus, would present upside risks for0 gold. Persistent geopolitical uncertainty also continues to underpin strategic demand from institutional, official-sector and retail investors.

- Concerns about central-bank gold selling have resurfaced, particularly following recent price weakness and headlines around Turkey. While some central banks may sell modest amounts of gold at times, we see little evidence of a structural shift away from gold accumulation. We continue to expect official-sector net purchases to slow only gradually, broadly in line with recent trends. Temporary monthly selling episodes are not uncommon and often reflect idiosyncratic factors rather than a change in strategic intent.

- Headline risks remain as markets continuously re-price geopolitical and macro developments. Nevertheless, speculative positioning is cleaner, long-term investors remain under-invested, and diversification demand is rising. We continue to expect new highs in gold over time.

Gold is consolidating



Source: LBMA, FTSE Russell, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

“Geopolitical and market risks remain elevated.... against this backdrop, we expect gold to retest US$5,000/oz in early 2027...”

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given above are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The results ultimately achieved may differ substantially from these forecasts.

Financial forecasts

Interest rate forecasts

Australia	Latest (10 Apr)	Jun-26	Sep-26	Dec-26	Mar-27	Jun-27	Sep-27	Dec-27	Mar-28	Jun-28	Sep-28
Cash	4.10	4.60	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.85	4.60	4.35	4.35
10 Year Bond	4.97	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.00	4.95	4.90	4.90	4.90
US											
Fed Funds	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625	3.625
US 10 Year Bond	4.30	4.40	4.40	4.45	4.50	4.55	4.60	4.65	4.70	4.75	4.75
New Zealand											
Cash	2.25	2.25	2.50	3.00	3.50	3.75	4.00	4.25	4.25	4.25	3.75
10 Year Bond	4.69	4.85	4.95	5.00	5.05	5.10	5.10	5.10	5.10	5.10	4.95

Exchange rate forecasts

	Latest (14 Apr)	Jun-26	Sep-26	Dec-26	Mar-27	Jun-27	Sep-27	Dec-27	Mar-28
PGK/USD	0.2311	0.2250	0.2200	0.2150	0.2150	0.2170	0.2220	0.2270	0.2320
PGK/AUD	0.3262	0.3125	0.3056	0.2945	0.2945	0.2932	0.3000	0.3068	0.3178
PGK/NZD	0.3934	0.3814	0.3618	0.3468	0.3370	0.3288	0.3323	0.3388	0.3483
PGK/EUR	0.1964	0.1907	0.1864	0.1807	0.1792	0.1793	0.1820	0.1861	0.1909
PGK/GBP	0.1709	0.1661	0.1618	0.1569	0.1558	0.1561	0.1586	0.1610	0.1651
PGK/JPY	36.78	35.55	34.32	33.11	32.68	32.55	32.86	33.14	33.41
PGK/SGD	0.2943	0.2846	0.2772	0.2709	0.2709	0.2723	0.2786	0.2847	0.2909

Sources: Bloomberg, Westpac Economics.

Economic and financial forecasts

Major trading partner growth forecasts (year average)

Real GDP %ann	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024f	2025f	2026f	2027f
World Economy	**–2.7**	**6.6**	**3.6**	**3.5**	**3.3**	**3.2**	**3.1**	**3.2**
US	–2.2	6.1	2.5	2.9	2.8	1.9	1.3	1.6
Eurozone	–6.0	6.3	3.5	0.4	0.9	1.4	1.1	1.4
Australia	-2.0	5.4	4.1	2.1	1.0	1.8	2.4	2.5
New Zealand	–1.3	5.7	2.9	1.8	–0.6	0.3	2.1	3.4
Japan	–4.2	2.7	0.9	1.5	0.1	1.1	0.8	0.8
China	2.3	8.4	3.1	5.4	5.0	4.8	4.6	4.5
India	–5.8	9.7	7.6	9.2	6.5	6.6	6.4	6.3

Sources Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Economic indicators

		2023	2024 (est)	2025 (est)
Inflation	**ADB**	2.3%	0.7%	3.8%
	BPNG	3.9%	0.7%	3.0%
	IMF	2.3%	0.6%	5.5%
	Westpac	3.9%	0.7%	4.7%
GDP growth	**ADB**	3.8%	4.3%	4.2%
	BPNG	3.0%	3.0%	4.0%
	IMF	3.8%	3.7%	4.6%
	Westpac	3.8%	4.3%	4.7%

Sources Macrobond, Westpac Economics

PNG Economic Statistics

	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Money supply (% year)	4.4	7.0	13.4	14.8	11.5	–6.4	6.9
Private Sector Credit (% year)	4.0	4.2	2.5	6.9	19.0	3.0	4.0
Current Account (K millions)	18,522	17,281	12,222	11,543	9,220	13,201	13,649
Total Imports Cover (months)	5.0	7.4	5.4	7.4	6.3	5.7	4.3
Non-mineral imports cover (mth)	8.2	11.8	8.4	15.1	11.6	12.2	9.3
Headline inflation (% year)	2.7	5.1	5.7	3.4	3.9	0.4	3.0
Fiscal Surplus/Deficit (K millions)	–4,172	–6,501	–6,270	–5,852	–4,935	–4,935	–3,984
Defecit as % of GDP	–5.0	–8.0	–6.7	–5.4	–4.4	–4.4	–3.3

Sources Macrobond, Westpac Economics

Financial Markets

Indicators	2022	2023	2024	2025f	2026f
Broad money supply	14.8	11.5	9.9	7.3	7.5
Monetary base	29.5	–8.7	–2.3	7.8	7.0
Claims on private sector	6.9	19.0	11.5	12.3	13.6
Net claims on government	–5.4	33.1	19.9	0.9	4.4
Net foreign assets	52.4	3.99	–6.0	–4.3	4.2
Fiscal Surplus/Deficit (K millions)	–5,852	–4,935	–3,984	–2,654	–1,314
Defecit as % of GDP	–5.4	–4.4	–3.3	–2.0	–0.9

Source: BPNG forecasts

Commodity Forecasts April 2026

End of period	Latest (14 April)	Jun-26	Sep-26	Dec-26	Mar-27	Jun-27	Sep-27	Dec-27	Mar-28	Jun-28
LNG in Japan US$mmbtu	19.09	25.6	25.3	20.3	16.0	13.5	11.3	10.0	9.7	9.2
gold (US$/oz)	4,819	4,770	4,700	4,900	5,000	4,970	4,920	4,870	4,820	4,770
copper (US$/t)	13,013	12,460	12,470	12,670	12,920	13,100	13,050	12,480	11,680	12,390
aluminium (US$/t)	3,560	3,490	3,500	3,460	3,460	3,440	3,410	3,380	3,160	3,260
nickel (US$/t)	17,586	17,100	17,200	17,400	17,500	17,300	16,800	15,400	13,700	13,900
zinc (US$/t)	3,333	3,200	3,300	3,330	3,280	3,180	3,050	2,840	2,590	2,640
lead (US$/t)	1,907	1,900	1,910	1,930	1,930	1,840	1,770	1,630	1,450	1,470

Source: Bloomberg, Westpac Economics

Corporate directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro-Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

Westpac PNG

Port Moresby.
Harbourside West Tower, L4 & L5,
Stanley Esplanade, Papua New Guinea

Patrick Wright
Head of CCB PNG
E: patrick.wright@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clark@westpac.co.nz

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

This information, unless specifically indicated otherwise, is under copyright of the Westpac Group. None of the material, nor its contents, nor any copy of it, may be altered in any way, transmitted to, copied of distributed to any other party without the prior written permission of the Westpac Group.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given above are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The results ultimately achieved may differ substantially from these forecasts.

or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK and EU: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation. This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

Preview of RBNZ April 2026 Monetary Policy Review

#rbnz #newzealand

By Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist, Westpac New Zealand

10:15 March 31 2026

Share

Governor Breman's recent speech suggests the OCR will remain at 2.25% next week. The RBNZ will repeat that it is prepared to look through the first-round impact of the oil shock while remaining vigilant for signs of second-round impacts on pricing behaviour.

Read full report here (PDF 760KB)

****Date corrected****

25 March speech redux

- Consistent with guidance given by Governor Breman in a recent speech, we expect the RBNZ to hold the OCR at 2.25% at the 8 April review.
- Barring major developments over coming days in the Middle East, the associated commentary – which will include a post-meeting press conference – will likely closely mirror Governor Breman's recent speech.
- We expect the Bank to emphasise that it will not react to the first-round impact of higher energy prices on near-term inflation but that it will respond should there be evidence of second-round effects that might create persistent inflation.
- While the post-meeting statement will present the consensus view of the MPC, the Record of Meeting will likely reflect a diversity of views about the likelihood of second-round persistent inflation and thus the appropriate policy stance.
- The Bank is not scheduled to present revised economic projections at this meeting. However, it is possible that the RBNZ will provide some guidance of the likely magnitude of the upward revision to near-term inflation and downward revision to GDP growth that might be considered in May.
- We think the Bank will aim to balance a desire to avoid a further tightening of financial conditions with the desire to not sound complacent about the medium-term inflation risks that come with an energy price shock.

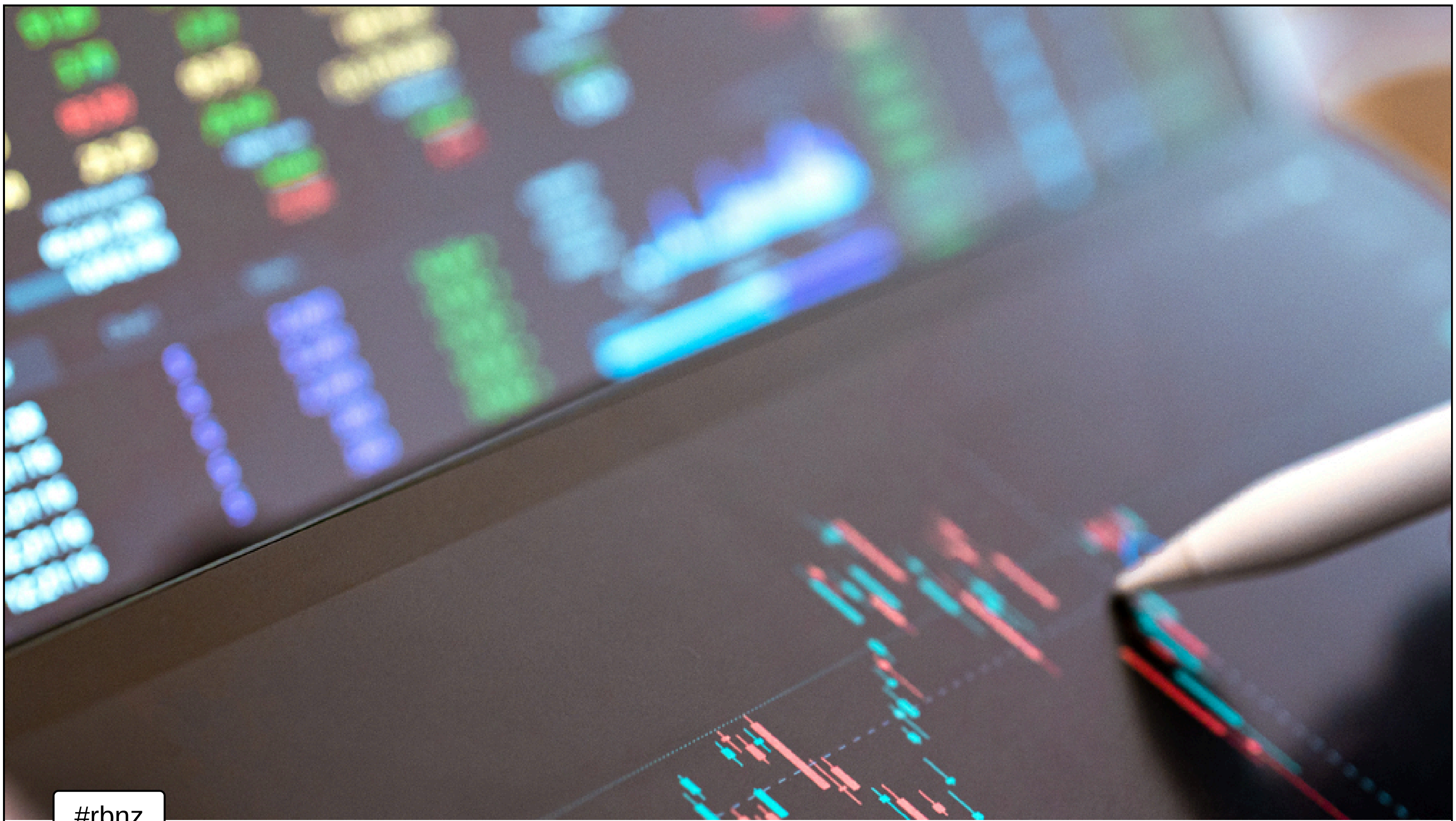
Related articles

#rbnz

RBNZ 8 April 2026 Monetary Policy Review and change of call

April 08 2026 • 3 mins

By Kelly Eckhold



#rbnz

Hawks, doves, and kiwis, Apr 2026

April 02 2026 • 4 mins

By Westpac New Zealand Economics

#rbnz

First Impressions: RBNZ Governor Breman speaks on Middle East war

March 24 2026 • 4 mins

By Kelly Eckhold & Darren Gibbs

Browse topics

#aud #interestrates #australia #nzd #usd #rates #credit #yieldcurve

#newzealand #acgb #semigovernment #basis #commodities #ustreasury #fx

#rba #jpy #abs #rbnz #inflation Show more tags

Disclaimer

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward-looking statements. The words “believe”, “anticipate”, “expect”, “intend”, “plan”, “predict”, “continue”, “assume”, “positioned”, “may”, “will”, “should”, “shall”, “risk” and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-

looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the

appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at the internet address www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S.: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent

liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and

“professional clients” as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for “retail clients”. Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area (“EEA”): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH (“WEG”) under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority (‘BaFin’) and subject to its regulation. WEG’s supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank (‘Deutsche Bundesbank’). WEG is registered with the commercial register (‘Handelsregister’) of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA’s Prudential Standard 222 ‘Association with Related Entities’, Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an ‘investment recommendation’ and/or ‘information recommending or suggesting an investment’, both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) (“MAR”). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Economic Calendar

April 2026

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI
		1	2	3
		AUSTRALIA Cotality Home Price Index Mar exp 0.7% prev 0.6% (12:01am) Building Approvals Feb exp 5.0% prev –7.2% (11:30am) **CHINA** RatingDog Mfg PMI Mar exp 52.5 prev 52.1 (12:45pm) **EURO ZONE** Unemployment Rate Feb exp 6.1% prev 6.1% (8:00pm) **JAPAN** Tankan Large Manufacturers Index Q1 exp 16 prev 15 (10:50am) **NEW ZEALAND** Building Permits Feb prev 1.9% (8:45am) **UNITED STATES** ADP Employment Change Mar prev 63k (11:15pm) Retail Sales Feb exp 0.4% prev –0.2% (11:30pm) Fedspeak – Musalem (12:05am) Fedspeak – Barr (12:10am) ISM Mfg Mar exp 52.3 prev 52.4 (1:00am) Business Inventories Jan prev 0.1% (1:00am) **GLOBAL** S&P Global Manufacturing PMI Mar (F)	**AUSTRALIA** Goods Trade Balance Feb exp $1.5bn prev $2.6bn (11:30am) Job Vacancies Q1 exp 3.0% prev –0.2% (11:30am) **UNITED STATES** Trade Balance Feb exp –$66.0bn prev –$54.5bn (11:30pm)	**CHINA** RatingDog Services PMI Mar exp 53.7 prev 56.7 (12:45pm) **UNITED STATES** Employment Report Mar (11:30pm) Nonfarm Payrolls Chg exp 51k prev –92k Unemployment Rate exp 4.4% prev 4.4% Avg Hourly Earnings exp 0.3% prev 0.4% S&P Global Services PMI Mar (F) (12:45am) **GLOBAL** Good Friday – Markets Closed
6	7	8	9	10
UNITED STATES ISM Services Mar exp 55.0 prev 56.1 (1:00am) **GLOBAL** Easter Monday – Markets Closed	**AUSTRALIA** MI Inflation Mar y/y prev 3.6% (11:00am) ANZ-Indeed Job Ads Mar prev 3.2% (11:30am) Household Spending Indicator Feb exp –0.2% prev 0.3% (11:30am) **JAPAN** Household Spending Feb y/y prev –1.0% (9:30am) **UNITED STATES** Durable Goods Orders Feb prev 0.0% (10:30pm) NY Fed 1-Yr Inflation Expectations Mar y/y prev 3.0% (1:00am) Fedspeak – Goolsbee (2:35am) Consumer Credit Feb prev $8.1bn (5:00am)	**EURO ZONE** Ger. Factory Orders Feb prev –11.1% (4:00pm) PPI Feb y/y prev –2.2% (7:00pm) Retail Sales Feb prev –0.1% (7:00pm) **JAPAN** Current Account Feb prev ¥941.6bn (9:50am) **NEW ZEALAND** RBNZ Policy Decision prev 2.25% (12:00pm) **UNITED STATES** FOMC Meeting Minutes (4:00am)	**CHINA** Credit & M2 Data Mar (9–14 Mar) New Yuan Loans ytd prev CNY5610bn M2 Money Supply y/y prev 9.0% **EURO ZONE** Ger. Industrial Production Feb prev –0.5% (4:00pm) **UNITED STATES** Personal Income Feb prev 0.4% (10:30pm) Personal Spending Feb prev 0.4% (10:30pm) PCE Deflator Feb prev 0.3% (10:30pm) GDP Q4 (F) ann'd prev 0.7% (10:30pm) Wholesale Inventories Feb (F) prev –0.5% (12:00am)	**CHINA** CPI Mar y/y prev 1.3% (11:30am) PPI Mar y/y prev –0.9% (11:30am) **NEW ZEALAND** BusinessNZ Mfg PMI Mar prev 55.0 (8:30am) **UNITED STATES** CPI Mar y/y prev 2.4% (10:30pm) Factory Orders Feb prev 0.1% (12:00am) UoM Consumer Sentiment (P) Apr (12:00am) Durable Goods Orders Feb (F) prev 0.0% (12:00am)

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are Westpac forecasts and for other countries are Bloomberg consensus forecasts as at the time of publication. Westpac forecasts are subject to change in subsequent publications. (P) refers to preliminary or first estimate; (S) refers to second estimate; (F) refers to final estimate.

Economic Calendar

April 2026

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI
13	**14**	**15**	**16**	**17**
UNITED STATES Existing Home Sales Mar prev 1.7% (12:00am)	**AUSTRALIA** RBA's Hauser – Fireside Chat (8:45am) Westpac–MI Consumer Sentiment Apr prev 91.6 (10:30am) NAB Business Survey (11:30am) Conditions prev 7 Confidence prev –1 **CHINA** Trade Balance Mar prev US\$91.0bn **JAPAN** Industrial Production Feb (F) (2:30pm) **NEW ZEALAND** Net Migration Feb prev 4460 (8:45am) **UNITED STATES** NFIB Small Business Optimism Mar prev 98.8 (8:00pm) PPI Mar y/y prev 3.4% (10:30pm)	**EURO ZONE** Industrial Production Feb prev –1.5% (7:00pm) **JAPAN** Core Machinery Orders Feb prev –5.5% (9:50am) **UNITED STATES** NY Empire Manufacturing Index Apr prev –0.2 (10:30pm) Import Price Index Mar prev 1.3% (10:30pm) NAHB Housing Market Index Apr prev 38 (12:00am) FOMC Beidge Book (4:00am)	**AUSTRALIA** RBA's Hauser – Panel Participation (6:00am) Consumer Inflation Expectations Apr y/y prev 5.2% (11:00am) Labour Force Survey Mar (11:30am) Employment Change exp 25k prev 48.9k Unemployment Rate exp 4.2% prev 4.3% Participation Rate exp 66.8% prev 66.9% **CHINA** GDP Q1 y/y prev 4.5% (12:00pm) Activity Data Mar ytd y/y (12:00pm) Retail Sales prev 2.8% Industrial Production prev 6.3% Fixed Asset Investment prev 1.8% **EURO ZONE** CPI Mar (F) (7:00pm) **UNITED KINGDOM** Monthly GDP Feb prev 0.0% (4:00pm) **UNITED STATES** Philadelphia Fed Manufacturing Index Apr prev 18.1 (10:30pm) Industrial Production Mar prev 0.2% (11:15pm)	**EURO ZONE** Trade Balance Feb prev €12.1bn (7:00pm) **NEW ZEALAND** Selected Price Indices Mar (8:45am) Retail Card Spending Mar prev 1.4% (8:45am) **UNITED STATES** Washington's Birthday – Markets Closed
20	**21**	**22**	**23**	**24**
NEW ZEALAND Trade Balance Mar prev –NZ\$257mn (8:45am) **UNITED KINGDOM** Rightmove House Prices Apr prev 0.8% (9:01am)	**EURO ZONE** EU ZEW Expectations Apr prev –8.5 (7:00pm) **NEW ZEALAND** CPI Q1 (8:45am) q/q prev 0.6% y/y prev 3.1% **UNITED KINGDOM** ILO Unemployment Rate Feb prev 5.2% (4:00pm) **UNITED STATES** Retail Sales Mar (10:30pm) Business Inventories Feb (12:00am) Pending Home Sales Mar prev 1.8% (12:00am)	**AUSTRALIA** Westpac-MI Leading Index Mar ann'd prev +0.08% (10:30am) **EURO ZONE** Consumer Confidence Apr (P) prev –16.3 (12:00am) **UNITED KINGDOM** CPI Mar y/y prev 3.0% (4:00pm)	**UNITED KINGDOM** Public Sector Borrowing Mar prev 14.3 (4:00pm) **UNITED STATES** Chicago Fed Nat Act Index Mar prev –0.11 (10:30pm) Kansas City Fed Manufacturing Index Apr prev 11 (1:00am) **GLOBAL** S&P Global PMIs Apr (P) Manufacturing Services	**EURO ZONE** Ger. IFO Business Climate Survey Apr (6:00pm) **JAPAN** CPI Mar y/y prev 1.3% (9:30am) **UNITED KINGDOM** GfK Consumer Sentiment Apr prev –21 (9:01am) Retail Sales Mar (4:00pm) **UNITED STATES** UoM Consumer Sentiment Apr (F) (12:00am)

Times are AEDT. All data forecasts are m/m or q/q and seasonally adjusted unless otherwise specified. Forecasts for Australian data are Westpac forecasts and for other countries are Bloomberg consensus forecasts as at the time of publication. Westpac forecasts are subject to change in subsequent publications. (P) refers to preliminary or first estimate; (S) refers to second estimate; (F) refers to final estimate.

Economic Calendar

April 2026

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI
27	**28**	**29**	**30**	**1 May**
CHINA Industrial Profits Mar y/y prev 5.3% (11:30am) **UNITED STATES** Dallas Fed Manufacturing Index Apr (12:30am)	**JAPAN** Jobless Rate Mar (9:30am) BoJ Policy Decision prev 0.75% **NEW ZEALAND** Employment Indicator Mar (8:45am) **UNITED STATES** FHFA House Prices Feb (11:00pm) S&P CoreLogic CS House Prices Feb (11:00pm) Richmond Fed Manufacturing Index Apr prev 0 (12:00am) Conf. Board Consumer Confidence Index Apr (12:00am)	**AUSTRALIA** CPI Q1 (11:30am) Headline q/q exp 1.4% prev 0.6% Headline y/y exp 4.1% prev 3.2% Trimmed Mean q/q exp 0.9% prev 0.9% Trimmed Mean y/y exp 3.5% prev 3.4% Monthly CPI Mar (11:30am) Headline m/m exp 1.1% prev 0.0% Headline y/y exp 4.5% prev 3.7% **EURO ZONE** M3 Money Supply Mar y/y prev 3.0% (6:00pm) Economic Confidence Apr (7:00pm) Consumer Confidence Apr (F) (7:00pm) **UNITED STATES** Wholesale Inventories Mar (P) (10:30pm) Durable Goods Orders Mar (P) (10:30pm) Housing Starts Mar prev 7.2% (10:30pm) Building Permits Mar prev –4.7% (10:30pm) FOMC Policy Decision prev 3.625% (4:00am)	**AUSTRALIA** Private Sector Credit Mar (11:30am) Trade Price Indices Q1 (11:30am) Export Prices prev 3.2% Import Prices prev 0.9% **CHINA** NBS PMIs Apr (11:30am) Manufacturing Non–Manufacturing RatingDog Mfg PMI Apr (11:45am) **EURO ZONE** CPI Apr (P) (7:00pm) GDP Q1 (P) prev 0.2% (7:00pm) Unemployment Rate Mar (7:00pm) ECB Policy Decision (Deposit Rate) prev 2.00% (10:15pm) **JAPAN** Industrial Production Mar (9:50am) **NEW ZEALAND** ANZ Business Confidence Apr (11:00am) **UNITED KINGDOM** BoE Policy Decision prev 3.75% (9:00pm) **UNITED STATES** Personal Income Mar (10:30pm) Personal Spending Mar (10:30pm) PCE Deflator Mar (10:30pm) Employment Cost Index Q1 prev 0.7% (10:30pm) GDP Q1 (F) (10:30pm) Chicago PMI Apr (11:45pm)	**AUSTRALIA** PPI Q1 prev 0.8% (11:30am) **NEW ZEALAND** ANZ Consumer Confidence Apr prev 91.3 (8:00am) Building Permits Mar (8:45am) **JAPAN** Tokyo CPI Apr (9:50am) **UNITED STATES** ISM Manufacturing Apr (12:00am) **GLOBAL** S&P Global Manufacturing PMI Apr (F) ISM Manufacturing Apr (12:00am)

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro-Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Kelly Eckhold
NZ Chief Economist
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.com.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.com.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.com.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.com.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clark@westpac.com.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

DISCLAIMER

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the **New Zealand Privacy Policy here**, or the Australian **Group Privacy Statement here**. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access **Westpac's Financial Services Guide here** or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at **www.westpac.co.nz**.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from **www.westpac.com.fj** © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from **www.westpac.com.pg** © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement.

WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found **here**. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

SORRY, WE CAN'T FIND THAT PAGE

The page you’re looking for has been moved or taken off the site. Do you want to go our homepage or search?

If you continue to have difficulties – send us an email and we’ll get back to you as soon as possible.

AGRI BITES

Expect the unexpected.

31 March 2026

CONTENTS AND AUTHOR

Paul Clark, Industry Economist

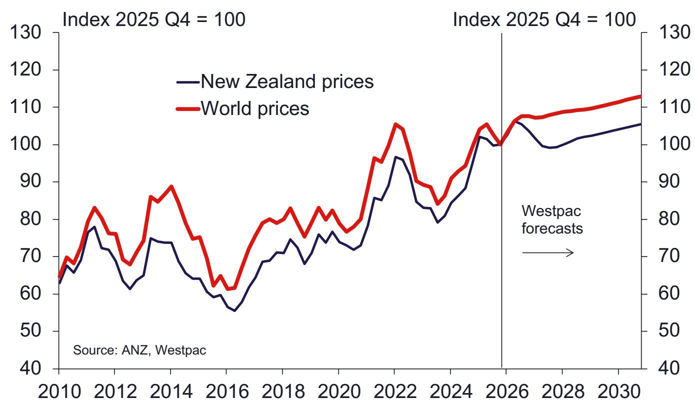
+64 9 336 5656 | +64 21 713 704
paul.clark@westpac.co.nz

SUMMARY

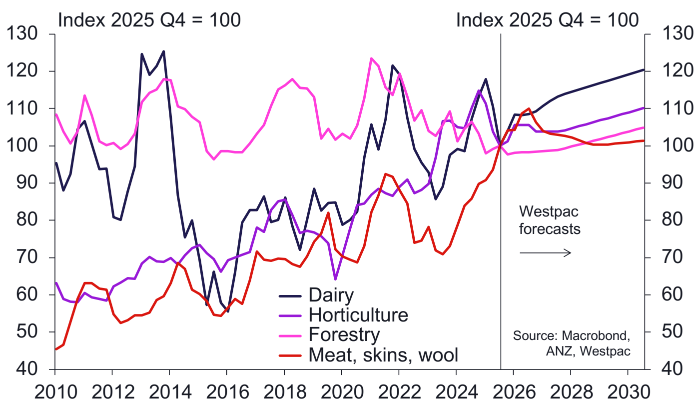
Despite uncertainties, agricultural export prices to remain elevated.

- The impact of war in Iran is likely to be broadly supportive of prices. The key issue is whether war-induced costs can be passed on. In the near term, the scope for passthrough is likely to be limited, which implies some pressure on margins. Should hostilities persist, the potential to pass on higher costs increases, providing more support to prices, and a recovery in margins.
- We've revised up our farmgate milk price forecast for this season by 40 cents to $9.80/kg, which is slightly higher than the midpoint of Fonterra's forecast range. While global supply remains ample, that's been matched by strong demand for protein. That said, with the war introducing new uncertainties, we have kept our milk payout forecast for the 2026/27 season at $9.20/kg.
- Beef and lamb export prices are set to remain elevated. Key considerations include the war in Iran, how quickly the US beef herd rebuilds, the resilience of US consumer beef demand, ongoing weakness in the Chinese market, and price resistance in the UK and EU markets for lamb.
- Meanwhile, kiwifruit and apple export prices are set to plateau at high levels as supply catches up with demand in key offshore markets.
- Log export prices are expected to remain rangebound, showing little upward momentum. Rising freight costs imply margin squeeze, which could result in corporate action.

Commodity prices – World and NZ dollar denominated



Commodity prices by category

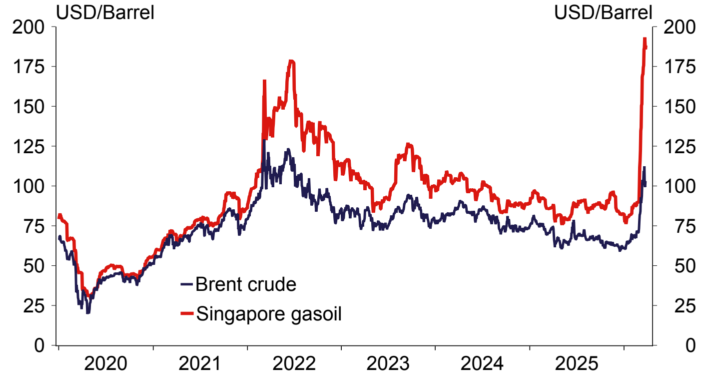


IMPACTS OF WAR IN IRAN

Ability to pass on higher input costs to increase over time.

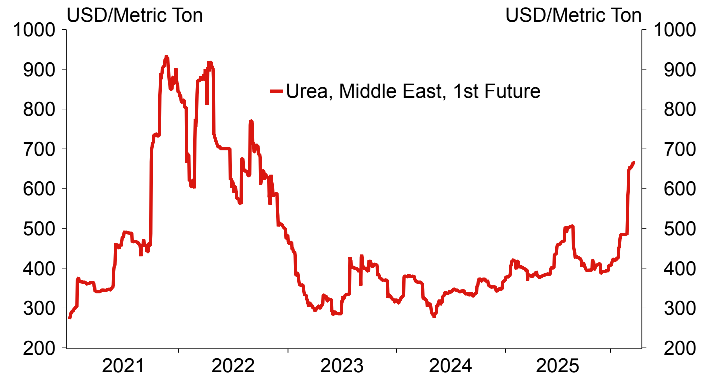
- Prior to the conflict with Iran, the IMF had forecast 3.3% global growth for 2026. Hostilities are set to trigger downgrades, with worldwide economic output expected to drop 0.2% for every 10% sustained increase in oil prices.
- Even so, we think the conflict in Iran will be broadly supportive of New Zealand commodity export prices, and that support will be reinforced over time. That will be less about demand, and more about the ability of farmers, orchardists and exporters to pass through higher input costs arising from the conflict.
- The closure of the Strait of Hormuz has led to a lift in energy prices more generally, resulting in sharply higher diesel prices. It has also disrupted urea exports, which in turn has spurred on fertiliser prices.
- Higher diesel and fertiliser prices translate directly into higher on-farm and on-orchard costs, that can either be absorbed or passed down the value chain. Processors and exporters face similar pressures through higher freight costs.
- In the short term, the passthrough of higher input costs is set to be constrained by existing supply contracts. Already-elevated prices and growing buyer resistance further limits scope for passing on costs. However, if the conflict persists and higher input costs are sustained, a growing acceptance by buyers and greater scope for renewing supply contracts should increase passthrough, resulting in prices that restore export returns.

Crude oil and diesel prices



Sources: Macrobond, SGX, ICE, Westpac

Urea prices



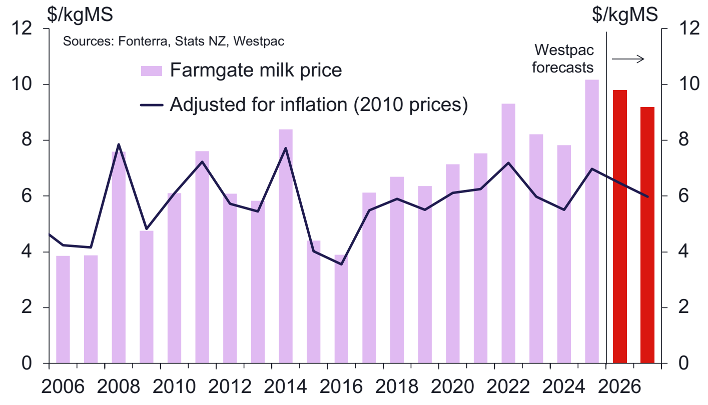
Sources: Macrobond, CME Group, Westpac

DAIRY

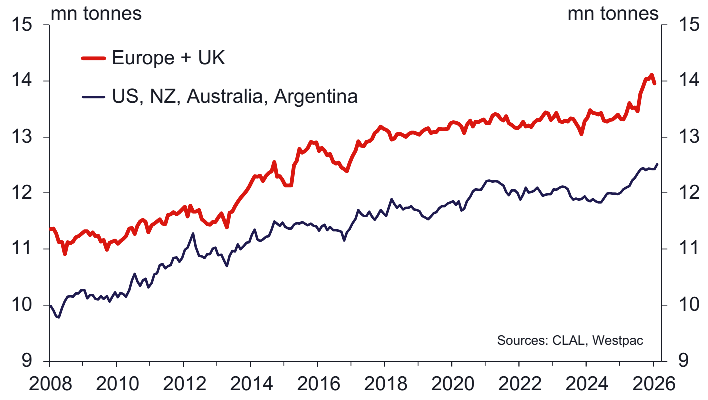
Current season forecast revised up to $9.80/kg.

- World dairy prices rebounded rapidly from the price falls seen through late 2025. We've revised up our farmgate milk price forecast for this season by 40 cents to $9.80/kg, which is slightly higher than the midpoint of Fonterra's forecast range of $9.40-10.00/kg.
- The global milk supply remains ample. Collections among the main exporting countries are up about 4% on a year ago, though with some signs that they have plateaued in recent months. This is being matched by strong global demand for protein, which is benefiting skim milk powder prices in particular (less so for whole milk powder, which is our major export product).
- The Iran war creates new uncertainties around the outlook for dairy prices. On one hand, disruptions to shipping and the cost shock faced by global consumers could weigh on demand. However, the global dairy industry is facing pressures of its own, such as rising costs and limited availability of fertiliser and fuel. European dairy systems are perhaps the most exposed to these risks – milk production could be scaled back significantly in regions that were already grappling with low margins.
- This two-sided uncertainty about the year ahead means that our forecast for the 2026/27 season remains at $9.20/kg. Fonterra's opening forecast at the end of May is likely to come with an appropriately wide range – probably similar to the $8.00-11.00/kg range that they started with for this season.

Farmgate milk prices



Milk production by top 5 exporting regions

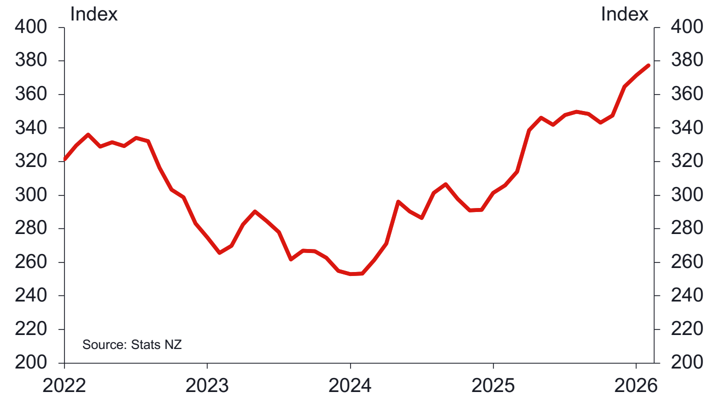


BEEF

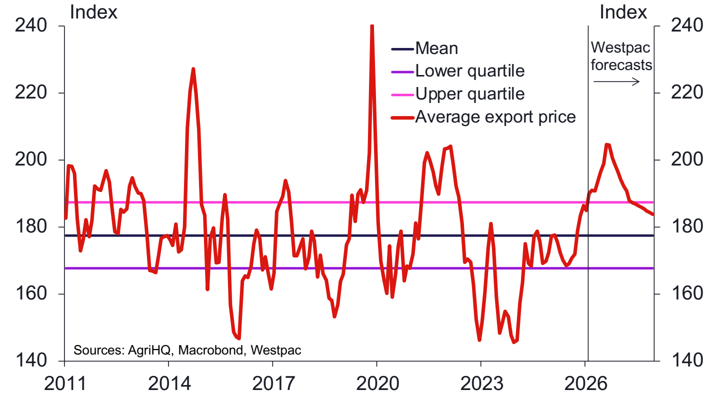
Structural, cyclical and systemic shocks to keep beef prices elevated.

- Global beef supply to remain tight in 2026, reflecting low cattle inventories in the US, Brazil and parts of Europe.
- New Zealand beef output is expected to lift modestly, supported by favourable pasture conditions and stronger prices. Slaughter volumes should also benefit from increased dairy-beef supply.
- Export prices are likely to remain firm, underpinned by strong US demand for high-quality protein. Wholesale beef prices in the US – especially premium cuts – have risen faster than retail prices for everyday beef, suggesting retailers and processors are absorbing some of the costs.
- With US supply chains already wearing the cost of elevated beef import prices, it seems unlikely in the near-term that New Zealand's beef farmers and exporters will be able to pass on higher costs they incur as a result of the war.
- However, the longer hostilities continue and as buyers look to confirm supply agreements, the greater the scope for passing on these costs, which could lead to a tick up in beef export prices and a recovery in margins.
- New Zealand is also set to benefit from a larger beef quota into China in 2026, improving market access, while Brazil and Australia face relatively tighter conditions following quota reductions.

Average monthly beef export prices - nominal



Average monthly beef export prices - real

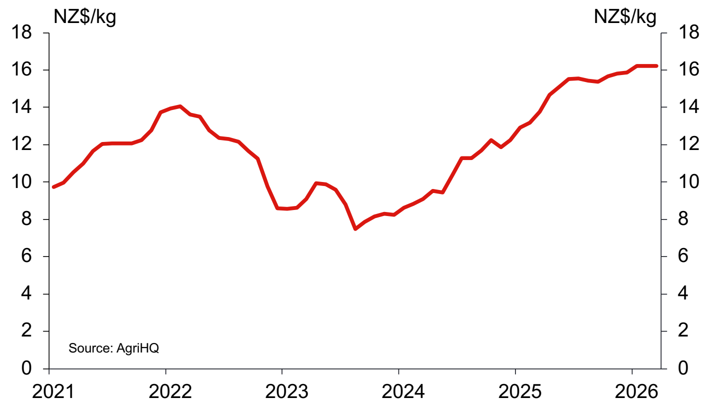


SHEEP MEAT

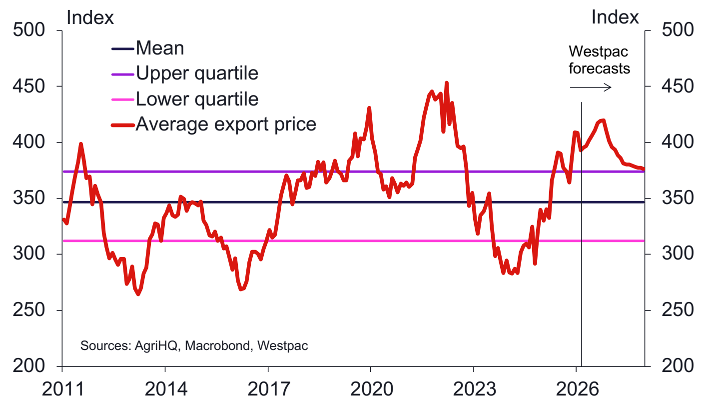
Lamb export prices to remain elevated despite some resistance.

- Our key assumption is that the global supply of lamb will remain constrained. This partly reflects structural change in New Zealand, including ongoing destocking and a smaller breeding flock, as seen by fewer breeding ewes.
- More importantly, supply dynamics in Australia point to tighter global availability. Australia is the key swing supplier in the global sheep meat market, and after a very high sheep and lamb slaughter last year, the Australian flock is now moving into a rebuild phase, reducing near-term export supply.
- Export demand from the EU, UK and US remains relatively robust, supported by declining domestic production in those markets. However, cost-of-living pressures and cheaper protein substitutes are creating resistance to further price increases, effectively capping prices at current levels.
- The conflict in Iran is unlikely to materially affect lamb export prices in the near term. An inability to pass on higher energy costs in an environment where lamb prices are already high is likely to result in margin compression. If hostilities are prolonged, the scope to pass on higher input costs should improve, resulting in higher export prices and wider margins.
- Meanwhile, demand in China – the world's largest market for lamb – is holding steady rather than expanding rapidly.

Average monthly lamb export prices - nominal



Average monthly lamb export prices - real

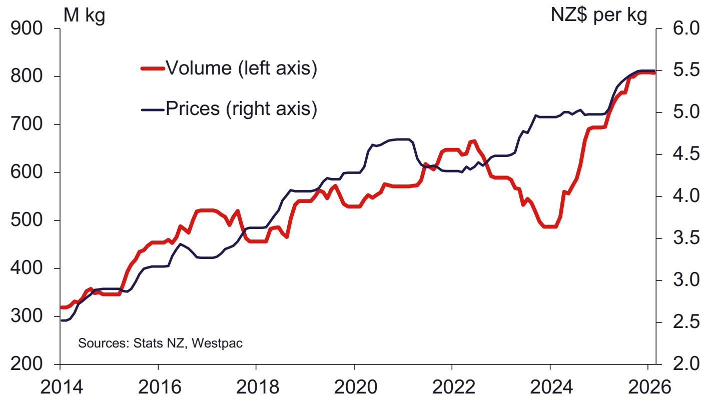


HORTICULTURE

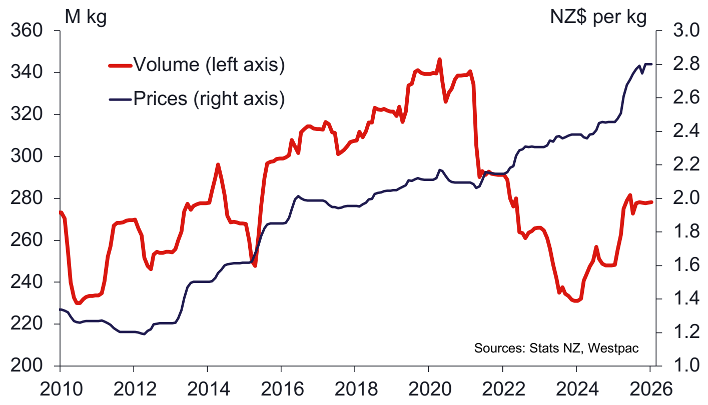
Prices to remain elevated, but largely moving sideways.

- Europe remains the strongest market, while NZ kiwifruit continues to see solid growth at the premium end in urban China and in the big US market.
- Demand in Japan and parts of Asia is stable to softening due to weaker real incomes, and in China more generally, growth is being constrained by rising domestic supply, making competition and price sensitivity more important.
- Export prices for kiwifruit should stay high but largely flat over coming years with strong demand and premium branding helping to support prices, while expanding supply caps further upside, implying a high price plateau rather than continued increases. That said, we also think that prices could lift temporarily to reflect higher war-induced energy price hikes.
- Meanwhile, improving fruit quality, a shift toward premium varieties, and solid demand in Asian markets are supporting stable to modestly higher NZ apple export prices.
- Increasing production from maturing orchards and high export volumes in 2026 continuing into 2027 are likely to keeping prices stable or rising only modestly year to year.
- Any improvement in average prices is more likely to come from a greater share of IP-protected premium varieties and a still favourable exchange rate, rather than tighter global supply or stronger consumer markets.

Kiwifruit – average export prices and volumes



Apples – average export prices and volumes

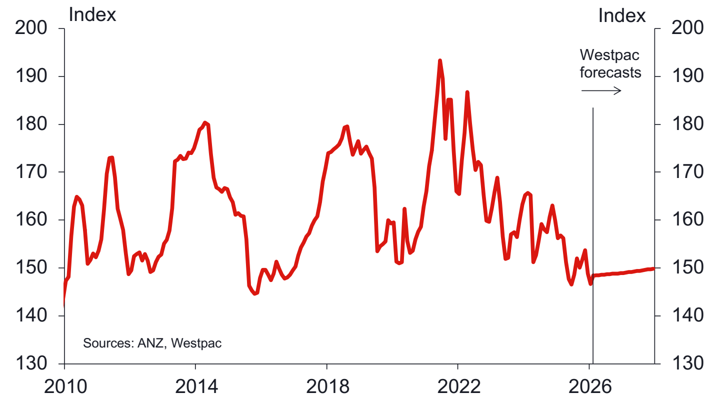


FORESTRY

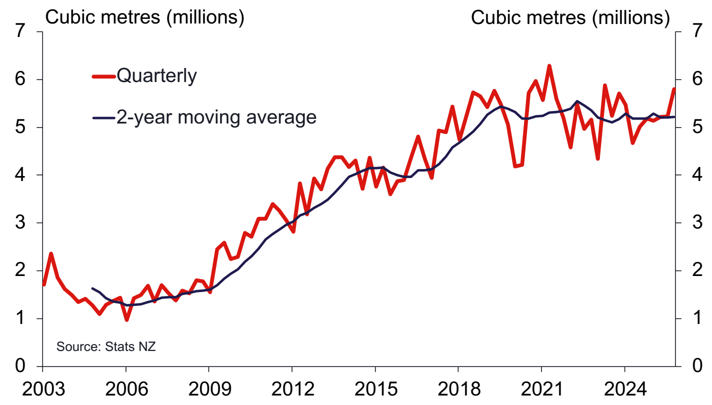
Log export prices display inertia, with marginal gains expected in 2026.

- China is still absorbing large volumes of NZ logs. But with that country's housing market still firmly in the red and construction activity subdued, demand remains well below the historical high.
- Chinese demand for logs is mainly supported by furniture, refurbishment and the manufacture of engineered wood products.
- Port inventories in China are comfortable (around 50–60 days' supply), reducing buyer urgency and capping upward price pressures.
- NZ log supply has eased gradually, preventing further sharp price falls but not tightening enough to drive a rebound. Lower NZ production may help to prevent further price declines over the coming year.
- Meanwhile freight and fuel costs have risen in early 2026 mainly because of the war in Iran. This in turn has squeezed at-wharf-gate returns for New Zealand exporters and eroded forest-gate margins.
- Looking forward, the most likely outcome is broad price stability rather than recovery, with limited upside unless Chinese construction activity improves materially.
- With prices set to move sideways, a continuance of the conflict in Iran is likely to squeeze exporter and plantation margins, heightening the risk of closures.

World forest prices



Log export volumes



FARM INPUT EXPENSES

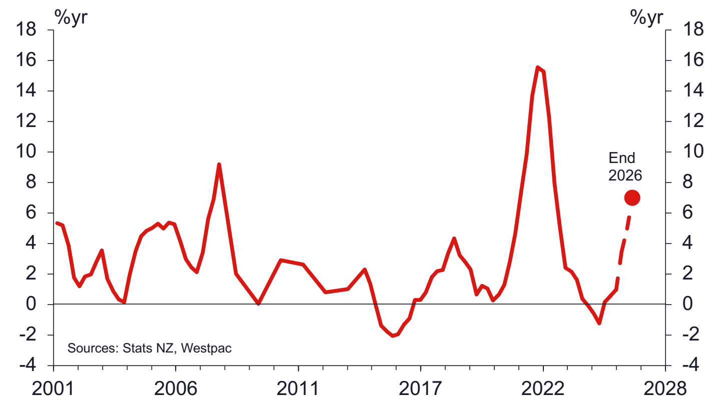
Rising farm input expenses to squeeze on-farm margins.

- We think that farm input cost inflation will rise sharply this year to around 7%yr.
- Global prices for crude oil have risen by more than 50% since the start of the conflict in the Middle East. This impact has been compounded by a significant rise in refining spreads. Combined, these developments have pushed the local price for diesel up by around $1.60/ltr.
- The continuing conflict in the Middle East does mean that oil prices could swing around a bit over the coming months. However, at this stage it's looking likely that local fuel prices will remain elevated for some time.
- Those higher fuel prices and other disruptions related to the conflict are also pushing transport and other costs higher. We estimate that about 15% of farm costs have some exposure through higher on-farm production costs and freight transportation costs. Notably, prices for urea (a key ingredient in fertiliser production) have risen by around 50%.
- The key question is to what extent farmers will be able to pass on these input costs? In the near term, many operators may find they are unable to raise prices due to factors such as existing contractual arrangements, and that signals a squeeze on margins. However, if the increase in input costs is sustained, we're likely to see those higher input costs flowing through to higher output prices as time progresses.

Change in prices – Start of Iran war to now

Commodity Price (US$)	Price change
Brent crude oil	~50%
Singapore gasoil	~80%
Urea	~50%
NZD/USD	~-3%

Farm input expenses

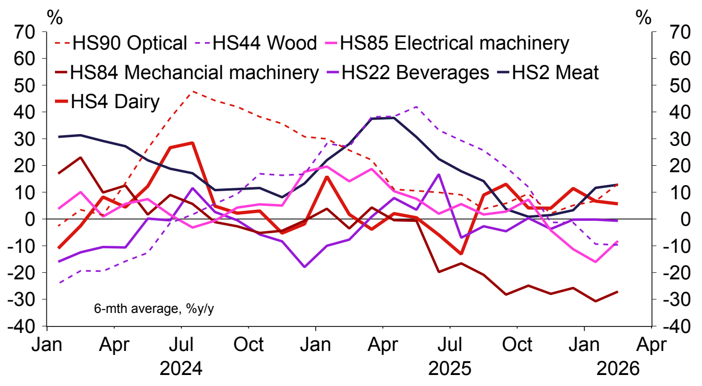


US TARIFF UPDATE

Tariffs facing primary exporters little changed by Supreme Court ruling.

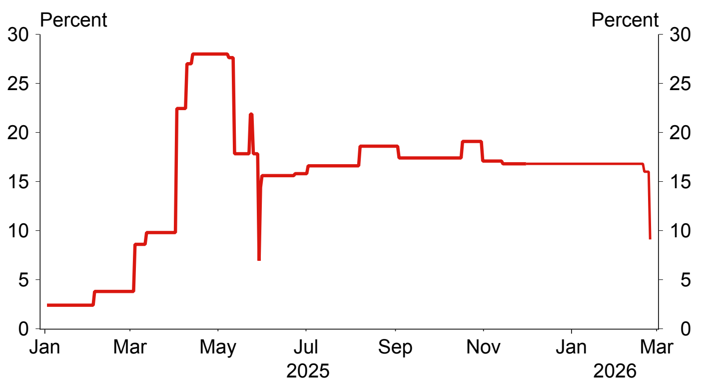
- After the Supreme Court's ruling that the Trump Administration's earlier tariffs (issued under "IEEPA" legislation) were illegal, most NZ goods entering the US now face a new 10% "Section 122" tariff. However, authority to implement tariff's under Section 122 is limited to 150 days unless approved by Congress.
- Key NZ agricultural exports (including dairy product, beef, kiwifruit and some fresh produce) are exempt from the Section 122 tariffs, as was the case before the Supreme Court's ruling. Even so, the ruling was good news as it did remove the legal basis for expanding blanket tariffs, reducing the risk that agriculture is swept into future economy-wide measures.
- Future product-specific actions remain possible. New Zealand is on a list of 60 countries under a Section 301 (unfair trade) investigation related to allegations of the use of forced labour. It remains to be seen if these will hold water.
- Several NZ export-relevant sectors (e.g. timber, pharmaceuticals) are under active US investigations, creating upside tariff risk. And US sheep meat producers continue to call for an investigation into New Zealand exports into the US, citing unfair competitions.
- Export data suggests that the largest negative impact of the tariffs to date has been faced by manufacturers, with exports of mechanical and electrical machinery well down on pre-tariff levels.

Major exports to the US



Sources: Macrobond, Stats NZ, Westpac

US effective tariff rates



Sources: Macrobond, Budget Lab at Yale, Westpac

FORECASTS

New Zealand commodity prices (end of period)

	Latest	Jun-26	Sep-26	Dec-26	Mar-27	Jun-27	Sep-27	Dec-27	Mar-28	Jun-28
NZ commodities index	**394**	**403**	**407**	**407**	**406**	**406**	**408**	**410**	**412**	**413**
Dairy price index	332	342	342	342	345	349	353	357	359	361
Whole milk powder USD/t	3,863	3,500	3,450	3,400	3,500	3,600	3,670	3,750	3,790	3,830
Skim milk powder USD/t	3,243	3,100	3,020	2,950	3,000	3,050	3,100	3,150	3,180	3,210
Lamb price index	631	656	679	651	633	622	621	620	617	612
Beef price index	391	407	427	413	404	398	398	397	396	395
Forestry price index	148	149	149	149	149	149	149	150	150	151

New Zealand commodity prices (annual averages)

	Levels				% change			
	2025	**2026f**	**2027f**	**2028f**	**2025**	**2026f**	**2027f**	**2028f**
NZ commodities index	**390**	**402**	**408**	**413**	**9.2**	**3.1**	**1.4**	**1.2**
Dairy price index	348	338	351	361	9.7	-2.8	3.8	2.9
Whole milk powder USD/t	3902	3525	3594	3829	13.5	-9.6	1.9	6.5
Skim milk powder USD/t	2702	3052	3054	3216	0.7	12.9	0.1	5.3
Lamb price index	587	657	626	609	27.0	11.8	-4.6	-2.7
Beef price index	337	407	400	394	19.1	20.6	-1.7	-1.4
Forestry price index	152	148	149	151	-4.9	-2.1	0.6	1.2

Forecasts as at 30 March 2026.

Contact

Westpac Economics Team
westpac.co.nz/economics
economics@westpac.co.nz

Connect with us

Kelly Eckhold, Chief Economist
+64 9 348 9382 | +64 21 786 758
kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod, Senior Economist
+64 9 336 5668 | +64 21 710 852
satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs, Senior Economist
+64 9 367 3368 | +64 21 794 292
darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon, Senior Economist
+64 9 336 5670 | +64 21 749 506
michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark, Industry Economist
+64 9 336 5656 | +64 21 713 704
paul.clark@westpac.co.nz

Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance. The forecasts given in this document are predictive in character. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which the forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from these forecasts.

Disclaimer

underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability-related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access **Westpac's Financial Services Guide** here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at **www.westpac.co.nz**.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from **www.westpac.com.fj** © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from **www.westpac.com.pg** © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the **general disclosure** which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Westpac Banking Corporation.

30 MARCH 2026

WESTPAC-DATAX CARD TRACKER

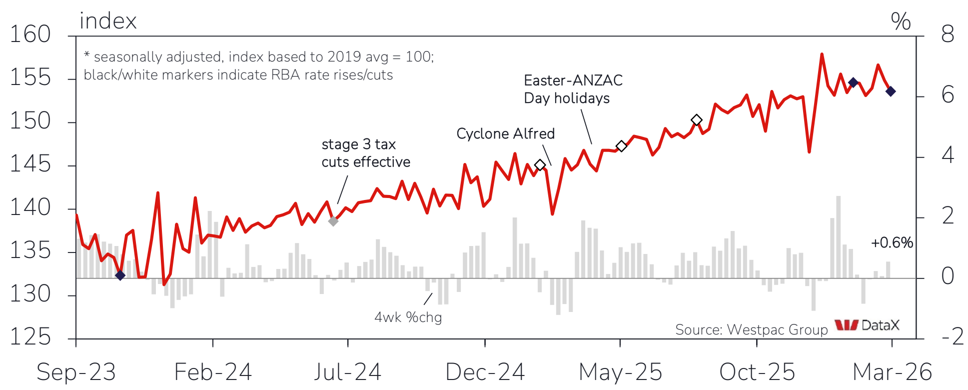
Powered by DataX

Card activity shows fuel disruptions starting to impact

- The **Westpac-DataX Card Tracker Index*** softened slightly in the first three weeks of March, dipping 0.4pts to 153.6 as at the week ending March 21.
- Quarterly momentum has been mixed, the last two weeks showing a lift back to 1.9%qtr, up from 1% in late February, but with growth rates affected by the weak reads just prior to Christmas, which are now in the base for comparisons. The quarterly growth rate is likely to settle back into the 1-1.5%qtr range as this noise drops out, well below the 2-2.5% pace seen through much 2025 H2.
- Monthly growth momentum is much softer, having slowed into the 0-0.5% range since February. Moreover, all of the gains over the last four weeks have come from a sharp rise in fuel spend, up 8.2% compared to the previous four weeks. Non-fuel card activity dipped slightly, by 0.2%, over the same period.
- The surge in fuel reflects sharply higher prices and volumes. In seasonally adjusted terms, the first two weeks of March saw the highest number of card transactions across the 'operation of motor vehicles' sub-category since the data began in 2019, the average transaction value up 7.9% vs February.
- The softening in non-fuel card activity has centred on discretionary services, led by accommodation and recreational services but with a notable weakening in international transactions as well. Notably, there have been no real signs of weakness around discretionary goods with card activity in this segment over the last four weeks up 1% vs the previous four weeks, durables up closer to 2%.
- State-wise, the rise in fuel spend looks to have has been slightly more pronounced in Qld and slightly less so in Vic and SA. For total card activity, the quarterly growth pulse remains firmer in Tas, WA, SA and Qld and noticeably slower in Vic.
- Overall, with available card data now covering over 85% of Q1, the quarter looks to be tracking a 1-1.5%qtr rise in nominal card activity. While that is likely to be only marginally firmer than the Q1 CPI gain (due to be released on April 29), the total spending measure in the Q1 national accounts will see a positive effect from the end of electricity rebates.

"... all of the gains over the last four weeks have come from a sharp rise in fuel ..."

1. Westpac-DataX Card Tracker Index*



The **Westpac-DataX Card Tracker** presents indicators based on the millions of credit and debit card transactions processed by Westpac every day. The measures are a timely guide to shifts in spending. See p11 for a detailed explanation.

This report is produced by Westpac Economics.
Matthew Hassan, Head of Australian Macro-Forecasting
Email: economics@westpac.com.au
This issue was finalised on 30 March 2026.

If you would like more insights on your sector or business from this and other Westpac data please visit Westpac DataX or contact datax@westpac.com.au.

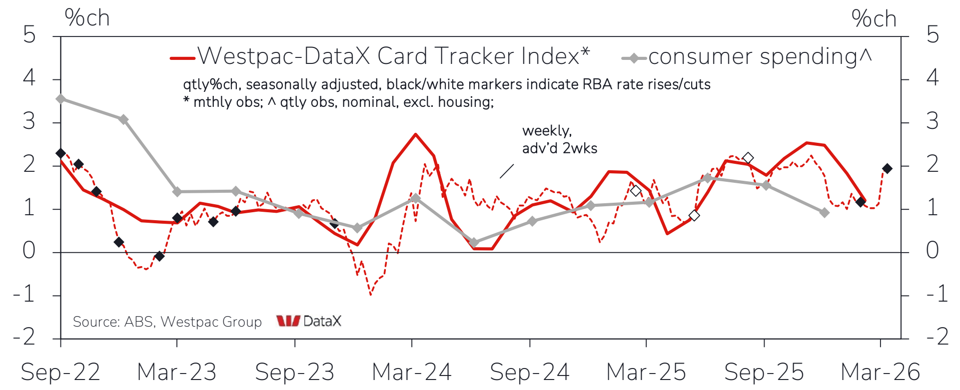
Underlying momentum slows

- Chart 2 shows how quarterly growth in the **Westpac-DataX Card Tracker Index** compares to growth in nominal consumption as reported in the quarterly national accounts. Note that all estimates are adjusted for regular seasonal variations.
- As noted, quarterly growth momentum has ticked up over the last two weeks due to a mix of weekly volatility and increased fuel spend. At 1.9%qtr, the latest weekly pace has lifted from the 1.0%qtr seen late last year but still off the 2-2.5% growth rates recorded in Q4 and through much of last year. Fuel accounts for about 0.25ppts of the latest up-tick.
- Monthly measures are likely giving a more accurate picture of momentum shifts at the moment. These have shown a very clear moderation, activity rising just 0.3% in December, 0.4% in January and 0.1% in February. While the latest weekly pulse is running at 0.6%mth, all of this is coming from a sharp lift in fuel activity with non-fuel activity dipping by 0.2%mth.
- As discussed in our last report, the Q4 national accounts showed nominal consumer spend (ex housing) up just 0.9%qtr undershooting the signal from our card data. The difference partly related to electricity rebates which will become a positive in Q1. Our card data is tracking a 1-1.5%qtr rise for Q1.

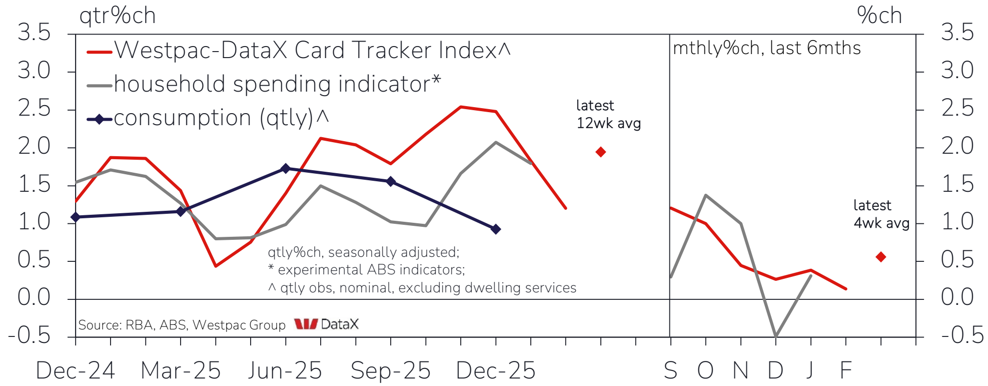
qtly%ch	Q2	Q3	Q4	latest
Westpac–DataX Card Tracker	**1.4**	**1.8**	**2.5**	**1.9**
ABS monthly household spending indicator*				
Nominal	1.0	1.0	2.1	n.a.
Real*	1.0	0.1	0.9	n.a.
ABS consumer spending (qtly)#				
Nominal	1.7	1.6	0.9	n.a.
Real	1.2	0.6	0.2	n.a.

All series seasonally adjusted. Latest is either the latest weekly obs (12wks %ch on previous 12wks) or latest monthly obs (3mths %ch on previous 3mths). See p11 for more details.
* ABS monthly household spending indicator based on domestic card transaction and new vehicle sales data. Real estimates are quarterly.
# Consumer spending excludes housing costs.
Sources: ABS, Westpac Group

2. Card activity and spending: growth momentum



3. Consumer spending: selected indicators



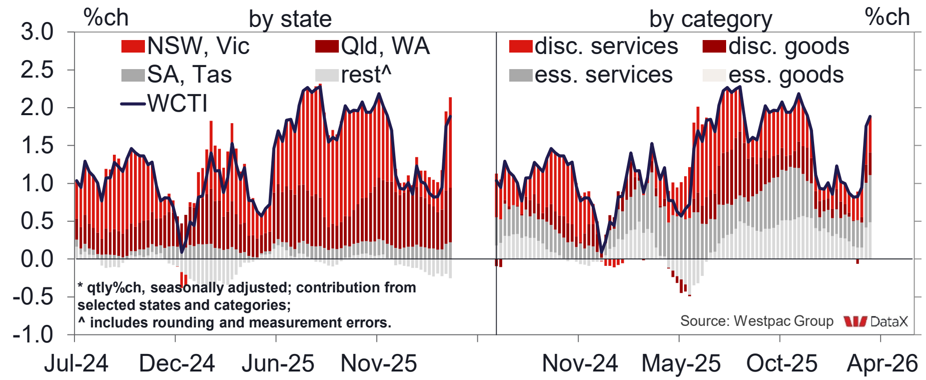
Fuel surges, discretionary services slows, rest mixed

- Chart 4 shows the category and state contributions to quarterly growth in domestic card activity week-to-week (i.e. excluding international transactions).
- The quarterly growth pulse has shown a broad lift across states and categories, reflecting the common factors of weekly Christmas-related noise affecting the base for comparison and surging fuel spend. In quarterly terms, essentials growth has lifted to 2.3%qtr, while discretionary spend has firmed to 1.5%qtr. By state, Tas continues to lead (+3.5%qtr) with WA (2.8%qtr) and SA (2.3%qtr) also tracking slightly firmer, NSW (2.1%qtr) more in line while Vic (1.8%qtr) is slightly softer.
- Chart 5 shows quarterly growth in card spending broken into four groups: fuel, hospitality, other domestic and international. Markers show the quarterly pace based on the last four weeks, three of which follow the outbreak of conflict in the Middle East.
- The material lift in fuel spend is clear, this segment currently tracking towards a 4%qtr pace. As detailed on p6 the rise is coming from both prices and volumes. Across other categories, there has been a significant moderation in international transactions and accommodation, hospitality and recreational spend. Other domestic activity has also slowed a touch. The charts on p8 given more detail.

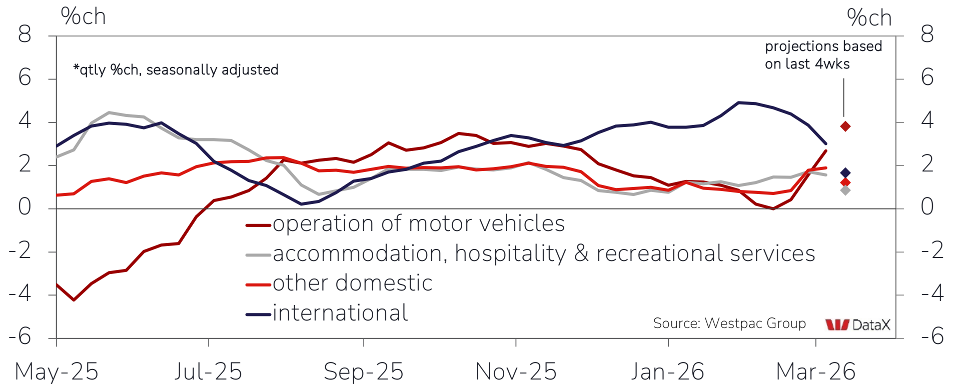
	Dec	Jan	Feb	21/3
Westpac–DataX Card Tracker	**154.0**	**154.6**	**154.8**	**153.6**
By category				
– discretionary*	156.1	156.4	156.0	153.8
– essential*	148.4	149.3	149.6	152.5
By state				
– NSW	148.2	148.2	147.5	149.0
– Vic	145.2	145.2	144.8	146.1
– Qld	169.3	167.9	165.7	167.5
– WA	169.0	169.5	170.6	170.3
– SA	161.5	160.5	159.9	164.2

All indexes based on the value of spending–related transactions, seasonally adjusted, 2019 avg=100, see p11 for more details including classifications.
* indexes revised due to re-classification.
Sources: ABS, Westpac Group

4. Card activity: contribution by state, broad category



5. Card activity: fuel, hospitality, international vs rest

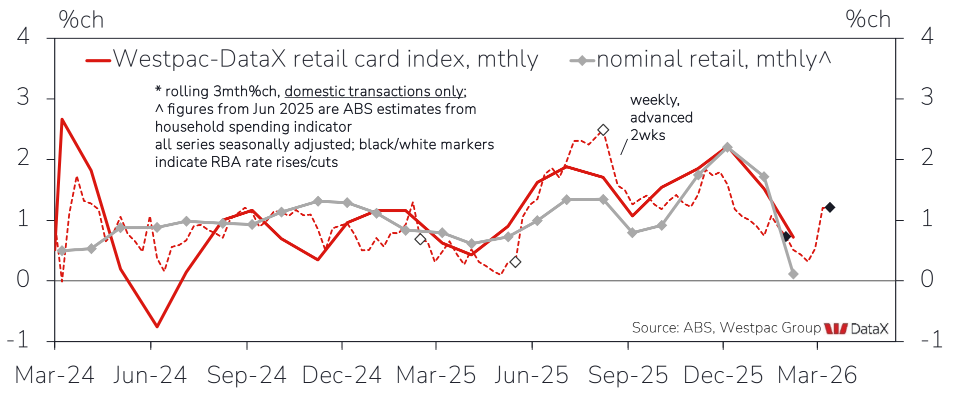


Retail still lagging and sensitive to non-fuel slowing

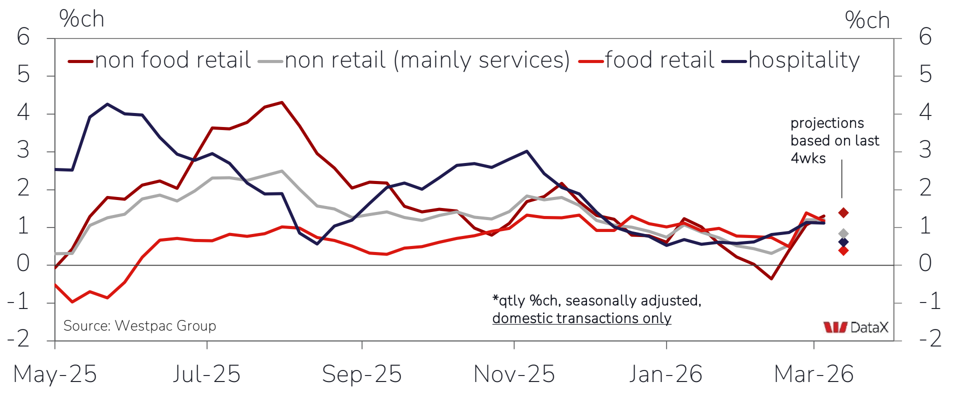
- Our MHSI and retail card indexes are composites based on transactions in categories that are in scope for the ABS monthly household spending indicator and ABS retail sales surveys (based on MHSI) respectively.
- Both the MHSI and retail card indexes have seen a lift in quarterly growth momentum in line with the lift in total card activity but with the pace of growth a touch softer. The MHSI card index is running at 1.6%qtr, 7.3%yr while the retail card index is growing at 1.2%qtr, 6.4%yr. That compares to WCTI growth of 1.9%qtr, 7.3%yr.
- The sub-category split shows a re-convergence in quarterly growth, food, hospitality and non-food retail all in the 1.1-1.3%qtr range. Annual growth is more varied, ranging from 3.3%yr for food retail to 8%yr for non-food retail and 9.3%yr for hospitality. Non-retail card activity (including fuel) is tracking at 2.6%qtr, 11%yr. All retail sub-categories have slowed over the last four weeks.
- The ABS monthly household spending indicator for January came in at 0.3%mth with quarterly growth slowing a touch to 1.8%qtr, 5%yr (see here). The February update will be released on Apr 7.

	Dec	Jan	Feb	21/3
MHSI card index	**150.5**	**150.9**	**150.6**	**151.3**
– qtly%ch	2.2	1.6	0.8	1.6
– qtly, ann%ch	6.0	5.6	5.5	6.1
ABS MHSI				
– %ch	-0.5	0.3	n.a.	n.a.
– qtly%ch	2.1	1.8	n.a.	n.a.
– qtly ann%ch	5.4	5.0	n.a.	n.a.
Retail card index	**150.9**	**151.1**	**150.7**	**149.9**
– qtly%ch	2.2	1.5	0.7	1.2
– qtly, ann%ch	5.6	5.5	5.3	5.7
ABS retail sales*				
– %ch	-1.5	0.4	n.a.	n.a.
– qtly%ch	2.2	1.7	n.a.	n.a.
– qtly ann%ch	4.9	4.7	n.a.	n.a.

6. Card activity: retail



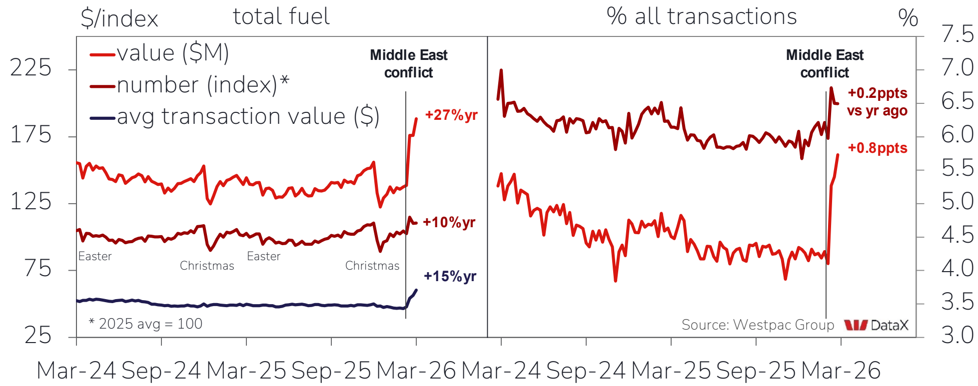
7. Card activity: broad retail and non-retail groups



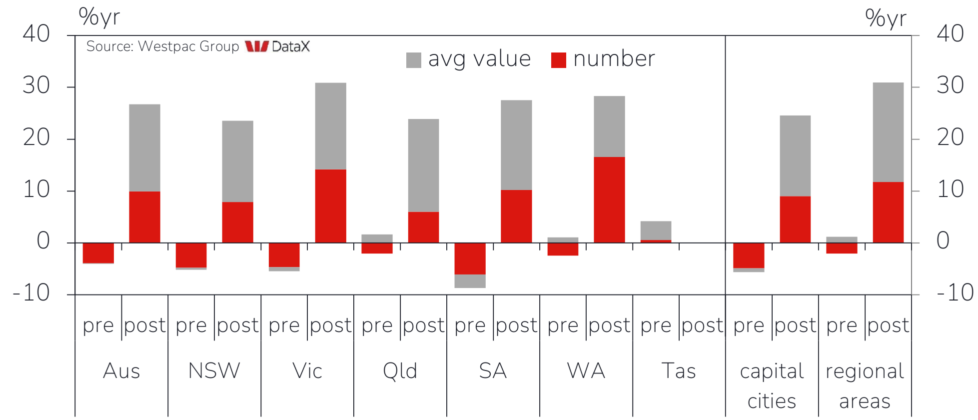
Middle East energy shock: fuel spending patterns in detail

- Westpac data provides a near real-time view of how the global energy shock is unfolding across the economy. As well as the weekly card activity presented in this report, daily activity and customer-level measures provide valuable insight into both behavioural shifts and cost and price effects. This section takes a closer look at recent trends. To date, the main theme has been a sharp rise in retail fuel costs and a rush in demand as buyers seek to secure fuel ahead of further price rises and potential supply shortages. It should be noted that this is occurring before actual physical supplies have seen any drop off.
- Chart 8 shows card activity across a sub-set of the 'operation of motor vehicles' category referred to elsewhere in this report, that is more specifically capturing activity across petrol stations. The left panel tracks the total value of transactions, the number of transactions and the implied average value. Note that the average value will broadly track pump prices but is also affected by shifts in average litres purchases, the fuel mix (diesel vs petrol) and non-fuel purchases.
- All have spiked sharply since the onset of the Middle East conflict, transaction values up 27%yr, numbers up 10%yr and average transaction value up 15%yr.
- The increase in average transaction value compares to a 21.5%yr increase in average terminal gate prices for fuel (weighted average of petrol and diesel).
- Fuel has been accounting for around 6.5-7% of all transactions by number and 5.3-5.7% by value – up 0.2ppts and 0.8ppts compared to a year ago.
- It should be noted that annual changes are likely understating the rise slightly as growth was running negatively prior to the shock (–3.9%yr in value terms).
- The more granular information shows: March 3 was a clear peak for purchase volumes in most jurisdictions; that the main change for individual purchases has been an increase in average fill size rather than frequency but with around 200k purchases per week in March coming from cardholders that did not purchase fuel in February. There has also been a significantly bigger ~30%yr lift in the volume of large purchases (>$150).
- Chart 9 shows how annual growth in card activity pre and post-crisis varies across state and across capital city and regional areas combined. Charts 10 and 11 on the next page provides the post-crisis growth at a local area level for major cities and regions.

8. Card activity: fuel

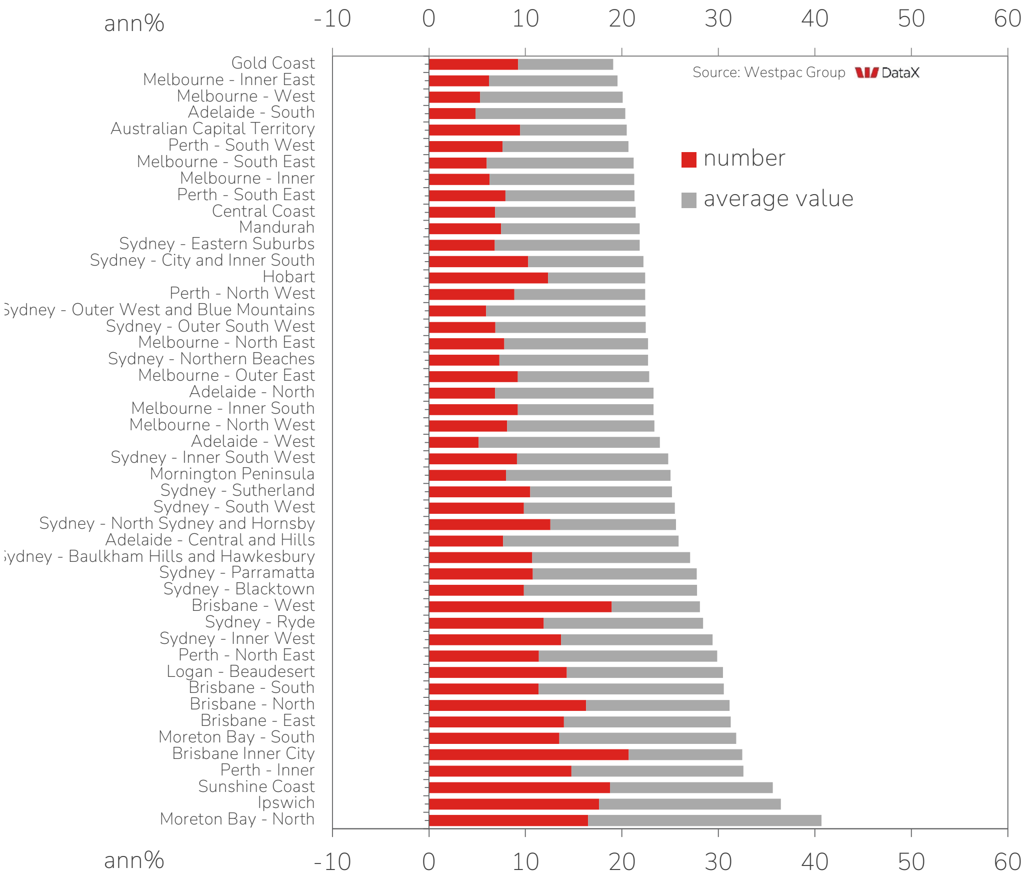


9. Card activity: fuel by state, capital city vs regional

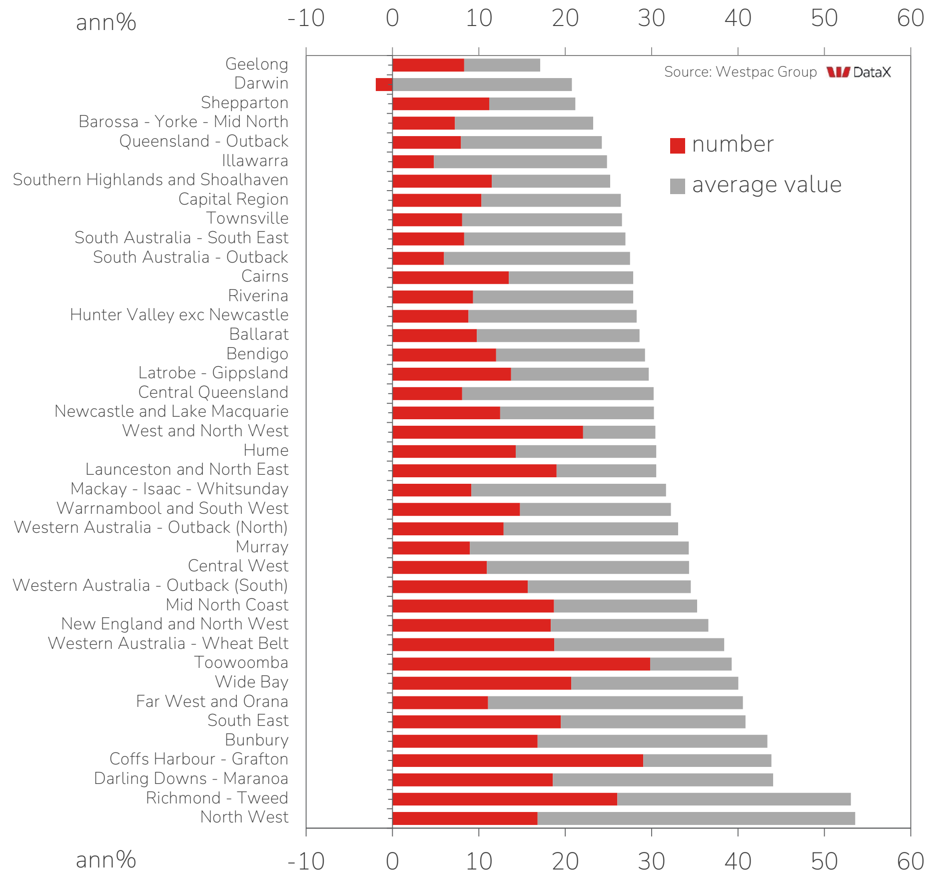


Card transactions: regional detail

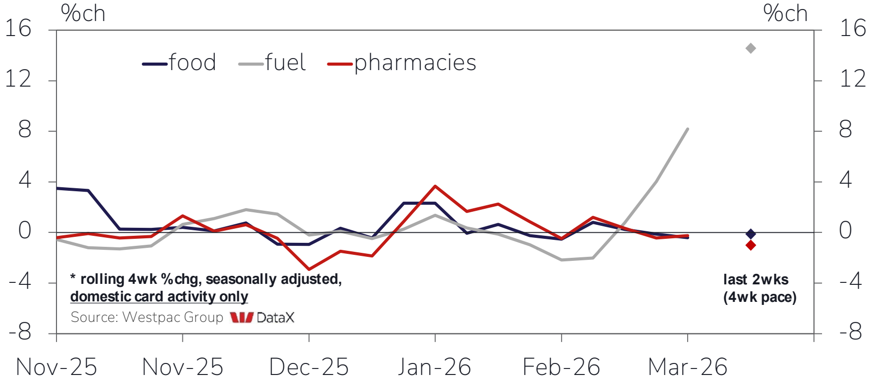
10. Card activity: fuel by local area, capital cities



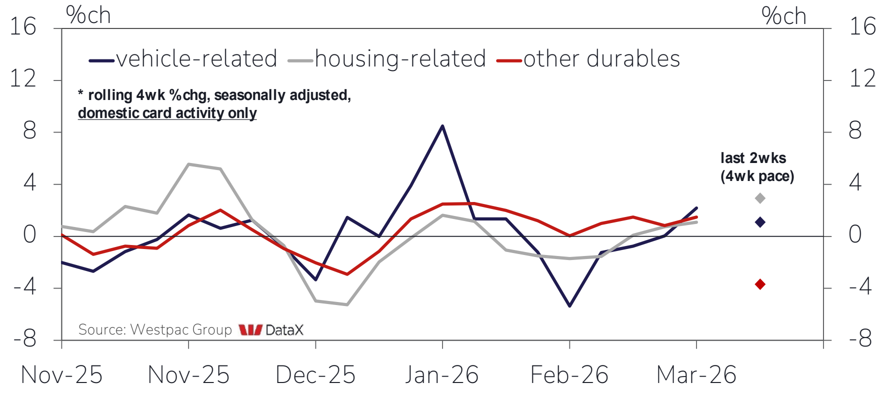
11. Card activity: fuel by local area, rest of Australia



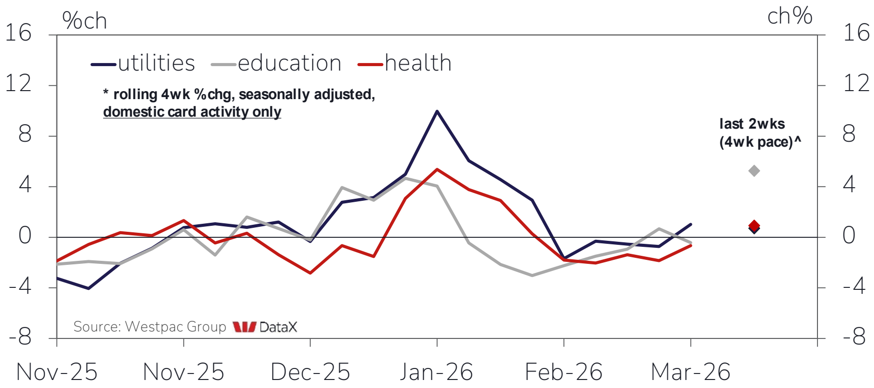
12. Card activity: essential goods



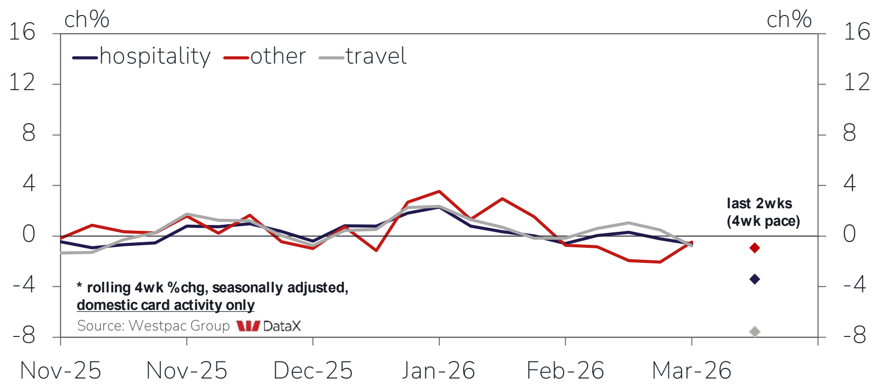
13. Card activity: discretionary goods



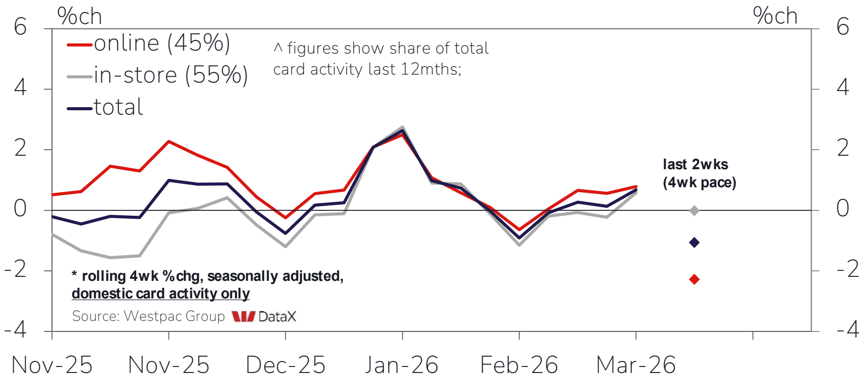
14. Card activity: essential services



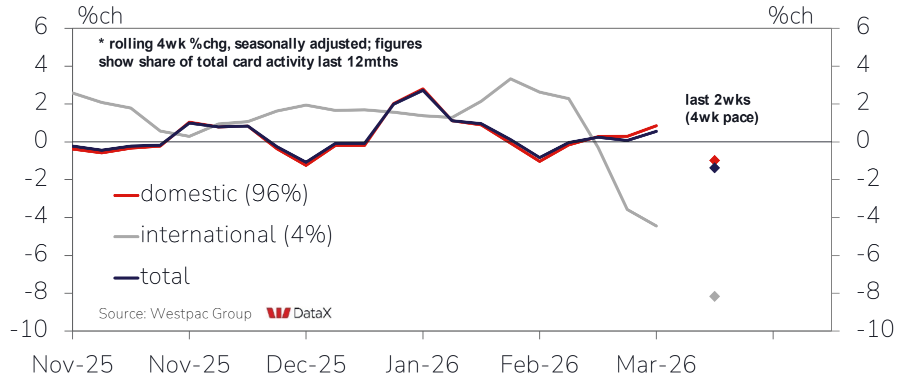
15. Card activity: discretionary services



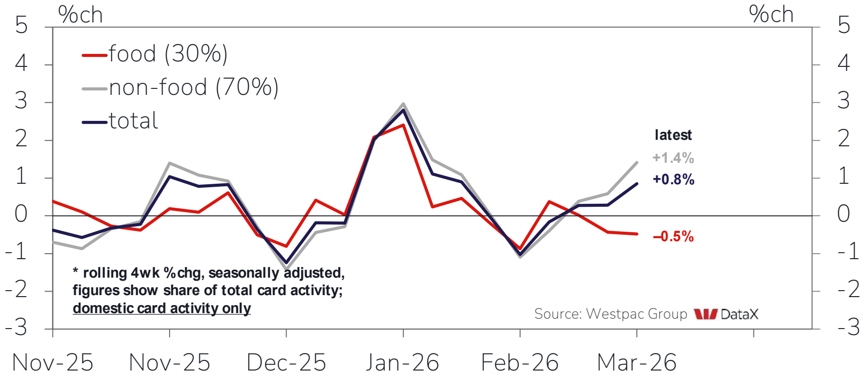
16. Card activity: online and in-store



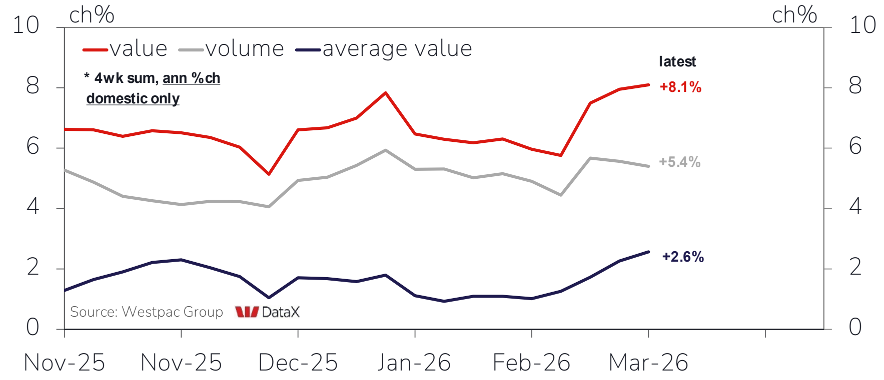
17. Card activity: domestic and international



18. Card activity: food and non-food



19. Card activity: value and volume



	2024				2025					2026		week ending:			
	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Dec	Jan	Feb	28/2	7/3	14/3	21/3
Westpac–DataX Card Tracker Index	**139.6**	**139.7**	**141.3**	**143.1**	**145.1**	**147.2**	**149.8**	**153.5**	**154.0**	**154.6**	**154.8**	**154.0**	**156.7**	**154.9**	**153.6**
qtly%ch	2.7	0.1	1.1	1.3	1.4	1.4	1.8	2.5	2.5	1.8	1.2	1.0	1.1	1.9	1.9
qtly, ann%ch	5.0	4.1	4.1	5.3	4.0	5.3	6.1	7.3	7.3	6.7	6.7	6.7	7.2	7.6	7.3
By category															
– discretionary^	141.8	141.1	143.3	145.7	146.4	149.1	151.2	155.5	156.1	156.4	156.0	156.0	157.7	154.7	153.8
– essential^	136.2	137.5	138.0	138.6	141.6	143.1	146.1	148.4	148.4	149.3	149.6	149.9	154.1	153.7	152.5
services	143.6	145.1	147.7	150.5	153.4	156.1	160.1	164.1	164.9	165.9	167.0	165.7	168.1	165.0	163.1
– discretionary services^	148.1	147.3	151.1	154.7	155.4	158.3	161.2	166.4	167.6	167.9	168.6	167.1	168.5	165.2	163.2
– essential services^	137.2	141.8	142.9	144.6	150.5	152.8	158.4	160.9	160.9	162.9	164.8	163.8	167.5	164.8	162.8
goods	135.4	134.6	134.9	135.3	136.4	137.9	139.3	141.9	142.0	142.2	141.1	142.4	145.8	145.2	145.0
– discretionary goods	134.9	134.2	134.7	135.8	136.6	139.0	140.3	143.6	143.6	143.9	142.4	143.9	146.0	143.3	143.6
– essential goods	135.8	134.9	135.1	134.9	136.1	137.0	138.4	140.5	140.6	140.7	140.0	141.1	145.7	146.7	146.2
MHSI card index*	139.1	138.9	140.3	141.7	142.9	144.9	147.0	150.2	150.5	150.9	150.6	151.3	153.8	152.1	151.3
qtly%ch	2.7	–0.2	1.0	1.0	0.8	1.4	1.4	2.2	2.2	1.6	0.8	0.6	0.8	1.5	1.6
qtly, ann%ch	4.0	3.5	3.6	4.7	2.8	4.4	4.8	6.0	6.0	5.6	5.5	5.4	6.0	6.3	6.1
retail card index*	140.7	139.6	141.2	142.6	143.5	145.8	147.4	150.6	150.9	151.1	150.7	151.1	152.8	151.0	149.9
qtly%ch	2.7	–0.8	1.2	1.0	0.6	1.6	1.1	2.2	2.2	1.5	0.7	0.3	0.5	1.2	1.2
qtly, ann%ch	3.3	2.5	3.0	4.1	2.0	4.4	4.3	5.6	5.6	5.5	5.3	5.1	5.6	5.9	5.7
By state															
– NSW	135.0	136.0	136.7	137.8	139.9	142.8	144.0	147.8	148.2	148.2	147.5	150.1	150.5	149.7	149.0
– Vic	135.0	134.9	135.1	136.4	138.2	139.9	141.9	144.8	145.2	145.2	144.8	144.9	146.3	146.8	146.1
– Qld	148.5	148.9	151.3	153.3	154.7	158.9	162.5	168.0	169.3	167.9	165.7	168.5	178.4	167.4	167.5
– WA	145.7	148.5	151.3	153.6	157.1	159.5	163.2	167.8	169.0	169.5	170.6	171.7	173.8	175.2	170.3
– SA	145.5	147.2	148.0	149.8	151.9	154.5	157.0	160.5	161.5	160.5	159.9	162.8	164.7	166.4	164.2

All indexes based on the value of spending–related transactions, seasonally adjusted by Westpac, 2019 avg=100. See p11 for more details.
* composite based on transactions in categories in scope for ABS monthly spending indicator and ABS retail sales surveys respectively.
^ indexes revised due to re–classification.
Group

Sources: ABS, Westpac

About the Westpac card data indicators

The indicators presented in this report are based on the millions of credit and debit card transactions processed every day. Transactions covering over ten million merchants are classified into over 700 categories. These are in turn grouped into higher level aggregates that provide a timely guide to wider economic trends.

The main focus of these indicators is consumer spending. Where possible, we have sought to exclude 'non spending' transactions such as: money transfers; tax payments; loan repayments; charitable donations; and superannuation contributions.

It should also be noted that these indicators will also be affected by shifts between card and non card transactions. This was a significant factor during the COVID–19 pandemic – health concerns about the use of physical cash leading to significantly higher use of cards vs cash, particularly where contact–less transactions are available. Transaction flows also include reversals/refunds which were also a significant phenomenon during the onset of COVID, especially in areas such as travel.

All transaction data is compiled at a highly aggregated level so that individual customer or merchant data is never revealed.

Index construction

The key metrics used in this report are indexes of spending–related card activity where the base of 100 is average activity in 2019. As an example, if transaction flows are 5% above their average level in 2019, the index read for the period is 105. If flows in a subsequent period are 8% above the average level in 2019, the index read for this period is 108. Growth between the two periods can be calculated simply as the change between the two index reads, i.e. 2.9%.

All measures are adjusted for regular seasonality. Weekly estimates are generated using the US Bureau of Labor's MoveReg weekly seasonal adjustment program. Note that in some cases, high levels of volatility during the COVID mean it is not possible to produce seasonally adjusted estimates for some historical periods.

Also, note that previous versions of this report used different approaches to seasonal adjustment and measurement more generally. This means Index reads are sometimes not directly comparable. See the 'About the Westpac card data indicators' sections from earlier reports to more detail.

Classifications

Note that the measures used for card data and in this report do not align completely with the those used in official ABS statistics, including the ABS household spending indicator, ABS retail trade survey and ABS estimate of consumer spending published in the national accounts. There are a range of differences including around both coverage and classification. As such, the card data should be treated as broadly indicative.

The transaction data is grouped into 26 categories that are then combined into four main as follows:

Discretionary goods: alcoholic beverages, tobacco, clothing & footwear, furnishings & household equipment, household appliances, vehicle–related, recreational & cultural goods, newspaper, books & stationery, and other personal effects.

Discretionary services: transport services (part), recreational & cultural services, gambling, catering services, accommodation services, other personal care, insurance & financial services, other services.

Essential goods: food & non alcoholic beverages, medical products, appliances & equipment, and operation of personal transport equipment.

Essential services: electricity, gas & other fuels, health services, transport services (part), communications and education.

The report also uses two additional classifications:

MHSI/Retail: based on the extent to which categories cover activity that is in scope for the ABS monthly household spending indicator and ABS retail trade survey.

Corporate directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro-Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clark@westpac.co.nz

DISCLAIMER

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.

Week beginning 30 March 2026

AUSTRALIA & NEW ZEALAND WEEKLY

Analysis and forecasts for this week's key releases.

In this week's edition:

Economic Insight: The epic blunder of fighting the last war.

The Week That Was: A fork in the road.

Focus on New Zealand: Inflation up, growth down, OCR on hold?

Forecast Update: our new baseline incorporates a 2-month closure of the Strait of Hormuz.

For the week ahead:

Australia: RBA Minutes, private credit, dwelling approvals, goods trade balance, job vacancies.

New Zealand: employment indicator, business confidence, building permits.

Japan: CPI, jobless rate, industrial production, manufacturers index.

China: NBS PMIs.

Euro area: HICP inflation, unemployment rate.

United States: non-farm payrolls, unemployment rate, ISMs, retail sales, Conf. Board consumer confidence.

Global: Good Friday.

Information contained in this report current as at 27 March 2026.

The epic blunder of fighting the last war

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist, Westpac Group

- **The Middle East conflict and the resulting fuel crisis are not the same as previous crises and should not require COVID-style policy responses such as work-from-home mandates. Governments and other decision-makers need to avoid the temptation to "fight the last war". Nor should they fall into the trap of "we must do something, and this is something", when that something is ill-suited to the current problem.**
- **The focus should instead be on the key issue for the world economy: how the conflict maps into energy-supply disruption via the closure of the Strait of Hormuz and/or damage to oil and gas infrastructure in other Gulf states. Time is almost up on our initial assumption that the Strait would be closed for about a month, so we have updated our baseline forecast to reflect this. But the Strait is a time-limited source of leverage for Iran. At some point, third-party countries will respond to the damage being done to them; already some tankers are being allowed through.**
- **This is a significant shock to the economy and a challenging situation for public policy. For the next few weeks, though, the appropriate monetary policy response is "wait and see". The current crisis is not (yet) a financial crisis or a pandemic requiring immediate, potentially out-of-cycle, action. And conditions could be quite different in a month's time. Domestic conditions will continue to shape the RBA's decisions at its regular meetings.**

"Fighting the last war" is a common cognitive trap: trying to make a current crisis fit a past one. We saw attempts to make COVID fit the GFC template by expecting borrower distress despite massive fiscal support and, in some quarters, to make the AI boom fit the COVID template of sudden mass job losses, at least in the US.

The current conflict in the Middle East is producing plenty of examples of this behaviour, again misguided. The US/Israel attack has not gone the same way as the US intervention in Venezuela, nor are the implications like those of Russia's invasion of Ukraine. The geographic pinch-point of the Strait of Hormuz shapes both the energy-price implications and the military ones. The context also differs significantly: the world is not emerging from a pandemic, with macroeconomic policy highly expansionary and other supply chains already disrupted.

The domestic context in Australia also differs in important ways, particularly the ceiling on east coast wholesale gas prices introduced after the 2022 episode. We are also four years further along with solar and battery installation. These changes mean that, for Australia, this is mostly an issue of fuel prices and availability, rather than electricity (as in 2022–23).

In addition, the current conflict bears little resemblance to the COVID pandemic, so policy responses should differ. We were surprised that work-from-home mandates have been seriously proposed. A fuel shortage is not a respiratory virus, and there is no reason to prevent or discourage workers from attending their workplace if they commute by foot, bicycle or public transport. Better responses would be to expand public transport coverage and frequency, encourage carpooling (including more extensive transit lanes), and cancel non-essential government travel. Only if those policies fail, or fuel shortages become so extreme that critical workers need to be prioritised, would WFH become an appropriate response.

Likewise, businesses are not facing a sudden loss of income as the community goes into lockdown. Income support measures should therefore be much more targeted, if they are needed at all.

The main similarity to the pandemic is stockpiling, as people fear downstream supply disruptions. Policy responses to address this make more sense than mandating work-from-home. Options include publicising the restocking of petrol stations that had run out of some fuels, as well as measures already taken such as temporary changes to fuel standards and the oil-for-gas supply deal with Singapore.

A kinetic war between US/Israel and Iran could drag on without necessarily having its current dramatic impact on global energy markets. For the rest of the world, the key issues are closure of the Strait of Hormuz and actual or threatened damage to gas and other civilian infrastructure in non-combatant Gulf states. But closure of the Strait is a time-limited source of leverage for Iran. At some point, third-party countries will respond to the damage being done to them; already some tankers are being allowed through.

The immediate issue for the global and Australian economies is fuel availability. Higher prices will curb demand, but periods of localised unavailability will be especially disruptive.

The implications for macroeconomic policy depend on the broader effects on inflation and growth. The RBA was already hiking rates ahead of the outbreak of the conflict. Demand growth had picked up a little more sharply than they, or we, had expected. And with the economy no longer running with significant spare capacity as in the 2010s, even small upside demand or downside supply shocks show up in prices rather than being absorbed. More frequent policy adjustments should therefore be expected.

As highlighted by the RBA's counterparts at the RBNZ, policymakers should ordinarily try to look through the first-round, fuel-specific impacts on inflation from a shock like this. Second-round effects such as higher transport and materials costs flowing through to other prices may, however, require a response. A lift in inflation expectations is also a watch point. But if the supply-disruption element of the conflict fades over the next month or so, these effects will also be short-lived. While the update to our baseline forecast is more severe than this, the risks around it are two-sided. It will therefore pay to wait to see which scenario plays out ahead of the May meeting. A May rate hike is still on the cards for pre-existing domestic reasons, but pre-judging the second-round effects on inflation, and the need for any hikes beyond the next one, is a much less secure strategy.

In particular, we do not expect an out-of-cycle RBA decision. These are rare: the last one was in March 2020, just ahead of lockdown, and the one before that was in 1997, both to cut rates. Even during the GFC, there were no out-of-cycle policy decisions. The decision tree facing the RBA also does not require one. May seems a long way away, but by then either things will have de-escalated, or the war will have escalated, drawn in Gulf states and worsened energy supply. De-escalation would see some of the inflationary shock soon moderate, weakening the case for further policy tightening. Escalation would be an even larger negative shock to global growth than we are already facing, but also inflationary. With the Board already split on the need to hike expeditiously, we see neither the need, nor the appetite, to bring forward that decision in either scenario. This is not COVID, and we do not expect policymakers to act like it is.

Forecast changes

- **The US/Israel–Iran conflict is likely to result in a more prolonged disruption to energy production in the Middle East and shipping through the Strait of Hormuz than we previously assumed.**
- **We have therefore revised our baseline forecast to assume an eight-week closure of the Strait of Hormuz and a slower recovery, compared with the previous assumption of a one-month closure and one month of recovery. Shipping traffic through the Strait is assumed to be closer to 20% of normal in May, with a gradual return to normal by year end.**
- **Oil is now expected to average US$120/bbl (Brent) in Q2, from $90/bbl previously. It is expected to remain $13 higher even by the end of the year. Japanese LNG prices are expected to peak at a quarterly average of US$26mmbtu over the next few quarters.**
- **We have also made more allowance for wider refinery margins and downstream flow-on from transport and fertiliser costs into prices, especially food prices, as well as some moderate second-round effects including wages. We continue to assess that there will be minimal impact on Australia's domestic electricity prices.**
- **For Australia, headline inflation peaks at 5.5% in 2026 Q2. Trimmed mean inflation is less affected but still peaks at 4% by end 2026.**
- **At 1.4%, GDP growth over 2026 is more than 1ppt weaker relative to pre-war forecast and 0.6ppts weaker than our March Market Outlook base case. The unemployment rate is also higher in the second half of 2026, reaching 4.7% in Q4.**
- **There have been no changes to our forecasts for interest rates and exchange rates.**
- **There are risks on both sides of this base case, depending on the progress of negotiations between US/Israel and Iran, the status of the Strait of Hormuz and whether there is further damage to energy infrastructure.**
- **Additional detail on our revised base case forecasts will be released on Monday.**

Cliff Notes: a fork in the road

Elliot Clarke, Head of International Economics
Ryan Wells, Economist

In Australia, February's CPI came in slightly below expectations, headline inflation ticking down to 3.7%yr from 3.8%yr, while trimmed mean inflation held steady at 3.3%yr. Constructive elements of the detail included: dwelling purchases posting its smallest increase in ten months; a below-expectations annual increase in education prices; and lower childcare costs, the result of increased take-up of the Childcare Subsidy following the introduction of the three-day guarantee. There were also a couple of upside surprises, however, most notable were clothing and some food-related categories. The impact from electricity rebates has also now abated, bringing reported electricity prices back into line with actual prices.

The net result is that the inflationary pulse Australia was experiencing prior to the current surge in fuel prices was marginally softer than expected. While fuel will undoubtedly boost headline inflation from March, the trimmed mean pulse is likely to hold above but near the top of the target range through 2026. For a detailed view of how each state's economy is positioned to weather coming headwinds, see our latest Coast-to-Coast report.

The Q1 Westpac-ACCI Survey of Industrial Trends meanwhile showed that the long-awaited improvement in manufacturing conditions is finally materialising, the Actual Composite rising to 59.3 – a strong expansionary read. Underpinning the move was a surge in output growth, another solid lift in new orders and, encouragingly, a rise in employment and overtime. Note though, this survey was largely completed before the onset of the Middle East conflict. Australian manufacturing's acute exposure to fuel and energy costs is likely to see a partial reversal in Q2 and a degree of apprehension over the outlook.

"the trimmed mean pulse is likely to hold above but near the top of the target range through 2026"

Offshore, data released was inconsequential. The preliminary March S&P Global PMIs for the major advanced economies unsurprisingly pointed to softer momentum and heightened inflationary pressures in the initial weeks of the Middle East conflict. FOMC members Bowman and Waller meanwhile were focused more on labour market weakness than inflation, though they felt it prudent to wait-a-while to assess the implications of the current conflict for price risks.

Regarding the state of the Middle East conflict, equity markets took solace in news the White House had been involved in initial intermediated discussions over the path to a ceasefire, although uncertainty over who in Iran's leadership will take the lead in any formal negotiations has kept participants guessing on both the timing and potential success of these initiatives. The overnight extension of the 5-day reprieve for Iranian energy infrastructure by President Trump to 10 days is a positive step towards fruitful negotiations, however.

Iran's military actions have also been relatively contained this week, and safe passage through the Strait of Hormuz has been provided to several ships, consistent with prior communications from Iranian officials that ships operated by countries not involved in the conflict are free to transit if Iran's conditions are met. It is not clear if this includes a payment of up to US$2 million per shipment as previously telegraphed. If Iranian authorities hold to this guidance, China's fleet and vessels from other non-aligned countries such as Malaysia (a key supplier to Australia who reportedly reached an agreement with Iran overnight) could slowly reduce the current global deficiency in crude and LNG supply, even if the US/Israel and Iran continue military actions against one another. The key risk remains the intentional, or unintentional, destruction of production and/or logistics facilities, turning a temporary loss of supply into an enduring one. The duration of this conflict and lost supply matters a great deal to both the persistence of global consumer inflation and the policy outlook.

Inflation up, growth down, OCR on hold?

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ

As the war has drawn on and evidence of disruption to the NZ economy has accumulated, we have had another cut at estimating the impact on the economic outlook. The hit to growth and employment looks significant and inflation is set to move well above the top of the RBNZ's target range. The RBNZ noted an intention to try and look through the direct impacts of the shock. But there is significant uncertainty around the outlook so we should be humble around what we know now about how things will develop over the year ahead.

The Iran war is expected to significantly crimp the previously expected recovery.

The Iran war has not moderated in the last couple of weeks and in some sense the pressure on the New Zealand economy has intensified as early hopes of a fast resolution and quick return to global economic normality have waned. We can't say with any certainty when the conflict will end. But we now think it will be at least another month until we see tangible signs of an end to the war with the possibility of more normal service to the global oil markets returning.

Crude oil prices have remained volatile but refined fuels markets have continued to tighten as the flow of crude oil around the world has now been constrained for more than three weeks. Damage to infrastructure in the Persian Gulf has accumulated which means that even if the war ended tomorrow, the path to normality will take some time. As refined fuels spreads are wider and capacity at the Asian refineries where we and our trading partners access fuel has declined, pressure has built on the economic outlook.

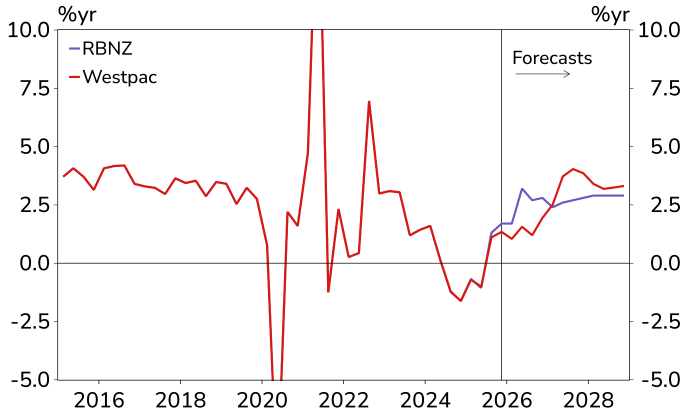
We continue to assume that the Iran war eases in around a month and that crude oil and refined fuels prices will gradually ease over the rest of 2026. Crude oil prices are expected to drop back to around pre-war levels by the start of 2027. However, refined fuels prices remain elevated compared to levels seen a few months ago as we expect some element of a war risk premium to remain, and damage to infrastructure may take time to repair. That means inflation in New Zealand will likely linger at elevated levels for much of this year.

We think that the Iran War will have damaged confidence in the household and business sectors and will be prompting changes in spending and investment plans given people have no real idea on when conditions will improve. We saw an early read on this with the monthly consumer confidence survey for March released today. This showed that consumer confidence dropped sharply over the month and currently likely sits some distance below the average level of confidence reported for the month overall.

We've pulled down our forecast for GDP growth over 2026 to 1.9% (from 2.8% previously). In the very near term, we've pencilled in a fall in quarterly GDP of 0.4% in the June quarter. That's mainly due to an expected drop in household spending in response to increases in living costs and related falls in consumer confidence. Those headwinds will not be significantly offset by the Government's support package targeting lower income households.

We also expect weakness in investment spending over the coming year, with some businesses likely to delay major capital spending in response to the increased uncertainty about the outlook for economic growth and the near-term downturn in demand that may be experienced in some industries. We will learn more about this when the NZIER QSBO is available on 21 April.

GDP growth forecasts



Source: RBNZ, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

The most direct impact of the shock on exports will be felt in the tourism sector, with the recent strong growth in international arrivals likely to be reversed for a period due to a combination of flight disruptions, much higher airfares and perhaps consumer reluctance to travel long distances. The economic impact will be partly mitigated by fewer New Zealanders choosing to holiday abroad. At this stage we have made no major changes to our forecasts for the volume of merchandise trade. As is usually the case in New Zealand, weaker global growth is likely to manifest mostly through lower prices, rather than lower volumes.

Growth is expected to pick up again next year as the eventual fall in oil prices boosts households' disposable incomes. However, the recovery in investment spending is expected to be more gradual, with businesses likely to remain cautious about major capital expenditure until they are confident that the recovery is entrenched.

We anticipate that the shock will put paid to the recovery in the labour market we had expected over 2026. We now expect unemployment will rise from 5.4% currently to 5.6% in the middle of this year, before easing back gradually. With a softer outlook for economic growth, businesses are likely to remain cautious about taking on new staff, and some firms may shed workers.

With weakness in activity and the jobs market, the overall level of wage inflation is expected to remain moderate in the near term (though some workers with specialised skills may be able to negotiate larger pay increases in response to the rise in living costs). Longer term, as the economy recovers, we are likely to see demands for larger cost-of-living adjustments to wages as workers try to claw back the loss in their purchasing power.

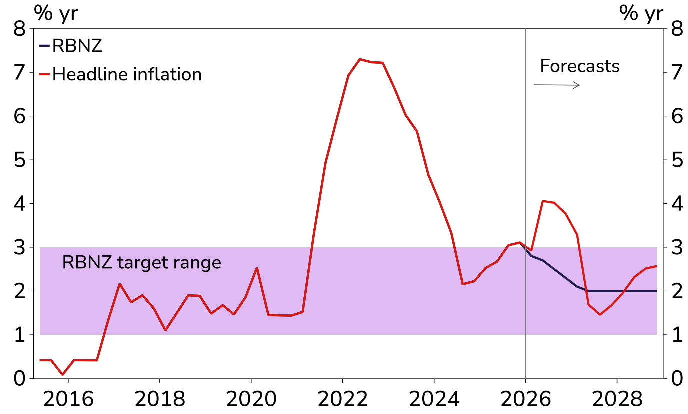
Another sector that won't likely see an improvement over 2026 now is the housing market. The hit to the household sector coming from the increase in fuel costs combined with the weaker labour market is likely to be a kick in the guts of a housing market that was already just treading water. We now expect house prices to fall around 1% over 2026 as buyers step back from the market. Further ahead, we expect a return to more moderate rates of house price growth.

Our revised economic outlook also has implications for the Government's fiscal position. As growth is expected to be weaker then so also will be government revenue. Spending is also likely to be higher than expected as unemployment rises. The Government's fuel package announced this week will have just a modest impact given the Government indicates that the roughly $370 m cost implied will fit within current operating allowances. The bottom line is that the OBEGALx deficit in 2026/27 is now likely to be around $4bn larger than we had forecast previously. A surplus might still be achievable in 2029/30, but the cumulative deficit over the forecast period would be around $7-8bn higher than forecast previously, with net core Crown debt peaking at around 46% of GDP. Treasury's forecasts are likely to be more pessimistic than our own with implications for the forecast bond programme.

There are consequential implications for the inflation outlook. We now expect that inflation will peak at 4.1% in mid-2026, and that it will remain above 3% through the first quarter of 2027. That is up sharply from our previous forecasts, which assumed a peak in inflation of around 3.2%. And importantly, inflation is set to remain well above the levels the RBNZ had previously assumed for all of 2026. Higher refined fuels costs are the key driver here. There are direct impacts on petrol and diesel costs, but also indirect impacts through a broad range of goods and services.

When oil prices do eventually drop back, inflation is expected to fall to levels that are lower than we previously assumed (a pattern that is often seen in the wake of oil price spikes). In our updated projections, inflation is expected to briefly dip below 2% in late-2027, before rising back up to around 2.3% further ahead.

CPI inflation forecasts



Source: RBNZ, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

The extent of the current uplift in inflation signals upside risk for inflation expectations and business price setting behaviour. In the near term, any uplift in output prices will be moderated by the softness in activity. However, when activity recovers, we expect some firms will attempt to rebuild margins, while workers are likely to ask for larger wage increases to offset the erosion of their purchasing power.

This leaves the question on how the RBNZ will respond to the significant change in circumstances. The RBNZ is "exquisitely skewered" between a much higher inflation outlook and the likelihood and increasing excess capacity amid weak growth.

Governor Breman released a speech this week discussing the framework the RBNZ expects to follow. Breman's emphasis was that policy would be focused on medium term inflation pressures, and that for now there's little evidence these have lifted by enough to justify near-term OCR hikes. Breman indicated that rate hikes will only be brought forward should there be an accumulation of evidence suggesting that the oil shock is generating second-round pressures on wages and prices, leading to higher inflation over the medium term. Those second-round effects – which are more likely to occur if the conflict is prolonged – are unlikely to be evident for some time.

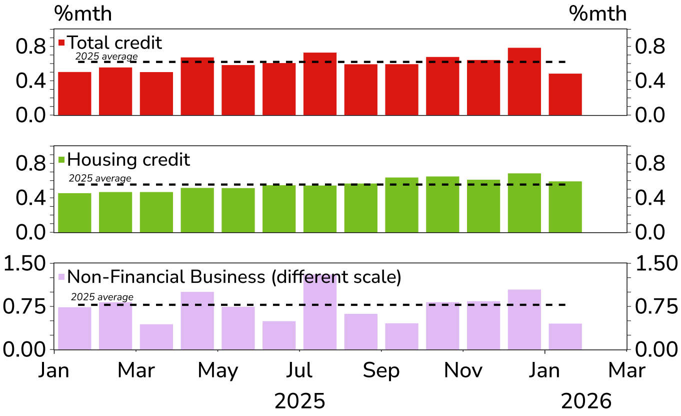
AUS: Feb Private Sector Credit (%mth)

Mar 31, Last: 0.5 Westpac f/c: 0.6
Mkt f/c: 0.6, Range: 0.2 to 0.7

Private sector credit growth reached 0.8%mth in December but eased to 0.5%mth in January, surprising to the downside as all major credit components reported weaker growth.

We expect growth to rebound to 0.6%mth in February – slightly below the average pace of 0.7%mth recorded in the second half of last year. The RBA cash rate increase in early February and weaker consumer sentiment at the start of the year are likely to affect credit flows with a lag. With house prices remaining firm, though somewhat lower than last year, credit growth should be supported for now. However, inflationary pressures and rising interest rate expectations from higher energy prices represent a downside risk for Q2 and beyond.

Private sector credit growth



Source: RBA, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

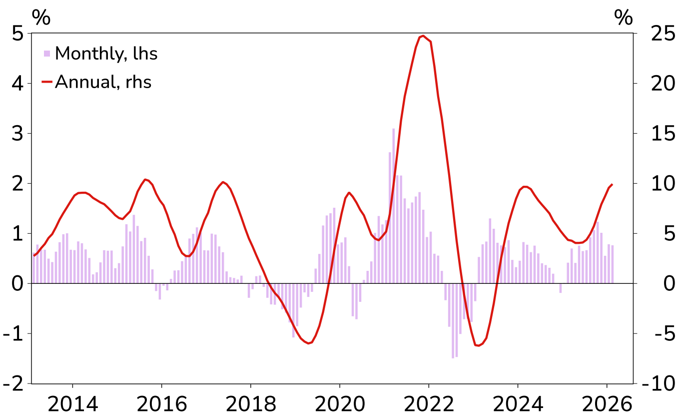
AUS: Mar Cotality Home Value Index (%mth)

Apr 1, Last: 0.6, Westpac f/c: 0.7

The Cotality home value index rose 0.6% in Feb following a 0.7%mth in Jan, a 0.4% rise in Dec and 0.9-1.2%mth gains through Aug-Nov. Despite the softer tone in recent months, annual growth still lifted, rising to 9.6%yr. The detail shows a significant slowing in price growth and a pull-back in turnover in the Sydney and Melbourne markets but a much more muted slowing effect in other markets.

The daily measure points to a similar 0.7% rise for the March month, the detail again showing softness in Sydney and Melbourne but robust gains in Brisbane, Adelaide and Perth. Weekly auction activity – which is only a meaningful guide to conditions in Sydney and Melbourne – suggests there has been a further weakening in these markets into month-end.

Cotality home value index



Source: Cotality Australia, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

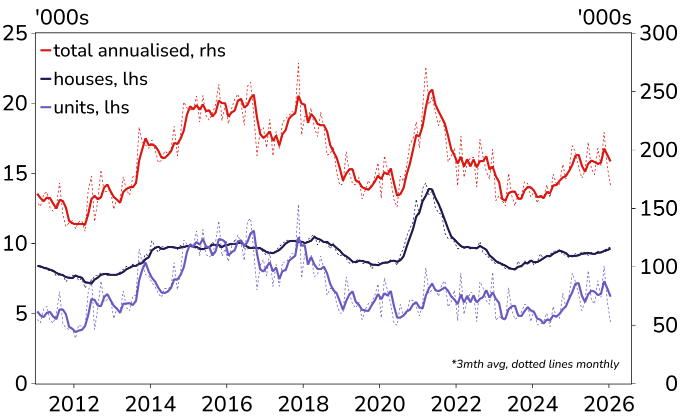
AUS: Feb Dwelling Approvals (%mth)

Apr 1, Last: –7.2, Westpac f/c: 5.0
Market f/c: 6.0, Range: -1.0 to 14.0

Dwelling approvals have been very choppy over the last six months, most recently falling 7.2% in Jan after a 14.9% drop in Dec unwound 15.9% jump in Nov, the swings driven by high rise. On a rolling 3mth avg basis, growth has slowed back to 0.9%qtr. As always, housing data needs to be treated with more caution over the December-January low period.

Feb is likely to see some 'pop' higher for headline approvals, with high rise approvals coming off an 18mth low. The segment can be very hard to predict but is generally slower to respond to cyclical shifts, suggesting what we have seen recently is more likely to be lumpiness-related noise than a response to the changed interest rate environment. On balance we expect a 5% rise in total approvals with upside risks if high rise returns to average level of the last two years.

Approvals ascent re-emerges



Source: ABS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

AUS: Q1 Job Vacancies (%qtr)

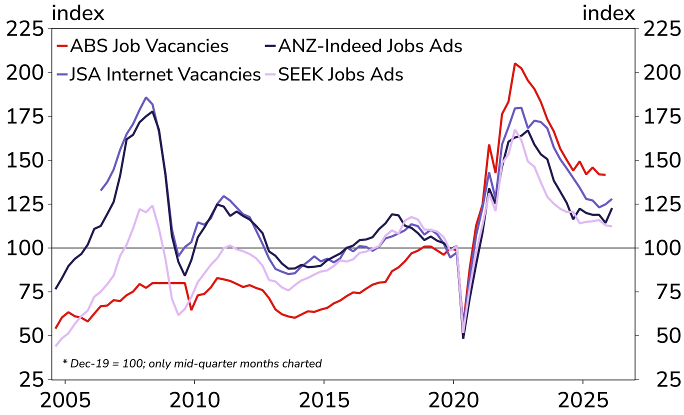
Apr 2, Last: –0.2, Westpac f/c: 3.0

Job vacancies fell by just –0.7k (–0.2%) between Aug and Nov, a smaller decline than expected. Over 2025, job vacancies have been broadly steady around 40% higher than pre-COVID levels.

While vacancies have been stable, the size of the labour force has continued to grow, seeing the vacancy rate nudge lower. The unemployment rate also gradually rose over last year. Overall, the labour market is operating around the Beveridge curve, suggesting the relationship between vacancies and unemployment is behaving broadly as expected.

Monthly partial indicators were on the stronger side in recent months, suggesting the official ABS stock measure of vacancies will likely bounce higher in Q1. We have pencilled in a lift of 3.0% for the quarter.

Partial indicators point to a lift in Q1



Source: ABS, Jobs & Skills Australia, ANZ-Indeed, SEEK Australia, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

---

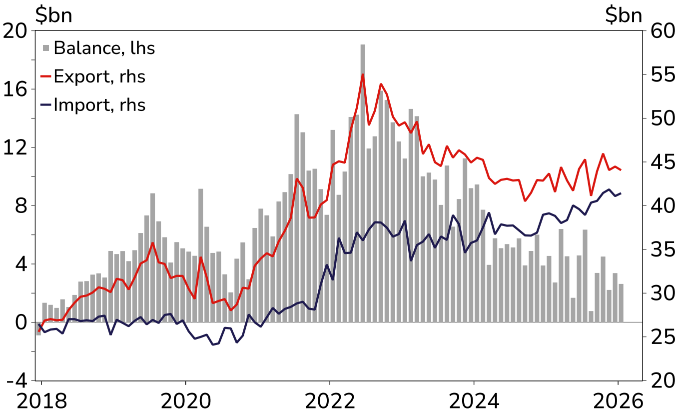
AUS: Feb Goods Trade Balance ($bn)

Apr 2, Last: 2.6, Westpac f/c: 1.5
Mkt f/c: 2.9 Range: 1.5 to 3.5

Lower exports and higher imports saw the monthly goods trade surplus narrow to $2.6bn in January. We expect this trend to continue in February – we forecast a further narrowing to $1.5bn.

Major commodities are likely to report lower exports, as adverse weather has disrupted production and shipments. Coal production in Queensland appears to have been particularly affected. Iron ore shipments are also likley to decline. Significant AUD appreciation is set to weigh on exports of other goods. On the imports side, January saw large monthly changes across major categories, but overall imports increased by a relatively modest 0.8%mth. We may see notable compositional shifts again, although total imports are expected to be only slightly lower.

Goods trade balance



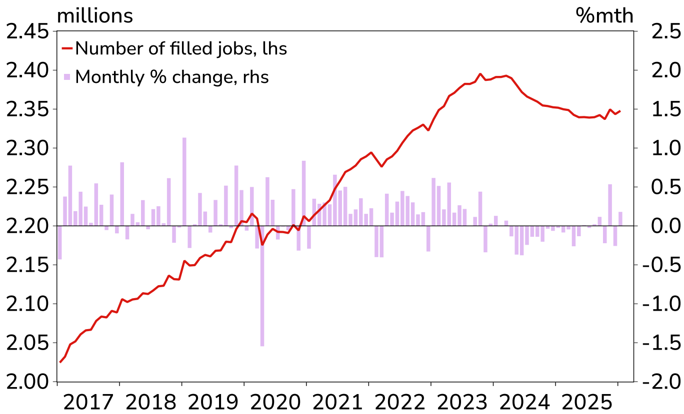
Source: ABS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

NZ: Feb Monthly Employment Indicator (%mth)

Mar 30, Last: 0.2, Westpac f/c: 0.6

The MEI is likely to add to the evidence that the New Zealand economy was regaining momentum prior to the Iran conflict. The weekly snapshots provided by Stats NZ are now running slightly higher than a year earlier, having been down year-on-year since mid-2024. For the February month, we expect an initial print of around +0.6%, although both that and the 0.2% rise in January are likely to be revised down a little in subsequent releases.

Monthly Employment Indicator



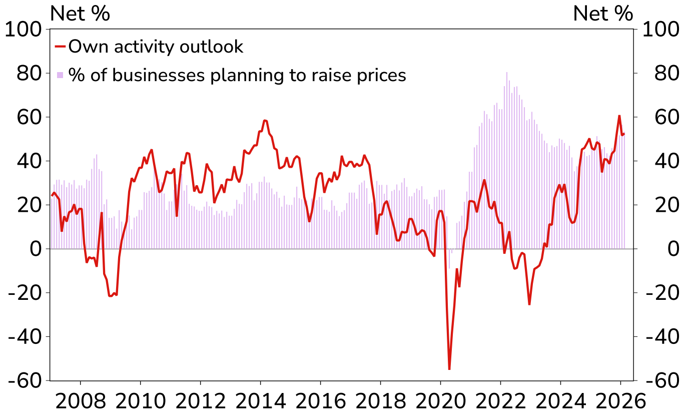
Source: Stats NZ, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

NZ: Mar ANZ Business Confidence (index)

Mar 31, Last: 59.2

ANZ's monthly survey is likely to show a sharp deterioration in business sentiment since the start of the Iran conflict – and as with their consumer confidence survey, it will have worsened over the course of the month, with the headline result only capturing the average. The surge in fuel prices will no doubt send inflation expectations and pricing intentions higher as well; the big question for the RBNZ will be around the potential for ongoing rounds of price increases, given that businesses' own customers are also facing a significant hit to their purchasing power.

Business confidence high prior to Iran conflict



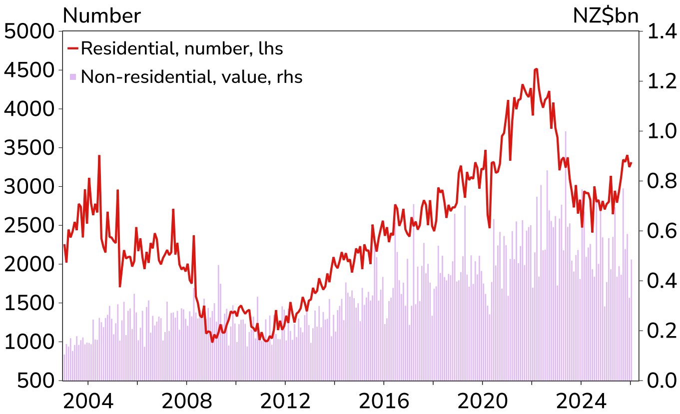
Source: ANZ, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

NZ: Feb Building Consents (%mth)

Apr 1, Last: 1.9, Westpac f/c: 5.0

Following a modest 2% rise in January, we're forecasting a 5% rise in dwelling consent numbers in February. That's in part due to an expected bounce in multi-unit consents after softness in January. More notably, if we smooth through the monthly swings, the total number of homes consented over the past 12 months has been trending higher and looks set to reach its highest level since 2023. But while this is encouraging, the lift in consents does pre-date the Middle East conflict and related increases in uncertainty around the economic outlook. We expect those factors will weigh on new construction over the year ahead.

Building consents picking up



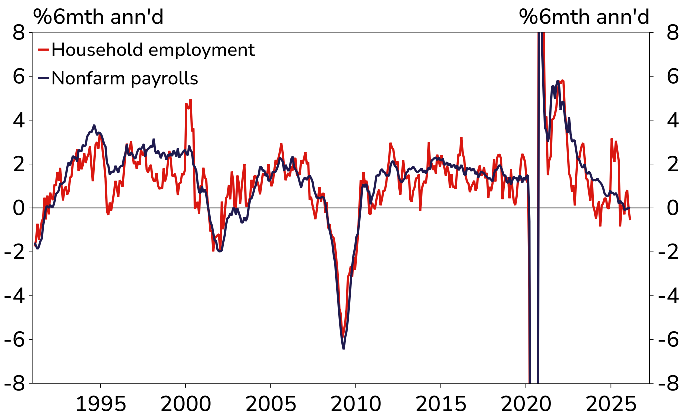
Source: Stats NZ, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

US: Mar employment report

Apr 3, payrolls, Last: -92k, WBC f/c: 70k, Mkt f/c: 51k
Apr 3, U/E rate, Last: 4.4%, WBC f/c: 4.4%, Mkt f/c: 4.4%

The US labour market surprised to the downside in February, with 92k jobs lost in the month and a 69k cumulative downward revision to December and January. Nonfarm payrolls employment rose by just 13k per month over the year to February, a marked step down from 89k the year prior. If this trend rate of growth continues for employment, the unemployment rate will edge up towards 5.0% through the remainder of the year. Given the comparatively low level of participation, there is also a risk of a step change in the unemployment rate any given month. For the FOMC, downside risks will have to be balanced against inflation pressures.

Labour demand has stalled



Source: BLS, Macrobond, Westpac Economics

What to watch

	For	Data/Event	Unit	Last	Market f/c	Westpac f/c	Risk/Comment
Mon 30							
NZ	Feb	Monthly Employment Indicator	%mth	0.2	–	0.6	Signs of picking up prior to the Iran conflict.
Eur	Mar	Economic Confidence Indicator	index	98.3	–	–	Economic sentiment set to drop on weak consumer confidence.
US	Mar	Dallas Fed Manufacturing survey	index	0.2	–	–	Volatile, but pointing to a tentative improvement in 2026.
		Fedspeak	–	–	–	–	Williams.
Tue 31							
Aus	Mar	RBA Minutes	–	–	–	–	Will provide more colour around the 5–4 split vote to hike.
	Feb	Private Sector Credit	%mth	0.5	0.6	0.6	With house prices firm credit growth should see support.
NZ	Mar	ANZ Business Confidence	index	59.2	–	–	An immediate response to the Iran conflict and fuel prices.
Jpn	Mar	Tokyo CPI	%ann	1.6	1.6	–	Core inflation decelerating but still sustainable.
	Feb	Jobless Rate	%	2.7	2.7	–	Labour market is softening marginally.
	Feb	Industrial Production	%mth	4.3	–2.0	–	Very strong start to the year for factory output.
Chn	Mar	NBS Manufacturing PMI	index	49.0	50.2	–	Factory activity softened as expected ...
	Mar	NBS Non–Manufacturing PMI	index	49.5	50.0	–	... post-LNY data will provide a clearer read.
Eur	Mar	HICP Inflation	%ann	1.9	2.7	–	ECB now forecasting inflation above target in 2026.
UK	Q4	GDP	%qtr	0.1	–	–	Final estimate.
US	Jan	S&P/CS Home Price Index	%mth	0.5	–	–	Stabilising but on fragile footing as confidence falters.
	Mar	Chicago PMI	index	57.7	–	–	Middle East conflict brings apparent exuberance into question.
	Mar	Conf. Board Consumer Confidence	index	91.2	88.0	–	Confidence revisiting pandemic- and tariff-era lows.
	Feb	JOLTS Job Openings	000s	6946	–	–	Labour market is not a source of inflationary pressure.
		Fedspeak	–	–	–	–	Goolsbee.
Wed 01							
Aus	Feb	Dwelling Approvals	%mth	–7.2	6.0	5.0	Volatile high-rise approvals to come off an 18-month low.
NZ	Feb	Building Permits	%mth	1.9	–	5.0	Consent issuance to continue trending higher.
Jpn	Q1	Tankan Large Manufacturers	index	15	16	–	How will manufacturers react to offshore risks?
Chn	Mar	RatingDog Manufacturing PMI	index	52.1	52.5	–	Suggests export-facing businesses are faring better.
Eur	Feb	Unemployment Rate	%	6.1	6.1	–	Continues to surprise and hit new record lows.
US	Mar	ADP Employment Change	000s	63	40	–	Been on the firmer side of official payrolls figures of late.
	Feb	Retail Sales	%mth	–0.2	0.4	–	Momentum decelerating but consistent with growth at trend.
	Mar	ISM Manufacturing	index	52.4	52.3	–	Echoing the positive signals from regional surveys recently.
		Fedspeak	–	–	–	–	Musalem.
World	Mar	S&P Global Manufacturing PMI	index	–	–	–	Final estimate for Japan, Europe, UK and US.
Thu 02							
Aus	Feb	Goods Trade Balance	$bn	2.6	2.9	1.5	Adverse weather disruptions to major commodity exports.
	Q2	Job Vacancies	%qtr	–0.2	–	3.0	Monthly indicators point to a bounce in Q1.
US	Feb	Trade Balance	US$bn	–54.5	–66.0	–	Volatile as companies adapt to tariffs.
		Initial Jobless Claims	000s	–	–	–	Still at a low level versus history.
Fri 03							
Chn	Mar	RatingDog Services PMI	index	56.7	53.7	–	Suggests Lunar New Year holiday spend was firm.
US	Mar	Nonfarm Payrolls	000s	–92	51	70	Jobs growth revised lower, strikes also temporarily weighing.
	Mar	Unemployment Rate	%	4.4	4.4	4.4	Constrained labour supply keeps unemployment low ...
	Mar	Average Hourly Earnings	%mth	0.4	0.3	–	... and wages growth fairly robust.
	Mar	ISM Services	index	56.1	–	–	Shaky confidence puts services activity boom at risk.
World	Mar	S&P Global Services PMI	index	–	–	–	Final estimate for Japan, US.

Economic & financial forecasts

Interest rate forecasts

Australia	Latest (27 Mar)	Jun–26	Sep–26	Dec–26	Mar–27	Jun–27	Sep–27	Dec–27	Mar–28	Jun–28
Cash	4.10	4.35	4.35	4.35	4.35	4.35	4.35	3.85	3.60	3.60
90 Day BBSW	4.30	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.45	4.45	4.30	3.80	3.70	3.70
3 Year Swap	4.80	4.60	4.45	4.40	4.35	4.25	4.10	3.95	3.80	3.60
3 Year Bond	4.82	4.62	4.47	4.42	4.37	4.27	4.12	3.97	3.82	3.62
10 Year Bond	5.11	4.95	4.90	4.85	4.80	4.75	4.75	4.70	4.70	4.70
10 Year Spread to US (bps)	70	65	55	45	35	25	20	10	5	0
United States										
Fed Funds	3.625	3.375	3.375	3.375	3.375	3.375	3.375	3.375	3.375	3.375
US 10 Year Bond	4.42	4.30	4.35	4.40	4.45	4.50	4.55	4.60	4.65	4.70
New Zealand										
Cash	2.25	2.25	2.25	2.50	3.00	3.50	3.75	4.00	4.25	4.25
90 Day Bill	2.54	2.45	2.50	2.90	3.40	3.75	4.00	4.25	4.45	4.45
2 Year Swap	3.52	3.60	3.85	4.10	4.30	4.40	4.40	4.40	4.35	4.30
10 Year Bond	4.76	4.80	4.95	4.95	5.05	5.10	5.10	5.10	5.10	5.10
10 Year Spread to US (bps)	34	50	60	55	60	60	55	50	45	40

Exchange rate forecasts

	Latest (27 Mar)	Jun–26	Sep–26	Dec–26	Mar–27	Jun–27	Sep–27	Dec–27	Mar-28	Jun-28
AUD/USD	0.6909	0.72	0.72	0.73	0.73	0.74	0.74	0.74	0.73	0.73
NZD/USD	0.5761	0.59	0.61	0.62	0.64	0.66	0.67	0.67	0.67	0.665
USD/JPY	159.64	156	155	154	152	150	148	146	144	142
EUR/USD	1.1542	1.17	1.18	1.19	1.20	1.21	1.22	1.22	1.22	1.22
GBP/USD	1.3343	1.35	1.36	1.37	1.38	1.39	1.40	1.41	1.41	1.41
USD/CNY	6.9128	6.85	6.80	6.70	6.60	6.50	6.45	6.40	6.35	6.35
AUD/NZD	1.1963	1.22	1.18	1.18	1.14	1.12	1.11	1.10	1.10	1.10

Australian economic forecasts

	2025		2026				2027		Calendar years			
% Change	**Q3**	**Q4**	**Q1f**	**Q2f**	**Q3f**	**Q4f**	**Q1f**	**Q2f**	**2025**	**2026f**	**2027f**	**2028f**
GDP %qtr	0.5	0.8	0.5	0.1	0.3	0.4	0.5	0.5	–	–	–	–
%yr end	2.1	2.6	2.6	1.9	1.7	1.4	1.4	1.8	2.6	1.4	2.0	2.8
Unemployment rate %	4.3	4.3	4.2	4.3	4.5	4.7	4.7	4.6	4.3	4.7	4.5	4.4
Wages (WPI) %qtr	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.8	0.7	0.8	–	–	–	–
%yr end	3.3	3.4	3.3	3.2	3.2	3.2	3.2	3.2	3.4	3.2	3.0	3.4
CPI Headline %qtr	1.3	0.6	1.4	2.1	0.7	0.3	0.5	0.6	–	–	–	–
%yr end	3.2	3.6	4.1	5.5	4.8	4.5	3.6	2.1	3.6	4.5	2.4	2.7
CPI Trimmed Mean %qtr	1.0	0.9	0.9	1.0	1.0	0.9	0.8	0.7	–	–	–	–
%yr end	3.0	3.4	3.5	3.9	4.0	4.0	3.8	3.5	3.4	4.0	3.0	2.7

New Zealand economic forecasts

	2025		2026				2027		Calendar years			
% Change	**Q3**	**Q4**	**Q1f**	**Q2f**	**Q3f**	**Q4f**	**Q1f**	**Q2f**	**2024**	**2025**	**2026f**	**2027f**
GDP %qtr	0.9	0.2	0.8	-0.4	0.5	1.0	1.4	0.8	–	–	–	–
Annual avg change	-0.6	0.2	0.6	1.2	1.3	1.5	1.9	2.4	-0.3	0.2	1.5	3.5
Unemployment rate %	5.3	5.4	5.4	5.6	5.6	5.4	5.1	4.9	5.1	5.4	5.4	4.6
CPI %qtr	1.0	0.6	0.8	1.6	1.0	0.4	0.3	0.1	–	–	–	–
Annual change	3.0	3.1	2.9	4.1	4.0	3.8	3.3	1.7	2.2	3.1	3.8	1.7

Corporate Directory

Westpac Economics / Australia

Sydney
Level 19, 275 Kent Street
Sydney NSW 2000
Australia

E: economics@westpac.com.au

Luci Ellis
Chief Economist Westpac Group
E: luci.ellis@westpac.com.au

Matthew Hassan
Head of Australian Macro–Forecasting
E: mhassan@westpac.com.au

Elliot Clarke
Head of International Economics
E: eclarke@westpac.com.au

Sian Fenner
Head of Business and Industry Economics
E: sian.fenner@westpac.com.au

Justin Smirk
Senior Economist
E: jsmirk@westpac.com.au

Pat Bustamante
Senior Economist
E: pat.bustamante@westpac.com.au

Mantas Vanagas
Senior Economist
E: mantas.vanagas@westpac.com.au

Ryan Wells
Economist
E: ryan.wells@westpac.com.au

Illiana Jain
Economist
E: illiana.jain@westpac.com.au

Neha Sharma
Economist
E: neha.sharma1@westpac.com.au

Luka Belobrajdic
Economist
E: luka.belobrajdic@westpac.com.au

Westpac Economics / New Zealand

Auckland
Takutai on the Square
Level 8, 16 Takutai Square
Auckland, New Zealand

E: economics@westpac.co.nz

Kelly Eckhold
Chief Economist NZ
E: kelly.eckhold@westpac.co.nz

Michael Gordon
Senior Economist
E: michael.gordon@westpac.co.nz

Darren Gibbs
Senior Economist
E: darren.gibbs@westpac.co.nz

Satish Ranchhod
Senior Economist
E: satish.ranchhod@westpac.co.nz

Paul Clark
Industry Economist
E: paul.clarke@westpac.co.nz

Westpac Economics / Fiji

Suva
1 Thomson Street
Suva, Fiji

Shamal Chand
Senior Economist
E: shamal.chand@westpac.com.au

IQ

westpaciq.com.au

Things you should know

We respect your privacy: You can view the New Zealand Privacy Policy here, or the Australian Group Privacy Statement here. Each time someone visits our site, data is captured so that we can accurately evaluate the quality of our content and make improvements for you. We may at times use technology to capture data about you to help us to better understand you and your needs, including potentially for the purposes of assessing your individual reading habits and interests to allow us to provide suggestions regarding other reading material which may be suitable for you.

Disclaimer

This information has been prepared by Westpac and is intended for information purposes only. It is not intended to reflect any recommendation or financial advice and investment decisions should not be based on it. This information does not constitute an offer, a solicitation of an offer, or an inducement to subscribe for, purchase or sell any financial instrument or to enter into a legally binding contract. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice. Certain types of transactions, including those involving futures, options and high yield securities give rise to substantial risk and are not suitable for all investors. We recommend that you seek your own independent legal or financial advice before proceeding with any investment decision.

This information may contain material provided by third parties. While such material is published with the necessary permission none of Westpac or its related entities accepts any responsibility for the accuracy or completeness of any such material. Although we have made every effort to ensure this information is free from error, none of Westpac or its related entities warrants the accuracy, adequacy or completeness of this information, or otherwise endorses it in any way. Except where contrary to law, Westpac Group intend by this notice to exclude liability for this information. This information is subject to change without notice and none of Westpac or its related entities is under any obligation to update this information or correct any inaccuracy which may become apparent at a later date. This information may contain or incorporate by reference forward looking statements. The words "believe", "anticipate", "expect", "intend", "plan", "predict", "continue", "assume", "positioned", "may", "will", "should", "shall", "risk" and other similar expressions that are predictions of or indicate future events and future trends identify forward-looking statements. These forward-looking statements include all matters that are not historical facts. Past performance is not a reliable indicator of future performance, nor are forecasts of future performance. Whilst every effort has been taken to ensure that the assumptions on which any forecasts are based are reasonable, the forecasts may be affected by incorrect assumptions or by known or unknown risks and uncertainties. The ultimate outcomes may differ substantially from any forecasts.

Conflicts of Interest: In the normal course of offering banking products and services to its clients, the Westpac Group may act in several capacities (including issuer, market maker, underwriter, distributor, swap counterparty and calculation agent) simultaneously with respect to a financial instrument, giving rise to potential conflicts of interest which may impact the performance of a financial instrument. The Westpac Group may at any time transact or hold a position (including hedging and trading positions) for its own account or the account of a client in any financial instrument which may impact the performance of that financial instrument.

Author(s) disclaimer and declaration: The author(s) confirms that (a) no part of his/her compensation was, is, or will be, directly or indirectly, related to any views or (if applicable) recommendations expressed in this material; (b) this material accurately reflects his/her personal views about the financial products, companies or issuers (if applicable) and is based on sources reasonably believed to be reliable and accurate; (c) to the best of the author's knowledge, they are not in receipt of inside information and this material does not contain inside information; and (d) no other part of the Westpac Group has made any attempt to influence this material.

Further important information regarding sustainability related content: This material may contain statements relating to environmental, social and governance (ESG) topics. These are subject to known and unknown risks, and there are significant uncertainties, limitations, risks and assumptions in the metrics, modelling, data, scenarios, reporting and analysis on which the statements rely. In particular, these areas are rapidly evolving and maturing, and there are variations in approaches and common standards and practice, as well as uncertainty around future related policy and legislation. Some material may include information derived from publicly available sources that have not been independently verified. No representation or warranty is made as to the accuracy, completeness or reliability of the information. There is a risk that the analysis, estimates, judgements, assumptions, views, models, scenarios or projections used may turn out to be incorrect. These risks may cause actual outcomes to differ materially from those expressed or implied. The ESG-related statements in this material do not constitute advice, nor are they guarantees or predictions of future performance, and Westpac gives no representation, warranty or assurance (including as to the quality, accuracy or completeness of the statements). You should seek your own independent advice.

Additional country disclosures:

Australia: Westpac holds an Australian Financial Services Licence (No. 233714). You can access Westpac's Financial Services Guide here or request a copy from your Westpac point of contact. To the extent that this information contains any general advice, it has been prepared without taking into account your objectives, financial situation or needs and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the advice.

New Zealand: In New Zealand, Westpac Institutional Bank refers to the brand under which products and services are provided by either Westpac (NZ division) or Westpac New Zealand Limited (company number 1763882), the New Zealand incorporated subsidiary of Westpac ("WNZL"). Any product or service made available by WNZL does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WNZL). Neither Westpac nor its other subsidiaries guarantee or otherwise support the performance of WNZL in respect of any such product. WNZL is not an authorised deposit-taking institution for the purposes of Australian prudential standards. The current disclosure statements for the New Zealand branch of Westpac and WNZL can be obtained at www.westpac.co.nz.

Singapore: This material has been prepared and issued for distribution in Singapore to institutional investors, accredited investors and expert investors (as defined in the applicable Singapore laws and regulations) only. Recipients of this material in Singapore should contact Westpac Singapore Branch in respect of any matters arising from, or in connection with, this material. Westpac Singapore Branch holds a wholesale banking licence and is subject to supervision by the Monetary Authority of Singapore.

Disclaimer continues overleaf ▶

Fiji: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac Fiji are available from www.westpac.com.fj © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia and registered as a branch in Fiji. The liability of its members is limited.

Papua New Guinea: Unless otherwise specified, the products and services for Westpac PNG are available from www.westpac.com.pg © Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141. This information does not take your personal circumstances into account and before acting on it you should consider the appropriateness of the information for your financial situation. Westpac Banking Corporation ABN 33 007 457 141 is incorporated in NSW Australia. Westpac is represented in Papua New Guinea by Westpac Bank - PNG - Limited. The liability of its members is limited.

U.S: Westpac operates in the United States of America as a federally licensed branch, regulated by the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency. Westpac is also registered with the US Commodity Futures Trading Commission ("CFTC") as a Swap Dealer, but is neither registered as, or affiliated with, a Futures Commission Merchant registered with the US CFTC. The services and products referenced above are not insured by the Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation ("FDIC"). Westpac Capital Markets, LLC ('WCM'), a wholly-owned subsidiary of Westpac, is a broker-dealer registered under the U.S. Securities Exchange Act of 1934 ('the Exchange Act') and member of the Financial Industry Regulatory Authority ('FINRA'). In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WCM other than as provided for in certain legal agreements between Westpac and WCM and obligations of WCM do not represent liabilities of Westpac.

This communication is provided for distribution to U.S. institutional investors in reliance on the exemption from registration provided by Rule 15a-6 under the Exchange Act and is not subject to all of the independence and disclosure standards applicable to debt research reports prepared for retail investors in the United States. WCM is the U.S. distributor of this communication and accepts responsibility for the contents of this communication. Transactions by U.S. customers of any securities referenced herein should be effected through WCM. All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WCM. If you would like to speak to someone regarding any security mentioned herein, please contact WCM on +1 212 389 1269. Investing in any non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments mentioned in this communication may present certain risks. The securities of non-U.S. issuers may not be registered with, or be subject to the regulations of, the SEC in the United States. Information on such non-U.S. securities or related financial instruments may be limited. Non-U.S. companies may not be subject to audit and reporting standards and regulatory requirements comparable to those in effect in the United States. The value of any investment or income from any securities or related derivative instruments denominated in a currency other than U.S. dollars is subject to exchange rate fluctuations that may have a positive or adverse effect on the value of or income from such securities or related derivative instruments.

The author of this communication is employed by Westpac and is not registered or qualified as a research analyst, representative, or associated person of WCM or any other U.S. broker-dealer under the rules of FINRA, any other U.S. self-regulatory organisation, or the laws, rules or regulations of any State. Unless otherwise specifically stated, the views expressed herein are solely those of the author and may differ from the information, views or analysis expressed by Westpac and/or its affiliates.

UK: The London branch of Westpac is authorised in the United Kingdom by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) and is subject to regulation by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA) and limited regulation by the PRA (Financial Services Register number: 124586). The London branch of Westpac is registered at Companies House as a branch established in the United Kingdom (Branch No. BR000106). Details about the extent of the regulation of Westpac's London branch by the PRA are available from us on request.

This communication is not being made to or distributed to, and must not be passed on to, the general public in the United Kingdom. Rather, this communication is being made only to and is directed at (a) those persons falling within the definition of Investment Professionals (set out in Article 19(5) of the Financial Services and Markets Act 2000 (Financial Promotion) Order 2005 (the "Order")); (b) those persons falling within the definition of high net worth companies, unincorporated associations etc. (set out in Article 49(2)of the Order; (c) other persons to whom it may lawfully be communicated in accordance with the Order or (d) any persons to whom it may otherwise lawfully be made (all such persons together being referred to as "relevant persons"). Any person who is not a relevant person should not act or rely on this communication or any of its contents. In the same way, the information contained in this communication is intended for "eligible counterparties" and "professional clients" as defined by the rules of the Financial Conduct Authority and is not intended for "retail clients". Westpac expressly prohibits you from passing on the information in this communication to any third party.

European Economic Area ("EEA"): This material may be distributed to you by either: (i) Westpac directly, or (ii) Westpac Europe GmbH ("WEG") under a sub-licensing arrangement. WEG has not edited or otherwise modified the content of this material. WEG is authorised in Germany by the Federal Financial Supervision Authority ('BaFin') and subject to its regulation. WEG's supervisory authorities are BaFin and the German Federal Bank ('Deutsche Bundesbank'). WEG is registered with the commercial register ('Handelsregister') of the local court of Frankfurt am Main under registration number HRB 118483. In accordance with APRA's Prudential Standard 222 'Association with Related Entities', Westpac does not stand behind WEG other than as provided for in certain legal agreements (a risk transfer, sub-participation and collateral agreement) between Westpac and WEG and obligations of WEG do not represent liabilities of Westpac. Any product or service made available by WEG does not represent an offer from Westpac or any of its subsidiaries (other than WEG). All disclaimers set out with respect to Westpac apply equally to WEG.

This communication is not intended for distribution to, or use by any person or entity in any jurisdiction or country where such distribution or use would be contrary to local law or regulation.

This communication contains general commentary, research, and market colour. The communication does not constitute investment advice. The material may contain an 'investment recommendation' and/or 'information recommending or suggesting an investment', both as defined in Regulation (EU) No 596/2014 (including as applicable in the United Kingdom) ("MAR"). In accordance with the relevant provisions of MAR, reasonable care has been taken to ensure that the material has been objectively presented and that interests or conflicts of interest of the sender concerning the financial instruments to which that information relates have been disclosed.

Investment recommendations must be read alongside the specific disclosure which accompanies them and the general disclosure which can be found here. Such disclosure fulfils certain additional information requirements of MAR and associated delegated legislation and by accepting this communication you acknowledge that you are aware of the existence of such additional disclosure and its contents.

To the extent this communication comprises an investment recommendation it is classified as non-independent research. It has not been prepared in accordance with legal requirements designed to promote the independence of investment research and therefore constitutes a marketing communication. Further, this communication is not subject to any prohibition on dealing ahead of the dissemination of investment research.